

Textual Commentary on the Solid Rock Hebrew Bible

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Please note that these are my working files, not originally intended for publication; citations, therefore, are normally extremely vague and abbreviated, and by no means are all my thoughts, research, influences, and such fully or clearly expressed. Caution in using this material and indulgence toward my chicken scratch is requested; nevertheless, it is hoped that there might be a few gems of insight buried in this mine, or least motivation for others to do the work of establishing and explaining the text of the OT better than I have.

Number of S+- readings / number of words in book / the first number is what percentage of the second?

Word Counts (L; word counts taken from Andersen and Forbes) **Canonical Order (BHS)**

Genesis: 51 / 20613 = 0.247%

Exodus: 31 / 16713 = 0.185%

Leviticus: 23 / 11950 = 0.192%

Numbers: 48 / 16413 = 0.292%

Deuteronomy: 20 / 14294 = 0.140%

Joshua: 43 / 10051 = 0.428%

Judges: 38 / 9885 = 0.384%

Samuel: 297 / 24301 = 1.222%

Kings: 154 / 25421 = 0.606%

Isaiah: 97 / 16933 = 0.573%

Jeremiah: 103 / 21835 = 0.472%

Ezekiel: 199 / 18730 = 1.062%

MinP: 73 / 14355 = 0.510%

Psalms: 199 / 19586 = 1.016%

Proverbs: 74 / 6915 = 1.070%

Job: 70 / 8343 = 0.839%

Song of Songs: 6 / 1250 = 0.480%

Ruth: 5 / 1296 = 0.386%

Lamentations: 10 / 1542 = 0.649%

Ecclesiastes: 25 / 2987 = 0.837%

Esther: 6 / 3045 = 0.197%

Daniel: 25 / 5919 = 0.422%

Ezra-Nehemiah: 58 / 9065 = 0.640%

Chronicles: 159 / 24058 = 0.661%

Total = 305498

Average = 0.561% (median .495)

[Last update: 11/24/25]

Books in Order Of Accuracy:

[T] Deuteronomy

[T] Exodus

[T] Leviticus

[W] Esther

[T] Genesis

[T] Numbers

[P] Judges

[W] Ruth

[P] Joshua

[W] Daniel
 [P] Jeremiah
 [P] MinP
 [W] Song of Songs
 [W] Lamentations
 [P] Isaiah
 [P] Kings
 [W] Ezra-Nehemiah
 [W] Chronicles
 [W] Ecclesiastes
 [W] Job
 [W] Psalms
 [P] Ezekiel
 [W] Proverbs
 [P] Samuel

[relative to 1st edition, the main change is that Psalms moved into fourth from the end, and Ezekiel and Proverbs swapped positions, Proverbs now being the second most-damaged book (though still well behind Samuel)]

Gen 1:9a

Admittedly, it is not certain that G so read, but quite possibly, and other sources, including a Q source, do so read. See v7. Assimilation it possible (so BHQ), but we have found elsewhere (see on Sam below) that a *lamedh* can be misread as a *he* (for damage to the beginning of a text see Lunn on Mk 16 and, indeed, the frontispiece to Hendel); such would have been facilitated by the fact that השמים is very common in the OT and occurs in the near context, while לשמים is extremely rare and occurs only far away.

Gen 1:9b

The reading of G 4QGen^{h1} is intrinsically more likely than that of M, given the verbal linkage with the following verse that it represents. True, G tends to harmonize in this chapter, but the difference between these two readings is only a single letter. BHQ (1:*78) notes that graphic confusion can only have originated in a square script, but graphic confusion is not the only plausible explanation for the M reading: The word מקום is extremely common in the OT and in Hebrew usage generally, while מקוה is rare at least in the OT; unconscious substitution of a more for a less common word might well have led to the M reading. NICOT (1A: 124 n¹) argues that the *mem* which which מקום ends is enclitic and thus the M reading is semantically equivalent to the G reading, but the enclitic *mem* lends itself to poetry far more often than to prose, making this suggestion unlikely.

Gen 1:11

Hendel (120) ascribes M to “parablepsis.” The situation is not wholly clear, but the the visual similarities in the wording זרע ועץ (in the Siloam font: זרע ועץ) could have led to a problem, and M is difficult.

Gen 1:14a, b

This pair of readings is shared by the pair 4QGen^{g,k} – MSS which are quite different in other respects (though to my untrained eye it seems just possible that 4QGen^g also has ולשנים later in the verse). One spelling or another of אור is not appreciably notable, but the defective of מועד is very rare indeed. Perhaps proto-MT copied these two words as a unit, and inadvertently transferred the *waw* of לאתות to ולמעדים in view of his subconscious expectation of how the latter word would be spelled.

Gen 1:14c

Hendel (41-42) prefers the longer reading (“parablepsis,” 41).

The density of apparent errors in M in this chapter suggest G is preferable here. See further BHQ, and on

4QGen^k see Ulrich.

Gen 1:29

Hendel (32) supposes anticipation of 3:2 or 3:3, which is possible, but the above (first line: FrankRuehl; second line: Siloam; third line: Lachish) suggest another explanation: Corrupt dittography.

Gen 2:20a

See Hendel (44): Haplography easily explains the loss, difficult indeed as the *middle* of three parallel items.

Gen 4:8

See Hendel (46-47): Anticipation of the similar clause later in the same verse.

Gen 4:26

See Hendel (49), though we are inclined to explain the variant a bit differently (transposition + aural error; subsequent addition of a helping letter).

Gen 5:29

M can be explained it at least three ways: (1) The etymology is inexact, but such was not the intent or a desideratum. (2) The *mem* is enclitic. (3) The literary connection is to חן in 6:8 (Kalimi, *Methathesis in the Hebrew Bible*, 30-31. The first option is definitely possible, but with יניחנו as such a ready option (see below), it seems not to be the *best* option. The second option would be appealing if an enclitic *mem* of this sort is a legitimate early biblical Hebrew morpheme, but I am not sure that is is. The third option seems unlikely as it is far less obvious than the naming formula, and 6:8 is fairly far removed in space from the present verse; other explanations seem much more compelling.

G seems to be the best option, for (1) it explains the etymology / naming formula, and (2) it explains the appearance on M fairly clearly as (a) *mem/yodh* confusion in the paleo script + transposition, (b) confusion with the נחם root, or (c) a combination of these two errors. So also (at least) Ginsburg.

Gen 7:20

See Hendel (53). Possibly a directional variant, in that *he* → *resh* is easier to posit than the reverse.

Gen 8:20b

While otherwise the defective reading might be preferable, it appears that L has very slim external support here (Ginsburg cites ירושלמי) moreover, L erred with respect to *plene*/defective, albeit in the other direction, earlier in this verse (with, if anything, perhaps still slimmer support).

Gen 11:31

M is rather clearly a transcriptional error. See Hendel, and further NAC 103-104 (the latter source is noncommittal about the VU, but the comments there strongly support the non-MT reading).

Gen 13:8

L might be unique here (having checked Ginsburg, VDHTxt); the extra *yodh* might be a late *plene* spelling or a mechanical repetition. Such a form occurs elsewhere only in 16:5.

Gen 14:14

It is not clear whether וירק can bear the sense required by the passage, and it seems that וירק can (see BHQ, CDCH, 76b {and HALOT?}). Confusion between ד and ר is ubiquitous in the MS tradition.

Gen 18:10

waw/nun confusion, facilitated by the occurrence of הנה in the previous verse.

Gen 19:20a

L seems to be alone in this, so its וְהָיָה, rather than being a rare survival of that form in the Pentateuch, is probably an inadvertent error on the part of the scribe of L, inadvertently writing what he heard and/or expected in his mind according to non-Pentateuch grammar rather than what actually lay in front of him.

Gen 19:33

The anomalous הָיָה here and in 30:16, 32:23, and 1 Sam 19:10 puzzle J-M (138h) and W-O, both of whom (iirc) incline toward correcting the text in at least the Genesis passages. SamP (iirc) has הָיָה throughout Gen; in 1 Sam, 4QSama is not there extant, while 4QSamb is damaged (Ulrich reconstructs as הָיָה, if I am not mistaken). McCarter (39) points out that “*h* was written three times in a row.” But while that *could* explain the error, it is striking to me that in all four cases the preceding word is לֵילָה. Now, HALOT (1:528a) describes the lexeme לֵיל as “poetic,” but surely this is only partly true (Ex 12:42 is legal, not poetic). If לֵיל were used in all these cases, the lexeme would occur in prose only in the Pentateuch (as it does in M; note again Ex 12:42) and in Samuel (notable for how it often uses slightly different words and idioms than biblical Hebrew generally), while the term’s rarity not only explains its occasional appearance in poetic texts (even that concentrates in Isaiah, and only elsewhere Lam 2:19) but how easy it would be for scribes to transpose a *he* from the beginning of הָיָה to the end of לֵיל, since לֵילָה is extremely common, while לֵיל is extremely rare (both הָיָה and הָיָה being, of course, extremely common, as well as easily confused visually). So in all four cases are we to read (granting any necessary prefixes) לֵיל הָיָה? The case is a bit speculative, yet ties together strands from intrinsic and transcriptional probabilities—rather beautifully, to my mind.

Gen 22:13

It is difficult to account for this construction. There's a chance it could mean “another,” in which case Isaac is said to be a ram in the sense of being a(n intended) sacrifice, but this is a stretch; perhaps it means that the ram was caught in the thicket but behind in its from the vantage point of Abraham. Both approaches are difficult from the Hebrew point of view. My preferred approach is to note that many manuscripts and ancient translations represent אָחֵד in place of אֶחָד, and that in both ancient and modern scripts *daleth* and *resh* are extremely similar to the eye. In other words, I suspect that the original reading was אֶחָד, i.e. “a” ram (for the construction, see e.g., Dan 8:3; in BLB, search for וְהָנָה plus אֶחָד for plenty more). If this is correct, the emphasis is on the surprise that at this moment some ram would happen to wander to and get stuck beside Abraham and Isaac.

Gen 24:30

On the intrinsic evidence see BHQ 137*. The error in M could be near haplography in the paleo script (*waw* and *taw* being somewhat similar), or perhaps the *waw* was first transposed to create כְּרִאוֹת, then the (seemingly) *plene* spelling became defective.

Gen 24:62

The source of the error is not wholly transposed, but seems to be partly near haplography (*beth/mem*) and partly mechanical assimilation to the *aleph* at or near the end of the surrounding words.

Gen 25:4

Following Hilleli.

Gen 27:3

It is possible that Qr is correct, as it seems more in common with Mosaic usage, and that the Kt is a sort of assimilation to וְצֹדָה two words earlier, and that the OG supports the Qr; then again, Kt could be an assimilation or some other error. In the uncertainty of the case, it seems better to stick with Kt, but a marginal reading would be merited.

{Post-script: In light of a similar situation in 39:20, the Qr is preferable.}

Gen 27:5

See *Metathesis* (25). (NET wrongly sees a G plus here, wrongly retroverting the OG.) {Post-script: By way of refinement, I originally put down אביהו, presumably based on *Metathesis*, but Moses does not use that suffix with this noun, so I have adjusted to אביו. Corrupt metathesis is at work in any case.}

Gen 27:34

Following Ges 111h n². Near haplography (see end of v33).

Gen 29:34

M could be explained as either a vague 3rd person singular (“he came to be called”) or as having Jacob as its subject. But nowhere else in this chapter does anyone but the mother name the child, nor is there reason to think that in this instance alone there was a communal consensus or that Jacob took a particular interest. Rather M appears to be in error, due to (1) aural error, (2) assimilation to the large number of grammatically masculine forms earlier in this verse, (3) assimilation to the formula קרא שמו, which is more common than the formula קראה על שמו, to (4) the fact that the phrase על כן קרש occurs 13x (including several times in Gen prior to this point) vs. על קראה כן elsewhere occurring only in 30:6 (which lends intrinsic support to G here, and not much transcriptional evidence against it, since forwards assimilation is, as I recall, less frequent than backward assimilation) or (5) some combination of these things. True, the mother-naming situation occurs in the previous two verses, but those are formally rather different from here. Thus intrinsic and transcriptional evidence, while not indisputable, argue rather well for קראה, which has important external support.

Gen 30:34

See Huehnergard, “Asseverative,” 576^a: לו seems out of place here. V seems to have הן for הן (cf. Zech 4:7 – but I need to look into commentaries and lexicons re Zech 4:7 – and the ESV to our verse; but see also BDB sub הן for a good case that, perhaps especially in direct discourse, MT represents a legitimate usage), though this matter is separate from the question of לו. OG does not represent לו, but this is couldy either be because the translator did not understand it or because he felt it redundant. On the other hand, it is slightly possible that it is a dittograph after הן or הן. Perhaps since הן could easily have been taken by later scribes to mean “if,” and לו could also be understood that may in later times, this facilitated the error; examples of *he/lamedh* confusion certainly occur elsewhere, e.g. often in Sam. In so early a book as Gen, the ordinary syntax of the asseverative would most likely be honored. Tentatively, we accept a G-based minus of לו.

Gen 31:29

In the surrounding context, Laban's anger is clearly directed toward Jacob in particular, and indeed Laban's love for his (Laban's) daughters and grandchildren is protested. M is corrupt haplography in the paleo script.

Gen 36:1a

Following the Q spelling (cf. transcription in Textus 2023). Admittedly, this could be an assimilation to 26:34, but this MS seems pretty reliable in spelling, and that seems a rather distant and obscure sort of assimilation to posit. Also, a new document might be being used (36:1), making a different spelling as likely as not. (In 26:34, OG has Αἰλων (as here), which might point to a G reading אילון there, which would tend to emphasize the point that the move from defective to plene is more common than the reverse.)

Gen 36:2b

While NAC (2: 641 n³⁰) is inclined to retain MT (בת = “granddaughter”), it seems far easier (as BHQ 166* notes, Gen 36:24 and 1 Chr 1:38 and 1:40 are to be referred in this connection) to read בן (so, at least, BHQ 166* and NEB), especially as assimilation to the immediate context (two previous occurrences of בת earlier in the verse; the two forms are but one letter different; the last letter / vowel sound of ענה would suggest a feminine form to a scribe whose day no longer saw this name in active use) provides a ready explanation for the error in M(T).

A similar situation occurs in v14, where probably the antecedent error here, combined with very similar circumstances, prompted the same error. Cf. the repeated error of יעיש for יעוש in this chapter (on which see below).

Gen 36:2c

HALOT (1: 353^a) notes v20 in support of reading ההרי for ההוי here. While that is appealing, there may not be external evidence for that. {Have not yet checked P and V.} Interestingly, if I am reading the UPenn version of Gottingen correctly, there is versional support for *omitting* the term. Is it perhaps a corrupt vertical dittograph of the word ההחתי? For that term might well have been in the preceding line, and comes after אילון, which visually resembles צבעון. Now, BDB (s.v.) seems to think that הרי simply means “cave-dwellers” rather than being an ethnographic identifier. But again note v20, noting in that connection that Esau is associated with a *mountain* – so unless he dwelled *inside* the mountain {archaeological studies of the site?}, this would not seem to help here. (*Perhaps* a related error occurs in M-34:2, q.v. under Research Notes.)

Admittedly the situation is a bit unusual, but the minus here seems preferable in the light of v20.

Gen 36:5, 14

Note v18 where יעוש is undisputed and that in 1 Chr 8:39 the OG reads יעיש where the MT unitedly has יעוש, exhibiting the error in Kt-Gen 36:5, 14.

Post-script: Note that in v5 4Q1 has the Qr (see Textus 2023), lending further credence to this decision.

Gen 36:24

So HALOT (1:258a). Corrupt dittography of the preceding *nun*.

Gen 39:4

See Ges 155n. Either similarity to the following יש or to the overall shape of the preceding וכל accounts for its accidental loss.

Gen 39:6

Following Ges 137c. BHQ thinks an assimilation to v6, but does note the difficult syntax and the possibility of shared *Vorlage* behind SamP and OG. Probably a visual error.

Gen 39:36

See NAC 2: 658 n⁴⁴.

Gen 45:15

This spelling occurs several times elsewhere (and so is valid), always in the Pentateuch (and so fits authorial style).

Gen 46:13b

See BDB sub ירב.

Gen 48:7

This would be the only place where פדן is not followed by ארם, and the minus is explainable by homoioteleuton in the paleo script (the minus could also have happened in the square script, for מפדן and ארם are rather similar in terms of size and shape).

Gen 48:20

Homoioteleuton in the paleo script (or, less likely, assimilation to ישמך later in the verse). Agreeing with this reading is (at least) NEB.

Gen 49:4a

See BHQ – the external evidence for פָּחַזְתָּ for very strong. Admittedly, the error is a bit hard to explain: Perhaps due to the similarity of the right side of *taw* to *zayin* (similar apparent errors can be found elsewhere); or to the fact that the previous word is עָז, which both looks and sounds similar to the underlined portion of פָּחַזְתָּ, leading the latter word to terminate with the same letter as the former.

Gen 49:7-8

See Pericope vol. 4, p. 16.

Gen 49:13-14

See Pericope vol. 4, p. 18.

Gen 49:18-19

See Pericope vol. 4, p. 19.

Gen 49:19-20

Difficult. It is often said that G P V support עֲקֵבָם אֲשֶׁר, but (1) it is not altogether clear that all or perhaps even any support the presence of a *mem* (probably OG does; V might bear looking into as far as the intended sense of the Latin; P apparently depends on an inner-P variant), and (2) all (apparently; see Pericope vol. 4, pp. 19-20) support a sectional break between the verses, in which case movement of the *mem* from עֲקֵבָם to אֲשֶׁר is very hard to envision, the very circumstance which makes M hard to explain. That is, if the majority text (at least M^{ADL} and 17 MSS of SamP: so *ibid*, p. 20, n⁴²) is correct; if M^{F10} is correct in having no sectional break (*ibid*), then either (a) transposition of the *mem* to the wrong side of a word divider or (b) corrupt dittography after *beith* (in the herodian script) could explain the variation. The external support for a null division appears to be weak (Ginsburg, Davidson, VDH do not list MSS that do not break), yet in this context the addition of a break could be quite polygenetic. In favor of option A, BHQ points out that גִּיד is transitive, and the *mem* supplies an object.

But is it intrinsically possible/probable for there to be no sectional break between Gad and Asher?

{Analogous passages elsewhere?} If not, another approach would be to suppose that (1) the break attested in the ancient witnesses is original, (2) that the break was lost (probably accidentally) in proto-M, whereupon (3) the *mem* either arose secondarily or (more likely; see BHQ) shifted position accidentally prior to (4) an insertion by analogy of the other sections of the passage of a sectional break and (5) a later loss of the break in M^{F10}. This scenario is certainly complex, but difficult variation units like the present case might justify multi-step solutions. Tentatively, this approach is adopted.

Gen 49:25

M וְאֵל for G וְאֵל (on the retroversion see below) is visual error, or more specifically confusion of two words of very similar shapes and sounds; the preposition is carried over by ellipsis from the earlier מֵאֵל. (Recall that observation [of Hartley?] in Job that at least some styles of Hebrew poetry tolerate a like term recurring in parallelism.)

OG ο θεος ο εμος (notice the emphatic possessive pronoun) reflects וְאֵל שְׁדִי thus: The *waw* was emended to *he*, or skipped (accidentally?); שְׁדִי was analyzed as the relative pronoun שְׁ plus the Aramaic ה and the Hebrew 1st person suffix (cf. in *Hamlet on a Hill* on Aramaic and Hebrew running together in the minds of the OG translators).

Ex 1:10

So (at least) EEC, BDB. Mechanical assimilation to the ending of the previous words, facilitated by the resemblance of *waw* to the right half of *he*.

Ex 1:22

Propp thinks the plus is targumic, but the external evidence is impressive, and the plus seems to fit very well

both within the sentence and within the mood of the chapter. Moreover, the plus occurs between two words that are very visually similar, so this may be an extension of my principle that errors often occur in the space between two (near-)identical graphemes.

Ex 2:9

Following (per Propp) Sam MSS; see Ges on the intrinsic and transcriptional situation. If I recall, some MSS have הוּכִילי; could LA be an inner-MT error (waw/yodh confusion)?

Ex 2:17

Following Hilleli.

Ex 7:10

Following Q (see Textus 2023 article) and G. M is an unconscious (larger word to smaller word) substitute of a more common synonym. The variation posited here between וַיִּבֹּא לִפְנֵי and וַיִּבֹּא אֶל additionally seems the sort of minor variation to which Moses is prone.

Ex 7:21

Moses' staff normally has a possessive suffix; its absence in M here is most likely due to haplography (note the beginning of the next word).

Ex 8:13

M is a transcriptional error: See *Textus* 2018, 27-31.

Ex 8:19

Difficult. We tentatively prefer this option, noting, with one of the commentaries, the possible verbal link to וְהַפְלִיתִי in v18 and the fact that elsewhere *lamedh* has been known to become *daleth* through visual error. Another option cited in the secondary literature is פָּרְדֶּת*.

Ex 10:1

Faded final *mem* (Propp favors this iirc) or assimilation to earlier 3ms forms.

Ex 10:17

Mechanical anticipation of the following נָא? (Is this interpretation of the data hinted at in how EEC presents the variant?)

Ex 11:9

Following Hilleli.

Ex 14:9

The idiosyncrasy in L aside, on the orthography cf. Garr and Fassberg 1: 119.

Ex 14:20

Cf. the retroversion in BHK, though σατοζ και γγοφοζ is at least as likely to reflect חָשַׁךְ וְהַעֲנֵן as חָשַׁךְ וְהַעֲנֵן. We therefore modify only the verb (visual error) and the following אַת (ameliorating plus).

Ex 14:25

Following HALOT (1:748b). That MT is simply a defective spelling seems unlikely to me. EEC and KEL attempt to defend the MT, but implausibly in my view. Visual error, facilitated by the fact that סִיִּר is much more common than אִסִּר. Note also that a somewhat similar error occurs in M(T) in v20.

Ex 17:2

The external evidence for ומה for the second מה is very strong, and L (and inner-MT error?) could be near haplography after *yodh*, facilitated by the fact that מה occurs twice within a single verse multiple times in the HB. Once (Job 31:14) there is a ומה followed by a מה. More significantly, מה followed by ומה occurs only once, and that in the Pentateuch (Num 23:8).

Ex 19:3

It could be argued that G is a theological plus, but (1) does not handle similar cases like this (cf., e.g., v24), (2) there is great emphasis on the *mountain* in the immediate context, and (3) the word could easily have been lost, being small, wedged between two words similar to each other, and bearing resemblance to the preceding אל; the result also makes (superficial) sense without it, so the error, once made, would be easily overlooked.

Ex 19:18

M is intrinsically difficult, as (apart from, as BDB sub חרר, notes, Eze 26:18 and Is 41:5, where the use is either poetic or in reference to the inhabitants of those far-off lands) geography is nowhere else linked to this verb (BDD, *ibid*, supports G here). Graphic confusion is possible, not that the letters are similar in shape but that the letter sequences are identical in number, so a hasty scribe might have thought he saw one word. The immediate context could easily have suggested הר to a scribe. In sum, intrinsic evidence supports G, and transcriptional evidence makes the change from G to M plausible.

Ex 20:24a

External evidence is admittedly weak (P), but a scan of collocations of זכר with שם shows that the reading adopted here (and tentatively by BHS {others?}) is preferable on intrinsic grounds to M, and the faulty reading is explainable on transcriptional grounds (graphic confusion; see Talmon's essay).

Ex 20:24b

See Tov, *Text-critical Use* (93). Homoeoarchon explains MT, and there is no clear cause for assimilation in G. Cf. also Wevers' *Notes*.

Ex 21:22

Faulty word division, faulty dittography, and the addition of a helping letter explain M from G/Sam on transcriptional grounds; the opposite direction of change is hard to explain given the rare term employed in ולד, a term found elsewhere in the Pentateuch.

Ex 22:4

So NEB, Ginsburg, and cf. Wevers' *Notes* and WBC. homoeoteleuton, or line loss given the amount of material.

Ex 25:10

The previous instructions (viz. תעשו and ועשו in vv8-9) use the second person *plural*, yet the following (viz. וצפית and ועשית in v11) are in the *singular*. Intrinsically, the latter is probably more likely, in light of the sectional break between vv9-10. And there is a transcriptional explanation for M: Near haplography (note the *aleph* with which the next word ends) + *waw/yodh* confusion. (Less likely, M could be an assimilation to ועשו in v8.) Note also that Sam *does* support LXX here, while in v8 Sam *does not* support the singular in LXX (the latter being a secondary assimilation either in G or at the hands of the translator). In light of similar situations elsewhere (see the note on 25:37), it might be wise to preserve M as a marginal reading, but the reasons adduced for G here seem good, and the originality of the indicative form might have helped to prompt the probable assimilations (if they are not, in fact, original readings) alluded to in 35:37 and 27:7.

{Post-script: It seems that Talmon, 148-49, may discuss this.}

[Post-post-script: Propp also reads thus, but cf. v18 (where Propp retains M) and OG there.}

Ex 27:11

Following Ges 134n. (On the looseness of the LXX word order, cf. e.g. v9.)

Ex 27:15

Cf. on v11.

Ex 31:8

See Olariu (in THBS) 397n70, noting also that intrinsically speaking Pentateuchal usage suggests this reading as well.

Ex 32:11

Following a paleo MS (w/ G, assuming Wever, rather than Ralphs, is correct; it does seem to me that the new edition is an improvement on the older here). Cf. Propp, adding that this would seem to be an example of a longer word shrinking (a kind of haplography) facilitated by a more common word/expression.

Ex 34:10

So (most notably) HALOT (1:270a).

Ex 34:18

אשר appears to be the original reading of MT (if not of M), but OG appears to represent כאשר. There are about 10 instances of the former for every 1 of the latter in the OT, and they are only one letter different and very similar in sound, so אשר, the harder reading, is quite possibly an accident here.

Lev 1:7

Homoioteleuton in the paleo script, if not mechanical assimilation to the termination of the previous word (before the introduction of final letters). The intrinsic evidence is strong (cf. BHS): v8, v11, 2:2, 3:2, Num 3:3 (at least). (For a different, conjectural, solution, see Talmon. This latter solution is viewed favorably by WBC, though as I recall that source does not commit itself.)

Lev 2:6

BHQ argues that G etc. are “facilitating” (I think he uses exactly that term), but note the possibility of visual error and see the intrinsic arguments in WBC.

Lev 5:24

See BHQ, and cf. BDB, Ges, and WBC. I have tentatively supposed metathesis; another option is to read וחמשתיו, hypothesizing corrupt dittography. A decision between the two is difficult.

Lev 13:9

See BHS: The paragraphing structure supports the presence of the conjunction, which could have been lost by haplography due to the juxtaposition of several similar-looking letters (which might help explain its preservation in Sam; cf. the research notes on 11:31).

Lev 13:18

Cf. WBC (which, however, leans toward retaining M(T)) and BHQ (which, however, opts for a slightly different solution). Corrupt dittography.

Lev 14:20

Re לפני יהוה: As for transcriptional probability, (1a) could easily have dropped due to homoeoteleuton after המזבחה, and (1b) there is no clear trigger, based on occurrences of this word elsewhere, for assimilation or some such, so that the witnesses having the plus are more likely to be preserving than to be adapting the text;

additionally, (1c) OG-Lev does *not* show a tendency to add this phrase (though it does have many other pluses): The phrase $\epsilon\nu\alpha\nu\tau\alpha\sigma\tau\omicron\upsilon\sigma\tau\omicron\upsilon$ occurs the same number of times in OG-Lev (per BibleWorks9) as the phrase לפני יהוה in L-Lev (59x; the exact placement of this phrase is not the same, however, as evidenced at least by this present case and by 16:15, on which latter case see the research notes). As for intrinsic probability, (2) this phrase occurs so often in Lev that its occurrence here would very much be of a piece with the emphases of this book. Thus the evidence is strong for the plus.

Contrast the situation in 16:15 (see research notes there).

Lev 14:22

Haplography after ויהי. See further BHS “a”, noting that the OG MS evidence cited for $\mu\alpha$ over against $\eta\mu\alpha$ later in the verse (cited in BHS “b”) is exceedingly weak and may be an inner-greek corruption (Sam's reading there is surely an assimilation to its reading here).

Lev 18:28

Near haplography in the paleo script.

Lev 21:5

Intrinsic and transcriptional evidence make יקרחו clearly preferable. That form clearly fits the context (see the other verbs and their complements in the verse), and יקרח is readily explained as assimilation to the termination of the following קרחה (possibly facilitated by the visual similarity of *waw* to *he* on the right side). The OG presumably retroverts as תקרחו, which, while different in a facilitating way, preserves the *waw*.

Lev 21:14

Near haplography before *zayin*.

Lev 22:29

Near haplography. Cf. 19:5. (BHS cites 19:5 but does not explicitly call for this form to be read.)

Lev 23:17

A difficult case, since M(T) seems strained but not quite impossible (לחם can sometimes be feminine per BDB), but the transcriptional mechanism by חלות would have been lost is not indisputable. That said, a small word *in between* two words that begin with the same letter might have been jumped accidentally, so it seems best to read the plus. See further BHQ, WBC.

lev 23:38a

Following Hilleli.

Lev 25:33a

MT seems impossible (most English versions seem to paraphrase to the extent of tacitly emending); we follow the OG. Apparently an original בתי ועיר became *בתי ועיר by corrupt dittography, then this – whether by emendation or unconscious metathesis – became MT's בית ועיר.

Num 1:16

The Kt would seem to be the older, and accordingly in the Pentateuch more authentic, form. NET (at least) agrees.

The fact that the relation between Kt and Qr here is reversed in 26:9 *might* be explained thus: The two passages were at odds with one another due to a Herodian-era *waw/yodh* confusion, and *each* passage was corrected against the *other*!

Num 1:22

The word does seem very much out of place. The form פקדיהם occurs very many times in this context; borrowing Allen's column concept, perhaps (1) a scribe initially looked at the wrong column and began to reproduce this form, (2) stopped part way, producing פקדי, which form (3) was later emended to פקדיו.

Num 1:42

This reading has strong external and intrinsic support. The omission of a letter, whose absence does not, on a superficial analysis, produce nonsense, is among the sorts of errors one would expect in such a highly repetitive genre as this passage is.

{On the other hand, there is variation in the wording of the first two tribes, and so stylistic variation might be possible—all the more, perhaps, since our heading is the last in the list. Also, at least as the text has come down to us, the word in question is the very first word of a new paragraph, making an error as to its first word a bit less likely.}

Num 2:14

Following V (and some MSS); see BDB sub דעואל. MT and (O)G both have רעואל; in the case of the former, *daleth/resh* confusion is probable, while in the latter, assimilation is likely at work (cf. BDB ad 1:9; transcriptional error in M is possible in the places mentioned there, but the present solution satisfies Occam's Razor).

Num 3:28

See NICOT (81n³, 84). An error (as ib., 81, points out) of a single letter.

Num 4:3

BHS neglects to include the apparent support of G for הבא. There have been no articles in some time, so this might account for its loss, and the phraseology elsewhere in this book is very consistent and so favors the inclusion of the article.

Num 4:6

Homoeotelueton.

Num 4:19

Lamedh/taw confusion. See (at least) Davidson and BDB (sub נגש).

Num 5:27

In addition to Sam T^J mentioned by BHS, OG (NB: the versification differs here) appears also to support this reading. MT could be due to corrupt haplography in the square script or, more likely it seems to me, mechanical assimilation to the large number of grammatical feminines nearby.

Num 6:26-7:1

L has an open section, while Ginsburg and J'lem Crown have closed. One of the Pericope volumes discusses this passage, and while their conclusions about the passage are beside the point as the sections go, they might have valuable collation data here

Num 9:16

Perhaps the plus is assimilating, but it seems virtually required by לילה later, and it could have dropped out by homoiotelueton: Final *mem* is in the square script visually similar to the sequence *nun-waw* with which the previous word ends.

Num 11:31b

Dittography (of *mem*) + addition of a helping letter (or corrupt dittography of *waw* into *yodh*); the singular form

appears to underlie the OG. (Sam we theorize to be an independent development; note its practice with regard to other occurrences of שלו.)

Num 12:5

See WBC (which by oversight omits something like “be read” from the relevant sentence). NICOT retains (tentatively, it seems) MT, but translates in an unusual way. (NB that WBC denies, rightly in my view, the wisdom on BHS' suggestion re 11:24.) MT is assimilation to ויצאו in the previous verse, facilitated by the fact that the two words ויצאו and ויבאו differ by only one letter and are polar variants.

Num 16:1b

Taw/aleph confusion. On the (probable, not certain) lack of a *waw*, cf. the gentilic פלאי (s.v. HALOT).

Num 16:1c

This verse has a somewhat confusing array of occurrences of בני and בן, so a scribal slip here is not improbable.

Num 16:35

See W-O 283n23 (=15.2.6), noting that on a superficial reading Sam might seem more difficult, making it less likely to be a scribal correction, and the fact that there are multiple potential triggers for this plus in M (syntactic: the preceding אה; visual: the following *chet*).

Num 17:19

Corrupt dittography (*kaph* → *kaph-mem*) in the paleo script.

Num 17:28a

NICOT appears to understand the repetition as emphatic, but this seems highly strained (קרב כל הקרב for קרב but be more plausibly for this sense, but I am unsure even of this). Dittography (cf. WBC).

Num 17:28b

See Talmon 145-46.

Num 21:3

See esp. NICOT. Homoioteleuton.

Num 21:20

Following (at least) BHS, HALOT 2:1645^b (and cf. 23:28). Mechanical assimilation to the termination of the preceding word (הפסגה).

Num 21:24

So BHS. The letter sequence כי עז גבול could easily have become כי יעזר גבול via haplography of *yodh* after *yodh* + haplography of *resh* before *gimmel*, the whole process facilitated by the fact that יעזר is a rare proper name, while עז is a very familiar adjective which makes superficial sense here. WBC notes v32 as further support of G here.

Num 21:30e

While it is possible that MT is accurate, (1) it could easily be an assimilation, given the two occurrences of עד earlier in this verse; (2) a faintly written *lamedh* could have been read as a *daleth*; (3) this whole verse would seem to have multiple problems in MT, suggesting a poor exemplar or a fatigued, confused, or (less likely) overactive scribe.

Num 22:33

אולי appears several times in the relatively near context, providing opportunity for assimilation. Those same

passages also show OG translating differently, confirming that (as, e.g., NEB reports), G so read.

Num 23:10

BHS gives G as *ומי ספר*, but the future tense-form in the OG suggests *יספר*, which provides a nice parallelism to *מנה* in the previous line; Sam can be explained as subsequent haplography. M, meanwhile, overlooks the middle portion of the phrase including the word divider (originally, in all likelihood, a raised dot) easily overlooked between two *yodhs*. We have pointed the final syllable with a *kamatz* rather than a *cholam* because MT's accentuation was based on *one* word, not *two*; so we compensate.

Num 24:20

OG does not for some reason represent *עד*. Perhaps a tradent did not understand it, or perhaps it, being a small word, dropped accidentally. However, it does seem to support reading *יאבד*, and according to BHS other versions read (more or less) *עד יאבד*. So though there is additional confusion in G, there does seem to be support for a reading which makes sense and from which MT can be derived via wrong word division.

Num 25:5

Auditory error, or possibly visual error. See (at least) Tov, *Text-critical Use* (153). The word *שפט* never occurs in a relevant sense elsewhere in Num.

A very similar error occurs in Pr 19:29.

Num 25:9

1 Cor 10:8 has “24,000” over against “23,000.” See Carson-Beale and especially BECNT: Most likely, a non-text-critical approach is to be taken. That said, *τεσσαρες* and *τρεις* are visually similar, so it possible that *τεσσαρες* is an inner-greek error (Gottingen records no LXX MSS or versions reading differently in a way that is relevant to this theory), in which case the G reading might be *שלשה*, though it hard to derive *ארבעה* from *שלשה*. The collocation *שלשה וארבעים* occurs in 26:7. If this was in an adjacent column, perhaps a scribe's eye strayed to the other *שלשה*, and then by some error he copied not that but the following *ארבעים*, misrecalled as or visually confused with *ערבעה*.

{Post-script: On further evaluation, while MT might be correct (either the theory of Calvin or that of Morris [both cited in BECNT 462]; that of Koet [see *ibid.*, 462-63] is implausible since the golden calf and the Balaam plot are separate incidents), it seems that the process outlined above is plausible (though perhaps the inner-greek error in secondary conformity to an M-like text) textually, and we, at least in general, prefer text-critical solutions. We take courage from Holmes' call to bold editorial decisions. Also, Num is among the books for which Second Temple-era correction markings are found, so errors in M-Num need not be polygenetic. Still, the matter is most difficult and would certainly merit a marginal reading if such were in use.}

Num 26:3a, b

Very difficult. The ESV note to v4 takes words to the effect of “Take a census of the people” as implied, but (1) it seems strained to see such as implied, and (2) the words *כאשר צוה יהוה את משה* in v4 seems to demand that vv3-4 is not the *giving* but the *fulfilling* of instructions. A further peculiarity (see BDB sub *דבר*, § *pi'el* 3a) in v3 is the word *אתם* as a direct object (?) of *וידבר*. OG omits this word, but this might be a secondary (whether on the level of the *Vorlage* or at level of the translator is hard to say) deletion in avoidance of a difficulty.

NICOT (p. 533, see esp. n⁵⁰) follows P in reading *ויפקד* for *וידבר* and deleting *לאמר*, explained (by NICOT 533 n⁵⁰) as a gloss. This approach has three strengths: (1) It makes good sense of the text (fulfillment, not giving, of instructions, as noted above) with relatively little change relative to MT, and more specifically with regard to the first word, (2) a powerful transcriptional explanation is at hand (compare in the paleo script *וידבר* with *ויפקד*), and (3) there is intrinsic support (cf. 1:19). However, the external evidence is weak, especially considering that P is unlikely to derive from a paleo script (but even in the square script *וידבר* somewhat resembles *ויפקד*; indeed, it might be significant that the movement from *pe* to *daleth* is easier to envision than the reverse), and the addition

of לאמר is a bit hard to describe as polygenetic (413 Arab Sa omits λεγων; this does not seem like strong external evidence, but I should check THB 1B re Sahidic-Num).

Num 1:2 might suggest a different solution, but (1) the structuring is somewhat different (more extended instructions, no explicit fulfillment formula [note again in our passage by contrast the formula כִּי אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה וגו'] and (2) there is no external evidence for this.

{Post-script: MT, and possible G also, can be explained as assimilation to 33:50 = 35:1. We therefore accept P here.}

Num 26:39

While the situation is not completely clear, the external evidence for לשופם is quite strong.

Num 31:16

למסר does not make good sense here (concurring with the negative assessment, with varying degrees of confidence, are, at least, HALOT 1: 608^b, BDB, BHS). A suggestion which makes good sense and arguably explains M via visual error (though assimilation to v5 is not impossible) is למעל; moreover, as BDB notes, this latter verb nearly always, apart from in Chr and in Ezra-Nehemiah, has מעל as its direct object. For MT למסר מעל OG has του αποσθησται και υπερωδεν. Such could point to two different roots in the *Vorlage*, but the Greek Pentateuch is well-styled, so an avoidance of the same word twice in the translation would not be surprising. The Greek αποσθημι translates a dizzying area of Hebrew words, but does translate the verb מעל five times (Muraoka, 20). The use of *two* infinitives could also easily be a non-literal rendering, or it could reflect a *Vorlage* וילעלם or ולעזב, both possibly transcriptional errors (transposition in the first case, transposition + *beth/mem* error + *lamedh* → *zayin* through faint writing in the second), possibly plus emendation via addition of a conjunction and prefix (not unexpected in the expansionistic and assimilating G text of Hum) of מעל. (The root מסר is *not* a ghost form, however; see the research notes on v5.)

Num 32:22

It is important to note that נקיים also has some external support.

Num 32:25

Near haplography of *waw* after *resh*.

{as of 12/1/20, here the relevant places where the grammatical number of root אמר occasions a change in SRO: Num 32:25, Jdg 8:6, 1 Sam 12:10, 13:19 (3rd person plural), 16:4, 2 Ki 7:11, 9:11, Isa 36:7 (תאמרן). A comparable situation for root קרא *never* occurs. There is a variant concerning דבר in 2 Ki 25:6, but this is in the *opposite* direction, as is part of a larger nest of readings (i.e., a rather damaged few verses in M). Might ויאמר be a stereotyped term, occasionally referring to a group (rather like ויבוא is apparently a stereotyped term in Ezekiel [at least such is my assessment as of this writing])? The form ויאמר occurs in WTT (BibleWorks9) 2083x, while the form ויאמר occurs 311x. This disparity is so marked, and the possibility of near haplography is so plausible, and the number of cases cited is so small and so scattered, that textual error rather than a stylistic/grammatical phenomenon, seems the more probable explanation. Moreover, the cases of 1 Sam 13:19 and Isa 36:7 seem to fall under a different heading yet confirm the near haplography phenomenon. Then, too, I have not found such a category in Ges, J-M, W-O, or MNK. In short, L is probably in error in all the places mentioned.}

{11/16/22 update: In the interim, I changed my position re the Ezekiel forms. On the other hand, Kt-1 Ki 12:7 has an expected singular of דבר. Perhaps these cases should be revisited. In some instances, a passive vocalization might be called for. That said, the points made above still stand, and note also the following: (1) grammatical *number* does not seem to flux as much as grammatical gender; (2) study made after the previous update shows that near haplography of a single letter is extremely common. So on the balance there is at the very least a *strong* case to be made for the grammatically expected forms in these instances. Note also the related error in 2 Sam 1:8.}

Num 33:7

The loss of *waw* is difficult to account for, but M(T) seems impossible. (The plural reading is attested directly by Sam T^j and indirectly by OG and apparently most distantly by P. Re G's reading, BHS cites Ex 14:2, but an easier explanation is assimilation to יַחַד in the immediate context.) Perhaps near dittography after *beth*, as the right half of *beth* bears some resemblance to a *waw*.

Num 33:8

Two explanations are possible (and just perhaps one afflicted MT, the other G): (1) Corrupt dittography of the *yodh*; or (2) assimilation to פָּנִי and לִפְנֵי in the previous verse. (As for external support, BHS gives “Seb mlt Mss Sam P V”; BDB omits “Seb mlt Mss” but adds “Targum.”)

Introduction to Deuteronomy

From a draft of the SRO intro...

Three variation units, or sets thereof, will be discussed very briefly here. (1) Some (e.g. Eugene Ulrich, *The Dead Sea Scrolls and the Developmental Composition of the Bible*, Boston/Leiden, Brill, 2015, 47-65) suppose that in Deuteronomy 27:4 that גֵּרְזִים is an earlier text than עֵיבָל. Among the supporting arguments is the claim that an important Greek-language papyrus fragment and an Old Latin codex both suggest that ΑΠΤΑΡΙΖΙΜ was the original text of the OG; such might also be suggested by a Hebrew-language MS of uncertain provenance (ibid., 57-59). It is further claimed that עֵיבָל is an anti-samaritan emendation. While this scenario is possible, there are two possible explanations of the variation unit that favor the M reading: (a) The Gerizim reading might itself be an emendation, not for sectarian reasons (the Samaritans later made use of this type of text for their version of the Pentateuch), but to smooth out perceived geographical difficulties (cf. {Rosel, *Tradition and Innovation*}) or to avoid associating the post-wilderness altar with a place of curses (see Ulrich, 61, though he sees this circumstance as intrinsic evidence against the M reading); (2) the Gerizim reading might be Samaritan in origin, and the presence of a Samaritan-made MS, or a Samaritan-style translation technique, is to be accounted for on the grounds of the less-than-total separation between the groups in antiquity: Cf. {Knoppers} and Jan Joosten, “Septuagint and *Samareitikon*,” 1-15 in: *From Author to Copyist: Essays on the Composition, Redaction, and Transmission of the Hebrew Bible in Honor of Zipi Talshir*, ed. Cana Werman, Winona Lake, Eisenbrauns, 2015. See also {see Knoppers, subject index: Samaritans, diasporic communities of} on the wide spread of Samaritans, including Egypt. The issue is complicated by archaeological uncertainties regarding the location of various biblical sites, by text-critical questions in the book of Joshua (on which see the comments on that book), and by the set of variation units discussed immediately below.

(2) In three (12:5, 16:2, 7) of the twenty-two places where the phrase אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר occurs in MT-Deuteronomy, one or more witnesses to the text of the OG support a reading which appears to reflect an underlying בָּחַר. As the latter form is characteristic of the SP, the MT might be an anti-samaritan emendation. Yet as with the previous case, these readings in the OG *Vorlage* might be readings which are Samaritan, yet antedate the specific controversies that would make such readings untenable within mainstream Judaism. Moreover, the difficulties involved in OG textual criticism complicate matters; it is far from certain that the OG actually does differ from M at any or all of these points.

(3) In 32:8 many favor the apparent G reading בְּנֵי אֱלֹהִים over the M בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. Yet there is a case to be made for the M reading. Contrary to the possibility floated by {BHQ 141*}, the בְּנֵי with which v9 commences is probably not asseverative, for such usage seems to appear in counterfactuals and in claims thought likely to be disbelieved ({Ges 159ee}, {JM {see word index}}, {MNK 40.29}). Rather, v9 gives the backdrop of v8. It makes more sense to see God's special relationship with Israel as the reason for his allocating territory to other nations only in connection with his beneficence toward the Jewish people than to see it as the grounds for linking each gentile nation with some angelic figure. The MT preserves the same or similar wording in Genesis 6:2, 4, Job 1:6, 2:1, and 38:7 without complaint. Daniel Block (*The Gods of the Nations: A Study in Ancient Near Eastern National Theology*, 2nd ed., Wipf and Stock, Eugene, Oregon, 2006, ISBN 13: 978-1-62032-974-0, 2013, previously published by Baker, 2000, 28-31) adduces various Jewish sources for a tradition of angelic oversight of the nations, but this tradition might be the cause, rather than an effect, of the

G reading. For these and other reasons, especially the general reliability of the M text in this book, it seems safest to retain MT, and provisionally to do the same with the units of variation discussed above.

Dt 3:25

JC and Ginsburg read והלבנון, perhaps a defective spelling and therefore original over against L's *plene* והלבנון. However, (1) *nowhere* in the other 70 occurrences of לבנון in WLC [BibleWorks9], suggesting a standard spelling of this place name / technical term; (2) the loss of *waw* could be due to near haplography in between *nun* and final *nun*; and (3) Kennicot shows that there is considerable external evidence for the *plene* spelling. It also (4) is not hard to suppose the full spelling to underlie G, and it certainly is the Sam reading.

{Post-script: But the very rarity of the spelling might have led to purposeful or inadvertent correction; in any case, matters of spelling being so uncertain, it is preferable to remain consistent with my own principles at this stage—which here calls for accepting JC paired with another authority}

Dt 3:26

Following Hilleli.

Dt 7:16

Preferring JC spelling here. Perhaps L is an accidental omission of *waw*, a small letter.

Dt 8:2a

To judge from Kennicot, external support for the defective reading is very weak indeed, so, although it is a bit hard to explain, the JC seems preferable here.

Dt 11:32-12:1

Following (a bit tentatively) 4QpaleoDeutr; a bit less than conservative orthographically, but generally close to M. Additionally, אלה החקים has a sectional break nearby elsewhere in the Pentateuch, and closed sections are fragile.

Dt 13:10

See the chapter in Aejmelaeus' *On the Trail of the Septuagint Translators*.

The pointing is on the analogy of cases like תשיבנו in Ex 23:4; תביאנו in Dt 33:7; etc.

Dt 15:14

For אשר WBC (1:318) would read כאשר, citing LXX καθ᾽α, but in LXX-Dt this at least at times translates אשר, and that might actually intrinsically fit better than כאשר. WBC cites haplography, but dittography also could have happened.

{Post-script: McCarter (39) would read כאשר, noting further SamP, which is significant where there is a transcriptional trigger for M. Holmstedt does not discuss.} {BHK points out 16:10, which provides intrinsic evidence for the long reading, which is best explained as haplography in an early script.}

Dt 21:8

See J-M, Ges, and Howie (64); it is unlikely that so late a form would appear in Moses, but a scribe working in the Mishnaic error might have been influenced by his own grammar and mistook the *yodh* for a *nun*. Also, it makes more sense for the *whole* of v8 to be direct speech, rather than the speech ending with ישראל (cf. v9). Note as well the nearby error (v11) in M, and cf. the comments on Eze 23:48.

Dt 21:11

It seems that an object is required in this expression, and M(T) can be explained as mechanical assimilation to the previous verbs, facilitated by the auditory equivalence. There is also a nearby error in M(T) (v17). Cf. esp. NICOT and BHQ.

Dt 23:14

See Noonan (322f).

Dt 26:8

Following Hilleli.

Dt 28:9

WBC (2:669) cites an earlier scholar who made the observation that “the verb שבע, “to swear,” in Deuteronomy with YHWH as subject is used elsewhere only with reference to the promises to the father... though cf. 2:14” (to be clear, the word just quoted are Christensen's, who is summarizing Mayes). M is assimilation to the context, facilitated by the fact that לאבתיך and לך begin and end with the same letters.

Dt 30:16

See BHQ; intrinsic evidence is strong and M is readily explainable as a transcriptional error.

Dt 31:7

Cf. BHQ, adding that perhaps given the notable M external evidence for a *hiph'il*, the masoretic note was introduced precisely to militate against this reading, still widely circulating in the early days of the MT (cf. Ginsburg *passim*).

Dt 32:5 (originally written with reference to v6, but see post-script below)

The solution to this *crux* tentatively adopted here is that by near dittography with the preceding *taw-lamedh* sequence an *aleph-lamedh* sequence has dropped out. This solution seems to be supported by the LXX. Such a construction (accusative of thing requited, preposition + person thus requited) is found elsewhere (Ps 137:8; cf. with על Joel 4:4). Note that it in this scenario זאת is to be grouped with what follows, not what precedes.

{Post-script: This exact explanation would seem to run aground on the fact that זאת is feminine but עם is masculine. But if a restored אלה is grouped with the previous verse, a solution seems to be at hand. Other possibilities remain: (1) M with its unusual orthography could be original (the single-word branch of the MT tradition is probably a correction); or (2) M(T) with its unusual orthography is an error, and G (and/or VPT) preserves the correct, single-word reading.}

Dt 33:29

Following a rare defective reading in SamP (but ignoring its update of the suffix).

Dt 32:35

We follow Paul's (Rom 12:19; followed by Heb 10:30) lead here, seeing a confusion of a single letter in MT. Either Paul has created an eclectic text (!), possibly on the idea that ליום נקם is an eschatological expansion in G Smr but that ושלם is a transcriptional error in MT, or simply because he saw ולי נקם ושלם; the testimony of VPT suggests that MT is a late development. Cf. further BHQ.

{Post-script: in a paleo script, I think that an *aleph* following on the heels of a *mem*, could give the appearance of a *waw*, which is at any rate a very common way to begin a word.}

Dt 32:43

The variants in this verse are obscure, but it seems unwise in this book to abandon M on large-scale matters or to lean heavily on G in the same. The replacement of גוים with שמים might be due to an understanding (by a Hebrew-language scribe, as shown by the support of 4QDeut^a for reading שמים here) of הרנינו as a true causative: How could unclean gentiles cause Israel comfort? The insertion of ושהתחוו לו כל אלהים could easily come from Ps 97:7 (and cf. the comments on v8 ad fin). Reading עבדיו for בניו is likely targumic, referring to a reversal of the situation of v5. The plus after לצריו is probably the sort of expansion frequent in such loose texts as this one.

Only in regard to אדמתו does M seem to need correction, and here the problem seems to be merely anticipation of the following suffix. (As BHQ notes, PT point in the direction of אדמתו being original to M, not unique to MT as V might be taken to suggest.) Perhaps the M scribe was somewhat fatigued (or overtaxed by this obscure passage); note our hypothesis concerning near haplography in vv5-6 above. {Post-script: But this might be comparable to חיתו, as in Gen 1:24. Anticipation is possible, but so catastrophic and error is rare in MT, or at any rate MT-Dt. Corrupt dittography of *taw* is unlikely for the same reason and because this error is not, to my knowledge, found elsewhere, or certainly not frequently so. Provisionally, it seems best to retain MT as an odd (perhaps poetic? Cf. BDB to חיה) form.}

Dt 33:2

For the second למו read probably לו with G (see TC 2014).

Introduction to Joshua

Re the placement of the altar narrative (AN), Concordia-Josh 355 suggests that 4QJosh^a might be an overly literal interpretation of ביום in Dt 27:2. Does Zahn's book suggest *immediate* obedience to a command as a feature of reworked texts? (NICOT n¹¹ uses logic that might be an instance of such logic!)

Josh 1:8

Dittography + metathesis (cf. Boiling).

Josh 2:4

So (at least) BHS and Ges 135p. M is admittedly a bit difficult to explain – perhaps ותצפנו was misread as וצפנו and then emended to ותצפנו, or perhaps the mistake took place in one step due to an inattentive scribe or a poor exemplar. M is probably impossible, and transcriptionally is not far removed from G.

Josh 6:7

In the previous verse Joshua addresses the priests (plural). The Kt here might be an accidental anticipation of an expected plural response from a group, whereas in fact the priests' verbal response is not important, and the narrative moves to the next things Joshua says. The lack of an explicit subject is presumably for narrative coherence, binding this event to the others of the same paragraph.

Josh 7:1

As BHS notes, 1 Chr 2:6 points to G here. M is easily explained: *beth/mem* confusion + *daleth/resh* confusion.

Josh 9:4

See BHS, noting that the synonymous term found in OG-v12 is very much in keeping with the OG practice of varying its language for the same Hebrew term in this book (cf. van der Meer). Agreeing is (at least) NETS and (significantly, given its reluctance to depart from MT) Concordia.

Seemingly ציד (as a verb) is a ghost word.

Josh 9:8

L is the less usual form and so has some claim on originality, yet to judge from JC and Ginsburg, external support seems to be slim to nonexistent, so it may be a mere error.

Josh 9:27

As BHS notes, homoeotetuton accounts for the minus. Furthermore, the OG would not likely invent something so repetitive since it avoids repetition elsewhere, and the style is similar to Josh elsewhere (7:26, 14:14).

Josh 10:1

This could be a plus, but could be homoeotetuton, and seems to fit well with style/emphasis here and elsewhere

in the book.

Josh 10:21

Dittography after the preceding ישראל.

Josh 10:24

Following G. M is perhaps not impossible, for there is a rare construction in which the article can be a complementizer, but the examples of that construction are largely late and occur nowhere else in Joshua (cf. Holmstedt 69ff); moreover, the *aleph* as a helping letter in this position seems very unexpected indeed in so early a book. The error is a bit odd, but hardly impossible: Perhaps *waw/yodh* confusion + anticipation of the *aleph* with which the following word begins, at the expense of the last letter of this word.

{Post-script: In support of the decision made above, note the similarity of *mem* to *aleph* on some scripts, which might help explain the error. On the other hand, a minor conjectural emendation would be ההלכו, with the final *aleph* of M(T) taken to be dittography (note the following אהו).}

Josh 12:23

There is wide support for this change among commentators. The two forms are visually and auditorially similar, and גלגל occurs, apart from this verse, 12x in this book while גליל occurs only 2x.

Josh 13:16

Davidson (who seems to favor M(T)) notes considerable Hebrew MS, as well as other external, support for עד. (OG *does* support עד: Note εως at the beginning of the next verse, bearing in mind that, as WBC notes, (O)G omits מידבא.) NICOT retains MT and translates as “near.” WBC accepts G, though with at least one other difference as well, and notes that the decision is more intrinsic than specifically textual. Concordia does not comment.

While it is difficult to be certain, it seems that M(T)'s על is a mechanical assimilation to the earlier occurrence of that word in the same verse; note that the two words על and עד differ in one consonant *only* (even the vowel is the same).

Josh 14:8

On the form of MT see Ges 75ii for starters (Aramaic). We make the reasonable hypothesis that underlying the OG (cf. Deut 1:28) is הַמְסִי, which form (occurring certainly only there), became הַמְסִי by corrupt dittography, which then in some Massoretic witnesses became הַמְסִי by defective spelling or by overlooking the letter *yodh* since it merely stands for the *i* sound already represented by the *chiriq*.

Josh 15:8

L is the defective form but (to judge from JC, Ginsburg), without much (if any) support, and could be corrupt haplography.

Josh 15:22

Cf. Concordia to 1 Samuel, 556-557.

Josh 15:29

See Talmon (159-160): MT is a corrupt dittography, lacking in OG (I take βακωκ to be an inner-greek dittograph of Βαλα).

Josh 15:30

See Driver to Sam (175).

Josh 15:59

Taking M to be homoeotelueton, w/ most commentators. A couple of notes:

-Θεω is either an inner-greek corruption of Θεωε or an alternative rendering of תְּקוּעַ minus the furtive *patach*

-Φαγορ it taken to be either an inner-greek corruption of Φογορ or an alternative rendering of פְּעוּר (not the initial *schwa*); admittedly this identification is less than certain (but cf. NAC 342).

-I follow Codex A re Αιταμ (cf. 2 Chr 11:6); alternatively, Αιταν is not an inner-greek corruption but reflects the phonology of the translator.

-Re Κουλον, I am at a loss, but word-initially *kaph* very often becomes *xi*, so an initial *qoph* seems more likely; the first vowel is almost certainly an <u> (see *Transformation*, 106), and the second vowel is probably <a> (104).

-טטם is similarly uncertain; cf. Oort and Josh 15:24.

-שורש: We follow Codex A w/ NAC, Oort. The other reading is an inner-greek corruption (*E/S confusion* in the uncial script)

-גלים: Cf. Isa 10:30

-בית ער: Cf. Num 21:15. Some reconstruct בֵּיתָר or בִּיתָר, a place name found in some MSS of the OG at 1 Chr 6:44 (but {, while I have not yet checked Allen on this point,} this is probably an inner-greek corruption, and at any rate intrinsic evidence seems much against it, BDB putting an equal sign between this verse and Josh 21:16) and possibly in SS 2:17; cf. the Mishnaic place name (so HALOT {; have yet to check Jastrow}) the place name בִּתְרִין in 2 Sam 2:29.

-מנכו: Rather at a loss. Oort has מְנוּחָו.

Josh 17:4

Visual error in the paleo script (or, less likely, auditory error based on late Hebrew) facilitated by the multiple masculine words in the near context and the rarity of לֶהֱן.

Josh 18:28

Cf. BHS. Probably here the scribe misread the sequence גִּבְעַת וְקִרְיַת יַעֲרִים עֲרִים by interpreting the first word as the first element of a construct chain (the second element of which could not have a conjunction; its absence in M could be an emendation or simply a lack of an element the scribe was not expecting to see and so did not notice) plus either homoeoarchon of יַעֲרִים or loss of עֲרִים by homoeotelueton combined with the mistaken idea (easily formed in this context) that יַעֲרִים was עֲרִים. (The OG has corruptions of its own that do not affect the argumentation here.)

Josh 19:2

Dittography, with the minor (perhaps unconscious) emendation of adding a conjunction. Following 1 Chr 4:28; OG has וְשִׁמְעֹן, either a mere visual error or following 15:26 (though note that the OG reading both here and there is apparently somewhat uncertain; 15:26 is in any case referencing a city in *Judah*, not *Simeon*). Doing so restores the correctness of the number in v6. (As Concordia points out, OG in this passage also has the correct number of cities, but for a different reading, since it misreads וְשִׁמְעֹן as וְשִׁדְיָהוּן. But that M is there correct is shown by the Egyptian source [indeed, perhaps the name is Egyptian, which might explain why different forms of it exist in the OT, though as HALOT points out the form in 1 Chr 4:31 may be corrupt].)

Josh 19:10, 12

See HALOT, Concordia. Possibly this should be under Important List 1, but it seems plausible to me that OG originally read in such a way as to support our reading (at least with regard to the crucial points).

Josh 19:12

See v10.

Josh 19:28

This is either an inner-M(T) error or a polygenetic MG error, in which case it is Chr that has the right reading.

External data taken from BHS.

Josh 19:30

So BHS. *Beith/kaph* confusion, which could, it seems, have occurred in a variety of scripts.

Josh 19:34

I take M to be a corrupt dittography.

Josh 21:10

To judge from JC and Ginsburg, L is without much, if any, support.

Josh 21:16

NB that while witnesses frequently have ואת for את in this passage, the patterns (i.e. intrinsic evidence) in other places favor M^L, while here the reverse is the case. Sporadic addition of the conjunction was very common, but the reverse did surely occur on occasion, especially in a passage such as this where fatigue could easily set it.

Josh 21:36

See Barthelemy 1982 p67 [=PDF loc 213].

Josh 22:18

Following Boiling (Anchor); corrupt dittography, facilitated by the earlier occurrence of ואתם.

Josh 22:23

Near haplography after הזה, facilitated by the complicated train of thought in vv22-23 (and, in some ways, this passage as a whole).

Josh 24:5

So BHS. Kaph/beth confusion + homoeoarchon w/ the following word.

Josh 24:13

Corrupt haplography.

Jdg 1:16

A difficult case, but in short the syntax and 4:11 seem to support this reading. Perhaps MT is homoioteleuton in the paleo script (ובני חבב הקיני) from the *yodh* of ובני to the *he* of הקיני.

Jdg 1:27

Probably Kt arose thus: The pattern in the larger list is mostly (w)'t + grammatical singular + w't *bnwtyh*; since this ישבי occurs in the slot most often occupied by a grammatical singular, mechanical assimilation took over. External and intrinsic evidence are, at any rate, strong for the Qr.

Jdg 2:22

BHQ prefers to read דרכי for דרך, and it is true that, as דרך comes before יהוה, haplography could be polygenetic. Yet T is slim external support indeed. Better is to accept בה here, for (a) it is supported in G, a stronger witnesses for historical reasons than T, (b) it is supported in VS, a hence could be the proto-M reading, especially MT arose through transcriptional error (in a fairly modern script, to be sure, but such is plausible), and (c) assimilation could have led to MT, given the appearance of במ earlier in the verse.

Jdg 3:28

See BHQ. Also, HALOT 2:119a (if tentatively). Against G see KEL 191 n47, but, as that note states, the M

construction is much more common, so assimilation seems to be at work.

Jdg 4:11

Intrinsically, M-Josh 19:33 supports Qr, but, depending on a variant in the LXX tradition, G there supports the Kt here. P seems to support a reading with a single *nun* in Josh 19:33; V, however, appears to support M (*in Sananim*).

Externally, the LXX here in Jdg 4:11 is opaque (either not having recognized it as a place name or attempting to translate according to etymology); P supports Qr, as, apparently, does V (*quae vocatur Sennim*). Haplography seems more likely than dittography here, for the place name is rare in the OT and the double-*nun* results apparently in four consonants (though the root is probably ultimately צנע). On the other hand, the Qr could be a deliberate assimilation to M-Josh 19:33 (see the previous paragraph).

In the end, it seems most likely that G-Josh 19:33 (if indeed Vaticanus is correct) is a simplification of a slightly unexpected form, as is Kt-Jdg 4:11.

Jdg 7:13

The matter is obscure (see HALOT but צליל), but external evidence seems to weigh in for the Qr (see BHQ), for which the Kt could easily be *waw/yodh* confusion.

Jdg 7:22

See NAC. We depend here on P (there is a variant here – which, rather than being a correction to MT, probably rather highlights the polygenetic nature of this variation – but we follow Leiden, the assessment of which does not disagree with [at least] Davidson's assessment), which has an error of its own – admittedly slim external evidence, but this situation is much mollified by the fact that we are dealing with *daleth/resh* confusion.

Jdg 8:11a

That M has suffered transposition with regard to the *waw* is a proposition easily supported on transcriptional grounds and reasonably apparent from the external evidence. Support for any lack of the irregular article, however, is difficult to come by; indeed, the non-A text of the LXX seems with its article perhaps to presuppose an article in the Hebrew, and of course other versions can be expected to have tried to produce a sensible translation. Perhaps the fact that the next word in the construct chain has a prefixed preposition allowed the author of Judges to use an article here. The author does seem to use a slightly non-standard version of Hebrew.

Jdg 10:16

Possibly M is to be preferred as the more difficult reading – and indeed, it is difficult on multiple levels – but probably, as BHQ (*83) argues, M is an emendation, and part of the doublet in G^{OL} is to be preferred. It is debatable whether taking such a course entails the acceptance of a conjectural emendation, but the doublet seems to have originated precisely in the recognition that multiple *Vorlagen* existed, and hence the preferred reading existed, and elsewhere we see no problem in accepting G in part of a verse and rejecting it elsewhere. It is unclear what the original G reading was here, but such is possibly beside the point. Indeed, we are permitted ourselves to speculate that G* was in agreement with M, but that 4QJudg^{a,b} had the preferred reading (but do note that conjectural emendation of the LXX is almost certainly required in v17: ἀνεβησαν for ἀνεβοησαν, translating ויצעקו *niph'al*; the only non-conjectural solution I see here is that the LXX translator himself erred, putting down a word he did not intend). On the intrinsic side, see NAC (348-49) where the commentator is uncomfortable with M even though he seems unaware of an alternative textual tradition. Note also that while עו is common in this book, עמל occurs only once, and that with a different sense (5:26).

{Post-script: Also, Jdg is among the books for which Second Temple-era correction markings are found, so errors in M-Jdg need not be polygenetic.}

Jdg 12:7

See WBC (277) for a good starting point. Originally I had leaned toward the OG^L reading, but this is quite weak

externally, and leave other readings hard to explain; moreover, it has a very good chance of being a facilitating plus (whether originally Greek or Hebrew). Simplest is to read with OG בעירו and to assume גלעד to be an accusative of place (I'm not very confident in textual criticism of OG-Jdg, but I strongly suspect ענ to be secondary).

Jdg 14:10

Cf. Tov, *Text-critical Use* (94) on why this plus almost certainly traces to the G *Vorlage*, not the OG translator – and why, also, it is probably not an assimilation. NAC does not specifically comment, but does highlight the importance of the word משה in the larger context, so indirectly supports the reading on intrinsic grounds. M is homoeoteleuton.

Jdg 14:15

While M is maybe not impossible (see BHQ's citation of Ibn Ezra), it is certainly difficult, and the two forms differ in only a single letter. (Almost all of the LXX tradition supports the numeral 4.) Also, השביעי is over 3x more common in the MT than הרביעי is.

Jdg 14:18

See Ges 90f. On the Syriac equivalence see (at least) 2 Sam 4:7, noting also that P-Jdg is not consistent in how it renders הדר, that nowhere does P render הרס in a manner comparable to this, and that P translates the same word in 15:1 differently, suggesting that he is *not* assimilating 14:18 to 15:1 (somewhat unlikely in any case since forward assimilation is less common than backward assimilation, particularly – or so I suspect – in a translation). OG might have been revised, or else made the very same error (*daleth/resh* errors being highly polygenetic) as MT, facilitated by the common idea of the sun “going in.”

Jdg 16:2

Near haplography after אליה (end of v1).

Jdg 16:26

Note that while M^L lists the Qr as והמשני, M^A, VDH, Ginsburg, and Davidson all give it as והמישני without further comment. In the latter case, the Kt is easier explained as transposition (cf. BDB sub ימש).

{Just to double-check: Does BHQ comment?}

Jdg 16:23

I handled this unit as with other orthographic variants, but arguably it should be an S-class variant (cf. the note in KEL, where various strained arguments are advanced to explain L), at least in so early a book where a plene spelling of this kind seems unlikely. At the least, this (like movements to and from לוי) should be classed among the more significant of the O-class variants.

Jdg 18:29

See WBC, adding that it is OG^A (rather than OG^B) that preserves the correct reading in the next verse.

Jdg 19:3

The Kt is probably anticipation of the *waw* with which the next two words terminate.

Jdg 20-21

The cumulative effect of variation units in these chapters is to suggest that the ancestor of MT suffered considerable damage here by way of misreading, dittography, and the like.

Jdg 20:12

M is surely assimilation to earlier in the verse (so also BHQ).

Jdg 20:45

See BHQ for extensive commentary.

1 Sam chap. 1

The following readings are (a) related and (b) argued for by Anneli Aejmelaeus (*Corruption or Correction? Textual Development in the MT of 1 Samuel 1*, 1-17 in: {cited in Research notes under Dt 27:4}

-1:9 for MT וַתִּתְּצֵב לִפְנֵי יְהוָה read w/ LXX וְאַחֲרֵי שֶׁתָּה

-1:11 for MT וַיֵּד יוֹם מוֹתוֹ read w/ LXX (4QSam^a similar) לְפָנֶיךָ נָזִיר and [for יָמֵי חַיָּו possibly read וְיָמֵי חַיָּו and] before וּמִוֹרָה possibly add a retroversion of αὐτοῦ καὶ μεθ' αὐτοῦ καὶ μεθ' αὐτοῦ

-1:13 for MT וַיִּשְׁמַע אֵלֶיהָ יְהוָה read w/ LXX וַיִּשְׁמַע אֵלֶיהָ יְהוָה

-1:14 for MT minus (at end of verse) read w/ LXX וְלֹכֵי מִלְּפָנֵי יְהוָה

-1:18 for MT minus after לְדַרְכָּהּ read w/ LXX וַתֵּבֶא לְשִׁכְתָּהּ and for MT minus after וְתֹאכַל (the pointing of which should be non-pausal) read w/ LXX עַם אִישָׁהּ וְתִשְׁתֶּה (sic; but should last word really be וְתִשְׁתֶּה?) and for MT הָיוּ לָהּ read וְלָהּ.

-1:23 for MT דִּבְרוּ אֶת דְּבָרֵי read w/ LXX, 4QSam^a הִצִּיא מִפִּיָּךְ

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1 Sam 1:9

On the lack of וְאַחֲרֵי שֶׁתָּה in OG and on the meaning of the first part of the verse as a whole see Concordia 46-47 (which takes it as a scribal addition). Perhaps שֶׁתָּה is a dittograph of שָׁלָה, and וְאַחֲרֵי was later placed first by way of emendation. On the other hand, its absence in (O)G could be due to homoeotetuton, to avoidance of what could be taken as a redundant expression, or emendation on the assumption that wine is referred to (cf. v15).

The form אַכְלָה could be understood as an infinitive or as a feminine 3rd person verb (on the syntax see Concordia 47; as he points out, a verb after this very preposition is used in this same book, viz. in 1 Sam 5:9). OG took the former approach, likely reasoning (compare Concordia, 48, which uses the same reasoning) that v7 demands this approach. The question is whether v8 implies that Hannah received comfort, or at least ate. Verse 10 would indicate a lack of comfort, but does probably does not demand that she refused food in the face of her husband's reproach (outward compliance would be expected of a wife in those days). The infinitive would in any case most naturally refer to Hannah as the previously-named subject, not to Elkanah. Beyond that consideration, see W-O 35.5.2a: Not only is the finite use of a non-*waw*-bound infinitive rare in non-late literature, the sorts of uses of the construction seen elsewhere do *not* apply here. In short, the form here is probably finite. If so, שֶׁתָּה is all the more problematic, for while Concordia (47) ponders re-pointing it as a 3rd person *masculine* verb, from the above discussion it is apparent that this is improbable, and, if the feminine 3rd person form would be שֶׁתֵּה, for which there is no textual evidence, we are then in quite a bind (possibly it would be שֶׁתָּה, by simplification of the *taw-taw* sequence; cf. 3rd person feminine שֶׁתֵּה from שֶׁתָּה). Yet v18 strongly implies that she did *not* eat until after the conversation with Eli, so in the end this line of reasoning does not seem to be productive.

Also difficult is the placement of the plus (Concordia, 47).

A satisfactory solution is hard to obtain, so MT should be retained, if tentatively.

{Post-script: The above represents a misapprehension on my part, viz. that the accusative of general reference in OG's μετὰ τὸ φαγεῖν αὐτοῦς is interpretive. In fact, Driver (10) points out that the G *Vorlage* is probably אֶכְלָם, which makes good sense ("the suffix referring to the party generally, in spite of Hannah's [the first "H" has a dot beneath it] not joining with them," *ibid.*, 10), and from this reading M can be derived via *he/final mem* confusion. Good sense is then obtained for the first part of the phrase, but as Driver notes (10), the phrase וְאַחֲרֵי שֶׁתָּה remains problematic. Since there is no external support for a reading שֶׁתָּה, we recur to the dittography explanation and prefer G.}

¹ The M phrase is slightly more common than the G phrase. Both occur one other time in Sam. The G phrase occurs in Jdg 13:7 (re Sampson), which is either intrinsic evidence for G or evidence for assimilation. The M phrase occurs a plus in M-Jer 52:34

1 Sam 1:24

An attempt to read a damaged exemplar. On the intrinsic evidence see Concordia, 60.

1 Sam 2:28

He/chet confusion + loss of *yodh*, facilitated by the small size of the latter letter and the infrequency of the form יהיה vs. the high frequency of היה. (Davidson retroverts G היה, but this is unlikely both in light of the OG rendering ζη and in light of the intrinsic evidence, at least if Hebrew is tense-based.)

1 Sam 2:4

Some commentators argue for grammatical attraction, but it seems preferable to me to assume *he*/final *mem* confusion + insertion of a helping letter facilitated by mechanical assimilation to the suffix on גבורים. Cf. the nearby M errors in 1:9a and 1:24. Driver cites a passage in Isa in favor of M, but the parallel is not convincing because the syntactic situation there is different.

1 Sam 2:14

M is a tautology in context. Probably it was created by a faded upper shaft of the original *lamedh*. (Cf. on 2:33c below.)

1 Sam 2:20a

Given that compensation, not causation, seems to be in view (cf. the variation(s) later in the verse) seems to be in view here, שלם is more fitting than שום, and as Concordia notes, the accidental loss of a single is not hard to envision. So also BDB sub שום. A search in BibleWorks9 of שים plus תחת reveals that, where the sense is not physical, the meaning of תחת is “instead of,” “in replacement for,” usually, if not always, derogating the person/item being replaced. Such a nuance is absent from שלם plus תחת.

1 Sam 2:20b (=α-β)

Very difficult indeed. The most parsimonious explanation in our view is to divide the L word שאל into two variation units: (α) The beginning of the word (and arguably the middle, viz. the presence or absence of an infix); (β) the end of the word (viz. the presence and, if relevant, identity of a suffix).

As to the first: An initial *he*, attested in OG and in Q, could have been lost accidentally, though there are no clear triggers for this. Q also has an infix; certainty with respect to G on this point is not possible, but given the Q evidence and the OG translation it seems probable that such was present. That being the case, accidental loss of not only an initial *he* but also a medial *yodh* in M seems unlikely.

As to the second: M has a null slot, G and *taw*, and Q and *he*. The first option involves accidental loss of a single letter, which is certainly possible, though admittedly there is no clear transcriptional trigger. Either of the second and third options could be visual confusion for one another. The third could be an emendation, on the logic that it was not Elkanah but rather Hannah who acted with respect to Samuel. This third option could also be a deliberate assimilation to 1:28.

NICOT of course retains MT but gives it a passive significance. This is an interesting option, but would seem to flounder on (1) the difference in meaning between *qal* and *hiph'il*, and (2) the *lamedh* prefix on יהיה.

The M reading is hard to derive from the G and Q readings, while they can easily be derived from M via emendation. Yet M is very difficult on intrinsic grounds.

If in fact the G reading has no written infix, or even if it does, we might combine the G reading for the first part of the word with the M reading of the end to read הִשָּׁאֵל. This would mean that (1) M lost the initial *he* (single-letter loss facilitated by the rarity of this stem and the frequency of the *qal* stem), while (2) (O)G, not recognizing the passive nature of the verb, emended by adding a 2nd person marker and (3) Q, also not recognizing this, (a) made the spelling *plene* and (b) emended by adding a feminine 3rd person marker.

{I have yet to look at Leiden or BHV for assistance.}

שאל ליהיה

שאלת ליהוה

אשר השאלת ליהוה

{Post-script: The matter remains difficult. Tentatively, I read השאלת with G, in view of the strong witness of G in this book (or rather the weak witness of M!) and the intrinsic demands (“no witness is above commence sense”), offering a new explanation for M: The line was hard to read, and M represents the letters the scribe could both read and make some sort of sense of (M-Sam does not, at least often, transmit pure nonsense, so some attempt was made to wrest sense; the form landed on was facilitated, no doubt, by the high frequency of שאל *qal*).

1 Sam 2:27

Cf. Jenni 3: 62. On the syntax, cf. Num 20:15. H.t.

1 Sam 2:29

See Concordia, 99 for discussion. The MT is somewhat difficult, and G seems to make sense (since the locale, viz. the Tabernacle, is very much in view in this whole passage), with M being explainable as visual error.

1 Sam 2:33a-b

MT has probably mechanically assimilated to the long run of 2nd person forms in the preceding context, facilitated by the (mild) visual similarity of final *kaph* to *waw*.

1 Sam 2:33c

Visual error, probably from a damaged exemplar: *mem/pe* confusion + faint upper shaft of the *lamedh* (cf. on 3:16 below) leading (in this case) to *taw*.

1 Sam 2:33d

Probably the word was illegible (cf. the comments on the previous VU) and so left out.

1 Sam 3:16

Within Samuel קרא plus את never has the sense required here, but קרא plus אל occurs several times with the required sense. A faint shaft of the *lamedh* could have led to this. (This may be an inner-M error, not an M error per se.)

1 Sam 4:2

See especially Driver. A difficult case, but the simplest solution seems to be to assume corrupt dittography in M.

1 Sam 6:3

See Concordia 143-144.

1 Sam 6:19

My tentative solution to this crux: (1) The words המשים איש are a dittograph (cf. on 1 Sam 1:9 above) of שבעים איש via metathesis of the *shin* + *beth/mem* confusion + *chet/ayin* aural confusion; (2) to relieve the contradiction (“seventy men, fifty men”), the word אלה was inserted (relieving the contradiction, though ignoring the problem of such a large population in what was evidently a small village); (3) the OG was early emended on the basis of an M text (note that the phrasing in OG is odd, and literalistic, despite the more fluent Greek of OG-Sam generally), the original reading being preserved in Josephus (who at least often, and perhaps always, uses the OG); (4) the small number of Hebrew MSS that so read do so by homoeotetuton or by emendation.

1 Sam 7:1

Homoeoarchon.

1 Sam 7:16

(1) The repetition of את is either (a) a mechanical repetition due to the occurrence of the same word before ישראל, the scribe subconsciously expecting a pattern [direct object marker] + [other word] + [direct object marker]..., or (b) a corrupt dittography of the sequence אל with which the previous word ends (a faint shaft on a *lamedh* has been seen several times in this book).

(2) The loss of *beth* on בכל is corrupt haplography (or else subconscious reduction to a two-letter, *lamedh*-terminating word on the analogy of אל, if, as entertained above, a sequence אל ישראל has been created, such that ישראל בכל became ישראל אל בכל which became אל כל ישראל).

1 Sam 8:16

See Concordia 165.

1 Sam 9:16

See Concordia 180. Another possible explanation for MT is mechanical assimilation to the earlier occurrence of את עמי, in which no word intervenes.

1 Sam 9:18

See (at least) BDB sub נגש.

1 Sam 9:19

The plural is not constant with the context, and can be explained as corrupt dittography (*taw* → *taw* + final *mem*).

1 Sam 9:21

Mechanical assimilation, either to the earlier occurrence of שבטי or to the grammatical number of the previous word, or these factors in combination.

1 Sam 9:24

BDB sub האליה suggests so reading for העליה. There does not seem to be external evidence for such, however. {Leiden? BHV?} OG has a minus here. Perhaps העליה is a doublet for השוק, which doublet was then corrupted via aural error. It is not clear whether M-Sam has doublets of such a nature (we do not here speak of dittographs); even if so, the subsequent aural error to a possibly nonsensical form seems a bit odd. But M-Sam would be among the top candidates, if not *the* top candidate, for an M book in which such would occur. (There do seem to be *fehler* readings in M even in well preserved books, e.g. Lam 4:3.)

1 Sam 9:25

See Driver. (There is some sort of error, perhaps in my reprint, involving the pointing of וירבדו. The word is evidently *qal*, to go off Pr 7:16.)

1 Sam 10:10

Concordia (194) notes that “Saul's servant has not been mentioned in some time.” This is not decisive, since G might be a correction for this very reason. Yet the collocation שם גבעתה seems anomalous (could not find parallel constructions in BDB sub שם, which does not cite this passage), and the readings visually are not far apart. The G reading is to preferred.

1 Sam 10:11b

It might be thought that a reference to Saul's prophecy would not be marked, but (a) the external evidence for the inclusion of a sectional break shows signs of reliability elsewhere, and (b) Saul is at least once shown in a positive light via the breaks elsewhere (see Pericope 9: 43n³²).

1 Sam 10:15

Corrupt dittography most likely (cf. the earlier singular imperative). Cf. the VUs in 9:19 and 10:10.

1 Sam 11:9

L's לאִישׁ could be an assimilation to אִישׁ in v8 or an assimilation to *yodh-shin* sequence with which the following word, יָבִישׁ, ends.

1 Sam 12:11

See Concordia (219). But did Samuel deliver the people militarily? Sampson did, though in a direct way, which indirectness, along with the visual similarity of the two names, might have contributed to the confusion. (Assuming Samuel was among the last of the judges, his memory would be relatively recent, which fact would account for why he would be mentioned by Samuel.) According to BibleWorks9 the name שַׁמְשׁוֹן occurs only 38x, and those only in Jdg 13-16, whereas שְׁמוּאֵל occurs 140x (mostly in Sam, but also in Num, Jer, Ps, and chr); in light of the rarity of שַׁמְשׁוֹן, perhaps the error from שַׁמְשׁוֹן to שְׁמוּאֵל, at least in the early sections of the book of Sam, would not be surprising. (OL non extant here according to Sabatier.) {Verify Leiden}

1 Sam 12:15

See Concordia (220). Not only is the M expression more common as noted there, but the two terms are visually similar, and the *lamedh* → *beth* error seems to be characteristic of M-Samuel.

1 Sam 12:21

The M scribe anticipated כִּי תָהוּ later (perhaps in the line directly below the one at hand) in the verse.

1 Sam 13:5

See Concordia 233 for a very helpful discussion. M can be explained as *he/* final *mem* confusion + insertion of a helping letter. The OG apparently suffered some transmissional disruption here (as in another numerical problem; see on 6:19 above), or else OG^L was corrected against a Hebrew MS which differed (and perhaps agreed with P). (Another approach: שלשים is due to assimilation to the visually similar וּפְלִשְׁתִּים earlier in the v. Still another approach: “30,000,” in M or in the OG transmissional history, or both, is due to assimilation to one or more of the several places where that number occurs elsewhere in this book; cf. 4:10, 11:8, 2 Sam 6:1.)

1 Sam 13:7

Following Ges 119gg (*I have confirmed* OG).

1 Sam 13:20

For the pointing see HALOT 1: 355^a.

1 Sam 13:21

My tentative solution to this difficult passage:

-ולאִתִּים became in M ולשֵׁל by mechanical assimilation to the previous ולשֵׁל

-שֶׁקֶל lost its *shin* by haplography, and saw its word divider misplaced and its *lamedh* lost by visual absorption into the following לֶשֶׁן

-לֶשֶׁן suffered in M as noted above; in G, the *waw* was lost due to visual similarity to the following *nun*, or the tradent was overtaken by the obscure vocabulary, and לֶשֶׁן, “as for the tooth” was read

A literal translation: “And the price was a *pi(a)m* [see NICOT on the spelling] for the plowshares; and as for the *itim*, three sheqels to be sharpened [passive *qal*], and [the same three-*sheqel* price went for] the axes [as well], and [also] to repair the [in English style: “a”] goad.”

Concordia (who follows Brewer) is less choppy, but I am not aware of external support for omitting the first two letters of ולהקדמים.

1 Sam 14:5

Concordia (248) suggests מצוק is a “corrupt dittograph of the following word.” This seems to be a good solution given the character of M-Sam. On the specific letter confusions, cf. the VU in 12:11. (Ibid., n⁴, says that “Tsumura’s attempt to explain this word (*The First Book of Samuel*, 356, n. 9) appears to be special pleading in order to defend the MT at all costs.”)

1 Sam 14:18a

See Concordia 250-251 for extensive discussion. In short, M seems all but impossible. The explanation seems to be transcriptional: (1) The sequence הגישה האפד could become הגישה ארון via (a) dittography of the second *he* (albeit across a word boundary), (b) *pe* → *resh* (via a faint center?), (c) *daleth* → *resh* (via faint top left?), and (d) corrupt dittography of the left-most vertical shaft resulting in the creation of a final *nun*. These steps might not be entirely accurate, and need not be thought of as discreet steps: The overall visual impression (whether due to inattention or, more likely in my view, a damaged/venerable exemplar) was in the mind of the M scribe the second letter sequence. At any rate, once this change happened (b) the natural complement to ארון, viz. האלהים, was (consciously or unconsciously) supplied. (3) The form הוא could easily be misread as היה. At some point (4) inner-verse assimilation led to a second ארון האלהים. In short, the M scribe was trying his best to make sense of a difficult exemplar.

1 Sam 14:18b

As to לפני see Tamar Zewi in JANES for intrinsic evidence against M. Perhaps auditory error contributed to M (*beith/pe*). (An similar confusion occurs in other variation units?)

1 Sam 14:21

Wrong word division + consequent addition of a helping letter. Concordia 252 notes סבבו as the G reading and as preferable, but fails to note גם (translated as καὶ in OG) as the probable reading of G. (If αὐτοὶ αὐτὰ translates וגם, M’s סביב could be explained as transposition + *waw/yodh* confusion, but the syntax of the verse would be quite odd.)

1 Sam 14:24

The situation here is similar to v18 in that extensive damage to the M exemplar, followed by an attempt to produce something with at least surface meaning (cf. Beowulf book). Here it is difficult to say which reading is better: M might (a) recap 3:6 (cited by McCarter, cited in Concordia, as a motivation for a change in M), and prepare and (b) prepare the way for the soldiers’ desperate hunger. On the other hand, G (a) sits well in its immediate context, which is a *decisive* (cf. 14:15-16, 20-23) victory for Israel, and (b) segues naturally into Saul’s curse; also, (c) the adjective גדול is a favorite of the author of Samuel, and (d) the syntactic structure with which 14:24, combined with the summary statement of 14:23 (does Tsumura evaluate that verse in the same way?), make a good good that 14:24 begins a new (sub-)episode, rather than provide a flashback (cf. Gen 3:1) – Saul’s curse does not seem to be a concern of the preceding material, stretching back into chapter 13, but manifestly is a key concern of 14:24-46.

Admittedly, the transcriptional path from G to M is difficult to trace, but cf. the comments on v18 for the homogeneity of the shift. It can be remarked that *waw/yodh* confusion and transposition, both common errors, close much of the gap between וישאול and ואיש, and the *lamedh* with which וישאול ends might have inspired the plus ישראל, if such is not (note the McCarter citation alluded to above) a recollection of 13:6. (Alternatively, ואיש and ישראל are both corrupt dittographs of וישאול, which was subsequently deleted via emendation.) The word נגש could have arisen from שגג via *gimmel/nun* confusion + transposition. The loss of גדולה שגג is difficult to account for. Perhaps the words were dropped by emendation after these changes had happened since they were no longer sensible, or perhaps they were not sufficiently readable in the exemplar to attempt a reproduction of them.

Since G seems to fit better internally, and since this VU implies massive graphical confusion similar to that in v18, for which internal evidence strongly favors G, it seems best to accept the G reading. (Concordia retains M, though seemingly without strong conviction, while BDB sub שגג opts, at least in part, for G. {Driver?

NAC? WBC?})

1 Sam 14:32a

G supports the Qr. Kt is *s(h)in/tet* confusion (imagine the an ink blot or blurred left or right arm on the *tet*; such could look like a third arm, i.e. a *s(h)in*).

1 Sam 14:32b

Near haplography (loss of *he* after *lamedh*, the top stroke of which has been lost sight of).

1 Sam 14:41a

M is probably corrupt dittography, שאול becoming אל שאול, or perhaps its was inserted on the incorrect assumption that we are still in narrative when we read יהוה, rather than in direct discourse.

1 Sam 14:41b

Homoeotelueton. See Concordia 263-264. (On OG's rendering of ישנו, see v39. Cf. the same verse for the pointing of בעמך after ישנו.)

1 Sam 14:42

Concordia's explanation for why OG would add this extensive section is hardly convincing, especially when M is so damaged in this section. Rather with WBC we posit homoioteleuton.

Some notes on the retroversion:

-The first part is modelled on Josh 7:14. What ος ον represents we cannot, without a Hebrew fragment, know with certainty, though this is a plausible guess (keep in mind that German book's characterization of the translator's style)

-1 Sam 20:2 supplies the retroversion אין זאת (similar OG, similar idiom, same book)

-2 Sam 24:4 provides the basis for ויחזק (cf. BDB sub חזק *qal* 1d)

-In most of Samuel מן העם is found, but in 1 Sam 14:28 מהעם appears, strongly suggesting that the same form would have been used here

1 Sam 14:47

See Concordia 276. BDB sub ישע concurs regarding the decision.

1 Sam 15:17

Following OG, which, to judge from its practice in nearby verses, does *not* seem merely to be assimilating; M is readily explainable as h.t.

1 Sam 16:6

See Cross and Parry (66^a).

1 Sam 16:7a

See Cross and Parry (66^a).

1 Sam 16:7b

On the intrinsic evidence see Driver. There is not an obvious visual or auditory trigger for אשר from כאשר, but the former is about 10x more common than the latter, so it might be accidental replacement of a common term for a less common one, whether due to fatigue, inattention, or difficulty reading the exemplar.

1 Sam 16:7c

I agree with Concordia (303) that M has suffered homoeotelueton.

1 Sam 17:4

See Concordia 326-327.

1 Sam 17:12

See Concordia 329. This is a good example of M's transcriptional problems in this book: M is the addition of a single letter (quite possibly unconsciously inspired by the *beth-aleph* letter sequence which immediately precedes the word in question) + transposition; it is intrinsically difficult or impossible (this very chapter and many others make it clear that Jesse's was not a particularly notable family); assimilation to common usage is all but impossible since, as Concordia notes, the phrase *בא בשנים* occurs nowhere else in the OT; and the unusual nature of this phrase is not a knock against it since its equivalent *בא בימים* does *not* occur in Sam (i.e., this is the author's distinctive variation on the idiom).

1 Sam 17:23

Kt is oversight of a single letter. OG has a minus for this verse but V supports Qr. (Haven't checked P.)

1 Sam 17:52

On *גת* for *גיא* see Talmon 150.

1 Sam 17:55

Following OG^{MSS}. It is hard to see why, from a Greek perspective, *ἐγενετο* would be added if not for reflected a *Vorlage* *ויהי*, and it is hard to see why a Hebrew scribe would have added that at a late stage, since such would not be necessary in the Hebrew of his era.

Admittedly, the error in M is a bit hard to explain. Perhaps near haplography after the previous word (but note the section break intervening), near haplography before *כראות*, or a faded exemplar which the scribe made only a limited attempt to read.

In making this change, 1 Sam 17:55 should be moved in Ges from 111b to 111f.

1 Sam 18:6

Explaining Kt, either as some root other than “sing,” or as a morphological equivalent to *לשיר*, seems all but impossible, and *waw/yodh* confusion, especially in a book so replete with visual errors, accordingly commends itself.

1 Sam 18:9

Kt is corrupt haplography, if not simple oversight of a small letter (in the square script).

1 Sam 19:12

See Cross and Parry (66^a).

1 Sam 19:22a-b

See Concordia 376. Apparently *שכי* is a ghost form.

1 Sam 20:1

Such appears to be the G reading; cf. Concordia 374 to 19:18. M^{Kt} is *waw/yodh* confusion; M^{Qr} is an emendation, as elsewhere.

1 Sam 20:3

See McCarter's introduction to textual criticism (31). The OG paraphrases the verb, but its omission of an equivalent of *עוד* remains salient, especially since there is a transcriptional explanation for the existence of a variation here. Indeed, not only corrupt dittograph (as McCarter notes), but also assimilation (23:4, 2 Sam 6:1).

1 Sam 20:5

See Concordia 389.

1 Sam 20:8

See Concordia 2: 23 (*ad* 2 Sam 2:5, where G Q suffer from the same error as M suffers here): A single letter has been exchanged, shifting from one common preposition to another but disrupting an idiom.

1 Sam 20:19

See Ges 120c. NET cites a verse from Judges, but the context there is quite different.

1 Sam 20:25

See Concordia 394 together with BDB sub קדום. M is corrupt haplography of *daleth* before final *mem*, substitution of a more common term for a less, or one facilitated by the other.

1 Sam 20:26

Pu'al. Following OG and 4QSam^b. M is assimilation to earlier in the verse.

1 Sam 20:27

See Concordia 394. Omission of a single letter, substitution of a more common word for a less common word, backward assimilation (less plausible is forward assimilation in Q=G), or some combination of these things; cf. the similar situation in v25 above.

1 Sam 20:29

It is possible that for וְהָיָה צִוּי לִי אֶחָי we should read וְאֶחָי צִוּי לִי אֶחָי. But (1) the path is a bit unclear, (2) it is not clear that OG can fully be retroverted this way, and (3) there is a parallel for the unusual wording (see Driver 134).

{Post-script: But 4QSam^b so reads, so retroversion is not an issue. The parallel, moreover, is poetry, not prose.}

1 Sam 20:30

We follow G = 4QSam^b in reading בַּעֲרֹת, perhaps “you member of [a clan] slave-girl run-aways” (cf. Driver; apparently similar to modern-day “Gypsie” as a slur) or “you son of a rebellious woman” (=“you son of a b*****”). Haplography due to the visual similarity of *resh* to *waw*.

1 Sam 20:34

It is hard to decide on וַיִּחַפּוּ vs. וַיִּקָּם. For an argument for the latter see Cross and Parry, “A Preliminary Edition of a Fragment of 4 Q Sam b (4Q52)” BASOR 306: 68, which is tentatively accepted here, primarily on the basis, as they point out, of possible transcriptional confusion, especially given the many problems in M-Sam in this section.

1 Sam 20:38a

Either assimilation (so Cross and Parry 69^a) or visual confusion + metathesis.

1 Sam 20:38b

M is corrupt haplography in the paleo script.

1 Sam 21:1

See Cross and Parry (69^a).

1 Sam 21:3

See Cross and Parry (69^b). (Concordia has a typo here, representing 4QSam^b as having ידעתי.)

1 Sam 21:4

Following G and 4QSam^b, supposing only half the *taw* was visible.

1 Sam 21:5

Corrupt dittography (MT conflation according to Cross and Parry 69b).

1 Sam 21:6

See Concordia (408).

1 Sam 21:7

Concordia (408) thinks that המוסרים is “*ad sensum*” since “the bread of the Presence consisted of twelve loaves,” and that Q “is probably a secondary correction.” Such seems possible, especially as OG reflects a plural. On the other hand, BDB sub סור thinks that the plural is due to מלפני, and mechanical assimilation to הפנים is also a possibility. Perhaps one occurred in the M line and one occurred as an inner-G error.

{Post-script: Driver has another approach, viz. הלקחו for הלקחם. There the *waw* of MT might be due to missing the left half of the final *mem*, perhaps influenced by the fact that a *waw* follows said final *mem*, such that there was a rather long sequence of downward strokes, the middle of which (the *mem*) could easily have been lost.}

1 Sam 22:15

M's בכל for ובכל could be haplography due to the preceding *resh* or to the following vertical shaft of the *beth*, or assimilation to the later בכל.

1 Sam 22:22

See Concordia 429 and BDB sub סבב. The forms differ by only a single letter. M could be an accidental replacement of a rare word by a common one, facilitated by the visual similarity and by the occurrence of the root סבב in v17 (Cf. Concordia). It could be objected that חור is too late for Sam. A noun form occurs in Eze 18:7 (though BDB is doubtful regarding the text there). But given its cognates, it is hard to rule out an early use for it; this, combined with the transcriptional matters mentioned and the very difficult, if not impossible, use of סבב here, favor G.

1 Sam 23:6a-b

See Concordia 436-437, especially regarding the intrinsic evidence. However, his reconstruction of G from OG appears to be incorrect on a few scores: (1) The OG αὐτὸς αὐτῶς likely (though not certainly) suggests והוא. Similarly, (2) the OG appears not to support a form וירד, given the wide separation in the OG of the verb from the conjunction. Then too, (3) the word order is different, though not identical to M. Finally, (4) it is not clear that we can document a form ואפוד, which is perhaps easier but not necessary. Additionally, Concordia appears to be incorrect in ascribing the error to homoeoteteluton + transposition + omission of conjunction: Had the scribe's eye jumped from דוד to דוד, the verb ירד would have been irretrievably lost (it is far from clear that such could have been inserted merely from the broader context).

Our reconstruction is that homoeoteteluton from דוד to דוד *did* occur, but (1) that what preceded the lost דוד was not וירד but והוא, and (2) the form ירד occurred *after* קעילה. In M the word ירד also/subsequently traded places with אפוד. This latter error is unusual. Perhaps the error was in some way facilitated by the fact that ירד and בידו, next to which latter word the former moved in M, are visually similar. Or perhaps the word was accidentally omitted at first, then reinserted, but at the wrong location.

1 Sam 23:7

See Concordia 437 (though NET is a bit skeptical of whether the versions really had a different reading). MT's

נכר seems not to fit the context. The options סכר, which has broad M support, and G's מכר, both seem to work. The latter has parallels in Jdg (2:14, 3:8, 4:2, 9, 10:7) and in 1 Sam 12:9 (as well as elsewhere). MT could be a corruption of G via *mem/nun* confusion in the paleo script, but it is notable that most M-G differences in this book seems to stem from later scripts, and סכר is difficult to account for on this model. Perhaps G became סכר via *mem/samekh* confusion, which latter reading became in MT נכר due to a faint left half of the *samekh*, overlapping with the right right of *kaph*, or some similar error.

1 Sam 23:22

See Concordia (445-446).

1 Sam 24:5

The Kt is probably an accident due to the fact that the form איבך is more common than איבך in the OT.

1 Sam 25:1

Auditory + visual error. Most commentators so read, and v2 seems practically to require such.

1 Sam 25:18

The Kt appears to be an error (*waw/yodh* confusion), not an alternate form: Searching [*WBA@np*](#) and [*YBA@np*](#) shows no examples at all of the former and no examples of אבו appearing for אבי in the list generated by the second query; there is no OT precedent, then, for the sequence אבו in a proper name where אבי would be expected. (Probably different is the Kt-Qr in 2 Sam 3:3; see the research notes there.)

1 Sam 25:27

The error is admittedly hard to account for, but perhaps the fact that in the form הביאה two of the last three letters are vocalic in nature facilitated the error

1 Sam 26:16

Cf. Ges. M(T) is perhaps not impossible, but certainly difficult.

For the earlier א, (O)G might have read אה, as being expected after a transitive verb (according to BDB, א after ראה occurs only here, though importantly similar phraseology does occur elsewhere); but the OG might only be simply paraphrasing in having πω only once (and that a bit delayed).

1 Sam 27:3

We retrovert הכרמלי, without the final *taw*, from the OG. Concordia (2: 22) thinks L “is an impossible reading because Nabal was not from Carmel, but from Maon (1 Sam 25:2[a]).” That verse, however, makes a point of saying that Nabal’s “business was in Carmel” (ESV); the author of Samuel thereafter declines to mention Maon again, but mentions Carmel several times (1 Sam 25:2b, 5, 7, 40). Admittedly 1 Sam 25:7 implies that Nabal’s men were not there year-round, yet v36 speaks of Nabal feasting “holding a feast in his *house*” (ESV; emphasis added). Nabal might technically have been from Maon, but his association with Carmel was strong, and this latter association is certainly what would have been uppermost in the minds of readers of this book. So the reading is not impossible, but rather a good example of a reading superficially more difficult, but not thereby invalidated. The feminine reading has its merits, but it has its difficulties also: (1) The masculine form is transcriptionally difficult to derive, (2) the easier reading could be an emendation, and, most importantly, (3) the *same* error would have had to occur in *four* places (1 Sam 27:3, 30:5, 2 Sam 2:2, 3:3), a most unlikely scenario.

1 Sam 27:4

Re Kt-Qr: The root יס”פ when used in this sense (see BDB) is not elsewhere a participle. Perhaps corrupt dittography.

1 Sam 27:10

See Concordia (509). M is aural error + loss of מִ before פּ.

This is an example of עֵל becoming אֵל through transmissional error.

{Post-script: For another approach, see BDB sub אָן: Perhaps that rare form became אֵל via inner-M error in MT (+V?) and עֵל מִ in G via emendation.}

{Post-script 2: עֵל need not be read; such, if in a *Vorlage*, could be a standardization. But repointing is necessary.}

1 Sam 28:2

It is difficult to be sure whether אֵתָה or אַתָּה is preferable {would DCH sub לָכֵן shed any light?}, but the latter seems slightly preferable, for when the root יָדַע means “know [already],” it is (usually? Always?) in the perfect, so the meaning “You yourself know how capable I am” would more likely be expressed with יָדַעַת vs. תָּדַע. Most commentaries seem to be silent, but Driver prefers G, instancing 2 Sam 18:3.

1 Sam 28:3

Corrupt dittograph of the right half of the *beth*, or else difficulty reading the passage? On the intrinsic evidence see Ges 154a n¹, which prefers G here.

1 Sam 28:14

Pace Concordia (522), it is not clear why an “aged” man would necessarily be Samuel. Elsewhere in the OT people are identified by some distinctive feature (Jehu in his chariot; Elijah with his hairy arms); perhaps Samuel was known for his posture or height. Moreover, M is explainable as (1) substitution of a more common word for a less common one, or (2) *pe*/final *nun* confusion (Concordia 522 notes this possibility, but does not note that final *nun* for *pe* is a more likely error than the reverse, especially if in M the text was faded at times).

1 Sam 28:16

See Concordia (523). 15:28 might provide intrinsic evidence for the reading עָם רָעַךְ. Concordia fails to note that עָם could have fallen out due to homoioteleuton after וַיְהִי in the paleo script, if not due to its small size or to a damaged exemplar.

1 Sam 29:10a

Probably simply an accident, facilitated by the small size of the word. See Driver.

1 Sam 29:10b

See especially Driver.

1 Sam 30:1

See Concordia (550). Both forms occur a number of times in Sam; confusion could easily occur, especially on the part of an overtaxed scribe (viz. the M scribe).

1 Sam 30:14

The preposition of עֵל seems necessarily before גָּבַב, and, being a small word (and ending with a letter somewhat visually similar to that with which the previous word ends) could easily have been omitted accidentally. On the intrinsic evidence cf. Concordia to 2 Sam, 92n¹.

1 Sam 30:17

Cf. Concordia (554-555). The first point is pointed as in Jonah 4:7 (1 Chr 29:21 seems to be in a slightly different construction); the second, as in 2 Ki 19:11.

1 Sam 30:21

Aural error + *daleth/taw* confusion, facilitated by the happenstance that the phrase עַד הָעַם occurs nowhere else in

the OT (at least as per BibleWorks9), while **את העם** occurs 102x elsewhere, and **ועד העם** is also non-extant, while **ואת העם** occurs 99x. The use of **עד** with **נגש** is rare but does occur (Gen 33:3, Jdg 9:52).

1 Sam 31:11

See Concordia 567. We suppose that (1) the 1 Chr 10:11 reading is original, (2) in M **כל** became **אליי**, perhaps facilitated by the *yodh* {any support for a *plene* spelling **יְיוֹשְׁבֵי**} with which the next word begins; (3) this nonsensical word was either (a) lost due to homoeoteleuton or (b) ignored by translators.

An alternative explanation, less convincing but worth recording: The minus is original, M is due to aural error + *waw/lamedh* confusion + corrupt dittography such that **עו י** became **עו אליי י**; Chr is simply a paraphrase.

2 Sam 1:8

Kt is corrupt dittography or wrongful anticipation of a 3rd person form.

2 Sam 1:18

Concordia cites a view that **למד** collocated with **קשת** means “train for war.” This could make good sense (God's people have been attacked, so the song of lament could be not simply a sad reflection but an implicit call for military response to the affront), except that 2:1 uses the phrase **אֲחֵרֵי כֵן**, seemingly establishing a temporal relationship (suggested in any case by the sequence of the text), and thereafter David inquires of the Lord as to whether he should venture to Judah (which he surely knows will precipitate conflict; he could have remained in Ziklag). In short, if “train for war” is the meaning here, it seems to be in conflict. Also, v18a as instruction for military preparation seem to interrupt vv17, 18b in introduction of the following song.

No other sense beside that of the problematic “train for war” model can, so far as I can tell, be found in **קשת**.

The absence of **קשת** in the OG could be due (1) to it being an original minus, (2) to corrupt haplography after **יהודה** (*he/taw* confusion), or (3) to a tradent ignoring the word because he did not understand it. Any of these seem possible. Since the plus is so difficult, the first option is preferable if a transcriptional explanation is forthcoming. Corrupt dittography is all but impossible, but the word occurs in v22 after **גבורים**, which latter word is graphically similar to **יהודה**. Perhaps the scribe's eye went to the wrong place, leading him to copy **קשת**. Realizing his mistake he returned to v18, but either failed to note the error or his correction notes went unnoticed by a later copyist.

2 Sam 1:16

The idiom here is consistently in the singular elsewhere. OG supports the singular, the plural probably being a dittograph.

2 Sam 1:21

M does not seem to make sense, *pace* Concordia and NICOT. The proposal to read **שרעי תהומות** for **ושדי תרומת** is dubious as to the sense, and more importantly lacking in external evidence as to the second word. The first word is possible, as HALOT acknowledges (though it prefers not to emend), and just possibly correct (if it can mean “mountains”), but the sense of the Ugaritic is far from clear (cf. DUALT 2: 830).

I follow GL in reading **הרי תמותה** (“mountains of death”; HALOT does in another connection approve the second lexeme [indeed, David uses it], the rarity of which might have helped this variant along). For **עליכם** GL might have **על מרמכם** (*/meromekha/* “upon your heights”), but tentatively I view this as a doublet (on the translation level, I suppose, though possibly on the Hebrew level); adopting this latter reading would seemingly leave the meter rather unbalanced, and be a bit hard to explain.

At the risk of inconsistency (see on 3:3 below), I have put in an initial *daghghesh* on the *taw*.

2 Sam 2:31

M is corrupt dittography of the preceding final *nun* + *beth/mem* confusion.

2 Sam 3:2

Re Kt-Qr, see Driver.

2 Sam 3:3

We follow 1 Chr 3:1. Also G: The OG ΔΑΛΟΥΙΑ is probably a corruption of ΔΑΝΙΗΛΟΣ (so Josephus) or of ΔΑΝΙΗΛ (OG-1 Chr 3:1). Admittedly, M is difficult to account for. Two hypotheses: (1) (a) *Daleth* and *kaph* are a bit similar visually, (b) as are *nun* and *lamedh* (though error in the opposite error would be more likely, facilitated by the rarity of כלאב as a name in the OT), and (c) *lamedh* could possibly have become *beth* through (primarily) loss of the upper shaft. (2) (a) The form דניאל was somehow either (α) dropped from the text or (β) overlooked, and (b) the form כלאב was created through corrupt dittography of the following לאביג[י]ל.

The pointing here without the *dagesh* follows the analogy of how the *naqdan* treated M's כלאב, *i.e.* no *dagesh* in the first letter.

2 Sam 3:18

M is either an assimilation to the nearby 3rd person verb or an instance of auditory error.

2 Sam 3:27

OG most likely has על, for two basic reasons: (1) Contrast its rendering here (επι) with that of MT על in 20:10 (εις). 2:23 has επι but this could be an assimilation (given G's general character and the tendency, noted in BDB sub לא, of the author of Samuel to substitute one preposition for the other indifferent); in 4:6 OG has a very different text (on which see essay in *The Literary Dimension*) and so is not relevant to this discussion. (2) The Q reading עד is derivable from על via (a) a faint upper shaft of the *lamedh*, (b) emendation (if the preposition is interpreted overly literally), or (c) the second facilitated by the visual similarity of the two forms.

2 Sam 4:2

See Ges 128c. We follow certain MSS of the OG (see Cambridge); the B reading we take tentatively to an inner-greek assimilation to the name which will soon occur in v4.

2 Sam 5:2a

Wrong word division.

2 Sam 5:4

A look at the rather numerous other passages where this formula appears (albeit mostly in Kings rather than in Samuel) turn up no examples of asyndeton, and, as Concordia (75) notes, haplography after the preceding במלכו is a possibility, and external support for the conjunction is quite strong (indeed, this might be an inner-M error, though of this it is hard to be certain).

2 Sam 5:9

M is probably corruption haplography (jumping from the final *nun* of ויבן to the final *resh* of העיר). As Concordia (86) notes, the Q reading is probably an inadvertent, inner-G corruption. While אה might be expected before a definite direct object, that word is not strictly necessary (BDB sub אה says that its presence in such constructions in prose is “pretty” consistent; emphasis added). Here specifically note that 1 Chr 11:8 quotes this passage without the particle, and as that is later literature, such is hard to explain except for its absence here; also, the absence of the particle occurs (at least) just two verses later (v11a).

2 Sam 6:2

Based on Cambridge the OG text seems firm here. It's true that the OG could be a translational simplification, but the unusual syntax of MT (cf. Concordia, which does, however, prefer MT) suggests that MT is indeed a scribal slip. Note also another case of dittography in M in the near context (below, vv3-4).

2 Sam 6:3-4

M is a transcriptional error: See Concordia. (Curiously, the ESV either resorts to a conjectural emendation, translates loosely, or by some accident retains the word “new” near the end of v3 even though it seemingly adopts the shorter reading here.)

2 Sam 6:6c

See Concordia (105; second full textual note on this page). Concordia (105) suspects orthodox corruption in M to “protect readers from concluding that God struck Uzzah based on his intention rather than his accomplished action.” But it might rather be unintentional, for a faint *lamedh* could be misread as *waw+yodh*, or it could be inadvertent assimilation to the previous *wayiqtol* forms. 1 Chr 13:9 and Q reinforce the OG reading (if (O)G were merely an assimilation to Chr, it probably would have also assimilated את הארון to בו, since, as Concordia [ib.] points out, the latter is clearer).

Also, this section of the text seems to have many errors in M.

2 Sam 6:7a

See Concordia (106). Probably the error is from very ancient times, and the OG translator skipped this because he did not (could not) understand it, while Q emended based on 1 Chr 13:10. That latter passage, meanwhile, probably preserves the right reading, the sequence של being the readable remnant in a damaged exemplar of שלח. Dependence upon 1 Chr is also necessary in 6:6b, further evidence of damage in an early stream of the text.

2 Sam 6:7b

While M has been explained as an emendation (e.g. *Omissions in the Hebrew Bible* {if I recall the title of that book correctly}), a transcriptional explanation is at hand (in a context full of such errors): עם is a corrupt dittograph of שם, after which error לפני no longer made sense and ארון was supplied either deliberately (but not for theological reasons, simply in an attempt to make sense of the prepositional phrase; cf. v17) or by assimilation to the context which the Ark of God several times.

2 Sam 6:14

W/ OG (cf. Tov, *Text-critical Use*, 92; I have checked Cambridge and the text appears sound); the sense, though not the wording, seems implied in the parallel 1 Chr 15:27, with the same wording in a different context occurring in 2 Chr 30:21.

2 Sam 6:22

On the intrinsic evidence see Concordia (111). M is probably corrupt haplography in the paleo script (*waw* + *kaph* → *waw sol.*)

We have pointed as a pausal form (see Gen 16:6).

2 Sam 6:23

Some Massoretic witnesses (almost 50, according to Kennicott [1: 569 = PDF loc. 744]; though not A, L, or VDH) have וּלֵךְ. Might this be original? (Cf. the research notes on Gen 11:30). But *waw/yodh* confusion could account for an inner-MT error, and the Massorah (according to L and according to Ginsburg's list [1: 368^c = PDF loc. 372]) notes Gen 11:30 as unique (it is not, of course, aware of Ex 21:22). But might this Massoretic note have been designed as much to militate against this reading as to preserve the reading יֵלֵךְ in Gen 11:30? At any rate, Sam, with its unusual linguistic features, would be a prime candidate for having such a spelling. (If retained, see on the pointing BHQ-Gen 24*.) {Postscript: Note further that it could be a North Arabian borrowing; and that DCH volume 2, 2nd ed. cites Qumranic evidence for such a lexeme.}

2 Sam 7:7

See Concordia (122), Driver (211). M-1 Chr 17:6's reading makes more sense (speak to a tribe? Do the tribes shepherd the people?), and שְׁבִטִי could be an aural error, if not a visual error (indeed; note G-1 Chr 17:6!).

On the other hand, cf. Gen 49:16.

The opposite error occurs in Num 25:5 and Pr 19:29, strengthening the case for adjusting MT here.

2 Sam 7:19

Following 1 Chr 17:17 (on which see the Research Notes there). It is notable that this posited error is quite consonant with my findings from error types in the Pentateuch (see the special section near the beginning of the Research Notes file), and that visually the error is quite possible both in paleo and in modern scripts. A bit tentatively, I take המעלה as a gloss on the Chronicler's part, though it is not to be ruled out as an inadvertent loss after the adjacent האדם, which is similar in its terms of its length and the visual character of its beginning and terminal letters.

2 Sam 8:8

See HALOT (1:368a).

2 Sam 8:9

See 1 Chr 18:9.

2 Sam 8:18a

The high concentration of [*waw* + noun] forms in this passage could have led to a mechanical assimilation. Apparently early: Already in G. See 1 Chr 18:17.

2 Sam 8:8b

See Concordia 161-162, with these comments/modifications: (1) Cj seems unnecessary – the OG provides documentation. (2) The translations with “head” can be strongly suspected to be assimilations to 1 Chr 18:17. (3) Instead of סכני הבית, I prefer to retrovert סכנים, which, being just two letters different from כהנים, the more easily explains such. [2 Sam 8:18 ends with these words in the MT: וַיִּבְנֵי דָוִד כֹּהֲנִים הָיוּ, “and the sons of David were priests.” This presents great difficulties when we think of the very specific laws about who could be priests, and what happened, both before and after David's day, when people transgressed these laws. Of course, David was far from perfect, but the assessment of Scripture overall is positive, and the major exception that Scripture flags elsewhere—his murder of Uriah—is still a couple of chapters ahead of us. Here textual criticism comes to our aid, for the OG version has ἀρχαγοί, “administrators.” This is not a common word in the Greek Bible, and certainly not how we would expect the frequent term כוהן to be translated, but it works beautifully as a translation of סוכן, a word which is well attested with this meaning in related Semitic languages. The MT here is readily explainable as an accident, the forms סכנים and כהנים being very visually similar to each other—metathesis, or the swapping of adjacent letters, is a common source of error in all witnesses, and of course *samekh* and *he* look similar (perhaps we can speculate that the ink was a bit faded or faint, so that parts of the *samekh* were hard to see and a *he* was inadvertently substituted for it). This visual error was no doubt facilitated by the fact that כהן is extremely common in the Hebrew Bible, while סכן is anything but. So while David cannot be absolved of all guilt, and we might shift the question to whether he was too hasty in appointing his sons to positions of power, analysis of the text is of great importance at this point.]

2 Sam 9:11

M(T) is assimilation to the previous verse. (OG^L [note that we are *not* in a kaige section in *this* portion of 2 Reigns] and P [independently, I suspect] have “the king,” probably by way of assimilation to v13; V emends.)

2 Sam 10:7

So (at least) Concordia 182, first textual note, Ges 131b. See 1 Chr 19:8 (Ges by error says 1 Chr 19:9) and OG (G^L) here. Faulty anticipation of the arthrous nature of the following word; cf. Mic 2:12.

2 Sam 10:9

Difficult: The Kt could be a mechanical repetition from the preceding בְּהוֹרִי, the fact that *beth* there is part of the stem while such would here be a prefix being beside the point in such mechanical lapses, while the Qr could be a regularization of the rare construction construct form + preposition + head noun (in this latter case the OG might be translating according to sense rather than form).

{Post-script: acc. to J-M 129m, cases like this one are rare, esp. in prose. Section n lists a Sam case, but it occurs in poetry. Note also the similar sort of error two verses previous to this (see above).}

2 Sam 10:18

See Concordia 184. Note that Rahlfs appears to have a secondary reading here, not the OG. The error in M is difficult to account for, but (1) the external evidence of G and especially of 1 Chr 19:18 is weighty, and (2) large-scale error is common in Samuel. Perhaps the line of text of very difficult to read and had to be reconstructed. It is formally somewhat similar to 2 Sam 8:4 and might have been partly assimilated to it. Also relevant is the fact that the phrase אִישׁ רִגְלִי is rare (in L: Jdg 20:2, 2 Sam 8:4, 1 Chr 18:4, 19:18), so if the phrase was damaged its successful reconstruction in proto-M would be unlikely. Moreover, פְּרָשִׁים and אִישׁ רִגְלִי bear some visual resemblance: They both have *shin* as their third letter, both have *resh* in a similar position (2nd and 4th), and have a similar number of letters (5 vs. 7, the last letter in פְּרָשִׁים easily being conscious or unconscious emendation to an expected morphological plural; bear in mind that the separation between words is often quite small).

2 Sam 12:30

It is important to note that understanding וְאֶבֶן as “with a stone” is probably not viable (see JANES, Tamar Zewi “Is There a {} in Biblical Hebrew?”); she suggests reading וְבֶה אֶבֶן with 1 Chr 20:2.

2 Sam 13:16

Parables from *lamedh* to *lamedh*. Cf., e.g., HALOT 1:29b (but adding עַל before אֲדוֹת is a quite plausible retroversion of OG, fits with usage of אֲדוֹת elsewhere, and provides a transcriptional explanation for M).

2 Sam 13:19

A *yodh* could easily have been lost here. On the intrinsic evidence see Jer 2:37. Concordia (239) concurs.

2 Sam 13:21

While it is difficult to rule out that the plus is a secondary, explanatory expansion (so NICOT and Dreibach 233 [but it seems incredible to argue, as he does, that OG and 4Q here agree by *coincidence*, since the wording is identical]), (1) there is a transcriptional trigger for the minus (homoeoarchon from וְלֹא to וְלֹא: Concordia 240), M-Sam contains clear losses of similar amounts of material (a) generally and, in particular, (b) nearby (v27, q.v. and v34, on which see Concordia 249), and (3) the plus ties into significant literary themes, viz. (a) the theme within Sam of good fathers overlooking their sons' behavior (though admittedly this theme would probably remain intact without this plus), and (b) the patriarchal theme (cf. studies on David and Abraham/Israel) of being overly inclined toward a particular son, most often a firstborn.

2 Sam 13:27

As Concordia (247) points out, similar phraseology occurs in 1 Sam 25:36 and M can be explained by homoeotelen. There is no clear trigger for these words to be added in G, and they prepare the way for what follows.

2 Sam 13:39

See Concordia (250-251) for extensive discussion.

2 Sam 14:11a

Re Kt-Qr see HALOT.

2 Sam 14:11b

In the paleo script, *waw* could easily have fallen out after *resh*. Furthermore, LXX^L supports this reading. Rendsburg (*Textus* 2018, p116) notes a Cairo MS in its support as well as the Vulgate, though the former might be a polygenetic correction to the expected form and the latter might be translational paraphrase.

2 Sam 14:19

OG. Cf. further Driver.

2 Sam 14:30b

See Concordia (266-267). Our reconstruction is of the OG. Two notes in that connection: (1) We read אלו on the basis of Q, assuming G likewise to have been defective (its seems unlikely that Q would invent this reading; rather it is probably inherited from the G archetype, and that from the autograph). (2) Q's ילדי is puzzling: BDB does not recognize the required sense, and OG δουλοι would seem to point to the expected עבדי. Perhaps it is a Hebrew-level transcriptional error in Q, as the forms are rather similar visually. Or perhaps under the influence of נער, or even of νεανισκος (on which see Thayer), the word ילד had in the era of the Q scribe taken on the additional meaning of “servant.” In v30a and in v31 the OG renders עבד by παις. Perhaps M leveled ילד to עבד in all these cases, but (a) it is, again, not clear that ילד *can* bear this meaning in the author of Samuel's day, and (b) it would be strange for עבד to have been leveled in the *Vorlage* of OG and *not* in Q, since the latter is inferior to the former. Rather, the OG translator is probably aiming for good Greek style, producing παις, δουλός, παις, rather than δουλός, δουλός, δουλός.

2 Sam 15:17 (+18)

See Driver (242). The matter is a bit complex, and not altogether certain, yet he makes a good case (note especially 16:6, where עמ and עבד are, at least in the Absalom story, distinguished). v18a exists in a doublet in Greek. The reading עבדי there might be an assimilation to עבדי in v17 before עבדי there became העם via visual error + emendation (viz. addition of the definite article) (if not auditory error [viz. *ayin* → *he* + visual error]).

2 Sam 15:28

See Concordia (289, 321).

2 Sam 15:31

See Pericope 9: 47 for intrinsic evidence favoring a sectional break. Since MT-Sam comes from a single exemplar, the loss of a section is not hard to see. I have not been able to see this portion of 4QSam^b [or is this a typo for 4QSam^a? That MS is not extant for this part of this verse, but reconstructions might have deduced the presence of a break – Hebert?] so I do not know whether it is open or closed; the analogy of 2 Sam 24:10 suggests the former. (<https://www.deadseascrolls.org.il/explore-the-archive/manuscript/4Q52-1>)

2 Sam 15:31

ויד is probably a mechanical assimilation to the previous verse. הגד was either then deliberately emended or accidentally misread as הגיד due to the antecedent change in syntax, facilitated by the visual similarity of הגיד to ויד.

2 Sam 16:2

The Kt is probably mechanical assimilation (which has occurred recently; see on 15:31 above), due to the high density of *lamedh* prefixes (of varying significations, but such is beside the point).

2 Sam 16:10a, b

Rending both Qr forms: “Thus he must curse [me], for Yahweh has said to him, 'Curse David,' and who can say [?to God], 'Why have you done thus?’” (cf. OG). The first Kt-Qr may be explained as *he/yodh* confusion in the paleo script. The second is harder to account or, but in the Siloam script *waw* and *kaph* look rather similar.

But Driver thinks unnecessary, rendering “if... and if,” but I am unsure about this usage (DCH gives various examples of the sense *if*, but they seem different to me). See NICOT for another solution. WBC reads the first Qr; how it handles the second is unclear to me. Concordia (301) seems to prefer both Qr forms, but apparently not strongly.

v11 seems to support the understanding with which we began these comments, for there David takes Yahweh's instigation not as a possibility but as an actuality.

2 Sam 17:3

See Concordia (316). MT is readily explained an attempt to read a damaged or illegible exemplar, or as the work of a fatigued or careless scribe:

-The word division was moved to the wrong side of the *he* in הכלה, facilitated by the high frequency of the word כל.

-The sequence איש רק אישה was only partly visible, or The letters איש alone were reproduced. Alternatively homoeoarchon caused a jump to the last word of this sequence.

-The word אחד was misread as אשר, being only one letter different when the close visual similarity of *daleth* and *resh* are factored in.

2 Sam 17:16

See Concordia (321). Davidson confirms that there is very widespread Masoretic MS support for such. L has no Qr here (according to WLC at least), but apparently VDH does (if I am reading Davidson right; have not confirmed yet; also have yet to check Ginsburg, JC on this point).

2 Sam 18:8

Re Kt-Qr: We follow 4QSam^a (and, in all likelihood, OG *Vorlage*): Kt is *waw/yodh* confusion + metathesis. (Qr is simply an emendation.)

2 Sam 18:14

See Concordia (341). This also appears to be the opinion of Muraoka (22^a sub βελος).

2 Sam 18:20

Re Kt-Qr see Concordia (349) and note the probable OG support.

2 Sam 19:2a

Cf. Concordia (353), which favors M as the more difficult reading. But probably the easier reading is preferable since M can be explained as *yodh/mem* confusion in the paleo script. (P and V are probably translating loosely. {I don't recall: Does P-Sam show knowledge of G-Sam?})

2 Sam 19:32

Re Kt-Qr: Very difficult. Concordia (367) seems to adopt the Qr in the lemma but the Kt in his comments. Driver (259) argues in detail that the collocation את בירדן is impossible. The Kt is all but impossible to derive from the Qr, but the Qr is easy to derive, either via emendation or via assimilation to earlier in the verse (or the former facilitated by the latter). Driver (ib.) thinks that את בירדן represents two variant readings, viz. בירדן and את הירדן, and opts for the former as less common but possible. Davidson gives 5 MSS as omitting את; such an omission could be theorized to underlie OG, but this would be a tenuous theory at best, and this small-minority reading is readily explained by the difficulty of the expression.

{Post-script: When the Lucianic issue is taken into account, OG (ακ του Ιορδανου) seems to support מן הירדן (note that ירדן is always arthrous elsewhere in Sam, and that the form מהירדן occurs nowhere in the OT).

The preposition could have been lost by haplography after לשלחו (*waw* to final *nun*), but MT-Kt is still hard to explain.}

{Post-script 2: Driver points to בִּירְדֵּן in v19. Thus that reading is preferable on intrinsic grounds, and furthermore he is probably right that M(T) is a mixture between two readings (אֶת הִירְדֵּן being a conjecture, which either subsequently became the basis for the OG^B revision, or attests to a polygenetic tendency to [perhaps subconscious, at least in the case of M(T)] linguistic updating). OG can be explained as *beth/mem* confusion; it does, however, attest to a non-presence of אֶת. Thus בִּירְדֵּן is intrinsically good and explains the other readings.}

2 Sam 19:41

The Kt (most likely to be pointed as in BibleWorks9) is possible, but probably in the square script ה was misread as וי. The error might be not M but inner-M: a fair number of MSS (so Davidson) have no medial *yodh*, making the error that much easier, and V seems to support this reading. At any rate, G^L support the Qr.

2 Sam 20:6

On the intrinsic evidence see Ges 107q n³ (citing Driver). Near haplography after *nun*.

2 Sam 20:14b

Re Kt-Qr see Concordia (383-384).

2 Sam 20:18

So HALOT (1:227b-228a).

2 Sam 20:23

Re KT-Qr: Haplography. Note that even NICOT prefers the Qr!

2 Sam 21:4

In the square script ולי could be corrupt haplography + *waw/yodh* confusion for ולנו. Alternatively, Kt could be an assimilation to the 1st person singular forms in the previous verse.

2 Sam 21:9

Concordia (398) favors Qr, though he does point to Ges 118i. The other passages cited in the latter source, however, do not seem to bear out the sense required by the Kt here. Kt is probably corrupt haplography after the preceding final *mem*. NICOT slightly prefers Qr. {Note also J-M p429 n4}

2 Sam 21:16b

Cf. BDB sub שקל. (Note that Ralphs here apparently does not represent OG in his inclusion of ολακ, but even if original it could be a doublet; the undisputed plural σικλων is the key point here.) The *mem* has moved to the wrong place, prompted by the ומשקל earlier in the verse and further facilitated, we suppose, by the defective spelling;

2 Sam 21:19

See Concordia (406-408). Trying to retrace the error:

- The scribe saw יעיר and unknowingly transposed the last two letters.
- He then jumped from the final *resh* of יעיר to that of כמנור and copied over the following ארגים.
- Realizing his error, he resumed copying at the proper point, but either did not note his error, or his correction marks subsequently went unnoticed, leaving a repeat of ארגים after יעיר. (cf. *Textus* 2018 article.)
- Perhaps flustered, he substituted בית הלחמי for את לחמי; cf. Concordia 407 on this point.
- Either by way of emendation (see Concordia, 407) or accidental substitution of visually similar forms, he replaced אחי with את.

There is a complication to note: It is possible that the OG had not Αριωκυμ, in which the name יעיר or a

corruption of its is fused with and so transmits the corruption ארגים, but something like αδδεν (see Cambridge), which would seem to be a corruption (via *daleth/resh* confusion) of יעיר. In this case, either the second step above either needs rethinking, or somehow the G lines underwent corruption of a different sort than the M text (perhaps subsequent deletion via emendation of the nonsensical ארגים).

Since (at least for the most part; see the preceding paragraph) this error seems to have been very early (inasmuch as both G and M are affected), my instinct is to see all this happening in the paleo script. Yet several of the differences seem quite explainable in the *square* script:

-The *he* on הלחמי could corrupt dittography of the last letter of the preceding word, whether את or בית.

-The second letter of את for גלית could easily to have shifted to *chet*.

-The *yodh* on the end of אחי could have been lost due to corrupt haplography before גלית or to its small size.

(Even in the paleo script, however, אחי could become את simply because the two words are short, share an initial letter, and the latter is extremely common.)

We might, then, hypothesize that the archetype for M and G which diverged from the true text after the composition of Chr comes from a surprisingly late date. (Cf. the comments on 22:16 below.) Such a hypothesis is not here *necessary*, however, only *possible*; investigation of other variation units would have to be brought to bear.

2 Sam 21:20

For Kt מדין Qr מדון the parallel passage has מדה. It is possible that in our passage there has been an early corruption (*he/yodh* confusion in the paleo script followed by corrupt dittograph in the square script, then *waw/yodh* confusion in M(T)?). However, the noun suffix םן is common enough (e.g. עצבן vs. עצב) that we tentatively take מדון to be such a noun, and therefore synonymous to the Chronicler's מדה (he then is updating the language, to use more current verbiage); Kt is *waw/yodh* confusion.

2 Sam 21:21

See Concordia (408-409), noting that he (as well as Rahlfs) misrepresents the OG (on p. 408; see Cambridge).

2 Sam 22:11

So OG (cf. its rendering – surprising for ראה in any case – to that in OG-Ps 18:11). *Daleth/resh* confusion facilitated by the rarity (at least in the OT) of דאה.

2 Sam 22:12a

The *waw* at the beginning of the verse could easily have been added in assimilation to the verbs of the previous verse; Ps 18:22 suggests such. (Corrupt haplography is possible, but not likely, especially since in such a case we would expect the *second* element, not the first, to drop. In Ps 18:22, OG has a conjunction, but the G text there is not especially reliable, and the G text often adds such conjunctions apparently deliberately; alternatively, the addition could be an accident, as apparently here.)

2 Sam 22:12b

So OG. Probably the sequence of initial-*samekh* words caused the copyist's memory to fail him.

2 Sam 22:12c

Transposition in M. See the parallel passage.

2 Sam 22:12d

M is probably graphic confusion; the M word, though rare (a ghost form?), is thus explainable, especially since the scribe seems in this verse, if not this passage (even book!) overtaxed.

2 Sam 22:13

It appears that OG^L supports this reading, as does Ps 18:13. BHS to Ps 18:13 prefers בערו in both places, though a

thorough check of editions and versions (Kennicott, Davidson, Ginsurg, BHS, OL, V, P, Rahlfs [but not Gottingen], Holmes-Parsons) reveals absolutely no support for such in Ps 18:13. BDB tentatively prefers עָבְרוּ in both places (they propose dropping עָבְרוּ, but, while I have at this writing not yet examined the external evidence for that, it appears not to be necessary, for one can translate “Out of the radiance of his glory storm clouds passed / [even] hail and coals of fire”).

2 Sam 22:16

See Ps 18:16. MG = *beth/mem* confusion + corrupt haplography (note the top half of *kaph* as almost duplicating the top half of the preceding *taw*). (Cf. the comments on 21:19 *ad fin* above.)

2 Sam 22:23

See Cambridge: The OG supports this reading. M is probably *waw/yodh* confusion + subsequent emendation.

2 Sam 22:26

See the parallel passage (Ps 22:26; note that the OG ανηκ there *could* point to a reading גָּבוֹר, but such could be assimilation, corruption dittography, or nothing at all, inasmuch as ανηκ translates גָּבַר much more often than it translates גָּבוֹר according to Muraoka). M is probably corrupt dittography. The word גָּבוֹר does not seem suitable here (cf., e.g., the entry in HALOT).

2 Sam 22:28a

On the OG see Cambridge. In כִּי אֵת the *yodh* was confusion with *waw*, the word divider (if present), was overlooked, leaving the overall impression of the extremely common וְאֵת; the *kaph* could have been dropped subconsciously, via subsequent emendation, or perhaps it was not visible in the exemplar.

2 Sam 22:28b

Cf. the parallel passage. M = *kaph/mem* confusion (in a non-modern script) + emendation via insertion of עַל.

2 Sam 22:29

On the OG see Cambridge. The word doubtless dropped due to visual similarity with אֵתָהּ.

2 Sam 22:39

Following OG (θλαω does not elsewhere render מָחַצ, but such a rendering would make good sense, and neither word is common, and it would *not* be especially apt for כִּלָּה); M is corrupt dittograph (cf. last word of v38).

2 Sam 22:42

See Concordia (430). Supported by OG, Ps 18:42, OG-Ps 18:42 (note that the different rendering shows non-dependence, at least on the Greek level); plus, G is the longer reading and could easily have dropped a letter, but the addition of this letter here is harder to envision.

2 Sam 22:44a

See Ps 18:44; the sense, as often in Sam (see Concordia *passim*) is “troop” (here poetically lacking the article). The reading עָמִי could be assimilation to Ps 144:2 (NB: the sense there is different; note the verb) or a mechanical repetition of the *yodh* with which the previous word ends. The OG μαχης λαων I suspect has a two-fold explanation: The latter word is plural as translating עָמִים, which is either corrupt haplography (in the paleo script, *yodh* → *yodh* + *mem*; in the square script, *taw* [see the next word] → final *mem* + *taw*) or emendation; the former is the work of the translator trying to clear things up, as λαων by itself would not make much sense in Greek.

2 Sam 22:44b

See Ps 18:44.

2 Sam 22:45

So OG; cf. the OG of Ps 18:45.

2 Sam 23:8a

See Concordia (449-450).

2 Sam 23:8b

Concordia (450) fails to note that the OG reading is probably $\sigma\iota\omicron\varsigma\ \theta\epsilon\alpha\kappa\epsilon\mu\alpha\nu\epsilon\iota$, evidently representing בן תחכמני . Thus we have an error unique to M (though recensionally incorporated into the OG transmission history later on), viz. omission of בן (as being a small word or via homoeoarchon).

Prior to this, evidently corrupt haplography (cf. on 21:19 *ad fin*) had occurred, viz. *chet* → *taw* + *chet* (see 1 Chr 11:11).

2 Sam 23:8c

Following G^L w/ Concordia (450).

Cf. also the comments on 1 Chr 11:11.

2 Sam 23:8d

M is “rather incomprehensible” (Concordia 450). Seems to be considerable visual confusion. We follow OG (=1 Chr 11:11).

{Post-script: A possible refinement is that for הַנִּיצוֹ HALOT (1:343b) would read הַנִּיצוֹ “battle axe,” which is of course a rarer term and possibly also visually closer to M. On the other hand, we also need either to posit an error in 1 Chr 11:11 (ibid.) or to suppose that the Chronicler updated the vocabulary. Such would merit a marginal reading, but seems a bit tenuous as a main text reading.}

2 Sam 23:20a

Re *first* Kt-Qr: A difficult case. OG appears not to represent this word, and to have ישי for איש , representing confusion of two similar forms. V is probably a secondary emendation. Perhaps הי fell out after ישי . We restore היל from 1 Chr 11:22.

2 Sam 23:21

Probably Kt = transposition + *yodh/resh* confusion.

2 Sam 23:32-33b

The lack of a section is implied in the previous reading (where G is followed).

2 Sam 23:37

Kt is an aural error.

2 Sam 24:6

M seems to be gibberish. *Pace* Concordia, 2 Sam chap. 8 seems to indicate that Kadesh in Syria is *not* “too far north” for Israelite troops to have been stationed.

2 Sam 24:23

M is tortured. הַמֶּלֶךְ (A=1) is probably a corrupt dittograph of the following לַמֶּלֶךְ .

Introduction to Kings

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Concordia's theory of Jeremian authorship has some support in Jewish tradition: A Massoretic note

משה איש האלהים כתב חמשת חומשי תורה וספר איוב יהושוע כתב ספרו שמואל הנביא כתב (Ginsburg, PDF file 3, loc. 345) has ספרו וספר שפטים ורות ישעיה כתב ספרו ומשלי ושיר השירים וקהלת ירמיהו כתב ספרו וספר מלכים וקנינות דויד ועשרה נביאים חברו תלים חגי זכריה ומלאכי כתבו ספר יחזקאל ותרי עשר וספר דניאל ומגלת אסתר עזרא הסופר כתב ספרו וספר דברי הימים ברוך בוחר בישראל ומנחילם תורה תמימה שלימה מאושרה ערוכה בכל ושמורה דרשו מעל ספר יהוה וקראו אחת מהנה לא נעדרה.

1 Ki 1:6

Cf. Jan Joosten's essay in *In the Footsteps of Sherlock Holmes*, with the modification that if OG¹ was based on ילד, although it pointed it differently, it is not to mind actually a conjecture.

1 Ki 1:14

Haplography. Cf. v22 for intrinsic support.

1 Ki 1:18

Auditory error facilitated by the ועתה earlier in the verse.

1 Ki 1:20

The same auditory error as in v18 in the opposite direction, in some witnesses perhaps facilitated by assimilation to that verse as there found. The variation is polygenetic, and intrinsic evidence favors the *ayin* as this would seem to represent the seem between background material and the directive (here obliquely stated, since a monarch is being addressed).

1 Ki 1:25

Cf. Jan Joosten's essay in *In the Footsteps of Sherlock Holmes*, adding that the plurals in the context could have led to accidental assimilation in M and that this is not really a conjecture to my mind (the singular ולשר is supported by G, while the plus of G in יואב is a secondary matter, viz. an explicating plus secondary to a text in which ולשר was already present).

1 Ki 2:22a, b

Both cases are a mechanical repetition of the *lamedh* prefix so frequent in the immediate context. Alternatively, such is the case with the second item, while the first is inverted dittography after ולו.

1 Ki 2:28

The reading שלמה for אבשלום is fairly widespread (evidently P; a majority of the MSS cited by BSV [indeed, WBC (27) seems to think that such is the original V reading, though BSV thinks V = MT]; most likely the OG [as WBC (39) reminds, we are no longer in a Kaige section; {the opinion of Gottingen would be most helpful here!}]; Josephus [so van Keulen, 29]). As Concordia (322) notes, “there is no good mechanical reason” for a shift from the former to the latter, and the former could easily (given the frequency of references in this passage to Solomon) be an assimilation to the context (so much so that in the case of V, perhaps such assimilation led to an inner-latin error; correction against the OG is another scenario to consider, though I am not aware of such being a common error in the transmission of V).

On the other hand, the phrase אחרי אבשלום, albeit in a different sense, occurs in 1:7, and Absalom is mention in 2:7 as well. Might אבשלום then be an assimilation, or based on a look at the wrong column of text? Another possibility: Following after אחרי אדניה, perhaps a scribe initially wrote ואחרי א, noticed his mistake at that point, and attempted to set matters right, but the next scribe (or he himself in his confusion), fused the mechanically repeated *aleph* to שלמה to produce אבשלום (either by slight guess-work or due to the fact that the right-hand side of a *he* could be mistaken for a *waw* and then transposed, especially if this all occurred at a stage where final and non-final *mem* were not distinguished, though the two forms are similar enough to be confused and obviously sound the same).

In terms of intrinsic evidence, WBC (39) thinks that “if our narrator had intended to compare Absalom with Adonijah in terms of Joab's allegiance, he would have done so the first time Adonijah and Joab had been

mentioned together, 1:7. In light of the fierceness of Joab's attack on Absalom (see especially 2 Sam 18:14-15), there would be not point in comparing him with Adonijah in the present context.” And as *ibid.* points out, the claim of Montgomery-Gehem (cited in van Keulen, 29) that the verb + preposition here “has a connotation of disaffection and rebellion” (van Keulen's summary [29] of M-G's view; he provides several scriptural references as well) is hard to accept wholesale (note, e.g., 1 Sam 14:7, albeit not with the preposition אַחֲרֵי; it would be interesting to look into {the LSAWS volume on evaluations in Judges on Jdg 9:3}). Indeed, the very difficulties of נָטָה אַחֲרֵי here might have prompted an emendation of שָׁלֵמָה! Though at present (11/9/19) we do not see emendation as having a significant place in the transmission of M-Kings (in this connection note the possible transcriptional scenarios given in the previous paragraph). It is not clear why mention of Joab's loyalty during the *long-past* rebellion of Absalom *against David* would be mentioned here, whereas his *recent* disloyalty to *Solomon* is precisely the point. (The G reading is arguably redundant, which stylistic matter might be why Vaticanus attempted to improve the statement with an emendation or appeal to a variant textual tradition known to the scribe; the redundancy is, however, I feel – it would be nice to be able to verify this more specifically – of a type standard to Hebrew narrative of this era, clarity, emphasis, and/or a sort of parallelism being sought.)

In terms of scholarly opinion: Concordia (322), NEB, NAC (following NIV⁸⁴ without comment), HALOT (for 1: 693^a seems not to cite our passage), BHK (explicitly), Oort (without comment), van Keulen (29), and BDB (sub נָטָה) favor MT. Ginsburg, WBC (39), BHS (tentatively), and Davidson favor G. Burney (23) can see arguments for both readings. (Kauhanen in *Lucifer of Cagliari* does not comment.)

1 Ki 4:3

G seems stylistically preferable, and M is explainable as corrupt haplography in the face of the following *waw*.

1 Ki 4:7

Corrupt haplography. Cf. the similar error in 7:20.

1 Ki 4:9

On the intrinsic evidence in general, see Concordia. There seems no external evidence for a *waw* conjunction, but וַיִּדּוּ could have been lost as small and as a bit unexpected (but cf. v12).

1 Ki 5:12

Cf. Burney (52).

1 Ki 6:2

MT is probably corrupt haplography (final *mem* to *he*).

1 Ki 6:4

The defective reading might have been influenced by the preceding וְשִׁקְפִים, which follows the same vowel pattern.

The matter is more important than most spelling variations since this is the only occurrence of a rare word and the *plene* spelling gives a hint as to its vocalization. (Noonan does *not* comment.)

1 Ki 6:8a

M is either (a) a combination of aural error + visual error + transposition or (b) assimilation to later in the verse.

1 Ki 6:8b

While normally we are skeptical of the grounds for textually interchanging אַל and עַל, here the external evidence is strong (see e.g., Davidson) and the error could have sprung from a mechanical repetition of the *ayin-lamedh* sequence in וַיַּעֲלֵו. Admittedly, אַל could be an assimilation. {Have not check J'lem Crown}

The opposite error seems to have occurred near the end of the verse in G.

1 Ki 6:8c

Error of a single letter, possibly visual in nature. Note that, contra BHS, G seems to support the smaller number here.

1 Ki 6:29

Homoeotelueton.

1 Ki 7:20

Corrupt haplography after *resh* (so Concordia 561, which also notes Cairo and other MS evidence as well as specific transcriptional data).

1 Ki 7:30

The defective reading is probably an assimilation to כחפת earlier in the verse. According to Ginsburg the Massoretic MSS are quite divided, but M^A is *plene*.

1 Ki 7:36

Cf., e.g., V. Perhaps Kt is a mechanical repetition by a fatigued scribe of the conjunction with which the previous word begins. Concordia (589) suggests “an ink mark” or some similar mistake.

1 Ki 8:1

Note the strong external evidence and the small size of the word כל.

1 Ki 8:7

Note the external evidence and the strong possibility of assimilation the oft-repeated אל in the previous verse.

1 Ki 8:16

See WBC-2 Chr 6:5-6.

1 Ki 8:26a

While the inclusion of יהוה here could be due to assimilation, and might be so in some witnesses, (1) the intrinsic evidence is very strong indeed, for, with the exception, for obvious reasons, of 1 Ki 12:28, אלהי ישראל is in the book of Kings always (and many times) preceded by יהוה, and (2) the short reading could easily be due to homoeotelueton after ועתה.

1 Ki 8:37

The first half of the two words are the same, and one of the remaining letters is subject to *daleth/resh* confusion. This, combined with the frequent occurrence of ארץ, including earlier in this very verse, led to the error in M.

1 Ki 9:7

See 2 Chr 7:20 and HALOT 2: 1515b. At the risk of circular reasoning, if the proposed defective spelling is correct, (1) such spelling is more or less to be expected, especially in a relatively early book such as Kings; and (2) the brief and unusual spelling would make the accidental substitution of a common (and here synonymous) root very easy indeed.

1 Ki 9:8 (+2 Chon 7:21)

See the essay in the Talshir FS, which, however, if I recall right, does not marshal all the external evidence that BHS does – most notable being those witnesses to the text of the OG which suggest a superior reading there.

Granting that the OG readings read לעיין rather than לעליון in 1 Ki and add יהיה לעיין after אשר היה עליון in 2 Chr (there is some question about the second, for perhaps the OG, or one or more important Greek witnesses, have in fact a doublet representing an alternative, and better Hebrew reading, but this is complicated by the

presence of אשר in the Hebrew text), our explanation is that is 1 Ki transposition + *waw/yodh* confusion (see the essay) occurred while in the second case haplography occurred (so BHS), adding that in the second case we have the Chronicler using a play on words (cf. Kalimi's book on metathesis as a literary device).

1 Ki 10:11

מאפיר is apparently an accidental repetition (evidently with a helping letter accidentally omitted); cf. Noonan sub אלגומים.

1 Ki 11:7

Cf. v33, 23:13; M is corrupt haplography in the paleo script or accidental substitution of a more common consonant sequence for a less common one. The M form appears in 2 Ki 23:10, there with the support of G (note with respect to that text that according to Cambridge the L text does not differ from the B text in a way that affects this discussion), but that passage is widely separated from here and, discussing a different king, might copy over the preferred spelling of the source material which the author of Kings use there. (If M were to be retained, the pointing should be changed to include the article: See Kitto 3: 197^a.)

1 Ki 11:25b

A verb seems required, and עשה could easily have fallen out after אשר: Both words are 3 letters, one is the same, and two sound the same or similar.

1 Ki 12:2

Re pointing of וישב: Subsequent verses will show that Jeroboam is in Israel for the ascension of Rehoboam; thus, this statement (the *waw* is resumptive after כשמע) speaks of his return, not of his Egyptian residence (which is mentioned in the intervening parenthetical clause). *Beth/mem* in the preposition before the second מצרים confusion either led to this confusion or was caused by it; alternatively, assimilation to the במצרים near the beginning of the verse could easily have occurred. See also the parallel (2 Chr 10:2).

1 Ki 12:21

Kt could be an assimilation to the plural verbs in the previous verse (though there are singular verbs there are well), a mechanical assimilation to the *waw* with which the previous verb ends, or a corrupt dittography of the following *resh*.

1 Ki 12:33

Graphic confusion, most likely in the square script. (BDB cites Qr approvingly without explicitly commenting on the variant; Holladay calls for reading Qr.)

1 Ki 13:11

M is probably a mechanical assimilation, either to אָ earlier or to the preceding, graphically similar אָל.

1 Ki 13:33

Mechanical assimilation to earlier in the v.

1 Ki 14:26

See BHS. M is an assimilation to the previous occurrence of this particle, which there has the conjunction.

1 Ki 15:9

M is mechanical assimilation, creating a string [WORD] + MLK + [WORD] + MLK + [WORD] + MLK + [WORD], perhaps facilitated by the shared *lamedh* and the visual similarity of *ayin* to *mem*.

1 Ki 15:20

Mechanical assimilation to earlier in the verse?

1 Ki 16:21

Corrupt dittography. Cf. Jenni (3: 279).

1 Kings 17:1

On the pointing, see esp. HALOT, noting the use of הגלעד to distinguish from the other locale; the MT pointing is not wholly impossible, but quite improbable.

On the plus, note the fact that in Kings the term הנביא always comes after the name of the prophet (so the intrinsic evidence checks out, though admittedly in 11:29 the locale is mentioned first) and that the auditory and visual similarity of this word with what follows could easily explain its accidental loss.

1 Ki 18:4

As BHS notes, v13 supports the inclusion of a word which appears to be well attested and could very easily have dropped out by accident.

1 Ki 19:5

Following Hilleli.

1 Ki 20:15

Following Burney (235). Two arguments carry some weight against G: (1) The use of בני חיל in a strictly military sense is elsewhere attested only in Chronicles, and so might be a feature specifically of late Hebrew, but such is far from certain; (2) the G rewriter might have made this change to avoid the (false) implication that Israel had only 7,000 men; however, this seems like an unlikely way to go about the matter.

More likely, graphic error (perhaps in the paleo script, where it would have been easier; but in any case the final letter of each word is the same) combined with the fact that בני ישראל is vastly more common than בני חיל is led to accidental assimilation to the more common form. Note also that Ahab seems not to be mustering the entire army, but only an elite strike force (given the relatively small number and the emphasis also on the שרי מדינה).

1 Ki 22:33

Following Hilleli.

1 Ki 22:34

Both מלחמה and מהנה are used in the near context and so might in a scribe's mind, and given their visual similarity could easily be confused. Alternatively or by way of further specification, accidental oversight of *lamedh* could lead to the *mem* being thought to be *nun* by way of visual error in the paleo script or auditory error in some dialects.

1 Ki 22:53

It seems likely that M is an assimilation to the two nearby occurrences of דרך in this verse. G, it is true, could be an assimilation to the phrase חטאת ירבעם elsewhere, but the phrase אשר החטיא occurs so frequently with reference to חטאת ירבעם that it seems better to say that intrinsic evidence favors G than to say that G is assimilation.

2 Ki 1:13

So, tentatively, BHS. M(T) is probably a mechanical assimilation to the suffix on the preceding word. Cf. the flow of the passage generally and השלישי later in this same verse.

2 Ki 3:4

Cf. the error in Kt-Jer 48:7, noting that the OG versions may well not have gone through the (late?) Hasmonean

phase of writing in which *waw* and *yodh* were all but indistinguishable (so that in such cases—where the OG is not internally corrupt—the OG might be a more reliable witness to proper names); the fact that this foreign name would not likely to have been familiar to many in the late Second Temple period; and the possibility of assimilation to the Israelite name מישע.

2 Ki 3:24b

Cf. Burney (271). Aural error, perhaps by the anticipated *he* of the following והכות, by confusion stemming from the unusually spelled preceding ויבו, or some combination of these and/or related factors.

2 Ki 4:3

(I *have* verified OG.) M is probably transposition, facilitated by the unusual כִּי-forms in context standing out in the scribe's mind. (The passage is not consistent in its use of these forms – see the very next verse – so and ending *without* a final *yodh* is not intrinsically problematic here.)

2 Ki 4:17

Following Burney (275). There are about 10 instances of the former for every 1 of the latter in the OT, and they are only one letter different and very similar in sound, so אשר, the harder reading, it quite possibly an accident here.

2 Ki 4:39

See NET. (The BHS “d” entry can easily be misread as saying that the key versions represent יִדְעוּ, but G^L, at least, has in fact יִדְעוּ.)

2 Ki 5:13

Homoeoarchon.

BHS encloses P T V in parentheses – I have not checked them. Either BHS is simply reluctant to retrovert definitively, or they may be coping with a difficulty. OG (assuming that the L text in 4 Reigns is best) in any case so reads, and the difficult reading in MT is readily explainable; the historical question is whether the error in M or inner-M.

2 Ki 5:18

Re BHS c: The G reading seems to fit better, inasmuch as Naaman seems to be at pains to distance himself from idol worship. Also, the M reading is easily explained as *waw/yodh* confusion, as assimilation to the majority of the letter sequence of והשתחויתי earlier in the verse, or one facilitated by the other. Furthermore, the MT seems hopelessly redundant, while G makes sense. Had G's intent been to absolve Naaman of guilt, there is more that could have been done along those lines.

{For a possible refinement, see J-M p195; cf. on 6:9 below. Yet note the possibility of an Aramaic flavoring to the biblical narrative at this point, plus the uncertainty of Muraoka's precise retroversion.}

2 Ki 5:25

אָן is a rare synonymous for אֵין. See BDB sub אָן.

2 Ki 6:32

M(T) is haplography after מלפניי.

2 Ki 6:9

Following Burney (285). Note that he does not explicitly cite OGL, but I *have* verified from Cambridge (ενεδρευσουσιν). The error in M(T) might have been influenced by the Aramaic-language knowledge of a scribe.

2 Ki 6:22

See Burney (287) on the intrinsic evidence, especially the first cross reference he provides. In a somewhat convoluted verse a small negative marker could easily have dropped by mistake.

2 Ki 7:2

This reading seems required, though admittedly the error is hard to account for. Perhaps the tail of one of the instances of *qoph* in the previous verse was on the line directly above, and interested with the top of the *he*, making it appear rather like a *lamedh*?

2 Ki 7:10

We retrovert OG differently than BHS. M is corrupt haplography of *he* before final *mem*.

2 Ki 7:11

An inner-M error, assimilating to the /a/ sound with which the previous word ends? See also on Num 32:25.

2 Ki 7:14

See HALOT (2:1231b) and Burney (292).

2 Ki 7:17

G is correct (see 6:32 w/ 7:1-2). The words מֶלֶךְ and מֶלֶאךָ are visually and auditorially similar and can occur in similar overall contexts, so the confusion is understandable.

2 Ki 7:13

Following, e.g., McCarter (30), NET. The external evidence here is quite complex. It is difficult to be sure what the original G reading was and what the original M reading was. But the conclusion that there is a dittography here seems inescapable. Perhaps, indeed, the dialectical anomaly (see the Research Note on our verse) influenced the error.

2 Ki 8:21

While it is just possible that M(T) is correct, such a spelling would be *highly* unusual; corrupt metathesis seems a more likely explanation, especially given the form הַסִּיבֵּב in the parallel passage (2 Chr 21:9).

2 Ki 9:25a

The Kt is word שלישי "[a certain rank of] officer" (spelled defectively) with the alternative 3rd person singular possessive pronoun (found elsewhere in Ki).

2 Ki 9:25c

BHS positions the plus after אֲנִי, but it is better to place it after זָכַר, for then we have a transcriptional explanation for the minus (a jump from the first אֲנִי to the second). Following G here and with it repointing זָכַר in item b relieves the improbable syntax of MT.

2 Ki 9:25d

See BHS d. אַת is probably a corrupt dittography after וְאַתָּה.

2 Ki 9:33b

Waw/nun confusion.

2 Ki 10:13

See Burney (303-304).

2 Ki 11:1

Kt is dittography.

2 Ki 11:2

Qr is transposition, + either dittography or emendation. See BDB.

2 Ki 11:10b

The external support is strong. MT is corrupt haplography from *taw* to final *mem*.

2 Ki 14:6

While Qr could be an assimilation to earlier in the verse or to Dt 24:16, Kt could be transposition or assimilation to Eze 18:4, 20, or Jer 31:30. Since transcriptional error is a distinct possibility, the easier reading (which appears to have the support of G) is preferable.

2 Ki 15:10

קבל עֵם is a difficult case. With only c_2 defecting, G^L probably did reflect יבלעם, but this might be a Hebrew-level emendation (WBC). With WBC, we tentatively take this as an as-yet unknown place name.

{Post-script: But see below re 16:10.}

2 Ki 15:16

Following OG (apart from a dittograph?; at any rate, against its בֶּה, cf. 8:12), and cf. Ges 127i.

2 Ki 16:10

The form דומשק could simply be corrupt dittography, but *daleth* → *waw* dittography, while quite possible, is not abundantly common, the dittograph here comes *after* rather than *before* the true elements, and why so common a name as Damascus would be corrupted in this way is unclear. See HALOT, which (tentatively, it seems) favors reading דמשק here but notes an Aramaic by-form דומשק. We are inclined to agree: The scribe for the exemplar of M-Ki (or this portion thereof, if multiple hands worked on that MS) unconsciously allowed his dialect to intrude (due no doubt to fatigue). All the more when the case of קבל עֵם in 15:10 is considered: As WBC there notes, if this material had come from the hand of the author of Kings the form would have been either קבל העם or קבל עמא; but (*pace* WBC there) an inattentive scribe (more?) at home with Aramaic might have misread an uncommon place name thus.

2 Ki 16:15

Kt is mechanical repetition of the *waw* so that the word has the shape (where W = *waw*; O = some other letter) WOOWOW.

2 Ki 17:27

M (clearly impossible) is a mechanical assimilation to the number in מהכנים.

2 Ki 17:31

While many OG MSS have θεοις, GL has a singular, which, matching the Kt, seems to force acceptance of the same, especially as the Qr is readily explained as taking *both* false deities just mentioned as being of the gods of the place name about to be mentioned, facilitated by the fact that אלהי is obviously vastly more common than אלה. Might אלה be pointed as in Aramaic?? But in keeping with general policy to avoid for the present difficult phonological questions of this nature, we tentatively point as אלה elsewhere.

Meanwhile, and still following G^L , ספרים is near haplography.

2 Ki 18:17

A repetition created by a spotted jump from ירושלם to ירושלם. Cf. Ex 8:13 and the comments there.

2 Ki 20:4

Various explanations are possible, but probably in the square script: *he/chet* confusion + *ayin/tsadde* confusion + addition + insertion of a helping letter. (Less likely, in the paleo script: *chet/ayin* aural confusion + *yodh/tsadde* confusion + addition of the article by emendation. Cf. Talmon 162.)

2 Ki 20:9

M seems very difficult, and is explainable as near haplography in the paleo script. Note that in OG-Kings the interrogative prefix is only inconsistently rendered, so the lack of *ei* or some such here is not particularly problematic.

2 Ki 20:13

Aural error in an unpointed text. See the parallel passage.

2 Ki 21:12

G seems to support Qr: παντος ακουοντας αυτα (object omitted in G^B) is singular, shift in grammatical number of nouns in common in the OG, and on the Hebrew level transcriptionally שמעיו can be derived from שמעה.

2 Ki 23:1

Cf. WBC and 2 Chr 34:29. Corrupt dittography (possibly, but not necessarily, before the consistent introduction of final letters).

2 Ki 23:5

Probably visual error, *lamedh* rather resembling the combination *waw* + *yodh*.

2 Ki 23:10

Kt mechanical assimilation to the previous word.

2 Ki 23:16

M is homoeotelueton or homoeoarchon. The content seems demanded by the narrative flow into v17.

2 Ki 23:31

So G. Cf. 24:18, Jer 52:1, BDB.

2 Ki 23:36

Re Kt-Qr: The OG here is corrupt in a way that obscures the reading here. However, G-2 Chr 36:5 has a long plus, which plus, being in all likelihood a secondary development in the textual history of Chr, derives from this passage of Kings and attests to a reading זכורה. That reading, while attested *beth/kaph* confusion, gives ancient external evidence for the Qr, which is the morphologically more likely form for this era, and from which the Kt could have emerged from *waw/yodh* confusion facilitated by the influence of later morphology. (T also so reads, but quite possibly by adoptions of the Qr, not by transmission of a genuine M reading. V= Kt. I have not checked P.)

2 Ki 25:4

See BHS. MT is mechanical assimilation to the termination of the following word (וילך and דרך are adjacent, have a similar number of letters, and have additional visual and auditory [l/r] similarities).

2 Ki 25:6

Mechanical assimilation to the earlier plural verbs. This explanation is likely given v4 (see above).

2 Ki 25:7

Mechanical assimilation to the ending of the previous word, or to the grammatical number prominent in the previous verse.

Isa 1:18

On כשני see THBS 3: 38, noting also the research notes on Pr 31:21.

Isa 1:12

Not improbably retoverted from several ancient versions, including OG; homeoteluton. (This case was brought to my attention in Himbaza (ed.) *Making the Hebrew Bible*, 25, though the solution offered there is different.

Isa 2:4

This is not *necessarily* a statement regarding the *literary* priority of either the Micah passage or the Isaiah passage. But *textually* a loss of an energetic *nun* in Isaiah is quite possible, while use of its is rather characteristic of him. Cf. the situation in 60:6.

Isa 2:9

Following G (as I suppose) and two Q MSS. Metathesis, possibly prompted by anticipation of the following חשא. That last-mentioned word seems in G to be ששא, either because such is original (cf. the unannounced divine statement in [at least] 13:3; but then we would have to posit first an error in proto-M ['f' → tf'], then a *second* error in proto-MT [wl' → w'l], thus violating Occam's Razor) or because of *aleph-taw* confusion. (For the unannounced prophetic statement in M, cf. [at least] 61:10, 62:1.)

Isa 2:18

Haplography (cf. BHS, THBS 3; Davidson concurs). The (pausal) pointing we have made on the analogy of יחבלו in Job 24:9 (contrast the same word Job 24:3).

Isa 2:20

OG seems to have had a single word in front of them, though they did not know what it meant (unsurprising since it is a *hapax*); 1Qa has a single word but alters the grammatical gender, either via linguistic updating (was the word still used in Israel but not in Egypt in the last couple of centuries before Christ?) or via assimilation to וילעטלפם (so THBS 3: 52; *ibid.* notes that Th's transliteration supports the feminine ending).

Isa 3:16

Re Kt-Qr: We follow the orthography of 1QIs^a. MT is *waw/yodh* confusion, assimilation the following letter, or one facilitated by the other.

Isa 3:24

Following Hilleli.

Isa 5:23

The plural צדיקים most likely is due to corrupt dittography from the first two letters of the following יסירו. Cf. (at least) Ges 145m.

Isa 5:29

Following 1QIsa^a (=Qr); this forms make more sense (a *waw* consecutive perfect is not expected here, while an imperfect prepares for the imperfect + simple *waw* forms to follow later in the verse), and the Kt is easily explained (*waw/yodh* confusion). OG is hard to retovert.

Isa 7:1

Following Q and the versions (except T); cf. ICC (which seems to lean toward M, however), noting 2 Ki 16:5.

Note that the same letter (*lamedh*) both precedes and follows the point of variation, a situation which I have elsewhere seen to have influenced error. Also, *waw* bears some resemblance to *lamedh* in some scripts.

Isa 9:4

So *Metathesis* (25). This assumes that “rolled in blood” refers to illegitimate violence (cf. the references to oppression in the context), not to violence as such.

Isa 10:12

Either an auditory or a visual error. It is true that switching between persons is common, but here the syntax is against it.

Isa 10:15a

Corrupt dittography (of the right half of the *tet*), or else some other misunderstanding. See ICC, and note also that OG seem to understand this as well (possibly misreading תא as אא). This may be a place where MSS A {but verify this} and L do *not* transmit the text of M.

Isa 10:15b

Corrupt dittography. Cf. Ges 124k. Following P V (+pc MSS). As BHS notes, OG might support (so also ICC [492]), though it is hard to be sure, given the nature of the translation.

Isa 10:28

Following OG and noting (by way of intrinsic evidence) M-Neh 11:31; probably *he/taw* confusion, though Talmon (135), noting Q's עיא, puts it under the heading of *aleph/taw* confusion (in the paleo script).

Isa 10:29

See ICC (591). (OG adds a conjunction, but probably at the translational level; cf. in the near context.)

Isa 10:32

Kt is the accidental substitution of a more common for a less common word (though admittedly both are common). The phrase בית ציון occurs nowhere, while בת ציון occurs a number of times, including elsewhere in Isa.

Isa 11:6

See de Waard (55): Ugaritic supports the verb, as well as intrinsic evidence here, Q indirectly supports (see *ibid.*), and transcriptional error readily explains M.

Isa 11:11

Following (not certainly, but likely) OG. See שנה III in HALOT.

Isa 11:15a

See ICC (681-682).

Isa 11:15

See ICC (685), adding that the cause of the error may be that the letters before and after it are quite visually similar in some scripts.

Isa 12:5

See BDB.

Isa 14:25

See BHS “a.” To judge from the witnesses VL Syh etc., and the fact that αὐτῶν could easily have been lost after

ωμων, it seems that OG originally reflected a 3rd plural suffix. If on the other hand OG originally expressed no pronoun, this could have been the work of the translator, and the testimony of P V is sufficient to establish the plural. M can be explained as assimilation to the singular suffix on the last noun (וסבלו), facilitated by the fact that the right side of a final *mem* resembles a *waw*.

Isa 16:4

Following G and Q. MT is corrupt dittography of the following *resh*.

Isa 16:9

We see G (אלון) and Q (ארזיך) as each supporting ארזיך, the indirectly in that *waw* has mutated into *zayin*; the former confused the *resh* with *lamedh*, overlooked *yodh* after *waw*, and confused final *kaph* with final *nun*. Cf. THBS 3: 139.

Isa 17:6

Mechanical assimilation (THBS 3: 142-143).

Isa 17:9

Following the consonants of G but the word order of M, which seems most readily to explain the two texts.

Isa 20:2

Re רגליך: Various MSS (so Kennicott 2:24^a [=PDF loc 32]; Ginsburg 2:757 [=PDF loc 367]) support the *plene* spelling, but other MSS, including M^A, support a defective. The *plene* could be an assimilation to Ex 3:5, which is verbally but not conceptually similar. If the defective is accepted, note that the form could be a defective plural, but if it is singular (cf. the variant on ונעלך), the pointing is pausal.

Isa 21:16

See THBS 3:166. The plus bears some visual resemblance to the word which precedes it, and more still to the word which follows it, so its loss is not too surprising. The *Vorlage* of the OG specifically seems elsewhere to bear some errors characteristic of M(T). 1QIsaa thus is correct with the plus; but it bears, as so often, a secondary feature, viz. the unnecessary (cf., e.g., וחמש שנה in 7:8) substitution of שנים for שנה.

Isa 23:1

See {or cf.}? Talmon 151-52. {I don't remember exactly what Talmon said, but מבית seems not to be represented in OG, and dittographs tend to come before the element they stem from}

Isa 23:2a, b, c

The only way to deal with the difficult verse would seem to be to assume multiple error which, to go off the Q evidence, may not all have happened simultaneously:

-סחרי became סחר either due to the similarity of *yodh* to *resh* in the square script or due to the similarity of *yodh* to *tsadhe* in some paleo scripts (NB the following צידון);

-עברי became עבר, either due to the similarity of *yodh* to *resh* in the square script, to haplography before the another *yodh* (NB the following ים) or due to assimilation to סחר *after* the above error had already occurred;

-מלאכך became מלאוך by a kind of “haplography” (THBS 3: 172; full discussion on pp. 172-173).

Isa 24:19

So THBS (citing various scholars) and HALOT 2:1271a, with Q. Dittography.

Isa 27:13-28:1

While paragraphing matters must remain tentative at this time, we prefer the open section of JC over the closed section of G and the non-inclusion of L. L seems somewhat erratic, not least with the sections this book (but this

assessment is certainly open to revision in the light of further evidence), while G could be an assimilation to the closed nature of the previous few sections, especially as the last couple of them started with והיה which is visually similar to הוי in 28:1.

Isa 30:13

Jenni (3: 62) flags. Assimilation to 29:5. The retroversion is reasonably secure, as comparison of these two verses shows.

Isa 33:1

So, e.g., BDB (and that *before* the Qumran discoveries), THBS 3:226-227, McCarter 48 (M is “unintelligible”).

Isa 33:8

See Tawil and Cherry *s.v.*

Isa 35:1

BHS (sub “a”) does not cite G in support of this reading, but such is not unreasonable given the OG translation style, and the ease with which the error could occur (note the beginning of the following word). Davidson (at least) prefers so to read.

Isa 36:7

Either haplography (jumping from *resh* to final *nun*) or assimilation to the singulars of the previous verse. It is just possible that MT is in fact correct, since either reading makes sense, but the external evidence for the plural is strong, particularly Q's preservation of the energetic *nun*. Cf. also on Num 32:25.

Isa 37:21

M stems either from the (admittedly slight) visual similarity of שמעתי to אשור or from the confusion related to the uncommon usage of אשר earlier in the verse in the sense of “because,” or these two factors in combination. See 1 Ki 19:20 and (here in Isa 37:31) (O)G (albeit in a different position, at least in the Greek version), P (though the latter might be an assimilation).

Isa 38:14a

Substitution of a more common word for a less common one and/or *waw/yodh* confusion. On the intrinsic evidence see HALOT 1: 752^a.

Isa 38:17

See, e.g., Ges 119ff. Aural error dating prior to the development of the soft allophone for *kaph*?

Isa 39:1a

Both JC and Ginsburg (w/ *no* variation noted) have ההיא. Thus, L's ההוא is probably mere *waw/yodh* error.

Isa 39:1b

The Teaching Company course on Mesopotamia disusses at length relationships among contemporary monarchs, and the sickness of one was expected to evoke the concern, tangible expressed through letters and gifts, of the others. Thus the Babylonian emissaries would have been dispatched *before* Hezekiah recovered, though apparently – and such is not surprising given the geographical lengths involved – by the time they arrived he had made his recovery. The earliest extant quotation of this verse (2 Ki 20:12) provides a solution: Visual error (specifically, transposition + loss of a single letter), facilitated by assimilation to 38:21, caused הזקיהו to mutate into ויחי.

Isa 40:15

Another approach is to assume dittography from the following ולבנון and thus to read יטולו. {McKenzie does not comment.}

Isa 40:26

Corrupt dittography in the paleo script (*tsadhe* → *tsadhe* + *yodh*), facilitated by the rarity of the noun אִמָּץ. {McKenzie does not comment.}

Isa 41:29

See THBS 3, NET. Intrinsic evidence supports אִין, for which אִין could easily be a transcriptional error, with the caveat that אִין can, including in Isaiah, signify “idol” (see BDB sub אִין). But is such the meaning *here*? The parallels suggest not; and in the present verse the referents of the suffixes on מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם and נִסְכֵּיהֶם make it difficult to find coherence in this verse if “idols” is read here (idols don't make themselves).

Isa 43:14

It is difficult to wrest sense from וְכַשְׂדִּים בְּאִנְיֹת רִנָּתָם. Here are two attempts that seem plausible to me:

1) “Also [or “even”; so (at least) ESV] the Chaldeans, whose shout [i.e., pride] is in their ships.”

2) “And as for the Chaldeans, in [or *beth* of essence?] mourning shall their shout be [made].”

Both seem somewhat strained. The first seems odd in that the Babylonians are not thought of as a naval empire, though *Warfare in the Old Testament* cites an example of the Babylonians conquering an island. The second option repoints בְּאִנְיֹת. It also seems strained, though it would be less so if לְאִנְיֹת was read (but there seems to be no external support for such).

Another approach, reading וְכַשְׂדִּים בְּאִנְיֹת רִתְקוּ:

3) “And as for [or “and” or “even”] the Chaldeans[s], with mourning shall they be ensnared.”

This approach, like option (2) above, repoints בְּאִנְיֹת, and with OG (cf. Muraoka 27^a sub I δεω) reads רִתְקוּ (cf. Nah 3:10). This could provide a tight parallelism with בְּרִיחֵיהֶם (understood, as is all but certain in this context, as “fugitives”); alternatively, it could be a looser, or even antithetical parallelism, with the previous clause if the Chaldeans are *not* here synonymous with the Babylonians, but are rather the ruling elite of Babylon whose fate will not be ignominious flight (בְּרִיחֵיהֶם) but rather capture (רִתְקוּ). This seems, though not absolutely definitively, the best option.

{Post-script: This is a matter to revisit, inasmuch as the Chaldeans may have hailed from the south, where in ancient times people lived in reed houses and fishing was a major enterprise. Still, MT does feel strange, and presently I am still inclined to see it as an error. McKenzie (55) follows G.}

Isa 44:4

Following 1QIsa^a and G; the meaning is “spring up like a green *ben*-tree” (Allegro, ZAW 63 (1951), 154-156, quoted in THBS 3:310) (or, “they shall sprout like a green tamarisk,” Paul *Isaiah* 60-66, 227, quoted in *ibid.*).

Isaiah 45:24

Metathesis יבוא becoming יבוא our preferred approach; 1QIsa^a (not a strong witness, especially in matter of spelling), has יבוא, and the MT reading could be due to haplography.

Isa 46:12

See, e.g., HALOT 1:2b. (WBC cites a verse from Ps, but the meaning there is different, and might indeed have influenced M here.)

Isa 47:13a

Following 1QIsa^a and possibly some versional support. See DCH 3:155^a (and Ulrich, who marks MT as possible as *lapsus calami*). *He/chet* error.

Isa 47:13b

Following 1QIsa^a and some of the versions. Metathesis.

Isa 48:10

Note that this reading eliminates from putative Deutero-Isaiah a possible Aramaism (cf. BDB sub בחר). (Note that G might contain an error in the opposite direction in Job 9:14.) {McKenzie (94) so reads as well.}

Isa 48:11

=“For how shall I [=God] be profaned?” This is surely the correct reading (perhaps the error’s source is aleph/yodh confusion in a paleo script, possibly influenced by the preceding kaph+yodh sequence). It is even possible that such is the original M reading (V P T^{MS} 1QIsa^a 4QIsa^c 4QIsa^d), but it is hard to be sure. At any rate, even Barthélemy (2:354-55, quoted in THBS 3:338) departs from MT here, as does McKenzie (94).

Jer 48:18b

Following HALOT (2:992a). (For the retroversion, note that γγασα twice translates מים in contexts where the translator of Ezekiel thought that that Hebrew word bore a meaning which the translator of Jeremiah (indeed, the same person?) saw here.) Visual error, facilitated by the rarity of the word צאה. {McKenzie does not comment.}

Isa 49:5

The lines לא יאסף וישראל difficult. MT hardly seems intelligible {but have yet to survey commentaries as of this writing}. There is significant external evidence for לו, and this makes the line intelligible and affords a parallel to אלי in the previous line; this is probably the best option.

Another option is to point לא as an asseverative.

Still another option is to read אָאָסֶף with P, but *aleph* → *yodh* here does not seem polygenetic enough to have occurred in both the M and G lines, especially as this confusion would have occurred *between two alephs* if the original was לא אָאָסֶף. This is probably an emendation/paraphrase on the part of P. (BHS says the Arabic is similar {will BHQ address this point?}.)

{McKenize (103) follows G.}

Isa 54:11

Cf. Ex 28:18 = 39:11 on both the OG retroversion and the pairing of ספיר and נפק. *Waw/nun* confusion + metathesis, facilitated by the rarity of the terms involved (and perhaps the superficial sensibility of the M(T) reading).

Isa 52:5a

So (Qr) M^A w/o Kt-Qr.

Isa 56:5

So BHS plausibly suggests. (Q is a linguistic levelling.) Overlooking of a single letter, facilitating by the extreme commonness of לו, and possibly facilitated also by the influence of (the sound and number of letters of) the upcoming לא. {So also McKenzie (149).}

Isa 60:6

We take MT to be an inner-M error (either leveling to the more common / less archaic grammatical form, or near haplography after *waw*); 1QIsa^b is a strong M witness. Cf. further THBS 3: 92.

Isa 60:19

M(T) is haplography (from *chet* to *he*). The plus is well attested, and improves the meter (providing a metrical counterpoint to the previous line; cf. WBC). {McKenzie (175) also so reads.}

Isa 62:3

Re Kt-Qr, see HALOT. Kt is waw/yodh confusion.

Isa 62:5

Another possible reading is כִּי כְּבֶעַל (cf. 1QIsa^a), but we tentatively follow OG (which adds a conjunction at the level of the translation, in our assessment) in the light of similar cases elsewhere in Isaiah; Q could easily have added כִּי־ on its own (as a stylistic “improvement” or via dittography). {McKenzie does not comment.}

Isa 63:11a

Corrupt dittography. Once the dittograph came into being, various attempts to emend its nonsensical nature came about. {Old note: Regarding מִשָּׁה עָמָר: This is an example of a harder reading being preferable, inasmuch as the variants appear to be facilitating. Also, Isaiah, it seems to me, is elsewhere rather bold at times in his rhetorical forms.

NICOT reads for עָמָר the (as he says) V reading וְעָמָר. But BSV does not accept the *et* reading, which seems to have very weak external support and has every appearance of being an inner-Latin facilitating reading. (And even in the unlikely event that V *did* read *Mosi et*, such would still be quite suspect grounds for reading וְעָמָר.)

{McKenize (188) reads עָבָדוּ, and also follows 1QIsaa with regard to הַמַּעֲלָם.}}

Isa 63:11b

Based on the external evidence, probably an inner-M error.

Isa 65:4

See NET, HALOT 2:974^b.

Isa 66:19

Intrinsic evidence much supports. On the retroversion, cf. BDB. Substitution of a single letter. In certain square scripts, the right half of a *tet* looks rather like a *lamedh*, and the following *waw*, if the word division was minimal in size, might have (at least to a fatigued, hurried, or otherwise inattentive scribe) caused the left half of the *tet* to be lost to sight.

Introduction to Jeremiah

The differences between M and G in Jeremiah are substantial. This fact alone does not make Jeremiah unique among the books of the OT, but the relationship between M and G here is virtually the inverse of that which obtains elsewhere. We take the position that G, though of course evidencing occasional scribal errors of its own, is the better text of the two.

The M text of Jeremiah has its defenders. THB, taking chapter 52 as a test case, argues for M over G. Essentially four lines of evidence are adduced. First, the G text of Jeremiah in that chapter differs sharply from the parallel passages in Kings and Chronicles; “[t]his isolation indicates deliberate changes on the part of LXX-Jer” (1B: 546^{a-b}). Second, “the differences between the LXX and MT versions of this chapter suggest a shortened text and abbreviation tendencies with respect to content, similar to what can be observed in the rest of the book of Jeremiah” (ibid, 546^b). Third, “[t]he quotations of Deut 5:33 in Jer 7:23; Isa 15:5 in Jer 48(31):5; Hab 2:13 in Jer 51(28):58; and other similar cases show that MT-Jer often represents the presumed original text more faithfully than LXX-Jer” (ibid, 547^a). Fourth, the differences from M found in the LXX (the translation and not the *Vorlage* being largely in view here) include “rearrangement of the book and... its adaption to the needs of the new Greek-speaking Jewish environments in Egypt centuries later” (ibid); examples of such “adaption” include the partial suppression of “Johanan the son of Kareah and even King Nebuchadnezzar... [who] had virtually no relevance to its audience” (ibid n³³).

We are not convinced. As to the first point, it is at least as likely that some scribes would attempt to harmonize Jeremiah with Kings and Chronicles as it is that some scribe would revise Jeremiah heavily. As to the second point, Janzen (91-92) shows that the abridgment theory is difficult to sustain, in that the tradent behind

the often LXX keeps “the large doublets... both times” (see this whole chapter in Janzen; note also that if one assumes the priority of Ezra-Nehemiah, 1 Esdras did *not* twice transmit the apparent doublet Ezra 2 = Nehemiah 7). The situation in Jeremiah is unlike that in Job: In the latter book, “interweaving” {cite from THB} is evident (something characteristic of apparently secondary G readings elsewhere and of many M reading in Jeremiah) {the same also true for 1 Esdras?}, the material deleted tends to be that which is obscure ({cite THB}), and generally increases as the book progresses ({cite from THB table}). As to the third point, it is not clear how much weight the cited examples can bear. M in Jer 7:23 is probably an assimilation to common usage, the variation units in question in 48:5 and 51:58 reflect sorts of graphic confusion so common as to say little about recensional questions outside of themselves, and the biblical writers are in any case not picayune about the verbiage of their sources. The fourth point is the strongest, yet neither Johanan and Nebuchadnezzar nor are eliminated altogether in the LXX, nor does the LXX conclusively provide any applications, midrashic or otherwise, specific to a later, Egyptian community. Note as well that we suppose, on the basis of orthography (see 8:10-12 in L and observe הַזֹּאתָ in 26:6), that the interpolations of M have a very early origin, such that material concerning Johanan might have been particularly relevant at the time of the recension, if not simply reflective of a certain, now-defunct phase of editorial activity.

Some argue that the Baruch bullae gives intrinsic support to the MT. {explicate this} Yet Baruch's trade could easily be an inference, and furthermore this bullae seems not to be genuine (see Rollston, C. A., *Non-Provenanced Epigraphs I: Pillaged Antiquities, Northwest Semitic Forgeries and Protocols for Laboratory Tests*. *Maarav* 10: 135-93, 2003, and *ibid.*, *Navigating the Epigraphic Storm: A Palaeographer Reflects on Inscriptions from the Market*. *Near Eastern Antiquities*, 68: 69-72, 2005, both cited in Rollston, Christopher A., *Writing and Literacy in the World of Ancient Israel: Epigraphic Evidence from the Iron Age*, 2010, Society of Biblical Literature, Atlanta, GA, 137).

In our judgment, it must be concluded that, apart from a few places where transcriptional error led to a shorter reading in G, the long readings in M are interpolations, very often drawn from similar passages elsewhere (see Janzen *passim*). Then there is the parallel to the Samaritan expansions (which expansions might well have been inherited, not unique to the Samaritan community) and G expansions in the Pentateuch and to 1 Esdras (see BHQ to Ezra-Nehemiah, *10-11; the points of contact are at least large expansions and many doublets). {Intrinsically, spelling of Nebuchadnezzar and various phrases broken up – see Janzen.} Apparently when the OT canon which would become the archetype for the Massoretic text was assembled, the MS for Jeremiah that happened to be selected was of a different (indeed, inverse) textual cast than that of most or all other elements of the collection.

NICOT (119-20) and NAC (16:31) take something of a middle position, and propose that one examine each variation unit on its own merits. We agree that neither M nor G is perfect and that every discrepancy between M and G deserves attention (though the life of man is short), but also see in the cumulative evidence of a range of variation units good reason to stake out an overall approach to the book. de Waard {} declines to arbitrate between large-scale M and G divergences, taking them as differing literary traditions not susceptible to direct comparison. Yet whatever the literary qualities of the M and of the G text as such, and however helpful understanding these qualities might be for studying the reception histories of these forms of the text, our goal here is precisely to arbitrate large-scale differences between these texts in order to construct an informed proposal as to what Jeremiah himself, under the guidance of the Holy Spirit, intended. This approach is to adopt G, where it clearly differs from M, unless there is compelling reason to do otherwise. In view of this overall approach and in keeping with the general brevity of the present volume, many comments will simply label something in M a probable interpolation.

One set of related variants remains to be noted. In G the oracles against the nations are placed not, as in M, near the end of the book, but rather after 25:13, and the sequence in G is different. Most likely, either M is correct as to both position and sequence, or G is correct as to both; it would be peculiar if one source was content with the position but took the trouble to reorder the oracle, while the other moved a large section but left the sequence untouched. It is often remarked that the sequence in M largely mirrors that of 25:19-26. The same is not true of G, making the reading of G the one which better explains its rival. As to position, 25:18 puts the southern kingdom down as the first item in the list that runs to v26. If 26:1-45:5 was interpreted as fulfilling

25:18, then the material concerning the gentiles could be considered better placed on the other side of the Judah-related material. Thus, we adopt the sequence of the book found in G. In the interest of convenient reference, however, we have arranged our comments on variation units in the book in numerical order.

11/3/18 update: Cf. the comments on “Tabernacle Account” in Research Notes, and also the further reflections at the end of the comments on Jdg 6:7-10 above (in the current file).

11/27/18 update of a slightly different nature: Lundbom, though accepting the LXX sequence, thinks haplography caused great damage to the exemplar (almost 8% of the words being lost in this manner). That explanation does not square with the many short readings *not* explainable by haplography, and as Tov points out, the variants in the book should (largely) be taken together. Yet Tov elsewhere notes Jer as having a large number of transcriptional errors, and there does seem to be some warrant for this: See, for instance, the research notes on 32:8. If the *Vorlage* from the LXX translator worked had a large number of transcriptional errors, four things should be borne in mind: (1) Not everything that appears to be a transcriptional error need be understood so; (2) transcriptional error might afflict a good line of transmission; (3) as already noted, the variants should in general hang together in this case; (4) if the MS was physically damaged, the principal of least effort suggests that there must have been a compelling reason for a translator to work from such a MS; perhaps it was chosen for its antiquity {this last argument, though, seems a little desperate!}

7/16/18 note: Janzen () points out {the spelling of Nebuchadnezzar.} Yet Jeremiah's own name is variously spelled variously in several verses (chapter 28 *passim*, 29:1) where G also has his name. It is possible that the shared efforts of Jeremiah and Baruch led to such differences, or that one or both felt free to vary their spelling, but in any case, one cannot, apart from complex and speculative theories of redaction, make the book entirely uniform with respect to orthographic convention.

{Other Notes}

The formula infinitive absolute + *waw* consecutive is distinctive of Jeremiah's style, and apparently all examples of this construction are present G.² If many of them were absent, this circumstance would be difficult to account for, but as it is G on this point seems reliable.

Similarly, all the certain occurrences of *athbash* in M (25:26, 51:1, v41) are preserved in G.³

Jan Joosten traces the gradual disappearance of the iterative use of the *waw* consecutive perfect⁴ and notes several possible or certain examples of this construction in Jeremiah (viz. 6:17, 18:4, 20:9, 23:14, 24:4).⁵ None of these instances seem to be affected.⁶

{re spelling of Nenchadnezzar} “Generally LXX-Jer tries to render exactly its Hebrew *Vorlage*” (THB 1B: 547b), but it does sometimes attempt “to make the text more easily understood by adopting more common language” (ibid, 548a) and uses the term *ψευδοπροφήτης* (ibid, 550b). The spelling with *-rho-* apparently occurs nowhere in the LXX. Most likely, then, the *Vorlage* from which the LXX worked had a *resh* in the relevant places.

{authorship of LXX-Jer} Tony S. L. Michael (BIOSCS 39) makes points out major difficulties in theories of multiple authorship or of recensional activity affecting only part of the book. Since single authorship for any given book of the Bible is safe to assume barring evidence to the contrary, we tentatively hold the author of LXX-Jer to be one in number.

Along similar lines, THB notes an opinion (Tov? Others?) that the translator for LXX-Jer also produced LXX-Eze. Pending investigation into similar styles (though this may be hard to prove or disprove, due to the lack of consistency within LXX-Jer), this seems a most reasonable claim, for if one were inclined and able to

² Compare Fassberg, Steven E., “Sequences of Positive Commands, 57 n21 in: ibid and Avi Hurvitz, ed., *Biblical Hebrew in its Northwest Semitic Setting: Typological and Historical Perspectives*, Eisenbrauns, Winona Lake, Indiana, 2006.

³ For an uncertain example, see the comments on 25:25.

⁴ “Disappearance of Iterative WEQATAL,” 135-47 in: Fassberg and Hurvitz.

⁵ Ibid, 146.

⁶ A textual tradition boasting more instances of this construction than another textual tradition boasts would have some claim on being prior, although it must be borne in mind that the presence of the construction in a textual tradition could simply be a conservative approach to the transmission of an ancient text.

translate one (lengthy) book of the OT, it would seem that one would fill the need with respect to other books of the OT. Add to this that Ezekiel and Baruch are near in the canon, similar in style, and/or related in content to Jer, and the case seems significant. If so, similar *Vorlagen* and translation styles would be in play for Eze.

{Internal arguments for M-Jer} (1) The phrase ברזל ולעמוד ברזל seems to have good intrinsic support (see “An Apparently Redundant Reading in the Masoretic Text (Jer 1:18),” 323-327 in: Talmon), yet is missing in G (Janzen, 119, suggests haplography in the MS used by the OG translator, but haplography seems unlikely here). (2) The omissions of לוֹא by G in 2:25, 5:10, and 15:7 are suspicious when within the OT corpus this spelling is peculiarly Jeremian (in L: 17x elsewhere in Jeremiah; 1x in Lamentations; but only 18x in the rest of the OT, two of these in Ezekiel); similar is the omission of הַזֹּאת in 26:6 (if this omission is not inner-Greek haplography, viz. ταυτην lost after πολλιν; {Zeigler} lists {no? Little} support for such a minus, however), a former spelling is unattested anywhere else, even at Qumran where forms like אַתְּמָה and הוֹאֵה are regularly encountered. It could be corrupt dittography (note the visual similarity of *taw* to *he*), but it does tend to reinforce the impression that forms distinctive of Jeremiah have been obscured by the G text. (3) In Jeremiah 46:17 G has (if an assimilation, secondary to G tradition, to verse 2 is not hypothesized) the personal name נְכוֹ after פִּרְעָה, whereas the pharaoh in question is probably Apries or Amasis (ed. John Boardman et al., *The Cambridge Ancient History Volume III Part 2: The Assyrian and Babylonian Empires and other States of the Near East, from the Eighth to the Sixth Centuries B.C.*, 2nd ed., Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 1991, ISBN 0 521 227178 p. 719; cf. also {WBC}). [The preceding occurs in the current (11/12/19) draft of the general introduction.] The omission of חֶרֶן by G in 4:8 seems to run counter to the rhythm of the passage (see {Althann, 51, 54}) and can be explained as a small-scale avoidance of repetition for stylistic reasons (cf. {}); on the non-avoidance of large-scale repetition in G-Jeremiah, see {Janzen}).

Re Althann's Book: This book has many valuable insights and is an important voice in the discussion, granting (1) sometimes his specific proposals seem a stretch (rather like Tsumura's in Sam), and (2) his metrical counting (a) does not fully account for diachronic considerations and (b) has enough irregularities that one can conclude that his system, while close to the truth, cannot be relied upon altogether.

For what it's worth, G *does* contain 10:11.

{In favor of M, note this argument: “The precision of this text [viz., M] is further confirmed by the handling of the Ketiv-passages in MT-Jer. There are approximately 50 relevant instances; in 36 cases LXX-Jer sides with the Qere-readings. This indicates that already LXX-Jer - in the 2nd century BC - knew the Qere-tradition and gave priority to them, whereas in MT-Jer the Ketiv-readings have been maintained and exactly preserved in the main text, against the alternative or suggested Qere-readings” (Georg Fischer, *Jeremiah Studies: From Texts and Contexts to Theology*, 56, *Forschungen zum Alten Testament* 139, Mohr Siebeck Tübingen 2020 ISBN 978-3-16-158918-8).

Jeremiah Timeline

- c. 580 BC composition
- c. 250 BC OG translated
- c. 200 BC DDS written
- c. 167 Maccabean Revolt
- 67 AD First Jewish Revolt
- 132 AD Second Jewish Revolt
- 600 AD Early Massoretic Text

The symbols <> enclose comments written from a G-priority standpoint. (Note: At least for the most part, I did *not* evaluate S-type reading from a G-priority standpoint past 43:11.)

<Jer 1:10

The long reading is most likely an addition based on similar passages in the book. See further Janzen, 35.>

<Jer 1:11

The long reading is an attempt to clarify the people involved, an addition typical of G elsewhere in the OT but of M in this book.>

<Jer 1:15

It is difficult to say whether משפחות comes from 25:9 or whether M in Jeremiah likes to juxtapose synonyms or otherwise related terms for some reason (Janzen, 10, think that it is a conflation of two variant readings in 1:15, but this solution is conjectural), but given the general character of M in this book (see just above) and the similarity of this reading to still more suspicious readings of M elsewhere, the word is most likely secondary. See also the comments on 2:17 below.>

<Jer 1:18

The long reading fills out the text from elsewhere in the book. The short reading could in theory be due to homoeotetuton, but M seems so clearly to add material elsewhere in this book that the long reading is almost certain to be an interpolation.>

<Jer 2:2

There is no clear transcriptional reason for G to drop בארץ לא זרועה; probably these words were added by M to clarify when / where this following occurred. Given the rendering by the LXX of קדש ישראל ליהוה in v3 by τῷ ἁγίῳ Ἰσραὴλ λέγει κύριος ἅγιος Ἰσραὴλ τῷ κυρίῳ, one might suppose fatigue to have afflicted the G scribe. Yet it does unusual that a tired scribe both drop many words and add in others at the same time, especially when the additions, like the omission, lack a readily explainable cause. A better explanation might be as follows. The LXX translator apparently, unsatisfied with a first attempt or resuming work after a break, translate a word or short phrase twice, and any cancellation marks he left were overlooked by a later tradent (for data, see Janzen, 26). In this case, the translator, not having בארץ לא זרועה in his text, initially understood אחר as אחר and connected it with קדש ישראל, then (and here fatigue might have been a factor), he habitually added λέγει κύριος. At this point he observed his error (λέγει κύριος did not belong there) and started over again at the start of v3. This scenario, while speculative, takes into account the habits of various tradents (expansions in M, a generally reliable G text, and careful work with occasional double translations in the LXX).>

Jer 2:12

Quite possibly M is a transcriptional error, two of the four letters being the same in הרבה and הרבו and one (in the square script) very similar. The difficulty is in accounting for *waw* in place of *he*, especially as the consonant sequence (pointing aside) הרבו occurs only 24x in the OT. The sequence הרבה itself occurs only 57x, however. The only time Jeremiah elsewhere uses הרבה, he follows it up with מאד, which could be intrinsic evidence in favor of G. Tentatively, we favor that reading. HALOT does call M into question.

Jer 2:17

Corrupt dittography of v18a. So even WBC.

Jer 2:20b

Re Kt-Qr: On the existence of the Qr, see NET.

On the orthography, Ginsburg (2: 825 [PDF 435]) cites no support for the defective spelling, JC (=MM) has the *plene*, and Kennicott (2: 91 [PDF 98]) shows a quite divided MS tradition. Tentatively, we take the cumulative effect of JC, of the testimony of Ginsburg, and of the possibility of haplography in this instance as supporting the *plene* spelling.

<Jer 2:25

G could be an oversight, simplification of a complex verse, or an assimilation to 18:12. On the other hand, M

could be an addition intended to clarify the sense of נואש. The spelling לוא is common in Jeremiah but very rare elsewhere (Gen 1x; Lev 1x; Sam 1x; Kings 3x; Is 1x; Jer 16x; Lam 1x). This fact could be taken as intrinsic evidence in favor of M, yet לוא is so often repeated in Jeremiah that it cannot have failed to lodge itself in the mind of many a scribe. Moreover, the plene spelling would become common later (Qumran). A decision is difficult, but external evidence favors the short reading.>

Jer 2:26

M is most likely an unconscious assimilation to a more common expression aided by the visual and auditory similarities.

<Jer 2:29

G has a long reading here. Metrical considerations might favor the short reading, and it could be due to dittography. On the other hand, M could be due to haplography. The case is quite uncertain.>

<Jer 2:30

M is due to near haplography from the preceding *aleph*.>

Jer 3:1

Corrupt dittography.

Jer 3:20

Near haplography. Cf. J-M (147e iirc).

Jer 3:30

M is due to corrupt dittography of the following *nun* in the paleo script or of the preceding *taw* in the square script.

<Jer 4:12

M appears to be a corrupt dittography.>

<Jer 4:23

It is difficult to be certain that the Greek does not, in fact, translate both terms, but it probably translates only the first (contra Janzen 123, who supposes only the second). G could be due to homoeoteleuton. On the other hand, M could be an assimilation to Gen 1:2. (While תהו occurs a number of times without בהו, the latter term never occurs without the first.) The parallelism favors G, as does external evidence.>

Jer 4:29

Althann prefers a proposal to retain MT צרה, but the evidence for *צרה seems strong, and *he/chet* confusion plus the increasing rarity of the latter term makes alteration of MT preferable, though a marginal reading would probably be merited.

<Jer 5:15

See Janzen, 97. Yet he assumes for the LXX (1) haplography (but note the conjunction) of (2) a transposed phrase based (3) on a fairly large-scale assimilation to Dt 28:49. An alternative scheme: G is an assimilation of חרע only (→ תשמע) to Dt 28:49 (or a mere error of sight, since the two forms are graphically similar), while M is an expansive gloss.>

<Jer 5:19

Janzen notes that the extra letters in M are “from 16.11, 19.4, 22.9; cf. 1.16. The intrusive clause spoils the balance and thrust of the prophetic word” (36).>

Admittedly פקר as behind OG is difficult to establish, it being a rare word, but Althann overstates in our opinion (cf. further “Re Althann's book” above). Muraoka shows ω for הוי is firm, and to this Hebrew word הויא, a very common word, is visually similar. The article on עיר, meanwhile, could be a corrupt dittograph of *yodh* (if so, this took place presumably at an earlier stage than the preceding) or, more likely, a mechanical anticipation of that on the following word. (This retroversion of the OG is sometimes objected to, but (1) by definition it is hard to assess how the OG would handle a *hapax legomenon*, since we cannot compare translators' work in other passages, and (2) the presence of the word פקר in Mishnaic Hebrew suggests that it was known to the OG translator – its is not as though this *hapax* is known only through Ugaritic or some other very ancient source.)

So G (which OG wrongly vocalized in his mind בְּנִפְלֵם).

For the orthography $\Psi\aleph$, note OG $\omega\varsigma\pi\upsilon$. (The defective spelling of $\Psi\aleph$ appears to occur nowhere else [the text, in our view, is *not* sound in 2 Sam 14:19, Mic 6:10], but this is no barrier, given the occasional variant spellings of other common words elsewhere.)

G could be an assimilation to common usage in the book, but given that it handles the same phrase in M differently in the very next verse and the general tendency of M to add, the short reading seems preferable here.>

Compare the comments on 7:10.>

It can be readily seen how the words **השכם ודבר** could be added on the analogy of other passages in Jeremiah. As Janzen points out, this phrase is never followed by **ולא עניתם**.>

M is probably an unconscious assimilation to the phraseology found elsewhere (cf. Dt 1:31, 5:33, Josh 2:22, 24:17, 2 Ki 21:21).>

M has conflated two idioms (so Janzen, 37), one seen in such passages as 2 Chr 30:8 and one seen in such passages as Jer 16:12.>

Janzen (38) makes a strong case for the G reading in noting (1) that homoeoteteluton does not account for the short reading in that “καὶ ἐπεὶ presupposes ואמר,” the second, rather than the first, verb of speaking in M; (2) that the language of the long reading elsewhere (Isa 65:12, 66:4, Jer 7:13) “always constitutes a protasis introduced by יֵעָן, the apodosis of which expresses a judgment meted out by” God; (3) that “the parallel passage 17.23... would seem to suggest that 7.28 follows verse 26 better than verse 27”; and (4) that “את כל הדברים האלה would be a natural assimilation of את הדבר הזה for a scribe working in this particular book.”²

It is possible that Kt is correct, for a *waw* can follow a time indicator such as this. But Jeremiah seems not to do so with *היה בעת ההמה* or *בימים ההמה*, and metathesis is a ready explanation.

Jer 8:3

Vertical dittography (OTL 100).

Jer 9:13-14

Here JC is in the minority (over against L=Ginsburg), but the latter could easily be an assimilation to the rapid succession of closed sections seen recently.

<Jer 9:18

See 31:15 on the intrinsic evidence. M is a transcriptional error {specify: in which script?}.>

<Jer 10:3

As Janzen (38) points out, M has probably assimilated the text to Dt 27:15.>

<Jer 10:13

M is probably an adjustment to what is expected after מטר. G could be an assimilation to Job 28:11 (where the sense is different), but this possibility seems remote. Also remote is the possibility that the LXX φως is a Christian corruption to avoid making the Holy Spirit a created being (there is only Hexaplaric support for ανεμους). Given the reliability of the LXX in this book, it seems safest to stick with it.

Note that the same variation occurs in 51:16.

{Post-script: 51:16 and Ps 135:7 are the key cross-references. The former shows the same variation concerning רוח, and shows that either deliberate change has taken place twice or that one passage has been assimilated to the other after either deliberate change or a transcriptional error. The latter either provides the basis for an assimilation in M or provides intrinsic evidence for M. A transcriptional explanation for G is aural error (weakend *chet* → *aleph*) + transposition. Given this explanation, M might be preferable, especially since Ps 135:7 מוצא is *not* assimilated in *either* Jer passage. Ultimately, external evidence is probably the way to go.}>

<Jer 10:16

The word שבט in M likely comes from Isa 63:17 and Ps 74:2, while the word ישראל is likely inspired by Ps 78:71 (cf. Janzen, 39). The word שבט similarly appears in M and not in G in Jer 51:19; accidental omission might explain one verse, but not likely both. Perhaps the word is original to one verse and was imported by M into the other, but given the character of M, the lack of a clear transcriptional reason for accidental omission in G, and the parallels already noted, deliberate insertion in both cases seems to be the most likely scenario. Interestingly, G has in Dt 32:9 inserted ישראל, a circumstance which suggests, as we have noted in the introduction to this book, that the so-called M text of Jeremiah is really the G text, and *vice versa*.>

Jer 10:20

Following HALOT (1:426a).

<Jer 11:2

This variant is difficult on several levels. On the external evidence see de Waard (51) supplemented by BHS. It is difficult to be sure, but G probably did not have a *mem* at the end, for (a) it translates a singular, (b) does not have an accusative pronoun, and (c) the Syriac seems also not to have read a final *mem*. If de Waard (ib.) is correct that the *qamats* is the authentic MT vocalization, such is remarkable and likely points as well to a reading known to be important to the early Massoretes lacking a *mem*. Intrinsically, the plural would seem to comport better with שמעו at the start of the verse, but it could also easily be an assimilation to the same, and accidental loss of the *mem*, while not impossible, does not seem especially likely. “If [the singular is accepted], Hitzig’s interpretation should be followed, according to which the attention of the general audience is seized first, and then the prophet is addressed” (de Waard 52).>

<Jer 11:13

The long reading seems to be a polemic gloss on *מזבחות לקטר לבעל* (note the frequent association of *בעל* and *בשת* in Jewish tradition elsewhere).>

{Post-script: Even on M-priority (to which I have moved since writing the initial comment), this would appear to be a doublet (cf. *Concordia-2 Sam* p. 29n⁷). It is just possible that Jeremiah is expressing his outrage at the practice, but the repetition of “altars” and the positioning of it is rather characteristic of a doublet.}

{Post-post-script: But note *לקטר*, not a dittograph, and see the important arguments in OTL (135).}

Jer 11:14

Auditory error: See Tov, *Text-critical Use* (153).

<Jer 11:15

Our tentative approach to this difficult verse (drawing especially from de Waard, 54-57, and Workman, 306):

-LXX lightly paraphrases with respect to the first five words

-M's *המזמחה* commences with dittography from the preceding word

-M's *הרבים* is a corruption of *הנדרים*, which is not too distant graphically and makes sense in the context. The putative OL reading (*adipes* “fat portions”) could be based on the same *Vorlage* reflected in the extant Greek-language MSS, making for a tighter parallelism with *בשר* following.

-M's *כי* is a transposed dittography.

-M's *אז תעלזי* derives from G's *זאת תעוּזי* (note Ex 9:19 as a parallel for this verb as taking an accusative) by (a) transposition, (b) haplography, and (c) replacement of a single letter by another (perhaps mitigated by the fact that *עלז* is more common than *עוז*). (Workman retroverts OG differently, but Muraoka, 30, agrees with NICOT on this point.)

This approach supposes a very fatigued scribe or a badly damaged exemplar behind M, but such a scenario is far from impossible. >

<Jer 11:21

See the first NET footnote to this verse. This is thus a good example of G being a harder, but ultimately better, reading, where transcriptional factors do not explain the harder reading.>

{In actuality, *yodh/kaph* confusion in the paleo script probably explains the G reading.}

<Jer 12:4a

de Waard (60) argues that the fact that 4QJer^a has *יהוה* after *יראה* while G apparently had *אלהים* points to two different attempts to make the subject explicit and thus confirms M. Yet it is also possible that *יהוה* is an assimilation to common usage (*אלהים* occurs 145x in M-Jer [2602x in M-OT]; *יהוה* occurs 726x in M-Jer, [6828x in M-OT]). M, meanwhile, could be due to near homoeoteleuton in a square script, or simply loss of a single word (if not emendation to avoid ascribing inability to God).>

<Jer 12:4b

The noun at the end of the verse de Waard (60) regards as metathesis plus graphic confusion, but the same explanation could be applied to M relative to G. The verb *ראה* and the noun *אחרית* co-occur in Dt 32:20, affords a potential parallel to M. The noun *ארה* does not co-occur with *ראה* (aside from Jdg 19:17, where the sense is not relevant), but *דרך* does in some notable cases (Job 31:4 [cf. 34:21], Pr 6:6, Isa 57:18, Eze 14:22, v23).

Either reading seems plausible, so preference should be given to the stronger witness.>

{Post-script: Given Dt 32:20 and the current re-evaluation of M as the better witness, it seems best to retain M here. In favor of M is Kalimi, 72n⁴³, who cites another source for more details.}

<Jer 12:13a-c

M is either due to transcriptional error or to targumic clarification (what was their glory? Their crops. What was the reproach to their arrogant accumulation? God's wrath). Note *תהלה* is fairly rare in the sense required here (and so unlikely due to a later scribe) and that of the limited uses of this word in this way, several occur in Jer (13:11,

17:14, 33:9, 48:2 [but see comments on that v], 51:41), making it somewhat characteristic of him.>

Jer 13:13a

Jer collocates יהודה and ירושלים, and the matter could so easily have fallen out accidentally, that the longer reading seems preferable.

<Jer 13:20

We hypothesize the following: The Kt forms שאי and ראי are original, the Qr forms שאו and ראו being inner-massoretic attempts to correct an impossible situation generated by an earlier error, viz. עיניכם for an original עיניך. The error possibly sprung due to the plural forms in v18, or, more likely, due to corrupt dittography in the paleo script. Once this error was made, ירושלם dropped either due to homoeoteleuton or due to emendation (since the word was no longer suitable). Alternatively, ירושלם dropped before the corruption of עיניך due to near-homoeoteleuton or simple error.

The character of G offers no good reason to believe ירושלם falsely to have been inserted, and the above scenario supplies a plausible history of the text from the supposition that G is original here.>

<Jer 14:3

The situation here is much like that of 2:17. Here, however, there is a complication in that the M insertion in v4 (see the comments on v4b below) seems to presuppose the long reading here. Moreover, homoeoteleuton might explain the short reading. There might be multiple stages of corruption behind M as we have it, however (see the comments on 25:25, for instance), and expansions based (in part at least) on nearby material are liable to produce an appearance of homoeoteleuton. {Drop long reading even from margin?}>

<Jer 14:4a

M seems to have an interpolation here. The support of the Syriac for the short reading might suggest that the long reading entered M at a later stage than many other M interpolations did.>

<Jer 14:4b

The long reading is suspect, being found in M and possibly taken (perhaps by incomplete recollection) from v3.>

Jer 14:14a, b

Assuming G supports the Qr readings, the Kt was can be explained as *waw/yodh* confusion (resulting, in both cases, in a ghost form; see BDB).

Jer 15:9

Given the lack of a *taw* within the word שמשה (contrast Isa 54:12), it seems easiest to suppose that the word is masculine here and that the Kt באה is a mechanical assimilation to the repeated *he* endings of four of the previous five words (the exception being a feminine *taw*).

Jer 15:11

See NET's extensive commentary, adding that G presupposes (though wrongly “vocalizing”) a defective שרתך, of which Kt is either the insertion of a helping letter (also wrongly vocalizing) or corrupt dittograph of the *resh*.

<Jer 15:14

From the expansion in M in 17:4 it is evident that the GP form of this verse was found here; such makes good sense, and the MT corruption (antedating the 17:4 interpolation) is surely based on a visual error with regard to *daleth*, subsequently (or simulataneously) followed by an emendation (or oversight) in which the final *kaph* was dropped.>

<Jer 15:16a

M's נמצא is barely sensible, and is either a transcriptional error (transposition + *waw/yodh* confusion) or, more likely in our view, an emendation necessitated by emendation later in the verse (see immediately below).

The G כלם could possibly be derived from the M ואכלם by transcriptional error (loss of two letters by oversight), though this seem less than very likely. M can hardly be derived from G by transcriptional means, but M might be an emendation in the interest of creating a verbal link with Eze 3:3. M in this book seems far more likely than G to take deliberate action, to G seems preferable here. G makes good sense (see NETS, starting with previous verse).>

{Post-script: The above is much overstated. On נמצא see NICOT; G, meanwhile, is probably a transcriptional error, and, as noted above, כלם seems more likely to stem from ואכלם than the other way around. The Eze passage offers intrinsic evidence for M as long as M is *not* guilty of deliberate activity (and Rev 10 offers further intrinsic support, if to a limited extent since it seems to draw more on Eze), which as of the writing of this post-script seems to be the case. All that said, the G reading(s) remain viable and worthy of revisiting / a marginal reading (were such to be effected), though at present it seems best to retain M.}

<Jer 15:16b

The Kt is likely an assimilation to the דבריך earlier in the verse; the Qr has good external support {but preferably verify citation of P}}>

<Jer 17:9

Either reading is plausible, and either could have arisen from the other due to transcriptional error (transposition + *beth/mem* confusion).

The M reading seems to be a universal condemnation, yet, while this book would certainly affirm the sinfulness of all men, in this passage (vv5-10) the wicked and the righteous are contrasted, not lumped together. Moreover, the final two words of v9 speak of inscrutability, not wickedness. The G reading speaks of God's all-perceptiveness, his ability to distinguish the just from the wicked, despite the enigmatic nature of man's inner life. Passages collocating עמק and לב include Ps 64:7, Pr 20:5, and 25:3. The words עקב (in this sense) and לב (or ללב) are not elsewhere collocated.

The term אגש (wrongly pointed by LXX) does not necessarily carry moral connotations, yet it is not immediately obvious how the incurability of man's heart figures in on the G model. Perhaps the idea is that man is an unsolvable conundrum.

Given the collocations, the general sense of the passage, and the reliability of G in this book, it seems best to adopt G, but the matter is less than certain (would merit marginal reading).

{Post-script: Perhaps the LXX is actually correct in its pointing of ואגש (see the material following the present sentence) in which case the verse could be translated, "The [human] heart is deeper than anything [on this earth]; and [as for] Man[kind], who can understand this [inscrutable] being?" Takamitsu Muraoka (*The Tripartite Nominal Clause Revisited* in: Miller, Cynthia L., ed., *The Verbless Clause in Biblical Hebrew: Linguistic Approaches*, Linguistic Studies in Ancient West Semitic 1, Eisenbrauns, Winona Lake, IN, 1999), building on earlier Semitic scholarship, suggests that certain Hebrew pronouns (principally הוא but, at least in later books, also הם) can serve "highlight any part of speech" (207). Example include Jer 10:3 (ibid.) and Zeph 2:12 (208). (This is not necessarily to say that the LXX translator completely understood the verse, but he was on the right track.))

{Post-script 2: I had not noticed before, but Ps 64:7 provides strong intrinsic evidence for both these approaches, granting that איש there is a synonym of אגש here.}>

<Jer 17:10

M is probably haplography (cf. its expansion in 32:19).

In another matter, it seems quite possible that the LXX is simply rendering ולתת smoothly, not reflecting a *Vorlage* without the *waw* (the MSS that read such could be harmonizing to 32:19 or wittingly or unwittingly producing an easier reading). (The form as found in 32:19 would appear in the margin, however, as it is possible that this was the G reading and if so, it is possibly, though not necessarily, original.)>

{Post-script: Probably assessing M as haplography here remains correct. Note that the *same* error evidently occurred in G-32:19.}

<Jer 17:23

Janzen (37) thinks that G has here expanded from 7:26, but homoeotetuton seems to us a more likely explanation for the variation.>

Jer 18:15

See de Waard for discussion, though he is incorrect in our view ultimately to retain MT (M probably originally read as we do, though this is not certain), which text is probably corrupt dittography in the herodian script (not the beginning of the following word).

<Jer 18:18a

The MG reading without a final *waw* could be polygenetic (haplography), thus justifying a cautious appeal to P. The caution would seem to be justified on intrinsic grounds, for it is not clear how their words will effect Jeremiah's demise, and while לשון is elsewhere connected to evildoers such as these men, it is connected by the one under attack, not the one attacking, so the word as it stands in MG is incongruous on their lips. The reading בלשונו, however, makes the plotters say that their approach will be to find something in Jeremiah's words which they can use as a basis for a call to stone or otherwise execute him. Such is suggested by the earlier part of the quotation (a misplaced pietism is seen in the plotters). See also the next variation unit.>

<Jer 18:18b

M is probably an emendation, a reviser having overlooked the ironic tone intended (“then we will hear what this fellow has to say!”). (An alternative understanding of G, dependent upon accepting the reading בלשונו earlier in the verse, is this: “So let us listen closely to his words [to discover grounds for accusation].”)>

Jer 18:23

The Qr has numerous Hebrew MSS in its support (so Davidson), and is presupposed by G (on which see below). The Kt might be mechanical assimilation to the grammatical number of the preceding verb, corrupt haplography (see the end of the preceding word), the two together, or due to different causes in different sources.

G seems to have read יהי, likely due to corrupt haplography (*yodh*+*waw* → *yodh*), or possibly to grammatical assimilation to the previous verb. In any case, so reading had the consequence of reading not מכשלים but מכשלם as the next word in the verse, due either to conscious emendation or to unconscious adjustment to what was expected to have been seen (either of these could have taken place either in the *Vorlage* or in the mind of the translator).

Jer 19:2

See BDB. G {but have not double-checked Zeigler} agrees with the Qr. The Qr is probably not testimony to what the MT reading originally was, but early recognition that the Kt is erroneous.

<Jer 20:3

G might be due to homoeoarchon, but as מגור occurs everywhere else in the OT with מסבב following, it is more likely that it is a (conscious or unconscious) assimilation. Depending perhaps on phonetic considerations, the short reading might be preferable on intrinsic grounds, מגור by itself sounding very much like פשחור. A survey of how the LXX handles מסבב is interesting. In Ps 31:14 and Jer 6:25, 20:10, and 46:5 (LXX 26:5), the translator(s) did not grasp the meaning, yet translated anyway. Only in Jer 49:29 (LXX 30:24) does the translator show understanding; did he finally figure it out and neglect to correct the earlier occurrences, or did another translator do this final passage? In any case, the general trustworthiness of the LXX in Jeremiah is reinforced by this survey, though it also to be noted that the references are one evidence among many that the translator(s) of Jeremiah were not wooden in approach.>

<Jer 20:10

The M הגידו ונגידו is difficult but apparently sensible (see NET) and probably underlies LXX (contra BHS; but cf. Leiden on this point). Concerning שלומי שמרי צעלי, cf. Leiden, but Zeigler backs up Ralfs on the corresponding LXX. Considering the cloak of piety in which Jeremiah's attackers cast themselves elsewhere, it seems unlikely (though perhaps not impossible) that they would call on Jeremiah's "friends" by that term even as they call for his betrayal (unless perhaps this is Jeremiah's ironic interpretation of their words). Perhaps the LXX has mistaken *yodh* for *waw* on the first word or otherwise assimilated to the preceding grammatical third person. M's שמרי is quite awkward; probably שָׁמְרוּ is correct (LXX understood שָׁמְרוּ), M being *waw/yodh* confusion or assimilation to the preceding suffix. Thus: "All my friends have watched my steps [for opportunity to attack]!">

Jer 20:12

G seems to have so read (see its rendering in 11:20), as do some Hebrew MSS. M appears, on the basis of the parallel passage (11:20) to be an accidental insertion of a helping letter based on a misapprehension of the vocalization/meaning.

<Jer 21:5

As Janzen (43) notes, M has this word (and a following conjunction; *ibid*, 54) where G does not in 42:18. It is much more likely that M has twice added the word based on Dt 29:27 than it is that G has twice lost the word by accident or by design.>

Jer 21:6

M is a *waw/yodh* error (notice that, though intelligible, it is stylistically rather strained); the tense-form of G, too, matches that at the beginning of the verse.

<Jer 22:8

The short reading could be due to homoeotetuton. On the other hand, M seems to prefer the phrase גוים רבים, adding it in 25:14 and 27:7. On the strength of the external evidence, we have adopted the short reading, but with hesitation.>

<Jer 22:18b

Cf. G's rendering here and in 34:5 (=LXX 41:5) where the reverse word order occurs. The double occurrence of the סַפַּד root in M is strange indeed; if not unconscious assimilation, it is due to transcriptional error (aural error + *resh/dalet* confusion + transposition).

{Post-script: It is also possible that the error occurred in G *Vorlage* or that the LXX translator merely *thought* he saw יִשְׂרָאֵל, prompted by the (near) parallel. This situation would merit a marginal reading.}>

<Jer 23:6

It is difficult to choose between יהוצדק and יוצדק, for Jeremiah uses names with both prefixes in his book. Both forms the name are attested outside of Jeremiah, but the former appears slightly more often and in more books. Moreover, Jeremiah uses יהונדב slightly more often than יונדב, and he uses יהונתן three times, but never יונתן. {pointing?}>

Jer 23:14

Following Ges 113h n².

Jer 25:3

This would be the *only* place in Jer where a form other than the infinitive is used of this verse. Moreover, a transcriptional explanation is ready at hand: Assimilation to the 1st person/ *aleph*-initial verbs preceding (or auditory error). {J-M seems to notice this as well: p397 n1.}

<Jer 25:9

M is, as is often noted, most likely an interpolation from 43:10. If G objected on theological grounds to עבדי applied to Nebuchadnezzar (an unlikely scenario, given the LXX of Is 44:28, 45:1), a less drastic omission or some other subtle alteration of form would have sufficed.>

Jer 25:13

The L Kt is probably an inner-MT *waw/yodh* error (going off of JC, Davidson). On the pointing, cf. Eze 38:16 (cited with “+” in BDB sub בוא *hiph'il*).

<Jer 25:15c

As BHS notes, Ps 75:9 offers intrinsic support for G. M could easily be an assimilation to Is 51:17, v22 (and/or a midrashic clarification). Either reading is plausible, but accepting G priority in Jer leads one toward accepting its reading here.>

<Jer 25:23

Janzen (14) says that the long reading makes the line “metrically too long,” though little can be said definitively about ancient Hebrew meter. It is hard to see why ותפוצותיכם form would be supplied, and transcriptional error could easily have led to its loss, but M has many similarly strange pairs of synonyms elsewhere (see, for example, 26:21a). It is difficult to be certain.>

<Jer 25:25

The short reading could be due to homoeoarchon, but, given the variation unit noted just above, it seems more likely that it is an interpolation. In this case, as Janzen (14) notes, זמרי “probably is a corruption of זמכי, an *athbash* cipher for עילם. On the widespread use of *athbash* in antiquity, see “A Writing Exercise Remembered,” in: *Is There a Text in This Cave?*>

<Jer 25:30

M's מעון קדשו could be an expansion, but this phraseology is not at all common in the OT, and occurs nowhere else in Jer. G could be an accidental condensation / overlooking a small word, though the placement of the prepositions weighs somewhat against this. Metrical considerations *might* favor G. Very tentatively, we adopt G (there would be a place for M in a margin).>

<Jer 25:34

See NICOT. A plene כאילי is possible as well.>

{Post-script: In the same direction, M might be a mechanical assimilation of a letter, or an attempt to make sense of a poor exemplar.}

<Jer 25:38a

M is probably an assimilation to the previous verse. G is supported by 46:16 and 50:16.>

<Jer 26:6

It is difficult to decide between העיר הזאתה and העיר הזאת. (The form הזאת is surely an emendation.) The short reading could be due to homoeotelueton or (much less likely, due to the attempts elsewhere of the translator to render what he has even where the sense seems to elude him) due to the LXX translator not understanding הזאתה. On the morphology of הזאתה, see *Hamlet on a Hill*, 80, where it is argued that it is a late form comparable to ריקמה at Qumran. If so, this might be evidence that the word antedates Jeremiah (such indeed is suggested in *ibid*, n⁴⁰), though it is not certain that this morphological process began only after Jeremiah's day. The forms הזאת and הזאתה occur elsewhere both in undisputed cases and in M pluses, so no certain statement about authorial or redactional style can be made. That said, it might be worthwhile at least to raise the following possibility: Perhaps the (or an)

editor of this book was fatigued from approximately the beginning of chapter 26 to somewhere in chapter 29, and accordingly mixed in some of his own orthography, namely הזאתה here and נבוכדנאצר several times (cf. Janzen re 27:6). It should be noted in any case that M several times has הזאת after העיר where G does not. At the same time, G is unbalanced. Perhaps the issue is inner-Greek, ταυτην having dropped out after πολιν by homoeotelueton. {Check apparatuses, though even without external evidence this conjecture is plausible.}>

Jer 27:1

Corrupt dittography of 26:1 (perhaps the scribe's eye jumping to the text after the wrong open section break); see the commentaries.

<Jer 27:6d

Elsewhere (see the comments on 39:1), we give preference to the Old Latin in reconstructing the text of the LXX, and if we do so here, we get G = M. The difficulty is that such could be an inner-LXX correction toward M, and Janzen (55) points out that the parallel passage 28:14 favors לעבדו. The form לעבדו could arise (especially in Hebrew) from עבדי by anticipation of the end of the verse. Either way, it seems best to retain the MT reading, for in the one scenario G does not differ, and in the other it has erred by unconscious assimilation. Reading M here also helps to explain the M interpolations elsewhere. (The short reading in the LXX is most likely too poorly attested to accept, especially given the tendency of S toward omissions {yet is it fair to characterize S thus? NTTC literature should be checked into before making that statement}.)

Post-script: As noted above, 28:14 favors לעבדו on intrinsic grounds, the reading δουλευσεν αυτω would seem to have superior external support {though this assessment should perhaps be reviewed}, and לעבדו might have in the M tradition been corrupted to עבדי, this form then spreading to parallel passages. Not ascribing עבד to Nebuchadnezzar would also seem to accord better with Jeremiah's style (cf. the notes on 33:13 below). The variation between δουλευσεν and εργαζεσθαι can be accounted for on stylistic variation (note δουλος in 46:27 but παις in the very next verse) or inconsistency (cf. the BIOSCS 39 essay).>

<Jer 27:9

BHS' proposal is not impossible, but its reading could be translational *ad sensum* or if in a Hebrew *Vorlage* assimilation as to gender to the preceding nouns. HALOT and NICOT support BHS in siding w/ G. Tentatively, G is accepted, though M would deserve a place in the margin, as the error presumed by its reading, though possible (a single letter making it an instance of a relatively common noun over a rare participial form), is difficult to account for (no obvious transcriptional triggers).>

Jer 27:9

See (among others) HALOT (1:320b), q.v. A swap of a rather rare participle with a somewhat more common noun, facilitated by the visual similarity of *taw* to *mem* (corrupt dittography).

<Jer 27:12-15

TBH 1B:550^b n⁶⁴, citing Stipp, H. J., *Das masoretische und alexandrinische Sondergut des jeremiabuches*, Orbis Biblicus et Orientalis 136; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1994, claims that the short reading here is inferior because “the referent 'prophets' is missing in LXX,” but the referent is clear from vv9-10. It seems at least as likely that a later editor would attempt to supply the missing antecedent that that material would be cut in this fashion.>

<Jer 27:19

G is difficult to make sense of, and might have skipped over 6 words of MT by some mistake. M seems greatly expanded in the immediate context, however, and there is no obvious transcriptional trigger for such. If we take the *waw* as ironic or pleonastic (“And as for the vessels...”), the reading seems tolerable on intrinsic grounds.>

<Jer 27:22a

It is neither likely that G had יבוא as a transposition nor that G or the LXX paraphrased; most likely, we have M behaving here as G does so often elsewhere, turning an active voice passive.>

<Jer 29:2

Janzen (32) is uncertain; the verse certainly is difficult. The syntax of M points in the direction of a gloss (no conjunction or article on שרי יהודה וירושלם for part of the verse. LXX ελεσθερος hardly makes sense in the verse, but is explainable as a corrupt dittography (וההפשי from והחרש). That explanation suggests that the word order שרי יהודה והמסגר might never have existed in Hebrew; rather the inversion took place either in the translator's mind or as a corruption in the LXX tradition (much of the LXX MS tradition = M on that point; see Zeigler).

See also the research note on 24:1.>

<Jer 29:7

G could be assimilation to the more common word ארץ is about twice as common as עיר, both in Jer and in the OT as a whole). Either could be transcriptional error at a phrase when *stadde* did not have a final form (aural error + transposition + *tsadde/yodh* confusion; on the last point see Talmon's essay). There is a fairly high incidence of transcriptional error in Jer (see in Research Notes on Tov's essay on transcriptional error), though certainly bi-directional to some extent. The immediate context seems to focus on the city of Jerusalem, so M is probably preferable on intrinsic grounds, though the case is difficult and would merit a marginal reading.>

Jer 29:23

The Kt seems impossible. This very impossibility *might* explain its absence from G P (and V and T emend, in different ways), but (WBC?) points out, it could be (corrupt) dittography (admittedly with a *waw* appended on the following עד).

<Jer 29:21

Haplography could explain the loss of this material, but for so large a section thus to be lost seems unlikely except in a careless production (cf. Ginsburg, *Introduction*, 171-82, Tov, 222-24 {verify latter pagination}), and G surely is not such. NICOT (545) points out that verses 16-20 “interrupt the flow of Jeremiah's letter to the exiles from v. 15 to v. 21. The words addressed to Shemaiah (vv. 25-28) seem to be cut off abruptly.”>

Jer 29:26

Transposition + faulty word division + *beth/mem* confusion (WBC).

<Jer 29:27a

M is likely due to corrupt haplography {specify: in which script?}>

{Post-script: Note that *beth/mem* confusion afflicted M in the previous verse as well. Perhaps this is a characteristic of proto-M?}

<Jer 31:3b

Assuming (as is likely) that G had אהבת without the *waw*, this reading is probably preferable, for it is easier and can be explained as dittography due to the preceding לו. If so, this error occurred before the graphic confusion that produced לי there in M. (The reading אהבת BHS cites a few Masoretic MSS as having is probably just the polygenetic loss of conjunctions so often seen elsewhere, or possibly an attempt by one or more medieval scribes to smooth out the sense.)>

{On the contrary, this is probably one of many examples where the G-type text smooths out the text by omitting a conjunction whose function is not immediately obvious.}

<Jer 31:4

M could be due to corrupt dittography + aural confusion (*chet/qof*) + adding a helping letter, but in light of the parallel variation unit in v13, the change is probably deliberate. Might there be a connection with 1 Sam 1? Cf.

Aejmelaeus (*Corruption or Correction? Textual Development in the MT of 1 Samuel 1*, 1-17 in: {cited in Research notes under Dt 27:4} and see also the research notes on Jer 31:13.>

Jer 31:9

See HALOT 2: 1719a, ICC, etc.

<Jer 31:13a

Concerning בקהל, see the comments on v4 above.

Concerning יחדו, see the research notes on this verse.

Concerning the G minus of לששון, see the research notes file.>

Jer 31:38

The full phrase **בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם** occurs 21x elsewhere in the OT (14x in Jeremiah), while a non-occurrence of **בַּיָּמִים** is nowhere attested. The minus can easily be explained as haplography, owing either to the fact that **בַּיָּמִים** and **בַּיָּמִים** end the same way or to the visual similarity of **בַּיָּמִים** to the following **נָאֻם**. According to Kennicot, in the following Jer passages the following MSS omit **בַּיָּמִים**:

-7:34... 94, 112

-16:14... 89

-19:6... 112

-23:7... 224

-48:12... 13

-49:2... 150

-51:52... 1, 145

31:38 is on page 2:36 [PDF location 144]; there roughly 35 MSS add **בַּיָּמִים**, surely via assimilation (and surely unconscious, at least in some cases, given the frequency of this phrase)

Jer 31:39

Contrast the research notes on 1 Ki 17:23. Here the Kt could easily be dittography due to the beginning of the following word. This scenario seems likely in light of the fact that in Lam 2:8 it is קו, not קוה, that is used.

Likewise his (near?) contemporary Ezekiel uses קו in 47:3, never קוה.

<Jer 32:11

Note the graphic similarity between **הַמְּצוּהָ וְהַחֲקִים** and **הַמְּקִנָה אֶת הַחֲתוּם** (Janzen 16) and cf. the comments on 2:17 above.>

{Post-script: The matter is difficult. (1) M could be corrupt dittography, or G could be in error, due to (2a) “ignorance regarding legal terminology” (de Waard 134) or (2b) homoeoteteluton (*mem* to *mem*). For a speculative but intriguing bit of intrinsic evidence see de Waard 135. On the other hand, the syntax (note the non-repetition of **אֶת**) of M is somewhat suspect.}

Jer 32:12

NICOT and WBC are surprisingly unclear on the matter (de Waard does not comment at all), but as NAC points out, v7 seems to make pretty clear that the man is Jeremiah's cousin. The word **בֶּן**, being two letters only and very common, could easily have dropped out, even though there is not obvious transcriptional trigger.

<Jer 31:24

The reading ונסעי makes for very difficult syntax, and while the external evidence for ונסעי is not strong (V is probably paraphrasing, and quite possibly Symmachus and likely the Targum, leaving Aquilla, who, however, seems to evidence for a Hebrew *Vorlage* with a *yodh*), the graphic confusion *yodh* → *waw* could easily be polygenetic, afflicting the G subgroup from which the exemplar for the LXX came.>

Jer 31:28

Not only is ונסעי preferable as being defective and as found in M^A, but M^L might be an assimilation to 1:10 (a passage which, being near the beginning of the book, probably stuck in the mind more than 18:9; cf. also 11:17).

<Jer 32:8

It is possible that G was fatigued at this point (see the research notes on v6) and so responsible for a transposition. On the other hand, M might be an attempt to align the word more closely with v7 or to avoid the impression that Benjamin's tribal allotment was within a single city. The word order in G could be specification “the field in the land of Benjamin, specifically the field in Anathoth”; on this view the narrative has an element of suspense to it: Will the word of the Lord be fulfilled in the mouth of Jeremiah's cousin? At first it's not clear, as the expected location, Anathoth, does not appear immediately.>

Jer 32:23

OG uses πρσστγμμ (according to BibleWorks9) 5x: 5:22, 5:24, 39:23 (the present verse), 51:10, and 51:23. In the first verse it renders חק; in the second, חקה; the third verse will be discussed below; in the fourth, it renders חקה in a context where an adjacent occurrence of תורה in MT is omitted in OG, whether by homoeoarchon, by avoidance of redundant language (by the *Vorlage* or by the translator), or by simple lapse; in the fifth, it might render תורה in a context where νομος renders a priorly occurring חקה but, given the other examples and the close correspondence of תורה and νομος elsewhere in OG-Jer and in the Greek OT as a whole, probably in actuality renders חקה, G's *Vorlage* having תורה and חקה transposed relative to MT.

All that said, πρσστγμμ probably renders חקה here as well, so we have a variation unit on our hands. Since the two forms are graphically similar in the square script, transcriptional error seems to be at work. Here are rare case of direction in graphic degeneration *may* be present: A *qoph*, if faintly written, at least as regards its lower half, might be mistaken for a *resh*, while the reverse mistake seems less likely. The term תורה, moreover, is more common than חקה, and so more likely to spring to a scribe's inattentive (or badly straining, if the exemplar was broken) mind.

{The Kt-Qr variation, though ultimately beside the point if the above is correct, remain to be remarked upon. Kt could be an inner-M error of transposition, or Qr could be an assimilation to 26:4, 44:10, 44:23. V and P {check Leiden} *might* be of assistance, though caution is in order as both tend toward facilitating renderings. Tentatively, Kt forms the basis of the orthographic aspect of the reconstruction of G reading offered here.}

<Jer 33:13

This variation unit involves the largest discrepancy between M and G in terms of amount of text. The content of the large reading is also a bit unusual. Yet if one accepts, as we do, that G is frequently preferable to M in large-scale variation units in this book, then barring strong evidence to the contrary, the G reading should be adopted here. The reasoning of NAC (16:301) here is poor: “Verses 19 and 23 attribute the messages to Jeremiah. As such, vv. 14-26 are an integral part not only of the Book of Consolation (chaps. 30-33) but also of the Book of Jeremiah and the entire Bible.” The attribution of these verses to Jeremiah is only authoritative if the text which makes such attribution is genuine. The same page of NAC connects this passage to Jeremiah's purchase of a field and to 1:10. The former passage, however, has its echoes elsewhere (e.g. 33:12-13), and it is not at all clear that the present passage is required by it. The situation is similar with respect to the programmatic statement in 1:10. Janzen (122-23) shows that there are not good grounds for supposing deliberate excision in G (NICOT on Zech 3:8 suggests an LXX *Tendenz* relative to the priesthood, but evidence for such a *Tendenz* is unclear at best, and if such was at work, why not delete only the small portion of this passage relating to the

priesthood?), especially as G/LXX either inserts or the LXX preserves a plus regarding the Levites in 31:14, and there is no clear mechanism for accidental loss. Also note that לוי is rare in Jer (9x MT) but occurs twice here and once within another lengthy passage absent from the LXX (29:16-20) and that עבדי, apart from references to the prophets (and note the pointing) rarely occurs in Jer (certainly only in 46:27, v28). The interpolation might have arisen soon after the Exile in order to affirm God's continuing purpose for his people and for the Temple, or perhaps during the Hasmonean period. It predicts an eternal levitical priesthood. It can be doubted that the author of Hebrew would have made the arguments he does concerning priesthood had he known of this passage and considered authentic. Apparently some felt that God would relate to the descendants of Levi in a manner analogous to his promised treatment of the descendants of David. (Relevant regarding the future priesthood are Isa 66:21 [where the LXX translator has apparently attempted to remove the idea of non-levites becoming priests; note in this connection that Jer 33:18 is highly specific that it is *levitical* priests who will remain] and Zech 6:9-15.)>

Jer 33:22

Holmstedt (376) wants to read באשר. For this there is perhaps some Greek support (though the main OG tradition omits the whole passage), and the support of P and V (I have not checked T). Perhaps M is due to near haplography in the paleo script after *yodh*, or accidental substitution of a more common form for a less common one. This would merit a marginal reading, though.

<Jer 34:1b

Given the proximity of this variation unit to the preceding one, G is most likely original here. Intrinsically, Jeremiah rarely, if ever, uses יד of political sovereignty elsewhere in his writings. On the other hand, the G reading could be an oversight or an unconscious assimilation to 51:28.>

<Jer 34:14a

{Seemingly a strong case for G-Jer; yet see the research notes on v15}

G is (1) the harder reading, while being (2) intelligible and (3) not explainable as transcriptional error. M is surely a verbal assimilation to Dt 15, where, however, as BDB sub מן points out, the sense is at the *commencement* of the *seventh* year, while here (in G) the sense is the *termination* of the *sixth* year. This vagueness of מקץ explains G as plausible and how M arose; G as mere paraphrase is not impossible, but that scenario is considerably less likely. Note as well that the expansionist texttype displays a very similar sort of pedantry as M here in LXX-Gen 2:2 (though Hendel disputes that?).

{post-script: Yet OG might simply be praphrase: σταν πληρωθη εξ for מקץ שבע.>

<Jer 35:11b

Daleth/resh confusion is perhaps the most polygenetic of variations, and would be much facilitated if, as BHS suggests, אדם rather than אדום stood behind the reading ארם, although the insertion of a helping letter is, especially in this case, far from impossible. (BDB notes one certain instance of a defective spelling of אדם, though others are possible if retroverted.) Intrinsically, the assistance that the Edomites gave to the Babylonian invaders is stressed elsewhere in the OT (e.g., Ob), and were not the Aramaeans conquered by, and not assistants of, Nebuchadnezzar? On the other hand, the Rechabite ancestor was found in the north during Jehu's rise to power, so perhaps he fled from the north. The אדם or אדום reading seems preferable, though probably ארם would merit a place in the margin.>

{On the other hand, the commentaries (WBC, NICOT, NAC), and BHS also, do not seem to give this reading much credence, though they do note it (de Waard does not discuss, however). NAC (316) points to 2 Ki 24:2. Moreover, P is doubly weak external support here, for not only is it not a strong source in terms of transmissional history – certainly not when alone – but *daleth/resh* confusion could have afflicted *its* MS tradition (have not checked {Leiden}, but given the magnitude of certain MS discoveries, a conjecture of this nature, transcriptional in nature and restoring an agreement with MT, is not far-fetched).

<Jer 36:12

Regarding the name, M is surely an assimilation to v25 (cf. 26:22 in M). The LXX is divided between Ιωναθαν and Ναθαν. Either, as retroverted into Hebrew, is plausible as a bi-form of אֱלִנָּתָן, but the latter is broadly attested in the LXX tradition, and the former is about 4x more common in the Greek Bible, making it likely to be an assimilation.>

Jer 36:22

See HALOT 1:29b.

<Jer 36:26a

M could be a corrupt dittography on the preceding words, or G could be due to homoeoteleuton. The latter seems probable neither עֲבַדְיָאֵל nor his son appears elsewhere, and thus there is not motivation for the addition, and the case for homoeoteleuton seems especially strong here. A marginal reading might not be out of place, however.>

<Jer 36:26a

This v contains so many instances of the direct object marker followed by a simple name that הַסֵּפֶר could easily have been skipped over accidentally. Such might have been assisted by a visual similarity between *kaph* and *resh* in the script at hand, but this circumstance is not necessary to label G an accidental omission. It would be a bit odd for M to interpolate this word in only two references to Baruch, and the long reading here would help to explain the interpolation in v32 (admittedly there is v27, but the editor might have felt that no addition was necessary there following so soon after v26).

{Post-script: Accidental omission in G, while not impossible, is far from highly probable, and M does so much restructuring and name-adding in this chapter that the short reading really seems preferable. From Baruch's activities it is self-evident that he is either a scribe or acting in a scribal capacity, so the addition is explainable. G/LXX is not allergic to scribes: הַסֵּפֶר is rendered multiple other times.}>

<Jer 37:7a-b

M, taking its cue from v3, sees the people God enjoins to speak as the king's officials; G finds Jeremiah enjoined to speak to these men (who, by implication, are to speak to the king). G is probably the harder reading and not likely to be due to transcriptional error and so, especially given the meta-theory of the book, is preferable.>

<Jer 37:7c

It is difficult to be know whether M is a scribal error or whether G (whether the LXX or its Hebrew *Vorlage*) has smoothed out an unusual construction. A possible explanation of M is that in the paleo script corrupt dittography generated an erroneous *yodh* after *tsadde*, which *yodh* then became *waw* either by emendation or due to graphic confusion at later stage.

Given the general reliability of G in this book, the G reading has been tentatively adopted. Marginal reading!>

<Jer 37:13-14

Cf. Talmon 162. Evidently M erred once and then assimilated the following case. Alternatively, perhaps G misread his *Vorlage* twice. Since it would have to be twice, however, G is probably preferable given its strength in this book.>

Jer 37:19

The left half of the *he* was overlooked.

<Jer 38:1

It is difficult to know whether the M reading is interpolation inspired in some way by 21:1, or is a (misplaced?) corrupt dittography, or whether G is an oversight. Cf. the similar situation in 36:26.>

<Jer 38:5b

M is probably a corrupt haplography the herodian script. It seems unlikely that the king would be so forthcoming about his own inability to those putting him in fear; G has a more plausible scenario in which the narration supplies this information.>

{Post-script: Rather, G is probably a corrupt haplography, for יוכל, and indeed the whole כי clause, seems much more likely to be a direct quotation rather than a narrative comment from Jeremiah (or Baurch).}

Jer 38:22a

Assuredly missing in G; evidently added at a fairly early stage in M, though after the error mentioned below.

Jer 38:22b

Corrupt dittography.

<Jer 39:1

The situation is parallel to that in 29:15-20: Haplography is a possible explanation for the loss of verses 4-13 in the LXX, yet it seems odd for so large a bloc of text to be lost accidentally, and for the text to read smoothly despite a fairly large-scale scribal blunder. Most of the material here appears later in the book.

According to THB 1B:505b, the Old Latin text lacks verses 2-3 as well as 4-13, and this may be original. (THB 1A:327^a says verses 1-2 were missing, but from what it goes on to say and from the 1B citation just given this is probably a typo for 2-3.) Cf. Janzen, 50, and his observation elsewhere (p??) that the LXX was early on partly corrected toward a more M-type text (such could be the case for the Q MS cited in his appendix as well, where a minor M plus appears amidst a generally G-type text).>

<Jer 40:5b

G could be an assimilation to 41:5, but given that (1) the assimilation would only be partial, (2) M is explainable as transcriptional error (aural error + *yodh/tsadhe* confusion), and (3) G appears to be the stronger witness in this book, G is probably preferable here.>

<Jer 40:8b

The reading with ויונתן could be due to transcriptional error, and indeed it likely is due to homoeoarchon or homoeotelueton in some witnesses, but M, with its בני following, is probably an addition or a corrupt dittography, as elsewhere in this book. (BHS lists a number of Massoreite MSS as having בן, but this number seems to be small, and the change could be due in some MSS to assimilation to the earlier בן and in others to 2 Ki 25:23. Rather, בני is likely original to the Massoretic text here, an unconscious emendation in light of the addition of ויונתן by an earlier stratum of the text.)>

{Post-script: In the same direction, NICOT notes the absence of this figure elsewhere. (WBC's comment is not wrong but can easily confuse.) The visual similarity between the two adjacent names is quite strong. Also, בן could possibly have become בני through corrupt dittography in the square script, especially if at one stage final forms did not exist, though the possibility raised above of alteration to the expected form is also very much present.}

<Jer 40:9b

This is a good example of a principle under which we try operate: Where a harder reading (in this case, harder in light of a parallel passage) is explainable as transcriptional error (here, *yodh/waw* confusion + transposition) and the easier reading has a plausible textual history (here, presence in a strong witness, G).>

{Post-script: It may be well to be clear that we still take this stance on this variation unit even after abandoning the theory of the superiority of G over M in Jer.}

<Jer 40:10a

M is probably due to homoeoteleuton (There seem to be no parallels or other triggers for assimilation in G.)>

<Jer 40:10b

M could be due to corrupt dittography or to over-specification; G could be due to corrupt haplography or mere oversight of single letter if not merely to slight paraphrase in the LXX, but given the general reliability of the LXX and the apparent oversight in M earlier in the same verse (see immediately above), it seems consistent to adopt G.

Analogous verses with אשר suggest the article (and to the extent that the LXX represents a vocalic tradition, it also supports this view), as BHS suggests.>

<Jer 41:5

Possible explanations for the variation: (1) Since the two readings משלו and משלם (assuming BHS is correct at to the text of the LXX {have not checked Zeigler yet}), differ by only one letter, either could be due to oversight. (2) Alternatively, משלו might have arisen accidentally as being more common in the OT: שלו, in its various spellings, occurs 33x in MT; שלם as a proper noun occurs only 2x in MT). (3) Still another alternative is that משלו is an emendation, for if שלם is understood as a reference to Jerusalem, it would seem to be nonsense. (4) As a counterpoint to the last option, משלם might be an emendation, since Shiloah was long since desolate.

The second option seems the most likely, or a combination of the first and second (failure to read the last letter because a more common place name was anticipated). Intrinsic evidence can be adduced for both readings: שלו was in the north, and might have been rebuilt at some point (check lexicons, Bible dictionaries, commentaries), while שלם was apparently also the name of a northern site known to the LXX translators (see Judith 4:4 and LXX-Gen 33:18).

The evidence is fairly balanced but seems to favor G, which is also the stronger witness.>

{Shiloh apparently *was* rebuilt: See 2 Ki 14:2. The VU is not wholly clear, so it seems best to retain MT.}

Jer 42:1

Following (at least) HALOT (1:381a). Visual error (*ayin/yodh* confusion, facilitated by the following *zayin* + *resh/nun* confusion, perhaps influenced by the following *yodh* [since *resh* and *yodh* in proximity often leads to error]).

Jer 42:20

The examples BDB puts under the same heading sub תעה seem different than this case; root רעה seems better, and Kt can be explained as visual error (the following *ayin* might have made *resh* look rather like a *taw*, which latter letter might have been in the scribe's mind since an instance of it is upcoming; plus metathesis with *waw/yodh* confusion).

<Jer 43:2

It is difficult to say whether G is correct in having אלינו and that M thought it saw the more common אלהינו (or thus emended the text), or whether G overlooked a letter. Intrinsic evidence might favor the first option, given אליהם in v1.>

{Post-script: 42:6 seems to give good intrinsic support for M, which, as noted, is reading from which a single letter could have been dropped by accident to produce G.}

Jer 43:11

We take Kt to be a mechanical anticipation of the terminal *he* on the following והכה.

<Jer 43:12

The witnesses are unusually divided here, but it seems most likely that G is correct. Likely M has attempted to sort out just how Jeremiah buried the objects.>

<Jer 44:9

The MS tradition is in much confusion at this point. Probably *וְאֵת רַעַת נְשֵׁיכֶם* is missing from the Syriac due to haplography {check Leiden on this point}, *וְאֵת רַעַתְכֶם* is an interpolation in M (“this series... lists, not the evil deeds of Jeremiah’s hearers, but those of a number of *third* parties,” Janzen, 18, emphasis original), and *נְשֵׁי* in M is the result of a difficult-to-read exemplar (cf. the comments on 48:7 below).>

Jer 47:5

While there does seem to be evidence for a root *עמק* meaning “strength,” the connection between the Philistines and the Anakim seen elsewhere seems strong enough that the option taken here is the more probable of the two.

<Jer 48:2a

Either *תַּעֲלֶה* or *תַּהֲלֶה* makes sense. Either could lead to the other where the phonology of the scribe reflects a significantly weakened state of the gutturals. Such is probably more likely in the cause of the translator than of an editor working at a fairly early period (if indeed the recension of Jer, whether G or M, occurred early); in this scenario, this might be a psuedo-variant, existing only in the translator’s mind as he repeated what he had read to himself. Another possibility is the substitution of a common word (if in an uncommon sense; cf. the comments on 12:13 above) for a rare one (only 11x in M-OT, 2 of them [=18%] in M-Jer), due either to a damaged exemplar or to haste or fatigue. Yet another possibility is a damaged exemplar in the MS that gave rise to M (cf. the comments on 48:7 below). Given the uncertainty of the case it is best to stick with the stronger witness.>

{Post-script: There is more to the story of OG here. Taking a cue from WBC, but taking things, I think, in a little different direction, I theorize that (1) for *תַּהֲלֶה* G had *תַּעֲלֶה*, that (2) a variant on that word, viz. *תַּהֲלֶה*, was found in a margin and (3) wrongly inserted *after* *מִזֶּבֶעַ*, this word (4) then being rendered (maybe rather freely, but with sensitivity to the context) as *αγαυοτατα*. On this model, *תַּעֲלֶה* could be the original reading, yet *תַּהֲלֶה* was in early circulation. The older the variant, the less likely auditory factors are to be at work, and at not point do the letters look much alike, though it must be admitted that within the word as a whole only one letter being different is not a much difference. Verses 1 and 7 suggest strength, not healing power, was what was in the prophet’s mind, though once again the matter is uncertain.}

Jer 48:4

Following OG, viz. the place name Zoar with a directional *he*. Cf WBC and Isa 15:5.

<Jer 48:7

M appears to have suffered greatly here, with a visual error with respect to *בְּמַצְדּוֹתֶיךָ* and perhaps corrupt dittography as well, resulting in *מַעֲשֵׂיךָ*.>

Jer 48:44a

Kt is perplexing; perhaps corrupt dittography of the *nun* resulted in *yodh*.

Jer 48:44

Credit to Ges 131n¹.

Jer 49:25

Pointing an asseverative *lamedh* (with, at least, NICOT, and I think also WBC) and following OG over Kt (or Qr), we get (my translation): “How has [the] city been forsaken! / My praise, the town of my joy!” This seems to improve the meter, and possibly the flow of thought. Kt is either a theological emendation (since a gentile city is referred to), or *תַּהֲלֶה* became *תַּהֲלֶה* via assimilation to *קִרִּית* and then *תַּהֲלֶה* via *he/taw* confusion (or, less likely, emendation, if the option of apposition was not considered).

Jer 49:36

Waw/yodh confusion and/or confusion with the common word עולם.

Jer 50:44

See OG and 49:19 (parallel brought to my attention by BDB sub ריץ).

Jer 51:3

Dittography. I *have* verified the OG with Ziegler. On the pointing of אָל *bis*, see research notes.

<Jer 51:44-49

As with 29:15-20 and 39:3-13 (see the comments in those places), haplography is a possibly explanation, yet we are unaware of clear parallels of such large amounts of text being lost accidentally in what otherwise seems to be a reasonably well-produced MS. As Janzen (119) points out, the verses following 51:44-49 are very similar in content, and thus the case is similar to, if more dramatic than many of, the other instances of this book of a strange sort of dittography (as to this dittography, see the comments on 2:17). Rev 18:4 borrows the languages of 51:45, but the book of Revelation is not practicing textual criticism; rather the book is employing familiar, evocative language for its own rhetorical and didactic purposes, drawing either on M or one of the scattered LXX MSS which, to judge from the LXX MS tradition, must have existed early.>

<Jer 52:15

While G could in theory be due to haplography, it is far more likely, given the character of M in this book, that the long reading is an interpolation. Indeed, “Nebuzaradan would hardly have taken some of the poor to Babylon” (Janzen, 21) {unless this was part of an intermixture policy like the Assyrians used, but in any case this variation should probably be handled in a way that reflects one's position on the book as a whole, as Tov suggests in his essay on Jer}.>

{Most likely, (O)G is homoeoteleuton, from טַבְּחִים in v14 to that in v15.}

Jer 52:21

Qr appears to underlie OG, and Kt is explainable as *he/taw* confusion.

<Jer 52:34

M has a synonymous expansion. Note that the short reading *could* be explained as haplography, but (a) that this is the very end of the book complicates this hypothesis, (b) why would (here and so often elsewhere) haplography occur precisely where the meaning is repeated, while if (as Lundbom suggests) the translator did not like repetition, why (so Janzen argues) did he bother to translate so much redundant material elsewhere, and (c) why (so again Janzen) does the plus in M have a most probable source (cf. the endings of Kings and Chronicles)?>

Introduction to Ezekiel

The large-scale G-M differences could be approached similarly to those in Jer, for (1) some the variants are rather similar; (2) the OG translator(s) *might* be the same (this last can only be highly tenuous, however).

In a separate matter, the MT MS tradition seems unusually divided for this book, as can be seen by the number of times, compared to books of comparable size elsewhere, in which L and A, where they differ, *each* have non-negligible support from other MSS. (For this reason the first edition of SRO departs from L in few cases of L-A differences in Eze; too much is uncertain about stemmatic relationships here.)

From Ashley [a male name here] S. Crane, *Israel's Restoration: A Textual-Comparative Exploration of Ezekiel 36-39*, VTS 122, Leiden/Boston, 2008, ISBN 978 90 04 16962 3, “External evidence supporting G⁹⁶⁷”

(p245-49): “[re Dan]: [argues on analogy of large-scale pluses, minuses, and transpositions in OG there, plus G⁹⁶⁷ priority there, and] [p. 246] “Dan. 12:1-3 speaks of a resurrection... [which happens] *after* [emphasis original]

the conflict in Dan. 11 that appears to reflect Antiochus Epiphanes' persecution, with the prediction of Antiochus' death in the land of Israel (Dan. 11:45). This order of a major battle followed by a resurrection corresponds to G⁹⁶⁷'s order of events in Ezekiel. However, Daniel only talks of a 'king of the north', unlike Revelation which specifically mentions Gog.” [re Rev] “Of special interest is Rev. 20:11-15 that [p. 247] has a second resurrection *after* the battle with God and Magog (Rev. 20:7-10), therefore matching G⁹⁶⁷'s chapter order. It does raise the question of what might have inspired John to write of a second resurrection, if he was using Ezekiel's order of events. Most have focused on the first resurrection in Rev. 20:4-6 before the Gog epic, as that matches Ezekiel's received chapter order. There is nothing, however, in Ezekiel's received order to match John's second resurrection. Significantly, this second resurrection occurs just before the 'new Jerusalem' in Rev. 21. While we may grant John theological license here, we also suggest that John's writing was in keeping with differing early Jewish eschatological viewpoints, and existing textual traditions. List (1980, p. 180) questions which textual tradition was before John, suggesting that John knew of both, indicating that “Revelation was made up of two different apocalyses fused into one”. Lust proposes that G⁹⁶⁷'s order was most likely the tradition influencing John's order of events, and Lust presents a schema supporting his proposal. Curiously, Lust's schema ignores the first resurrection in Rev. 20:4-6. We suggest that John did know of both textual traditions for Ezekiel, and sought to include *both* traditions in Revelation. MasEze witnesses the received order; therefore the chapter reorder would have been done before John's time....” [on pp248-249, Crane argues for support also from Pseudo-Jonathan, though on p. 248 he argues that Targum Neofiti supports MT.

Eze 1:3a

For a counterargument see WBC. But only *once* does such a usage of the key root **היה** occur elsewhere in the HB, and that in a context where its emphatic force is felt, which is not the case here. Moreover, Ezekiel uses **היה דבר** **יהיה** language many times elsewhere, but never thus; and dittographs are the defining feature of M-Eze. Following (at least) Howie (75).

Eze 1:6

Vertical dittography, plus corruption (*nun + he* → final *mem*)?

Eze 1:8

Re the Qr, OG has dealt freely with the grammatical number, as often elsewhere.

Eze 1:11

See WBC, noting also the possibility that **וּפְנִיָּהֶם** is a corrupt dittograph of the following **וּכְנִפֵּיהֶם**, facilitated by the references to faces in the previous verse.

Eze 1:13a

Instead of WBC's explanation, we would appeal to transcriptional error (metathesis + visual error, facilitated by the several occurrences of **דְּמוּת** in the near context).

Eze 1:13b

Corrupt dittography, facilitated by the earlier comparable forms two verses earlier.

Eze 1:13c

Re **הַלְפָּדִים**: The article is dittography after the preceding word's final letter, as WBC notes; as far as intrinsic evidence goes, not the earlier anarthrous comparison. Furthermore, the density of errors in M in this chapter may lend support to this change.

Eze 1:14

See WBC and Howie (52, 60).

Eze 1:15a

See WBC on the intrinsic evidence. As for the error, perhaps rather a corrupt dittograph of the following word, facilitated by the many references to *חיות* in the context.

Eze 1:15b

See WBC (7).

Eze 1:16

See on v15b.

Eze 3:4

See *Florilegium Lovoinse* (sp?) (Martínez FS). Corrupt dittography of the *daleth* in the paleo script.

Eze 3:6

WBC's discussion is helpful as usual, but ultimately we opt for a corrupt dittograph of *אם* or of the first two letters of *אליהם*, facilitated by the several instances of *לא* in the verse and the flow of thought which, though ultimately logical, could be confusing. Note also the large number of apparent dittographs in M-Eze to this point.

Eze 6:3c

L's Kt appears to be an inner-MT error (cf. Davidson, JC). The apparently autographical form, *ולגיאיות*, is difficult because the *plene* spelling combine with the inclusion of the etymological *aleph* results in a digraph, something attested in later Hebrew (see Wise's book) but rare in the OT.

Eze 6:14

See especially Concordia (although he ultimately follows V). External evidence for *רבלחה* is weak (V), though admittedly *daleth/resh* confusion is polygenetic. But in a book that postdates the destruction of the Northern Kingdom, would a south-north designation for the whole land be used? But a roughly east-west orientation, implied in M (and G) makes sense. And why a place in Syria as the northern border? And is there really a wilderness there? So M seems preferable, *pace* WBC, Concordia, and HALOT.

Eze 7:21

So go off Davidson, JC, L's defective spelling is incorrect. With that matter out of the way, the Kt is preferable as the less usual orthography

Eze 8:16

WBC offers more complex scenarios, but I suspect corrupt dittography of the following final *mem*.

Eze 10:3

See WBC (*pace* Gordis 393 n⁷⁷).

Eze 13:9

On the intrinsic evidence see WBC. In our view, the problem is visual error (the *nun* could be mistaken for the right half of a *he*; the *tet* beside a *yodh* could be confused to the left half of a *he*; the final *yodh* was perhaps overlooked because of the following *יד*, or else lost simultaneously with the mental supplying of the final *he* of *והיתה*) facilitated by the distinctiveness of *יד והיתה* in Ezekiel.

Eze 13:11

ויפל looks like a corrupt dittograph of *תפל*. Possibly the conjunction comes from metathesis with *והיה*, or some emendation took place after the error. Cf. WBC.

Eze 14:1

Some argue for metathesis in **וּבְיוֹא**, but this situation obtains so often that (setting aside from a few genuine cases of transmissional error involving root **בּוּא**, e.g. 22:4) it seems to me that in Ezekiel's dialect/usage, 3rd person singular **בּוּא** has become a stereotyped formula, rather like **וַיְהִי** in narratives.

{Post-script: But in fact the instances are not many (14:1, 20:38 [haplography?], 23:44, 36:20), and the errors in M(T)-Eze are so numerous, and often repeated, and often involve transposition, that textual error seems more likely than a dialectical peculiarity restricted to a single prophet. Cf. the rather similar situation discussed at Num 32:25.}

Eze 16:15, 16

This variant and the following are quite difficult. Tentatively, we take **לֹא יִהְיֶה** to be corrupt dittography for **וְלֹא יִהְיֶה**, and **בְּאוֹת** to be metathesis for **תְּבוּא** (the wording **לֹא תְבוּא וְלֹא יִהְיֶה** meaning “Such ought not eventuate or be!”; cf. BDB sub **לֹא**).

Eze 16:20

L's orthography appears to be unique, and so wrong (cf. Davidson, JC). Beyond that, while the Qr is supported by many MSS (Davidson), the Kt, being found so in (at least) L, JC, VDH.

Eze 16:22

BDB cites this verse, but the usage here does not seem to fit the description of the heading there, nor the pattern of the other Eze verses it cites. Rather, this verse seems to be more summary and hinge, making **זֹאת** fitting. As WBC points out, similar phenomena occur in 47:17-19.

Eze 16:47

See BHS. The external evidence is very strong (including JC), and the *beth* might moreover be either a visual error or an assimilation to **בְּדַרְכֵּיהֶן**, – a word controlled by a different verb than the word under question – or the former facilitated by the latter. 43:8 might be taken to support L, but the sense there is different. (WBC says BHS is a printing error, but see WLC 4.20.)

Eze 18:10

Corrupt dittograph (cf. WBC), not found in OG (which, admittedly, seems to have other minuses in the near context).

Eze 18:29

Haplography of *waw* after *nun* (in a fairly early script); cf. v25.

Eze 20:31a

Of the three (L, JC, Ginsburg), JC is alone here, but (a) Aleppo seems to be a strong witness in paragraphing matters in this book and (b) this section, being open and coming at an unexpected point, could easily have been overlooked more than once.

Eze 21:7

Haplography due to visual similarity (accepting the long Greek reading, the short reading being in our view a typical inner-greek error, or possibly a correction against MT); cf. 7:24.

Eze 21:24

Corrupt dittography of the following **בְּרֹאשׁ**, made in anticipation of the later **בְּרֹא**.

Eze 21:21

See HALOT 2:1325^b-1326^a.

Eze 21:25

MT lacks the article necessary to be sensible if ירושלם were to be modified (Neh 2:17 is a predicate construction), and is simply a visual error. See also NET.

Eze 22:10

An alternative explanation (to that of WBC) is mechanical assimilation to the grammatical number of ערות.

Eze 22:18

For the retroversion of the OG, cf. its rendering of סגים near the end of the verse (on the OG rendering of the end of the verse in general see Concordia).

Eze 22:20

See WBC, adding that paleo *kaph/mem* problems occurred recently (v18).

Eze 22:24

An alternative to WBC's explanation is metathesis. {In terms of intrinsic support, note (at least) W-O.}

Eze 25:8

For the intrinsic evidence see NICOT, adding that everywhere else where Ezekiel mentions שער he, distinctively, uses הר; for an explanation of the error see WBC, though perhaps a slightly different explanation is to be advanced, viz. that ושער is (setting aside the slight emendation by which the conjunction was added and possibly by which also the position of the word was adjusted) a corrupt dittograph of עשות in v12, the scribe's eye having jumped from יען יהוה יאמר אדני here to יען יהוה יאמר אדני there (and influences by אדום in the latter passage, which is semantically related, of course, to שער).

Eze 25:14

According to Kennicott (2:207) there is substantial MS support for the *plene*, but many of those same MSS also support ולא for ולוא in 24:16 (2:206); cf. further HALOT.

Eze 27:6a

See WBC and also NET.

Eze 27:6b

Haplography in MT, if not an emendation (cf. 23:14).

For the opposite Kt-Qr, see Isa 23:12 and research notes there.

Eze 27:19

See WBC, adding that since there is no external evidence for reading ודני, we speculate that in Hebrew דן (“casket”) is a collective.

Eze 28:23

See WBC and Ges (also Howie 64). Had OG seen ונפלל, it probably would not have understood the (impossible) form and passed over it rather than render it.

Eze 29:7

See WBC. We have modeled the pointing on הכעס in 1 Ki 21:22.

Eze 29:9

See WBC. Haplography due to the visual similarity of final *kaph* to *resh*. For the pointing see 35:10.

Eze 30:4

See WBC for the intrinsic evidence. As for an explanation, we take the plus to be a corrupt dittograph of the following two words, noting the visual similarity.

Eze 30:13b, c

OG $\mu\epsilon\gamma\alpha\lambda\alpha\upsilon$ quite plausibly represents גדולים, which (1) in terms graphically explains גלולים readily enough, (2) bears a plausible sense (cf. BDB גדול para. 6b), (3) and which, together with אילים, on which see WBC, makes the parallelism consistent, given ונשיא later in the verse.

Eze 30:23

Cf. v22. M is either haplography of *he* after final *mem*, or assimilation to the anarthrous state of the previous noun (חללים), which has a similar shape.

Eze 34:31

See NICOT where, according to Lust in Ulrich FS {I do not have; Van Pelt library) an opinion of Wevers that it is a corrupt dittography. Such seems a plausible explanation for a perplexing item.

Eze 36:12

See HALOT (248a) and cf. the previous verse. Concordia, apparently unaware of the alternative reading, calls MT “odd,” and the explanation offered is strained in that there is no specific mention of the land here.

Eze 36:15

See McCarter, 32 (dittography from v14 triggered by recurrence of עור).

Eze 37:22

Kt is an assimilation to יהיה earlier in the verse. Note how OG distinguishes the two forms (εσται and εσονται, respectively).

Eze 37:26

The MT plus ונתתם is an inner-M error (followed by T and V, the former translating a bit adventurously [cf. WBC] and the latter following its lead); P has the true M reading, while G probably also had it, but lost material from a closely related visual error (cf. WBC). MT jumped from the first אותם to the second, miscopied ונתתי, then realized the error and began copying correctly from וחרבתי, but the erroneous plus was left and perpetuated by future copies (cf. WBC).

Eze 38:17

As WBC, MT is surely dittography. (While orthodox corruption *could* explain the declarative reading, the strong versional support for such, together with the ready transcriptional explanation, suggests that the interrogative reading is an inner-M error.)

Eze 40:15

Very tentatively, we reject the apparently senseless Kt for what might be the reading of G (on which cf. WBC), viz. an otherwise unattested (coined by Ezekiel himself?) adjective from זָיִא formed on the analogy of תִּהְיוֹן (a word used by Ezekiel several times in this section), “outer.”

For another *hapax* restored from the OG, see 41:8.

Eze 40:48

Note that WBC has a typo wherein the word order is incorrect.

Eze 41:8

See WBC. It is hard to imagine (O)G conjuring up a nonsense word from something so obvious as וראיתי; here, the principle of the harder reading seems to be operative. Intrinsically, a technical architectural term is just what one would expect in such a setting. Indeed, later in this very verse another *hapax* (אצילה) of uncertain meaning occurs!

For another *hapax* restored from the OG, see 40:15.

Eze 42:6

See WBC. One point requires clarification: The follow G *except* that we take the *mem* in its פניהם is corrupt dittography, if not emendation based on the misapprehension adduced by WBC. (There are a number of typos in WBC in this section of the book. Here, the word פניה is wrongly given a *schwa*.)

Eze 42:10

See WBC on the intrinsic evidence, but as there are (it seems to us) much simpler (and therefore better) transcriptional explanations at hand: The visual similarity between the two forms (compounded, of course, by fatigue).

Eze 42:11

Probably dittography – see the ending of the previous word.

Eze 42:14

I am dubious of the usual grammatical explanation given for the difficult M (cf. on 10:3). Rather, we seem to have a large-scale graphic error / failed reconstruction of the type often found in M-Sam. The proposed text לא יבאו שם לבד has, including word breaks, 14 characters. The first four were not clearly visible, though either the medial part of the *lamedh* or part of the *yodh* might have suggested *beth* (but that may have been guesswork). Then characters 7-9 were not visible or were overlooked, as was the last word. M is a tautology, but G makes good sense on multiple levels: The Mosaic restriction of the Holy Place to priests, the Ezekelian emphasis on purity, and, in our verse ולא, sequel to the earlier לא.

Eze 42:16b

Perhaps corrupt dittography of the following word. The fatigued scribe never noticed his error, and mechanically repeated in the next few verses what he written here.

Eze 43:11

The situation is complicated, it would seem, by variation in the OG {as of this writing I do not have access to Gottingen-Eze}, even if there is a longer minus here in OG, it would be homoeotetuton; at any rate, we take וכל צורתו to be a corrupt dittography, influenced the by earlier צורתו, וכל, of the following וכל תורתו (The L Kt צורתי is an inner-MT error.)

Eze 45:1

While it is suspicious that this error would have had to occur several times (also 48:9, 13), there are at least two other chains of errors in MT-Ezekial (זאת for זאת and the addition of קנים), and ample opportunity in these chapters for various mechanical errors, not least regarding numbers.

Eze 45:13

Cf. HALOT 2: 1665b. A classic (in Ezekiel) case of corrupt dittography.

Eze 46:9

Kt is mechanical assimilation to the previous word, which ends in *waw*, or perhaps corrupt dittography.

Eze 46:10

Probably repetition of the error just made in v9.

Eze 46:22b

Quite possibly an inner-M error going back to the exemplar for MT, as indicated by the cancellation marks and possibly also by its absence from P and V (although one or both of these may be following the lead of OG, or passing over as a bit difficult). The word bears some resemblance to *ומבשלות* in v23 which, like the word in question, follows *לארבעתם*, so perhaps a scribe's eye jumped ahead; he then miscopied (influenced by the meaning of the word immediately before), but then noticed his error (ultimately in vain, sadly).

Eze 47:17, 18, 19

Visual error (might the M exemplar have written his *waw* and his *zayin* too similarly? But this hypothesis is not necessary, for a tired scribe could easily repeat his error in this repetition section). So BDB, citing v20.

Eze 48:34

Corrupt dittography.

Hos 3:5

The plene spelling of David's name occurs mainly in very late books, but at least 2x in Kings and about 4x elsewhere in MinP.

Hos 4:3

The noun phrase in G likely dropped due to homoeoteleuton. BHQ (12:7) takes the long reading to be an assimilation to 2:20, but if this was the case, the noun phrase would most likely be inserted after, rather than before, *ובעוף השמים*. KEL (56) notes that the judgment here "is even more severe than the flood... in that it includes the gathering of the fish." The long reading strengthens the connection to Gen chapter 1.

Hos 5:7-8

See the data in Pericope 9: 132.

Hos 6:5

The reading M is explainable as a misapprehension of where the words divide (stemming from an exemplar in which final and non-final *kaph* were not yet distinguished), while the G reading (supported by other witnesses as well) fits the immediate context and has important parallels in Mic 7:9 and Zeph 3:5. (There is no direct evidence that the earliest MSS lacked word divisions.)

Hos 6:10

Re Kt-Qr: See HALOT 2: 1619^a for strong evidence for the Qr form but none for the Kt form. The latter is either *waw/yodh* error or anticipation of the *yodh* which comes later in the word.

Hos 7:7

Following OG^A (cf. ICC, though as most often he retains M); the sense and the meter are improved, and M is explainable as a minor visual disturbance facilitated by the extremely high frequency of the word *אח*.

Hos 7:14

The parallel in 2 Ki 18:28 much favors the G reading (cf. the comments on Gen 14:14). BDB (151^a) concurs, though tentatively.

Hos 8:2a

G explains the other readings: P confused a final *mem* with a *nun+waw* combination (facilitated by the later 1cp

verb); and M(T)+V dropped the final *mem* sitting in between two identical letters (a kind of error often observed elsewhere). Note also the following of G later in this same verse.

Hos 8:2b

Dittography, either copying exactly from v3 due to an initial overlooking of זנה (a small word), or a corrupt dittograph of the visually similar ידענוך (and facilitated by anticipation of ישראל?). Assuming dittography eliminates seemingly impossible syntax. Similar metrical patterns occur (at least) in chapter 6.

Hos 8:5-6

A species of corrupt dittography (recall from the Pentateuch research that errors are in infrequently combinatory in nature).

Hos 8:13

The short reading could be due to homoeotetuton. On the other hand, Hosea rarely repeats himself word for word (see 9:3). Perhaps the long reading is some sort of midrashic interpolation (likely originating in the Hebrew *Vorlage*, not in the LXX; see on Amos 5:26b below) or an unconscious anticipation of 9:3. Further inquiry is required on this variation unit.

Hos 9:2

ICC's attempt to defend MT seems dubious, and the external evidence for בם seems very strong indeed, not to mention the ease with which the error could happen. (Possibly, indeed, the error mem -> he is somewhat one-directional, in paleo, early square, and modern square scripts; and בה is more than twice as common than בם.)

Hos 10:8-9

See the data in Pericope 9: 133.

Hos 10:9

Tentatively, we accept Talmon's (152) argument that M is a corrupt dittography (*aleph* and *taw* looking very similar in some ancient scripts).

Hos 10:13b

BHQ (*67) is right to note that the G reading fits well in the context, while NET (1687) is probably right to say that the M reading does not. The visual similarity of the two words, compounded by the frequency with which forms of דרך occur in the OT, led to the reading M from the G reading.

Hos 11:2a

Near haplography after *yodh* in a paleo script, plus (later?) waw/yodh confusion (or else assimilation to the large number of 3mp forms in this verse).

Jenni (3: 143) flags להם, but this difficulty is obviated by following G here.

Hos 11:2b

The M reading, difficult to extract sense from in the context, is explainable on the hypothesis that a scribe overlooked the dot or space separating מפני from הם; cf. the comments on 6:5 above. NAC (222) argues that the G text "seems to be a reflection on... how the people through the centuries disregarded the prophets' message. This passage, however, focuses not on prophetic history but on the exodus... [I]n the exodus itself Israel was already committing apostasy by yearning for Egypt (e.g., Num 11:4-6) and carrying Egyptian paganism with them." On the contrary, the G text seems not to emphasize the role of the prophets, but rather God's own relationship with his people, a theme begun in v1 and brought to a head in vv8-9. Moreover, the present verse will make a particular reference to Baal, a reference which is difficult to make little sense if Hosea is

dilating specifically on Israel's departure from Egypt.

Hos 11:3

The harsh change of perspective implied in M is most likely a mere scribal error triggered by the fact that the next word begins with a *waw* and perhaps facilitated by poorly-indicated word divisions in his exemplar (cf. the previous variation unit).

Hos 11:11

The two forms are easily confused, and though the M form is plausible, the G form seems to fit the context better (among those that concur is BDB 443^b). The defective form presented here is both only plausible in itself and is found (minus the suffixed pronoun) in Eze 20:22.

Hos 12:2

Although BHQ *69 states that the identification of the LXX καὶ μάταια with וְשׁוֹא is “dubious,” this identification does seem probable in light of LXX usage elsewhere. The word שׁוֹא is often collocated with כִּזָּב (TWOT 1:435a), and so unconscious assimilation might explain the G reading. On the other hand, six times (Eze 13:6, v7, v8, v9, 21:34, 22:28) שׁוֹא comes first, and only once (Pr 30:8) does כִּזָּב come first, making assimilation less likely. M might be due to transcriptional error, *daleth* and *aleph* resembling one another in some early scripts (the *waw* on this account being simply overlooked), but such is far from certain.

Hos 12:5

NAC (19A: 239 n¹⁷⁷) claims that the suffix in עָמְנוּ could refer to either the third person singular or the first person plural, but this claim is contradicted in the grammars (GKC §91e; J-M §94h {check new grammar as well}; the commentator might be thinking of the non-Babylonian form מִקְמָנוּ). The M reading might be an assimilation to a misapprehension of the preceding יִמְצָאוּ (see NET 1689). On the other hand, the G reading might be an emendation or an accidental neglect of the *nun* (precipitated by the misapprehension just alluded to). Turning to intrinsic evidence, one might argue that it is not until v7 that Hosea shifts from narrative to application. Weakening this line of evidence are the sorts of asides Hosea sometimes uses, particularly with regard to Judah (as in 1:7). Yet it is also true that Hosea barely uses the first person plural, and when he does so, it is either to castigate his hypocritical audience (8:2, 10:3) or to supply them with words of repentance (6:1-3, 14:3-4), neither of which is true of the present passage (although the second person in 12:7 might be taken as a stylistic variation on the approach of 6:1-3 and 14:3-4).

Hos 13:2

While NET (drawing on the Massoretic text) renders the relevant part of this verse as, “There is a saying about them: ‘Those who sacrifice to the calf idol are calf kissers!’” This rendering, however, would seem to make criticism of calf-worship a commonplace, but the picture that the book as a whole presents is that such idolatry was widespread among the people (cf. also Steiner, 205, in Geller, Greenfield, Weitzman, ed. *Studia Aramaica*). An alternative approach to the Massoretic text is to see in it a reference to human sacrifice, but such is also unlikely (see NET 1692 n¹ and NAC 19A:248-49). Much better is the rendering (of the alternative reading found in the LXX and Vulgate) proposed by NAC (19A:248): “‘To these,’ they are saying, ‘sacrifice!’ / Humans kiss calves!” Such represents popular practice on the one hand and Hosea's biting analysis on the other.

Hos 13:4

Cf. THBS vol. 1 pp. 413-415 (including for the placement of the pause)

Hos 13:5

Either reading could have arisen out of the other due to a misreading of the text. As NAC (19A: 258 n²³¹) points out, M has the advantage of playing off תָּדַע in v4, but G “leads nicely into v. 6.” A decision is difficult, but the possibility that the scribe responsible for G was fatigued or a bit hurried in Hosea (there seems to be a relatively

high number of slips on the part on M in this book) inclines us toward the G reading. Ginsburg concurs.

{Post-script: Note that in the previous verse G was followed over M, so the principle of avoiding alternating sources might incline toward G here, though not definitively since both haplography (in v4) and *daleth/resh* confusion (here) are polygenetic.}

{Update: Note in favor of G כמרעיתם in v6 (alluded to in NAC?). KEL 106 points out the connection to Deut, but the verses there do not clearly favor one reading over the other here.}

Hos 13:15b

The reading of 4QXII^c seems to explain the others well (see BHQ 72*), though it is just possible (but notice the apparent close relationship between G and this MS, seen in 13:4, argues against this theory) that G reads ויבייש, which form would explain (via graphic confusion) the M ויבוש. On the intrinsic evidence, see NET (1693 n¹¹).

Hos 14:3

Corrupt dittography (of *yodh*) in a paleo script, facilitated by the expectation of such a cultic term after the verb של"ם (D stem).

Hos 14:8

The M does not make good sense and is explainable as a transcriptional error (the first *waw* having been lost due to the ending of the preceding ישוב and the second turning into a *yodh* due to the similarity of the letters).

Joel 2:23

The expression כראשון occurs elsewhere only in Lev 9:15, so M could be an assimilation to more common usage. The *kaph* reading, however, does not represent a common expression, though it does seem to be a favorite of Ezekiel's (Gen 8:13, Num 9:5, Eze 29:17, 30:20, 45:18, v21). The combination of a fairly even split in external evidence (notice the alignment of the Vulgate with G) and the ease with which *beith* and *kaph* are confused in some scripts make a decision difficult. Marginal reading?

Joel 4:11

See NICOT 107n⁷. The error clearly happened in the square script (*waw/yodh* confusion). This being the case, the origin of the suffix which seems most likely to me is corrupt dittography (*resh* → *resh*+final *kaph*) + insertion of a helping letter.

Amos 1:11

As BHQ (*79) points out, Job 16:9 provides a parallel for the טרף-root linked with אף as in the Massoretic MSS and the LXX. Yet as Ginsburg notes, Jer 3:5 would seem to support the נטר-root of the Syriac and Vulgate. Widespread adding of a *pe* here seems unlikely, but not impossible in that טרף is more common in the OT than נטר is. Yet is not clear why a final *pe* would apparently be dropped in two separate witnesses. NAC (19B: 55) favors the reading ויטרף, as does Davidson, NEB (but, against the analogy of Job 16:9, pointing ויטָרף), and NET. BHS, HALOT 1:380^a, and, tentatively, BDB 383^a favor the reading ויטר. External support places the former reading in the main text, but internal evidence (and non-negligible external support) earns the latter reading a place in the margin.

{Post-script: The Syriac penchant for easy and harmonizing readings makes it highly suspect. V is more valuable, yet in a subtle semantic matter it is difficult to give it great weight on its own. Thus, M should be retained as the safer option.} {Post-post-script: Also note in favor M the observation in J-M p413 n2}

Amos 2:16-3:1

See Pericope vol. 5, 128-29, 135.

Amos 3:10-11

This seems to be the pattern elsewhere in Amos for לכן (see Pericope vol. 5, 135-36).

Amos 4:7

The M reading could be due to the graphic similarity of *aleph* to *taw* in the script in which the scribe was working, or simply to assimilation to the grammatical person of the preceding verb תמטר (or possibly to the grammatical gender of the following תיבש).

Amos 5:12

So (among others) HALOT (1:30b). This is admittedly a bit bold in that it is not *certain* G so read, but the translator worked as if it did, and there is a good transcriptional explanation, viz. corrupt dittography of the *aleph* (cf. the closely related error elsewhere in MinP [Hos 10:9]) facilitated by the fact that the masculine noun הטא is much rarer than the feminine noun הטאת

Amos 5:26a

The M reading is probably dittography, forcing סכות (apparently a cultic tent) to be interpreted as the name of a false god (see BHQ *84).

Amos 5:26b

The G reading might represent an attempt to make sense out of a difficult passage. Yet M is so difficult (cf., for instance, NET 1715 n²⁵) that it might only reflect some error. Note as well the generally literal character of the LXX in the Book of the Twelve (THB 1B: 619^b; essay by Tov {citation needed} {{but see now NICOT *passim*}}). Perhaps the scribe responsibly for M missed כוכב אלהיכם at first (homoeoteleuton in combination with overlooking a word division?), then supplied it in the margin, whence this construct chain made its way to the wrong place. Assimilation could the change from צלמיכם to צלמיהם. On the other hand, if צלמיכם is allowed to be a majestic plural in apposition to כיון (despite the grammatical number of כוכב, also, according to M, evidently in apposition to כיון), sense can perhaps be wrested from M. The rendering of Ac 7:43 is not decisive, for NT authors are not picayune about wording where the general shape of a passage or doctrine is not affected; furthermore, the form of the citation in this case is surely interpretive (note especially Βαβυλῶνος). We adopt the G reading, but with a low degree of confidence.

Amos 6:12

M is unintelligible, and is explainable as a mistaken transcription of a rare word (cf. HALOT 1: 719).

Amos 6:14-7:1

See Pericope vol. 5 p. 136; both external evidence and intrinsic evidence (viz. consistency of authorial/editorial style) suggest the adjustments to L here and in 7:3-4, 7:6-7, and 7:17-8:1.

Amos 7:1

HALOT (1:429a) suggests (tentatively, it seems) reading יצר, which seems to underlie OG. In most cases, a *participle* (rather than a noun) follows והנה in Amos, and the five words of the present verse define הלקש rather than constitute a parallel to the first והנה statement of the verse. So, a participle seems preferable; yet the evident G reading יצר is—when pointed as in M(T)—slightly preferable since it is defective (cf. the Job Q fragment).

Amos 8:8a

Auditory error; cf. BDB (which KEL refers the reader to).

Amos 8:8b

Cf. 9:5 (so BHQ *87).

Amos 8:11

The external support for the singular is strong, and the plural is readily taken as dittography (note the following

(יהוה).

Amos 9:6-7

See Pericope vol. 5, esp. 127, 128 ad fin through 129 top; also 136.

Ob 1:15

See the comments on Pr 12:14.

Mic 2:12

A difficult case (cf., e.g., J-M on this verse), but MT seems impossible, while a rare but *not* impossible transcriptional cause presents itself (to my mind, at least), viz. that the scribe, having written בְּתוֹךְ, expected הַדָּבָר when in fact the form was דְּבָרִי, and, having prefixed the article, failed to cancel it after he later encountered the possessive suffix (or else a later scribe overlooked or did not understand the cancellation marks). Alternative approaches are corrupt dittography of the resh or transposition of a plene hdwbr. (The OG translator has, as often in the Greek tradition, been loose with the grammatical number of the suffix, rendering in conformity with his earlier αὐτῶν.)

Mic 3:10

Auditory error, perhaps facilitated by assimilation to Hab 2:12. (An alternative explanation [Renz to Hab, p. 314] is that the redactor of MinP added Hab 2:12 to Mic 3:10 in order to compare the wicked Judahite rulers with the Babylonians without regard for the plurals in the context. But I am not at this point convinced of editorial interventions, of this kind at least, by the editor of MinP; even if there was, the importation differs in other details, so why bother to make those changes and not adjust בְּנֵי to בְּנֵה? This is also quite a subtle psychoanalysis of the editor IMO.)

Mic 5:5

NICOT and WBC (is one borrowing from the other?) seems to give the incorrect form; rather than transposition, as they say, is seems to be a loss of *taw* after *chet*.

Mic 6:9-10

“Listen, O tribe! And who is he who will summon [i.e., please summon] the city.”

Mic 6:16-17

See collation data in Pericope vol. 1 p. 176 n¹⁸.

Nah 1:4

BHS proposes דָּלֵל, but note the singular in the LXX and the fact that the syntax allows for a singular דָּלֵל (cf. grammars on singular verb + singular noun + *waw* + noun). *Aleph* and *daleth* could be confusable in some paleo scripts, making the words look similar; also, anticipation of אֲמַלֵּל later in the verse might led to accidental assimilation. The form דָּלֵל would preserve the acrostic – if there is one to be preserved; the meter does not seem to be as regular as other acrostics (cf. *PPP*). Note that ολιγοσ elsewhere in MinP translates אֲמַלֵּל, and that the translation of the same Hebrew word by two Greek words in a short context would be a strong argument (apart from inner-Hebrew transcriptional considerations) for two different Hebrew words only in a hyper-literal book, which MinP, though fairly literal, is not.

On balance, comparison with the metrical regularity of acrostics elsewhere is not favorable to דָּלֵל, and it is not certain that the OG so read anyway.

{Post-script: But see now NICOT, with extensive discussion of the acrostic scattered across several pages, but especially noteworthy here is p73. The evidence for a (half-) acrostic (plus a preface spelling ANY YHWH) is so compelling, and the OG evidence ameliorated by Renz's observations, that the דָּלֵל reading should be accepted, though a marginal reading of M might not be out of place.}

Nah 3:17

Corrupt dittography (so HALOT 1: 182a, BDB, some others, though other commentators [including BHQ, but it takes a great deal to convince Gelston to prefer something to MT] demur), specifically *waw/yodh* confusion + transposition, facilitated by the rarity of the terminology.

Hab 1:5a

See esp. KEL, noting also that it is strange that the audience would be told to look to the nations, when in fact only *one* nation (that of the Chaldeans) is the object of concern (though admittedly many nations fell under their power [v10]).

Hab 1:5b

Re תָּמוּהָ, for the grammar cf. Ges 113w. Intrinsic evidence between M and G seems pretty evenly split: Cf. Isa 29:9, which might support M, but the first verb is different, and there is a conjunction on the second there; Habakkuk does *not* seem to like to juxtapose two imperatives without a conjunction intervening (a partial exception is 2:19, but there chiasm is at work, and more importantly perhaps there is a line break intervening between the imperatives); to judge by a search for infinitive absolutes in Psalms (via BibleWorks9), the use of the infinitive absolute is rare (but not unheard of, and moreover its rarity would be increase the chance for a scribal slip-up); the use of juxtaposed imperatives line-finally seems strange (though not unheard of, e.g. Gen 29:7); excepting with the verbs קוּם or הֵלֵךְ, the double imperative is rare in poetry (outside SS and Isa). There might be assonance between תָּמוּהָ and פָּעַל; Habakkuk seems to really like sound-plays, based on just vv5-6. In the end, the fairly high density of errors in M from Nah 3:17-Hab 2:17 suggests (though does not demand, so a marginal reading would be a good idea) preferring G here.

Hab 2:4

Re הֵן הָעֵלֶף, see KEL, confirmed by HALOT, on the meaning of the root עָלַף, and quite possibly on the use of literary metathesis (cf. *Metathesis in the Hebrew Bible* passim; I have not checked that work to see if this particular instance is cited). See BHQ on the textual metathesis across a word division, with it noted that, even if OG understood a *hoph'al*, the verb would seem to be *hiph'il*. The *he* in the MT form of the verb is admittedly a bit hard to explain; perhaps mechanical assimilation to הֵנָּה after that error occurred, metathesis from its word-initial position (in which case perhaps הֵן to הֵנָּה is not wrong word division, but rather accidental substitution of a more common [in the Bible] word for a less common [in the Bible] word), or mechanical anticipation of יִשְׁרָה. The confusion pertaining to whose נַפֶּשׁ is in view (see immediately below) might be related.

{Post-script: Re הֵנָּה, Habakkuk uses this form several times elsewhere, but never הֵן. However, it is a short work, so statistics of this kind are hardly definitive. The style reminds me of Job (cf. NICOT on 2:1), and in Job the author uses *both* forms. So here both forms are intrinsically plausible. Transcriptional considerations then become paramount, and here we have the facts (1) that הֵן is the rarer form by far, (2) that wrongful word division occurs in M nearby (1:17), and that (3) a misplacement of a *he* also plays into the next word. Speaking of that word, הָעֵלֶף is a good guess in some ways, but the absence of a subject is, in the present context, quite difficult (cf. WBC). So tentatively I repoint the form just posited הָעֵלֶף, even though the qal of this root is not attested – the *hiph'il* occurs only once, and the derived stems do not often occur without a qal. This solution is lexically speculative, then, but not wildly so, and surely the “text has suffered in transmission” (this is an inexact quote of WBC). A translation is in order (on which cf. also the research notes for this verse): “Behold, as for the one who acts heedlessly [viz. of the prophecy in v3], his soul is not [up]right within it; but the righteous one by his faith [in God] will live.”}

Hab 2:5a

See BHQ on the external evidence. It is difficult to be certain, but G is probably correct, there being a rich irony in that the destruction which keeps the Chaldean constantly busy will deceive him. M is probably a transcriptional error influenced by the fact that הוּא in the singular is not common.

Hab 2:5c

Transposition explains the error most readily (though assimilation is not impossible). Note that **הלוא** occurs a number of times in MinP (including in Hab), and **כלוא** occurs in Ob 16.

Hab 3:16a

Admittedly the retroversion of OG is not quite certain (NICOT-Renz), but BHQ thinks so. NICOT-Robertson, who seems rarely to depart from MT, prefers this reading, and errors certainly occur elsewhere when *yodh* and *resh* come into contact.

Zeph 2:11

Haplography after **כי**. On the intrinsic evidence, cf. NICOT-Renz (542 nⁱⁱ), though he opts for a different solution (less convincing to my mind).

Zeph 2:14a

While Walters (189) thinks OG is being inventive, I wonder whether G *did* read **גיא** (a variation on **חיתו שדה** reminiscent of the kind of variations characteristic of the book of Samuel).

In 3:6 (which Walters also mentions on the same page), perhaps G read **גאים** or perhaps the translator *thought* he saw this; either way, we need not assume (O)G to be correct in this latter instance, but need to consider whether in either case assimilation to G-2:14 helps explain the slip. (For another instance of the opposite error occurring in M and G, see 1 Ki 1:18, 20.)

Also explaining the error is the similarity of *aleph* and *gimmel* in the paleo script. Note also that the lexeme **גי** occurs twice earlier in this chapter, inviting assimilation. According to Muraoka, **גן** does not elsewhere translate **גיא**, but it does render a huge range of words, including **שדה**. Also, Muraoka seems not to list this passage, suggesting his doubts about the equivalence. BDB does cite this verse, but the one and only parallel they offer for it is not convincing. Finally, note the error in M later in this same verse.

Zeph 2:14b

Auditory error and/or assimilation to **חלון**. Cf. NICOT-Renz, BDB (addenda).

Zeph 3:18

As NET (1783 n⁸) notes, “[a]ny translation [or text-critical solution] to this difficult verse must be provisional at best.” Yet here is our provisional solution: “Those who mourn because of [the loss of the celebration of] the appointed time[s] I will gather [into my fold] – [though] they were shattered [remnants], tributing being upon them as a reproch [to their honor as God's people.]” The concessive clause picks up on the observation of Geiger (in: *Advances in Biblical Hebrew Linguistics*, 173ff) that a *waw*-less clause not *startig* with a verb often provides a comment (either by Zephaniah, interrupting his first-person recitation or representation of God's feelings and intent, or, less likely, by the editor who compiled the Book of the Twelve); such an understanding arguably makes the verse intelligible, if still difficult (which itself helps to account for the LXX's attempts to make sense of it), and keeps the focus on restoration. The NET solution distinguishes between exiles and returnees, and this distinction seems to be foreign to the context; even if the distinction is there, the NET rendering lacks coherence, for the words preceding the m-dash seem to speak of the exiles positively, while the following words treat them negatively (If vv12-13 are taken to distinguish such groups, Zephaniah's analysis of the exiles is not positive.) The NICOT-Robertson solution (“from you they originated”) is probably not the best solution; it is unclear what a Jerusalemite origin does for the argument, while a reference to their being struck down prepared the way for v19. The NIV/NAC solution seem to overlook the participial nature of the word **בוגי**.

{Post-script: In response to NICOT-Renz, the verb here, at least in the niph'al as it must be, is one of grief, not wickedness; the use of the root **אסף** might indeed be connected in a literary way to the opening of Zephaniah's prophecy, but by way of *reversal*.

That said, I do accept Renz's rendering of Zeph 3:19.}

Zeph 3:20a

The form אֲבִיא occurs a number of times in the OT. The form אָטִיב, however, occurs nowhere else, and the high'fil of this verb is extremely rare. Visual confusion is not unlikely (only one letter, and that not the first, affected). Thus it seems probable that an early scribe, working a bit too quickly perhaps, thought he saw אֲבִיא and failed to check his work.

Zech 6:13a

G (and/or P) could be condensation or homoeoteleuton, but while the LXX in MinP is fairly literal, doublets are not an unknown phenomenon even in a reliable text (see Janzen re G-Jer), and the M scribe might well have been fatigued (especially if one of the unintentional explanations is accepted in the case of 6:13b below), such that a faulty dittography could occur here (see the end of the previous verse).

Zech 6:13b

M could be an assimilation to the על כִּסֵּאוֹ earlier in the verse, an assimilation to common usage (forms of כִּסֵּא being more common in the OT than forms of יִמִּין), or a theological reading (elevating the priesthood). G is much harder to explain and so is probably original.

Some commentators try to make the king and the priest in this prophecy the same person. The G reading would make this impossible, but even on the M reading this interpretation is quite implausible to our mind: “The counsel of peace shall be between them both” can hardly refer to the kingly and priestly *offices* (so {}), for no terminology to this effect is found in the text (indeed, the king is quite specifically a certain individual, who alone will construct the place of God's worship), and it is extremely strange to say that peace will exist between them because they will be *the same person* (so KEL).

Zech 8:12

Following HALOT (1:283a). It is possible that אֵם is an addition, clarifying the adversative sense of כִּי, or that the OG is translating כִּי according to the sense. But OG-MinP is fairly literal, the *Vorlage* is not vastly different, and above all there is a transcriptional factor: I have elsewhere found that errors tend to occur where a string of letters from an ABA pattern, here אֵם אֲזַרְעָה שְׁלוֹם (the word divisions here would not sufficiently clearly marked in any case, as is shown in the error ...r'h vlvwm → r' hvlwm). Alternatively or in addition, the eye might have jumped from *yodh* to *zayin*.

Mal 3:16

As BHQ (152*) notes, אֵל in appropriate here (see *ibid* for the details; Ex 33:11 is an exception), and M^A, M^C, and, according to Kennicott, virtually all other MSS besides L (he records one for על) have it. The word אֵת is both similar to אֵל in form and sometimes meaning, and frequently occurs inbetween אִישׁ and רֵעֵהוּ, though not with the sense required here. L is simply a mistake (one common word for another, similar in form and sound).

Introduction to the Psalms

We must address a few issues relating to the text of the Psalter – meter, the superscriptions, the arrangement of the text of the page, and divisions in the Psalter.

Meter

See the first two chapters of Freedman's *Pottery, Poetry, and Prophecy* for arguments that there are basically two types of poetry, one based on parallelism (this is the more frequent of the two), and one based on meter and often incorporated an acrostic scheme as well.

Superscription

The second issue can be dispensed with quickly. Critics might question the superscriptions for various reasons, but the external evidence for their existence is overwhelming. One may speculate whether they come from the

hand of the various poets, of the compilers of the early collections later incorporated into the canonical Psalter (see below), or of the final compiler, but they are certainly canonical.

As for the third issue, {discuss from THB, etc.}

Number of Psalms

The fourth issue is complex. There are two types of psalm-divisions, namely the five books and the variation units concerning precisely where a psalm begins.

The book “is divided into five books: Pss. 1-41; 42-72; 73-89; 90-106; and 107-50, each of which concludes with a doxology” (NICOT 25). Evidence from the LXX, Qumran, and the midrash all support this division (*ibid.*, 26). Both the textual critic and the exegete ought to bear these divisions in mind.

Among the variation units concerning where a psalm begins are as follows: {Check V and P on the following units} Some Massoretic MSS and the LXX fail to commence at a new psalm at 10:1, and thus psalms 9 and 10 are, as far as these witnesses are concerned, one psalm, not two; 27 MSS (Davidson) join 70-71 (but Ginsburg 1908 “many”); some MSS (46 according to Davidson; but Ginsburg 1908 “many”) have psalms 42 and 43 as a single psalm, and a range of witnesses (Ginsburg 1908 “many”) have 114 and 115 as a single psalm; 116:10 is the beginning of a new psalm in some witnesses; some MSS conjoin 117 with the preceding psalm, some with the following, and at least one (so Ginsburg, *Liber Psalmorum*) with both (3 MSS, according to Davidson, omit it entirely!); 34 MSS (the number comes from Davidson; but Ginsburg 1908 “many”) begin a new psalm at 118:5; the LXX begins a new psalm at 147:12.

One type of intrinsic evidence that can assist in deciding these cases is the frequency with which psalms, and a pair of consecutive psalms in particular, are placed beside one another owing to a catchword or catchphrase, conceptual parallel, or other point in common. For example, Psalms 103 and 104 are united by ברכי ה' while Psalms 3 and 4 both speak of sleep. Three psalms are united by having יהוה כי טוב at or near the beginning (105-107), and there are larger collections as well, such as the royal psalms (95-99) and the psalms of ascent (120-134).

Bringing this consideration to bear on the question of psalm divisions, psalms 111-118 all end with הללו יה except for 114. Many MSS, some important like L {and A?}, however, join 115 with 114, such that every psalm in this collection *does* end thus. On the other hand Constable quotes VanGemen (719) thus: “[T]here is little doubt that they form two separate psalms. The motifs and genre of the psalms are too different. Psalm 114 is in the form of a hymn describing the wonder of Israel's redemption from Egypt, whereas the literary forms of Psalm 115 are quite varied and include lament, liturgy, and confidence.” To the extent that the assessment of 115 as “varied” is correct, such would tend to allow of combination with 114. The unexpected shift from the end of the one to the beginning of the other might have led to the separation of 114 and 115 in one or more witnesses. The deliberate combination of them is hard to envision, though admittedly accidental combination or separation is likely in at least most cases of variation. The external evidence in any case is strong (Davidson: 71 MSS – according to Kennicott there are 272 MSS for Ps, of 71 is 26%, surely a significant number given the MS European Jewry must have experienced during the Crusades, Black Death, and so on, especially given that among this sizeable minority is L {and A?} – the LXX, P, V, Arabic, and Ethiopic {are there indications in the Massorah?}); a case for the two-psalm reading is hard to sustain on external grounds, and internal evidence does seem to corroborate this assessment.

The variation concerning 116 is similarly resolvable, for a new psalm at 116:10 would interrupt the הללו יה set just mentioned. Moreover, similar spellings prevail across the psalm, a circumstance strongly suggestive of unity.

Similar again is 147:12. Psalms 146-150 all begin and end with הללו יה; commencing a new psalm would go against this scheme on both counts (on only one with the LXX plus at the head of v12 is accepted, but this is quite tenuous given similar G readings elsewhere in Ps and still leaves the end of v11 anomalous). Moreover, as with 116 stylistic similarities would seem to bind the psalm together.

In the case of psalms 9 and 10, however, such considerations are not conclusive. The phrase לעזות בצרה occurs in 9:10 and 10:1, so we could have two psalms in a pair; on the other hand, a single psalm could have a recurring phrase – still, the first option seems stronger than the second in that the phrase is not part of a refrain.

So far, the case favors the two-psalm reading. Yet the psalm (if the one-psalm reading is correct) could be an acrostic, and given the complexities of this and other acrostics, scribes are unlikely to have tried to create an acrostic artificially. On the other hand, the difficulties in reconstructing this acrostic are numerous (but see below in the commentary on psalm 9), and the possibility exists of two psalms set side by side because each was partially acrostic (or, more specifically, because one begins and the other ends with an acrostic run). Note the parallel in Nah 1, where a reasonably clear acrostic runs to *kaph* but then ends there – just where psalm 9 leaves off! Moreover, depending on how one understands the versional evidence of Nah 1:4b, and how one tries to reconstruct the acrostic of Ps 9, Nah 1 might have in common with Ps 9 the absence precisely of the letter *daleth*, making the parallel all the more striking (see on Nah 1:4 elsewhere). The lack of a superscription for ps 10 is anomalous in that in Book I psalms 3-41 (the end of the book) all have a superscription except for 33 (where G and V add a superscription; 10 MSS according to Davidson conjoin 33 with 32). (Might V be especially influenced by the LXX in Ps do to Jerome's earlier work in that translation? {Yet some of this impression is due to using the BibleWorks VUL module, which appears to have the Gallican Psalter – see, e.g., 71:1 (=LXX 70:1).}) Yet assuming for the moment that the minus in 33:1 is correct, such an anomaly as 10 being without a superscription is tolerable, and the run of superscriptions is so great that scribes might have consciously or unconsciously united these two psalms on the expectation that the next psalm after 9 would begin with a superscription. (There are strong parallels to the case of 42-43 here, on which see below.) G does not seem to be a very reliable text in Ps, particularly with regard to structural matters (superscriptions, presence and placement of הללו יה, and divisions). The plus in 33:1 might *possibly* be defended on the basis of the visual similarity between the first letter of רננו and the last letter of לדוד, but this seems a great stretch and would not explain many other pluses in G; a possibility more worthy of consideration is the accidental skipping-over of a line in M[T?] due to a stichometric exemplar. In favor of a stichometric exemplar in M: This scenario might explain the puzzling plus in 13:6. Note that the combination of the verb זמר with the verb ידה is strikingly Davidic, occurring in Ps 7:18 (admittedly, that verse is potentially the source for the G/LXX plus), 18:50(//2 Sam 22:50), 30:5, v13, 57:10, 71:22, 108:4, 138:1; the only other examples are Ps 92:2 and (!) 33:2. {It may be vital to look into stichometric MSS for the Psalms – how old is the tradition and what are its characteristics? See THB-Ps and references there as needed.} Links between psalms 9 and 11 or 8 and 10 are hard to find. The closest I can find is כסאו with reference to God in 9:8 and 11:4, but the לעתות בצרה linkage seems stronger. Constable says this: “The Septuagint translators evidently combined Psalms 9 and 10 for two reasons. First, together they complete a somewhat modified acrostic in which each verse (almost) begins with the succeeding letter of the Hebrew alphabet. Second, the same unusual terms and the same basic structure occur in both psalms, suggesting that they may have been linked originally (e.g., “in times of trouble,” 9:9 and 10:18; “the nations,” 9:5, 15, 17, 19-20 and 10:16; and a closing emphasis on man's mortality, 9:20 and 10:18). In spite of these similarities, the differences between Psalms 9 and 10 justify their separation. Each psalm is complete in itself and has its own purpose. Psalm 9 is a positive song of thanksgiving, whereas Psalm 10 is a negative complaint and petition dealing with the godless. Psalm 9 is very national, but Psalm 10 is very personal. Both psalms are individual laments.” (We suppose the LXX one-psalm reading to have originated in the *Vorlage*, not with the translators, who are quite literal.) According to Davidson, only 4 MSS support the one-psalm reading, indicating that that reading is hardly the original MT reading and not likely the original M reading. G could still be correct in its one-psalm reading, however.

Another difficult case is 118:1-4, for on the one hand, external support for the two-psalm reading seems quite weak (34 MSS according to Davidson), yet that reading creates a pair of psalms balanced by a recurring phrase (see v1 and v29), rather like psalms 1-2. On the other hand, this could be the refrain of a single psalm. Ps 118 is part of the “Egyptian Hallel,” so perhaps a popular liturgy might have affected the transmission of the text, making a move to a single psalm polygenetic. {P and V could be important here for early M text.} A similar number (20 acc. to Davidson) wrongly (see above on 115 and on 116) begin a new psalm at 115:12, and a perusal of Kennicott suggests that scatterings of MSS in support of either joining or separating psalms is in fact rather common. (Indeed, Davidson mentions 14 MSS for a new psalm in v25, and 10 MSS for a new psalm in v26!) Thus only large numbers of MSS or important MSS or strong versional evidence should merit close consideration, and such appears not to be the case here.

Regarding 42-43: Most(?) commentators favor a single psalm, but “[t]he common refrains in Psalms 42 and 43 certainly provide justification for considering the two psalms as a single unit, but a significant difference between them provides a compelling argument for regarding them as distinct compositions. In Psalm 42 the psalmist is speaking to the inmost being... but in Psalm 43 the psalmist is speaking to God. Therefore, we should consider the possibility that the common refrains may have prompted the the collectors of the Korahite songs to place these similar psalms side by side, but not necessarily that they were at one time a single psalm” (NICOT 404). Psalms 84-88 constitute another Korahite run, with a Davidic interruption (86). This line of thought accords well with the fact that external support for the one-psalm reading is quite slim. (Constable is noncommittal regarding 42-43.) There is some disagreement among the witnesses of the Vulgate as to whether that version has a superscription for Ps 43: L has *dauid*, and FΣ has *psalmus dauid*. Neither reading is likely correct, for (1) the bulk of the MS tradition is behind the lack of a superscription, (2) a scan of *Biblia Sacra Vulgata* does not suggest that the witnesses constantly had trouble with the superscriptions, (3) the *psalmus dauid* reading could come from the Gallican Psalter, and (4) FLΣ all seem to add similar material elsewhere (see, in the Vulgate, psalms 32 and 37). We must confess that we are not well-versed in Vulgate textual criticism, but the short reading seems preferable there, and this fact adds to the evidence for a lack of a superscription in the original M text. In Book II psalm 43 would be the only psalm lacking a superscription except for 71, which a handful of MSS conjoin to 70 and to which the LXX adds a superscription. The predominance of superscriptions in Book II (and Book I before it) could have lead scribes consciously or unconsciously to expect that the next psalm would begin with a superscription. As mentioned, psalms 9-10 and 42-43 have this phenomenon in common. Inasmuch as the non-L readings in 33:1 and 70:1 are both tenuous, it would appear that the compiler of the several books did not necessarily object to some items in the collection not having superscriptions (indeed, such is certainly the case for Book I, unless psalms 1-2 are interpreted as themselves the introduction to Book I or the Psalter as whole, as some interpreters argue, or psalms 1 and 2 are conjoined with a handful of MSS or psalm 2 is given a superscription with G).

Partial Rewrite of the above: Starting with anomalies of book:

Book I (1-41): (Apart from 1 and 2) all psalms ascribe David authorship except 9 (wrong division?) and 33 (line loss?)

Book II (42-72): All psalms ascribe some authorship except 43 (wrong division?), 66 (see below, “Note on 66:1”), 67 (homoeoteleuton?), and 71 (line loss? wrong division?)

Book III (73-90): *All* psalms ascribe some authorship

Book IV (91-106): All psalms ascribe some authorship except 91 (line loss), 92 (see “Note on 66:1”), 93 (line loss?), 94 (line loss?), 95 (line loss?), 96 (line loss?), 97 (line loss?), 98 (homoeoteleuton?), 99 (line loss?), 101?, 102?, 104 (line loss?), 105 (no VU), 106 (no VU)

Book V (107-150): *Only* 108, 109, 110, 122, 124, 127, 131, 133, 138-145 ascribe authorship

Note on 66:1: BHS lists no relevant VU, and psalms division does not come into play here, but Gottingen lists some OL evidence for adding one to the OG text, apparently at the beginning of the psalm. The trouble is that such could be an inner-latin or inner-greek corruption, especially as, at least in Greek, there is no clear transcriptional explanation for the loss of τω δ(αυει)δ there, unless such was written on a line separate from the rest of the superscription (such is *not* the practice of 01). The situation is similar in 92:1.

General note: “Ascribing authorship” is *not* the same thing as “having a superscription.” Some of the psalms listed above as not having authorship *do* have a superscription, or textual evidence for such somewhere in the tradition. *Important instances in this regard are 66 and 67.*

It is possible that books I and II originally had superscriptions throughout (except 1 and 2), but trying to get book IV to have this feature looks desperate, and indeed is impossible to do from documentary evidence for 105 and 106 (perhaps they are a sort of chiasm to 1 and 2, but this seems quite a stretch). Moreover, most readings that add an ascription can readily (not certainly, but readily) be explained as assimilating pluses, especially given the witnesses in which they tend to occur (chiefly OG).

The best approach might be to go on a case by case basis (e.g., the intrinsic evidence for joining 9 and 10 is strong), but there is an argument to be made for a book-by-book (viz. book I, book II, etc.) basis also – that is, since book I is nearly complete, perhaps the VU in 33:1 should be read in this light. Also, there do seem to be

sets / run of similar superscriptions or of authors (e.g. Asaph) provides a measure of intrinsic evidence. Is, then, line loss in 104 be considered? Taking a related approach, might the superscription for 95 been lost because of the run of preceding psalms that lacked a superscription? This seems possible but strained; the datum from Heb is hard to weigh, since the author makes a point of Davidic authorship but probably was using the OG.

Postscript to the above section (starting with “partial rewrite”): See the notes below on 33:1, 43:1, and 71:1; it appears, in short, fully reasonable to posit that, once transmissional vicissitudes are accounted for, Books I, II, and III all (apart from the introductory psalms 1 and 2; cf. on 33:1 and the secondary literature) had superscriptions throughout. As far as Books IV and V, it is, due to the position and content of these books – and Qumran evidence *might* point in this direction as well (see e.g. Flint at length – probable that these psalters are later as collections than the first three, and it becomes not improbable, though admittedly hard to prove (but might the OG lack of “the words of Jeremiah” and possibly of “the song of songs which is Solomon's” point in this direction?), that the use of superscriptions was falling out of fashion at that time.

Returning to number of psalms, above it was stated: “psalms 111-118 all end with הללו יה except for 114.” This is partially in error: 111-113 *begin* with the phrase; 113 *begins and ends* thus. (G shifts that which terminates 113 to the beginning of 114, but this is part of larger chain of variation.) Arguably, with 113 the pattern shifts to הללו יה at the beginning of the psalm, such that 114 is not anomalous in a way that its being joined to 115 would help, unless we also shift the termination of 113 forward. (Against the combination of 114 and 115 on intrinsic grounds, see Allen in WBC.) Another option is to reject most G shifts of הללו יה, as well as its addition of the phrase in 119:1, but to posit the originality of the position at the head of 114, explaining the other VUs as an assimilation to the 111-114 pattern of psalm-initial notes (plus an extension of this into 119, perhaps prompted by an aversion of psalms without superscriptions). In this case, 113 would not be anomalous in beginning and ending with the phrase, and 114 would not be anomalous in lacking it altogether; 111-114 would form a set of four initial hallelujahs, 115-118 of four final hallelujahs. A convincing case indeed.

On LXX-Ps as likely having been translated in Egypt, see Pietersma, Albert, “The Place and Origin of the Greek Psalter,” 252-74 in: *The World of the Aramaeans: Biblical Studies in Honor of Paul-Eugène Dion*, ed. P. M. Michèle Daviau, John W. Weavers, and Michael Weigl, 1/3, Sheffield Academic Press, Chippenham, Wiltshire, England, 2001

Concerning acrostics, cf. Peckham, Brian, “Phoenicians and Aramaeans: The Literary and Epigraphic Evidence,” 22, in *World of the Aramaeans*, vol. 2/3

Ps 2:7

Gruber (*Marbeh Hokmah*, Hurowitz memorial volume, p276-277; VP library) thinks אל here (and in a few other places) has the meaning of תא, but I prefer to follow the OG, thinking M(T) a visual error facilitated by auditory similarity (at least in some dialects) and by anticipation of אלי later in the verse.

Ps 4:3

G reads rightly: “How long, o sons of me? / Stubborn people, why do you love falsehood? / [Stubborn people, why do you] seek a lie?” M, difficult to make sense of, is probably an attempt to reconstruct a broken exemplar, involving misreading letters, false word divisions, and the (accidental, most likely) addition of a helping letter.

Ps 6:11

M is most likely due to haplography.

Ps 7:1

The version could reflect an interpretive rendering, but for so many of them, and Aquilla in particular, to do so seems unlikely. The M reading could simply be an oversight of a single letter or an unconscious recollection of the place name. This is a rare case where impressive external evidence overrules MT where a clear transcriptional trigger is lacking. In OT, the personal name כוש is rare, but it is found a good number of times in

the inscriptions. Contrast the situation in later Hebrew (sketched in Jastrow).

Ps 7:3

Metrical considerations seem to favor M (compare the next couple of verses), though this is hardly certain, and it is possible that the reading found in the LXX is an emendation based on misunderstanding of the root פָּרַק owing to the Aramaic prayers with which a tradent (we use “tradent” in this commentary to mean “copyist or translator”) was familiar. On the other hand, Lam 5:8 provides a parallel for G, and the word אֵין could have been lost to oversight. Indeed, M seems to have several errors in this psalm (see the other comments on chapter 7 here), and David combines אֵין with וְאֵין several other times (19:4, 86:8, 142:5, 144:14). The long reading is adopted with hesitation.

Ps 7:5

Given the similarity of the two words in question, it is difficult to be certain what the LXX translated. Yet given the possibility that M transposes in two nearby variation units (see the comments on v10 and especially 8:2) and the apparent damage M has suffered here (see on v1 and 6:10) we tentatively adopt Ginsburg's suggestion. (Kraus prefers M for intrinsic reasons, but does accept the G retroversion.)

Ps 7:10b

G seems sometimes to fail to understand the *waw* conjunction when it is a near synonym of כִּי, so M seems preferable in that it is the harder reading without obvious transcriptional cause. On the other hand, it is possible that it is a transcriptional error, the *beth* and the *waw* (if the word is *plene*) having been transposed. This variation unit, like others in Ps 7, is difficult. Curiously, the Vulgate does not seem to read as BHS claims, rather supporting M.

Ps 8:4

The M tradition is divided: P (following Leiden; Ginsburg probably follows one of the infamously faulty printed editions of P) M^{AC}, VDH, and the Eastern school (following Ginsburg) have a singular, while V T M^L and the Western school have a plural (Davidson also cites the Arabic). G has the plural (εργα).

Of the commentaries that comment, WBC prefers the singular, while NICOT prefers the plural.

Davidson prefers the singular. NEB does not comment, but I'm unsure of the base text; likewise Oort. BHK and BHS register no opinion. Watson does not directly comment.

It is hard to say whether במְעִשֵׁי יָדַי in v7 supplies grist for assimilation, or intrinsic support for a plural. (Looking at WTM מַעֲשֵׂה יָד, “work” occurs in the singular much more often than it occurs in the plural, though there are exceptions. Davidic psalms attest to both variations.) The following אֶצְבְּעֹתַי might have occasioned assimilation, but such is far from certain, especially in light of the many instances of מַעֲשֵׂה יָדַי mentioned already. Aural error surely contributed to the confusion, though in which direction is hard to say.

In the end we appeal to external evidence: While P-Psalms is not a very helpful witness, M^A and the Eastern school over against M^L and the Western school seems more reliable.

Pss 9-10: Proposals for Reconstructing the Acrostic

Without very radical conjectures, it is impossible to reconstruct an entire alphabet with each member spaced at a regular interval. However, given the variability of Hebrew poetry in general and of acrostics in general, these are not desiderata. The letters *aleph-gimmel*, *zayin-lamedh*, and *qof-taw* are readily apparent; the other letters will be discussed in paragraphs below. {Commentaries not fully cross-referenced yet; BHS particularly influential on my thinking}

Daleth: This letter is either (1) to be counted as deliberately passed over or (2) is the *last* letter of וַעַד in 9:6. {This idea comes, at least in part, from the JHS article on acrostics in Book I.}

He: Probably הָאֵיב in 9:7.

Waw: Probably וַיְהוּה in 9:8, if not וְהוּא in v9 or the beginning of one of the next two verses.

Mem: For הָלַל in 10:3 we should probably read מְהַלֵּל, though admittedly it is difficult to account for the

loss of the *mem* (the form מהלל occurs thrice elsewhere; הלל twice elsewhere) and this scenario requires that the initial כּי not count for the purposes of the acrostic (a plausible position, if Watts is correct that that word often does not count for metrical considerations). For the purpose of parallelism, מברך should become מברך (assuming corrupt haplography in the herodian script in M). {Post-script: the error could be explained as remote corrupt haplography in the paleo script with the *kaph* of כּי, ignoring the common letter *yodh*.}

Nun: With the LXX, נאץ should become the start of the next line.

Samekh: (With BHS?) we should probably read סרו for מרום in 10:5, assuming graphic error in M (mem/samekh confusion + dittography of the mem with which the next word starts).

Ayin: One possibility is that the *ayin* is the last letter (cf. on *daleth* above) in עת in v5, in which case the approach to *samekh* above would probably need to be revised, unless the sequence *ayin-samekh* is tolerable. A similar option (without the sequence issue) is ברע in 10:6. Best, however, is with BHS to regroup the lines such that עיניו in v8 starts a line.

Pe: Just possibly this letter is to be found in at the beginning of the word פניו in 10:11, but such seems unlikely.

Tsadhe: Difficult to find; probably to be considered left out by the author.

Summing up: Once textual criticism has had its chance (as it should!), and allowing for considerable diversity in spacing between letters, most of the alphabet is reasonably secure. Quite questionable is *daleth*; probably missing are *pe* and *tsadde*.

{later update, based on Freedman's *PPP*}

The meter and stanzas seem very regular, as is the pattern in other acrostics. Here is my scan (comments appear afterward):

אוֹדָה יְהוָה בְּכָל־לֵבִי²
אֶסְפְּרָה כָּל־נִפְלְאוֹתָיו:
אֲשַׁמְחָה וְאֶעֱלֶזָּה בָּךְ³
אֲזַמְרָה שִׁמְךָ עֲלִיּוֹן:

בְּשׁוּב־אוֹיְבֵי אֱהוּר⁴
יִפְשְׁלוּ וַיֵּאבְדּוּ מִפְּנֵיךָ:
כִּי־עָשִׂיתָ מִשְׁפָּטִי וְדִינִי⁵
יִשְׁבְּתָה לְכֹסֶא שׁוֹבֵט אֶדְנִי:

גָּעַרְתָּ גּוֹיִם אֲבֹדְתָה רָשָׁע⁶
שָׁמַם מְלִיכָתָה לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד:
הָאֵלִיבֹ תִּמּוֹ תִּרְבּוֹת לִנְצַח וְעַרִים נִתְּשָׁתָּ⁷
אֲבָד זִכְרָם הָמָּה:

הִיְהוָה לְעוֹלָם יֵשֶׁב⁸
כּוֹנֵן לַמִּשְׁפָּט כְּסֵאוֹ:
וְהוּא יִשְׁפֹּט־תִּבְלָל בְּצִדְקָה⁹
יִדְּרֹן לְאַמִּים בְּמִישְׁרִים:

וַיְהִי יְהוָה מִשְׁגֵּב לְדָךְ¹⁰
מִשְׁגֵּב לְעֵתוֹת בְּצָרָה:
וַיִּבְטְחוּ בָּךְ יוֹדְעֵי שִׁמְךָ¹¹
כִּי לֹא־עֲזָבְתָה דֹרְשֵׁיךָ יְהוָה:

זָמְרוּ לַיהוָה יֵשֶׁב צִיּוֹן¹²
הִגִּידוּ בְּעַמִּים עֲלִילוֹתֶיךָ:
כִּי־דִרְשׁ דָּמִים אוֹתָם זָכָר¹³
לֹא־שָׁכַח צַעֲקָתָה (עֲנִיִּים) [עֲנִיִּים]:

¹⁴ חַנּוּנִי יְהוָה רָאה עֲנִי מִשְׁנָאִי
מְרוֹמָמִי מַשְׁעָרֵי מָנוֹת:
¹⁵ לִמְעַן אֶסְפְּרָה כְּלִתְהִלָּתִי
בַּשְּׁעָרֵי בִתְצִיּוֹן אֲגִילָה בִישׁוּעָתָה:

¹⁶ טָבַעְנוּ גוֹיִם בַּשַּׁחַת עֵשׂוּ
בִּרְשֻׁתָּנוּ טָמְנוּ נִלְכְּדָה רַגְלָם:
¹⁷ נִזְדַּעַו יְהוָה מִשְׁפָּט עֲשֵׂה
בַּכַּעַל בְּפִיו נִקְשׁ רַשָּׁע הַגִּינוֹן סָלָה:

¹⁸ יָשׁוּבוּ רְשָׁעִים לְשֹׁאֵלָה
כָּל־גּוֹלִים שְׁכַחֲתִי אֱלֹהִים:
¹⁹ כִּי לֹא לִנְצַח יִשְׁכַּח אֲבִיוֹן
תִּקְוַת (עֲנוּיִם) [עֲנוּיִם] תֵּאבֵד לְעַד:

²⁰ קוֹמָה יְהוָה אֲלֵי־עֵץ אֲנוֹשׁ
יִשְׁפָּטוּ גוֹלִים עַל־פְּנֵיהֶם:
²¹ שִׁיתָה יְהוָה מוֹרָה לָהֶם
יִדְעוּ גוֹיִם אֲנוֹשׁ הִמָּה סָלָה:

10:1 לָמָּה יְהוָה תַּעֲמִיד בְּרִחּוֹק
תַּעֲלִים לַעֲתוֹת בַּצָּרָה:
² בְּגִאֲוַת רָשָׁע יִדְלַק עָנִי
יִתְפָּשׁוּ בְּמִזְמוֹת זֶן חֲשָׁבוּ:

³ כִּי־הִלֵּל רָשָׁע עַל־תַּאֲוַת נַפְשׁוֹ וּבִצָּע פִּרְךָ
נֶאֱמָר יְהוָה: ⁴ רָשָׁע כְּגִבָּה אָפוּ בִלִּי־דָרֵשׁ
אֵין אֱלֹהִים כְּלִמְזֻמוֹתָיו:
⁵ תִּחִילוּ (דִּרְכוּ) [דִּרְכוּ] בְּכָל־עֵת

מִרֹם מִשְׁפָּטֶיךָ מִנִּגְדֹּי
כָּל־צוֹרְרָיו יִפֹּחַ בָּהֶם:
⁶ אָמֵר בְּלִבּוֹ בִלְ־אֲמוּט
לִדֹר וָדֹר אֲשֶׁר לֹא־בִירַע:

⁷ אֵלֶּה פִּיהוּ מִלֵּא וּמִרְמוֹת וְתוֹד
תַּחַת לְשׁוֹנוֹ עָמַל וְאָנוּ:
⁸ יִשְׁבּוּ בְּמִאֲרֵב חֲצָרִים
בְּמִסְתָּרִים יִהְיֶה נָקִי

עֵינָיו לִחְלֻכְהָ יִצְפְּנוּ:
⁹ יֵאָרֵב בְּמִסְתָּרוֹ כְּאִרְיָה
בְּסִפָּה יֵאָרֵב לַחֲטוּף עָנִי
יִחַטֵּף עָנִי בְּמִשְׁכּוֹ בִּרְשָׁתוֹ:

¹⁰ (וְדָכָה) [וְדָכָה] יִשָּׁח
וְנָפַל בְּעִצְיוּמָיו (חֲלָפָאִים) [חִיל] [כָּאִים]:
¹¹ אָמֵר בְּלִבּוֹ יִשְׁכַּח אֵל
הַסִּתִּיר שָׁנָיו בִּלְ־רָאָה לִנְצַח:

12 קוֹמָה יְהוָה אֵל נִשְׂא נֶדֶךְ
 אֶל־תִּשְׁכַּח (עֲנִיִּים) [עֲנִיִּים]:
 13 עֲלֵמָהוּ נֶאֱמַר רָשָׁעוֹ אֱלֹהִים
 אָמַר בְּלִבּוֹ לֹא תִדְרָשׁ:

14 רָאֵתָה כִּי־אֲתָהוּ עָמַל וְכַעַסוֹ תִּבְטֵחַ לְתֵת בְּיָדָךְ
 עֲלֶיךָ יַעֲזֹב חֻלְכָּה
 יָתוֹם אֲתָהוּ הָיִיתָ עוֹזֵר:

15 נִשְׁבַּר זָרוּעַ רָשָׁע
 וְרָע תִּדְרוֹשׁ־רָשָׁעוֹ בְּלִתְמַצָּא:
 16 יְהוָה מֶלֶךְ עוֹלָם וָעֶד
 אֲבָדוֹ גּוֹלִים מֵאֲרָצוֹ:

17 תִּפְאוֹת עֲנִיִּים שְׂמֵעֶת יְהוָה
 תִּקְרֹוּ לָכֶם תִּקְוִיב אֲזַנְךָ:
 18 לִשְׁפֹט יָתוֹם וְיָדָךְ
 בְּלִי־יֹסִיף עוֹד לַעֲרֹץ אֲנוֹשׁ מִן־הָאָרֶץ:

On this model...

-The *daleth* line is missing, but its metrical place is taken by another stanza. This is similar to other acrostics (e.g., double *resh*).

-*waw* is almost certainly 9:10

-In line with the previous model, 10:3 is probably the *mem* line, obscured in M (and far from obvious in G)

-10:3-5a might be a mixed mem-nun section, like the mixed he-waw section Freedman posits for Ps 25

-*pe* can be restored in 10:7 by transposing the first two words on the authority of Rom 3:14 (more of the verse might need to be arranged; look into this{!}); LXX-Ps some suspect on other grounds has undergone revision so this is possible (or Paul may have known a variant Hebrew text). Strengthening this is the *pe-ayin* sequence this supposes.

-*tsaddhe* is missing but replaced with a metricly similar section, as with *daleth* (see above)

Ps 9:1

Within the Massoretic tradition, the single-word formulation (the meaning of which CDCH guesses at, but without supplying anything really convincing, especially given the lack of a preposition before it) appears to be secondary (note the Massorah, M^A, many MSS and V). It is difficult to be sure whether the LXX reflects a *Vorlage* על עלמות or whether the preposition is the translator's work; other external support for the preposition is limited (Theodotion? But this version likes easy readings. Epsilon? But this could be dittography), and on transcriptional grounds it is more likely that עלמות would drop from such a construction than על. The reading עלמות of various witnesses is likely an assimilation to Ps 46:1, but here that form is hardly possible, given the lack of a preposition and the following לִבִּי. (The epsilon reading there is probably due to grammatical updating in a Hebrew MS, prepositions being less likely to interrupt genitive chains in later Hebrew.) The psalm is thus set to a tune the name of which is "The Death of the Son," striking a somber tone for much discussion about the wicked.

Ps 9:2

On אִוֶּדֶךָ, see Kraus.

Ps 10:1

In other passages (e.g. 38:12 and Is 59:14) מרחוק appears with עמד, and the irregularity in M here is explainable as transcriptional error (*beit* for *mem*) in the herodian script.

Ps 11:1

See *VT* article (2017) for strong intrinsic evidence. Another possibility is הר כמו צפור, and במו is used in v2, but the version seems to support the form given here, and while the defective is unusual, stranger ones are found elsewhere, and the form as it appears makes the movement from G to M very easy indeed before final letters were consistently implemented (single-letter transpositio, albeit across a word division but these can be very small in some MSS)

Ps 11:4

An object seems to be missing, and חלד would fit with the parallelism while the majority reading of the LXX may be an inner-greek harmonization to 10:8. BHS suggests the preposition ל for Greek εως, but הזה does not appear elsewhere to use this preposition, and Greek renderings of Hebrew prepositions are quite fluid. The vocalization is pausal.

Ps 11:5

While OG and P might be facilitating rendering (the latter in particular), small-scale transposition seems to be a feature of M-Ps (e.g. 10:7, 11:1, 11:6), and the former is quite literal in this book.

Ps 12:3

Visual error. Cf. the similar situation in Mal 3:{} and {}

Ps 12:8a

MT is visual confusion (*nun* + *waw* → final *mem*).

Ps 13:6

This is an unusual VU – the loss of so large an amount of material in M or, outside of the superscriptions, the addition of to large a stretch in G. The loss of a line seems the most likely explanation, especially since the metrics are roughly the same, there is no verbal trigger for assimilation that I can see, the number of syllables in similar in this lines to the three major sections of M-13:6, and a note of causation (כצדקו in Ps 7; כי גמל עלי here) precedes each occurrence of this (stock?) phrase. This VU ties in, possibly, with issues of stichometrics, in that a whole line might have accidentally been skipped.

{Post-script: If we adopt the word-counting metrical system (see, e.g., WBC 3/3 *passim*), then the plus would seem to fit nicely indeed, scanning the whole psalm (after, of course, v1) thus:

v2 4+4

v3 4+3+4

v4 4+4

v5 3+3

v6 3+3+4+4 (this last “+4” referring to the plus)}

Ps 16:3a, b

An extremely difficult line (really, the whole first half of this psalm is difficult). Tentatively, we follow G (possibly for the whole line, at least if αὐτοῦ is an example of the OG tendency to be loose with regard to grammatical number in nouns; alternatively, for בארץ המה G has בארצמו), and translate “As for the holy ones in the land, they have adorned all his delight in them,” i.e. “God’s election has been vindicated in Israel by the elect’s actions.” This sets up a contrast with the following verse, which describes apostates; it also alleviates the difficult המה (by connecting it with what follows rather than with what precedes) and ואדירי (but correcting a visual error in M; the *he* could have lost its right half by overlapping on, and being confused with, the left half of the preceding *he*, and the *waw/yodh* confusion is off course perennial). There are numerous other proposals,

but after extensive work this is the best I could come up with.

Ps 17:1

Agreeing with Kraus that M is odd, though not with his preferred solution. Near haplography of *yodh* before *he* in the paleo script. It is perhaps worth mentioning that either final *yodh* is a bit fragile in M-Ps (cf. 7:1, 22:31, 30:13), or else Psalms was written with an unusually defective orthography (cf. 16:2).

Ps 18:14a

So OG and see 2 Sam 22:14. The error was no doubt facilitated by *beth/mem* confusion.

Ps 18:14b

Seems out of place, and a repeat. A scribe might working from a stichometric MS might have resumed copying at the wrong place, then noticed his error, but with the result that a line got repeated in the wrong place. Cf. on 2 Sam 21:19.

Ps 18:15

See OG and 2 Sam 22:15. Perhaps the final *mem* was faded on its left side; at any rate the scribe here seems to be taxed, given the density of apparent errors.

Ps 18:42

Following HALOT 2:1444a w (at least) OG; cf. “El/Al Interchanges” in Research Notes.

Ps 18:43

Re the pointing, cf. HALOT 1:229b.

Ps 22:14

M is probably corrupt haplography {specify: in which script?} (note the end of the preceding word).

Ps 23:5

M could easily be an assimilation since first person forms are so frequent in the preceding material, while G is hard to explain as an error. It also seems to make better sense: “Your cup is satisfaction” = “What you supply fully meets my need.” Translating M is a bit more strained.

Ps 24:4

See the 2018 issue of *Textus*.

Ps 24:6a-b

Certainly a difficult verse. However, transcriptional considerations, plus positing a strong influence of a recension toward the Hebrew (cf., e.g., *TC* articles) for the LXX, might help:

1a) An original דרשי יהוה became דרשי by near-homoeoteleuton in the paleo script;

1b) This corrupt form was consciously or unconsciously corrected toward דרשו by mutation of a letter or toward דרשיו by the addition of a letter to the end of the form; the latter scenario has the advantage of not requiring (or at least strongly suggesting) a Herodian origin for the change;

1c) The resulting דרשו or דרשיו was in the exemplar from which an early recension in the transmission history of the OG was made;

2a) An original פני אלהי became פני by homoeoteleuton;

2b) This form was then emended in proto-M to פניך; the addition of *kaph* could also be near dittography in the paleo script.

Ps 25:5

The form ואתך could be an attempt to correct the apparently deficient acrostic, but this is unlikely, in light of the failure of the LXX {no major variants in the LXX here} to drop the seemingly superfluous v22. On the peculiarities of this and other acrostics, see Peckham (in: *The World of the Aramaeans* 2/3), 22, 34. Note that Freedman, *PPP*, 69 is supportive of the *waw* reading for metrical reasons.

It is possible that the original form is ואתך, in which case the M(T) reading could be due either to corrupt haplography (note the previous word ends in *yodh*) or the spontaneous omission of the *waw* conjunction seen elsewhere. However, transposition seems a common affliction in M-Ps and so is the preferred explanation here.

Ps 25:18

LXX, P, and V all have the same verb at the beginning of vv18 and 19. The Gallican Psalter has two different verbs for sight (first *vide* and then *respice*), which could mean that the LXX originally had two different verbs as well, but this is a stretch, especially as Jerome in his early work had a penchant for stylistic variation (see THB on V-Dan).

A look at CDCH turns up no candidates for a verb meaning *to see* that starts with *qoph*. One possibility is reading שָׁקַף or שָׁקַפָה or הִשְׁפִּיךְ, on the theory that a folk etymology existed wherein the initial *shin* was thought to be indicative of the š-stem. This is very unlikely, however, especially as this would leave only two radical letters, and thus would not likely be thought of in these terms. (Note also the essay in the Gragg FS on Semitic-speakers' perceptions of morphology.)

There thus seems to be no external support for deviating from MT here.

{3/7/19 update: The OL has *vide* and *respice*, which suggests two different verbs in the OG (though the OL does at times translate the same Greek word variously in the same context). The Gallican Psalter might be independent testimony to that fact or simply Jerome using an OL base text. In any case, קשב is plausible in sense, rare in *qal*, and plausibly explains ראה: *Qoph* and *resh* are similar in some old scripts, and a damaged exemplar, where the second and third letters were unclear, could easily have been restored as the common ראה. Alternatively, in a stichometric exemplar scribe might initially have looked at the following line in his copying. OG/LXX sometimes translates קשב by *προσέχω*, and, while I have not checked OL (where extant), I notice in (at least) Gen 4:5, where OG has *προσέχω* V, which might be based on OL or at least reflecting a common translational tradition, has *recipio*. A marginal reading would be merited, yet there does seem to be a good case for קשב, especially as scribal missteps toward an acrostic are much less likely than accidental error away from the same.}

Ps 25:21

While there is no obvious trigger for the loss of the word, it has good external support (G) and the meter supports it (per BHS); the loss of a small word is not surprising, especially when at least the first part of the book of Psalms seems to have a high incidence of transcriptional error.

Ps 27:12-13

Some witnesses appear to support the absence of לולא without any addition to MT at the end of v12. Not only is the external evidence a bit dubious, however, but reading חַמַּס הָאִמְנָתִי leaves the other readings without explanation. Reading לו, however, makes לולא as an emendation if the former was interpreted as לו. The form לולא was then noted to be absent in some witnesses or as difficult by some witnesses and deleted or marked as suspicious. Interpreting לו, and grouping it with the previous line, however, is sensible: “For witnesses of deceit rise against me / and a witness, violence with him.”

Ps 30:9

The majority of Massoretic MSS read יהוה here, but a sizable minority (over 50 MSS according to Kennicott) have אדני. This situation is peculiar: In certain other cases (e.g. Ps 2:4), a minority comparable in number supports יהוה in place of a majority reading אדני (in such places, אדני is preferable, at least as far as the question of the text of M is concerned, insofar as it has greater numerical support, is the rarer word, and might be an aural

assimilation to יהוה on the part of scribes universally trained to vocalize the Tetragrammaton in the modern manner). One might suppose that the juxtaposition of יהוה and אדני (if original) caused many scribes to assimilate the second term to the first, but, while a few scribes might have erred thus, it is difficult to claim that the substantial majority did so when so little confusion in the MS tradition obtains in 35:22. This reasoning would point to יהוה here. On the other hand, the G reading of אלהי is most readily explainable as a misreading of אדני, lending a degree of support to that reading. At a loss, we print the majority reading, but consider the minority to have nearly equal weight.

{Post-script: In light of M^A and the apparent fact (cf. THB) that the proportions in Kennicott-Ps might not always be accurate, אדני seems the preferable reading, though יהוה could be in the margin if there was one.}

Ps 30:13

See Wendland, *Studies in the Psalms*, 48. OG's η δοξα μου might (here Wendland cites WBC, which I do not as of this writing own) represent כבדי, in which case M could be explained as *waw/yodh* confusion + transposition. However, OG could also be representing (αα) a *Vorlage* כבודי by way of Hebrew-language emendation or (αβ) an Old Hebrew reading כבודי in which case in M corrupt haplography in the face the following *waw*, or (b) be a Greek-language interpretive rendering. Option αβ is opted for here (with, at least, BDB).

An important follow-up is that an adjustment to the word כבד, “liver,” is *not* supported with a strong degree of probability here, nor can it be supported, it would seem, apart from conjectural emendation in most of the similar passages (Wendland directs attention to BDB, II KBWD 5, which lists, apart from the present passage, Gn 49:6, Psalm 7:6, 16:9, 57:9, and 108:2; in all of these OG appears to have δοξα, with the exception of 16:9*). Either a special sense of “glory” is present after all in these passages, or כבד might be in at least some of these passages a synonym of כבד, “liver” (are there other examples of synonyms, one with and one without a *u*-class vowel after the second radical?; have not checked the lexicons on this point).

*In Ps 16:9 γλωσσα is puzzling. It is hard to see a transcriptional path from לשוני to כבודי or vice versa; note as well that a change from MT ויגל to ויגל might in the former scenario be required. Perhaps it is an inner-Greek transcriptional + aural error (HΛOΞH → HΓAΩΣΣA). The immaterial change in sense did not concern Peter (Ac 2:26).

Ps 33:1

It is important to note the testimony of 'ε which bolsters OG here, and that line loss is probable earlier in Book I (Ps 13:6). It is also most striking that the OG has some sort of superscription for every psalms *except* 1 and 2; i.e., those psalms were viewed in antiquity as introductory to the psalter. As such, it can safely be said that Book I has, where relevant, superscriptions everywhere except at 10:1 and 33:1, and explanations are at hand (wrong division and line loss).

Ps 34:18

Transcriptional, metrical, and intrinsic considerations comes together to commend this plus.

Ps 35:16

Following, as I recall, HALOT 1:336a. Sic pointing of לָעֵגוֹ.

Ps 37:3

M is not easy to explain specifically as a transcriptional error, but the difference between M and G is only one letter. Perhaps an exemplar was hard to read and a letter needed to be conjectured at this point. Seeing a word ending מונה, a scribe might easily supply the common word אמונה. The word המון, by contrast, is more rare, particularly in the sense of *riches*. Transcriptional probabilities, then, favor G. Turning to internal evidence, the situation much seems to favor G. First, it is not clear that M can mean what the translators want to make it mean. Second, David uses the word המון in the same sense later in the psalm (the psalm in general repeating many themes). Third, the psalm puts a great deal of emphasis on the land of Israel, and implicitly draws on the covenant regarding the land. The wicked will not last in the land, but the righteous will “inherit” (a key term) it.

The bounty to feed oneself one is not in God's constancy in very general terms, but specifically in the promise for the Israelite as it relates to the land; remain in it by good doing, and great rewards will be reaped. Cf. KEL 1:803.

Ps 37:35

See HALOT 1:28b, cf. Eze 31:3, and note the nearby errors in M. The addition of the *chet* was perhaps due to the *he* with which the previous word ends or to the similarity of the previous two letters (when taken together) to *chet* (either one a subspecies of corrupt dittography).

Ps 38:19

Following QPSa (the oldest MS of Ps according to Longacre); note the visual similarity across multiple eras of the Hebrew script and the tendency toward plene readings, plus the sometimes suspect nature of the OG, at least as presently reconstructed.

Ps 39:2a

Assimilation. Cf. Jenni 3: 97 *ad fin* and Kraus.

Ps 40:12

The word לא is, I suppose, textual metathesis for אל. Note (1) the imperative רצה in v14, (2) the מן in the generally-literal OG Ps 39:12, (3) the fact that (so at any rate J-M) prohibitive לא is used in legal or in specifically ethical contexts, not with specific requests like this one, and (4) the possibility of assimilation to the indicative mood dominant in the previous few verses.

Ps 40:16

As BHS notes, OG understands ישוב, but the plene spelling in 70:4 points to ישוב. M is due to *beith/mem* confusion in the paleo script.

Ps 42:5a

Cf. Kraus and HALOT. M's אדום is perhaps best explained as mem/yodh confusion with metathesis + daleth/resh confusion.

Ps 42:5b

Near haplography before מה.

Ps 43:1

See intro to Ps for arguments that (perhaps) Ps 43 is different enough from 42 to constitute a separate piece and that external evidence for joining the psalms is quite slim. It is quite possible that the OG reading is original, for (a) it could easily have been lost due to its unexpectedness since Ps 43 is so similar to 42, (b) line loss is quite possible, and, turning from transcriptional to intrinsic reasoning, (c) only ps 71, and there not at all certainly, is a psalm in Book II lacking a superscription.

Ps 44:15

On the pointing, cf. J-M 18.

Ps 45:6

See BHS. The loss is not easy to account for on transcriptional grounds (though *mem* and *resh* are somewhat similar in the paleo script), but single words can drop out without clear cause (see Wilson, singular readings). Intrinsically, the meter seems improved by the insertion of some word, and this word fits the context generally yet is not something that would likely occur to many scribes to add.

Ps 45:9

The *waw* prefix is easily added or omitted (see, e.g., the size in the Aleppo Codex at this spot). The lack of it here in MT could be a proto-M error (in which case V P are translational smoothing-outs) or an inner-M error.

Ps 45:13

The M text is probably dittography, {assuming that BHS is correct is its assessment of the original text of the OG}.

Ps 46:4

MT is probably haplography.

Ps 46:10

=“round shields” (HALOT 1:784a). Against MT, also cf. BDB.

Ps 49:9

So BHS. G does seem to fit the context better, and it appears that in some paleo scripts *waw* and *mem* resembled one another, such that M could be a transcriptional error. Or *waw* + the following *waw* looked like a final *mem*.

Ps 49:12a

As most agree, MT is a transposition, an error seen elsewhere in MT-Ps.

Ps 49:13

So BHS. The parallel (v21, IIRC) has יִבִּין, and in the modern script the difference is the presence or absence of an above-the-line shaft. Certainly the interchange is not common, but the parallel makes a strong intrinsic case where transcriptional factors are probably in play (not only the specific letter similarity just mentioned, but the generally poor state of preservation of MT-Ps 49; perhaps the exemplar was damaged at this point and needed to be repaired as Longacre (sp?) might suggest) and the strong external evidence for the alternative (G) compel us to abandon M here.

Ps 57:4-5 (BHS lists under v5)

The short reading could be due to homoeoarchon, or simply the loss of a small word. The long reading makes sense of the passage (if the following נַפְשִׁי is grouped with v4, as BHS proposed, rather than v5).

Ps 54:5

As BHS notes, 86:14 supports זָדִים. I have not checked Davidson, etc., on the MS count, the dalet resh interchange is of course very polygenetic.

Ps 58:10

This verse is the despair of interpreters. Nevertheless, with some text-critical data at hand, *perhaps* a solution is available:

-via metathesis and *waw/yodh* confusion (facilitated by the fact that the root byn is much more common), יָנוּבוּ became יָבִינוּ (so HALOT). This assumes a different reading in the OG based on the OL.

-סִיר is here to be understood as “thorn,” not “pot.” The 2mp reference is understood to be to the wicked (as in v3).

-חֵי is to be understood as “raw meat” (as in 1 Sam 2:15), something virtually unclean to Israelites

-הָרוֹן is to be understood as “fire,” “something hot [to the touch]”

-via visual error יִשְׁמְטוּ became יִשְׁעֲרוּ. The OG καταπιω almost always translates בָּלַע, but in Ps 141:6 (so, in the same book) it renders שָׁטַח, and the sense of that verb (“let drop,” BDB) is suitable here (as a metaphor for rejection).

-The OG tradition is divided over ὑμᾶς and αὐτοὺς at the end of the verse. The case is difficult to resolve, and it

is a bit unclear whether either or both goes back to a Hebrew *Vorlage*. Tentatively, the former is understood to be an assimilation to earlier in the verse, and the latter original (though in some witnesses perhaps an emendation based on v9, or else a felicitous paleographical error). In that case a ם suffix can reasonably be supposed to be that from which the M נו suffix emerged by visual error (granted, v9 vacillates with regard to the grammatical number of the wicked, but in v10, the second line is the complement of the first [NB בטרם], so consistency in number *here* seems likely).

-A translation of the result: “Before your thorns grow [גִּיבֵינִי] into a bramble [of wicked], / Like raw meat, [or] like something hot may he [viz. God] let them drop [יִשְׁקֹטֵם].”

Ps 60:4

Following Kraus (note the consistency within OG how the articles are handled in this psalm and the ready transcriptional explanation of the error in M; note also 61:2). Perhaps the density of cohortative *hes* facilitated the error; indeed, not the ininter-MT in L-v5.

Ps 60:11

A bit tentatively, I take this as a rare case of the same error affecting two parallel passages (viz., here and 108:11), whether independently (haplography, perhaps triggered by similarity of the bracketing *mem* and *nun* in the paleo script?) or in succession (one passage, having become well-known in its miscopied form, influencing the copying of the other). Note also that OG translates the two passages differently, so the translator is certainly not slavishly copying one passage from the other, or likely to have paraphrased in both places. Concurring with the decision is (at least) Kraus (2: 2), {}

Ps 62:4b

This is a case where a form cannot be proven due to paucity of ancient MS evidence, but it is most plausible that the form preferred is hidden behind OG, and perhaps other versions as well.

Ps 62:5a

The verb רצה can take an object in the accusative (see BDB), but the strong external support and the possibility of corrupt haplography with the following *kaph* makes the case for the presence of *beth* strong.

Ps 62:5b

The loss of *mem* could simply be accidental loss or accidental conformation of a rarer form to a more common one, or it could be corrupt haplography of the *yodh* in a paleo script.

Ps 63:10

See Kraus and Jenni (3: 298); triggered by visual similarity + the downward term in the parallel line.

Ps 64:6

Intrinsic evidence much favors לנו over למו, and למו could be a corruption in the paleo script or assimilation to earlier in the verse in any script. The trouble is BHS cites only V P in its support, though the Gottingen apparatus seems to indicate (at least some) Latin support for a 1st person plural reading in the OG.

Ps 67:5a

So BHS. Intrinsically, the plus much improves the meter and causes כי תשפט to fit much better than it does in M. The loss could be explained either as homoeoarchon or as accidental line loss, depending on whether each line had a colon or a bicolon (the former, which the present case would require, is suggested by the case in Ps 13:6).

Ps 67:5b

The loss of *beth* on מישור could be corrupt haplography or the loss of a different letter between two of the same value; in any case, its presence is suggested by the parallel בצדק, on which see the preceding note. As BHS notes,

Is 11:4 supports the preposition here (with a different verb, making assimilation somewhat less likely than it would be if the verb was the same). Following (at least) G T pc.

Note also the orthographic variation as well.

Ps 68:27

L, to judge from Ginsburg and JC, is alone in having יהוה for אדני. This is thus a good example of how the former is *not* to be preferred over the latter (automatically), for the more common word can easily be substituted for the rare homophone.

Ps 68:32

See Noonan (330f). To summarize: M is a ghost word created by corrupt dittography; the best reading is “swift ones.”

Ps 69:6

Following Kraus (*q.v.*). Note that the combination יהוה אדני occurs twice elsewhere in Psalms (71:5, 16) and both times is doubly rendered (though in a different way than the *v.l.* to OG here), and, in addition to the metrical considerations here, the phrase יהוה אדני צבאות occurs only (and distinctively) in Isaiah. We have here, then, an auditory dittograph, or else an error that was corrected without the error (אדני) subsequently being deleted.

Ps 69:11

See Kraus (2: 59), who, however, seems to have a typo with respect to the vocalization of the *aleph*.

Ps 69:32

MT is probably corrupt haplography after *nun*.

Ps 69:33

Corrupt haplography.

Ps 71:1

Apart from 43, only vpsalm in Book II w/o superscription. Some MSS join to the previous psalm but evidence is weak. OG adds לדוד, though admittedly with some other material as well, which might have been due to line loss or homoioteteluton from the preceding *resh*. The psalm certainly sounds davidic in style and content!

Ps 71:3a

Zayin/nun confusion; cf. 31:3. [Muraoka confirms the correspondence.]

Ps 71:3b

Transcriptional error (see 31:3). Multiple paths are possible (e.g. the *aleph* could be a corrupt dittography of the *taw* or an emendation via addition once the grapheme לבו had been produced by *waw/yodh* confusion + faulty word division; the *daleth* and *yodh* may have been transposed, or the *yodh* of M might be a *tsadde* by visual error [don't remember if Talmon cites this verse])

[NB OG retroversions: 70:3 εις τοπον οχυρον; 30:3 εις οικον καταφυγης]

[In the Bible, material is often reused, and in Ps 71 the first few verses are a repeat of the first few verses of Ps 31, with slightly stylistic variation. Just how slight the stylistic variation is a question, however. In 71:3, the MT diverges from 30:3. In 71:3, we have הָיָה לִי לְצִוְרֵי מַעֲוֹן לְבֹא תָמִיד צִנִּיתָ לְהוֹשִׁיעֲנִי, “Be to me a rock of refuge, that I can enter always; you have commanded to save me.” In 31:3, we have הָיָה לִי לְצִוְרֵי מַעֲוֹז לְבֵית מְצוּדוֹת לְהוֹשִׁיעֲנִי, “Be to be a rock of strength, a fortress to save me.” The differences here, on inspection, appear to be scribal lapses. The first difference is pretty straightforward: in the pair ma’on/maoz, the final form of the letter *nun* and the letter *zayin* obviously

look quite similar, and are easily confused in this pair of words which are almost synonymous in a context like this. The OG version has the same term in each place, $\tau\epsilon\pi\epsilon\alpha\sigma\pi\iota\sigma\tau\eta$, which translates מעון several times but never elsewhere מעון. As for לְבֹא תִמִּיד צְנִית, this string of words is at once peculiar and visually not too distant from לְבִית מְצוּדוֹת share nearly all of their letters in common; moreover, several of the letters of *waw* or *yodh*, which in the hands of some scribes—that of the Great Isaiah Scroll, for example—are indistinguishable. There’s also a chance, though this is less clear, that part of the problem was an earlier error, in the paleo script, which saw *taw* and *aleph* interchanged, these letters being similar in some old scripts. At any rate, the OG version is translating לְבִית מְצוּדוֹת in both cases, and, interestingly, it does so in two different ways (70:3 εις τοπον οχυρον; 30:3 εις οικον καταφυγης), showing that it is *not* the case that the translator is artificially conforming one passage to the other. To be sure, it could be replied that the underlying Hebrew had been artificially harmonized, but the difficulty of the MT version of 71:3, the transcriptional explanation for the difference, and the general shape that these two psalms take all lead me to the conclusion that the OG reading in 71:3 is correct. We thus obtain a clearer focus on the similarities between these two songs, and eliminate an unneeded obscurity in 71:3.]

Ps 72:3

“May the mountains lift up peace for the people, / and the hills [lift up] vindication [for the nation].” The external evidence is a bit complex, but it appears likely that OG supported the reading here given, and it is also possible, though not certain, that M originally so read as well. M(T) is a mechanical repetition inspired by the prepositions in the previous verse.

Ps 72:18

Cf. 41:14, 89:53, 106:48 and the meter; M is likely corrupt dittography. Do note that P is probably not transmitting the original text but is an assimilation, as so often elsewhere; likewise the small number of Masoretic MSS is probably due to homoeoarchon.

Ps 75:2

The retroversion is somewhat difficult, esp. as regards the last word of the trio. Perhaps we should read וספר with the Syriac, or ספור (infinitive), though the qal of this verb does not seem to bear the required sense elsewhere. Still, the retroversion given here (וְקָרָא בְּשִׁמְךָ סֵפֶר) would seem to have solid support (G), and arguably follows the rhythm of the verse as a whole:

“We thank you, O God; we thank you, [4 words]

And call on your name; we recount your wondrous deeds.” [4 words]

Ps 75:10

So (at least) HALOT and Kraus.

Ps 76:12

See BHS (noting that the reference to v5 is a bit misleading in that OG does not there suggest a *Vorlage* different from MT *in a way that supports the change proposed here*; cf. further the research notes there). *Mem/nun* confusion in the paleo script.

Ps 77:12

So BHS. Intrinsic evidence favors this move inasmuch as internal ruminations, not public proclamations, dominate the immediate context (indeed, possibly the psalm as a whole). External evidence points in the same direction. Finally, the Kt is easily explained as *waw/yodh* confusion in the early square script.

Ps 78:49

While MT could mean “messengers of evil men,” it seems more likely that corrupt dittography of a *mem* after a *yodh* in the paleo script has occurred.

Ps 78:72

In every other collocation of **הם** with **לכב**, the preposition is *beth*, not *kaph*.

Ps 79:7

The loss of *waw* here is admittedly difficult to account for (somewhat similar to following *aleph* in some scripts and somewhat similar to preceding *lamedh* in others), but seems to be demanded by the intrinsic evidence.

Ps 80:20

Note the refrain in vv4, 8 and the possibility of haplography.

Ps 81:13

Visual error may have played a role, but perhaps also the fact that the previous few verses refer to the nation in the grammatical singular. However, **לכם** shows that it is at this point that there is a shift to the grammatical plural. So G. Following (at least) HALOT 2:1515a).

Ps 85:7

G makes a great deal more intrinsic sense, inasmuch as **הלא** would cast God's actions in v7 as something all would expect, when in fact God's actions in this verse are being pled for in spite of countervailing circumstances. Meanwhile, the slightly unusual **האל** is used later in this very psalm (v9). The explanation for M, too, is at hand (transposition). (The transposition of two letters is easier to suppose than the reversal of a *three* letter sequence, if, as BHS tentatively suggests, **אלה** is read, and as mentioned, **האל** is used elsewhere in the psalm and so is the more likely form.)

Ps 86:2

Corrupt dittograph of the following word. The meter for the first few verses is long + short; parallelism is not at play, at least for the most part.

Ps 87:5

WBC makes a convincing case for this plus, even though Tate does not ultimately adopt it. The parallelism, and possibly the meter as Tate says, is improved, and it is hard to see G, or certainly OG, omitting it, and it could easily have fallen out, either due to the similar ending of the previous word or to the overall visual similarity of **אם** to the following letter sequences. This text (or if not Ps 87:5, OG-Ps 87:5) might be the inspiration for Gal 4:26 (but I have not checked commentaries on Gal on this point). Some (e.g. Gentry iirc, NICOT, NETS; but *not* Ralphs, either in his handbook or the Gottingen edition) think Μητηρ is an inner-greek corruption, the Hexapla apparently having μη τη, but the latter reading seems strained indeed and is itself, it seems to me, the inner-greek corruption.

Ps 89:2

Corrupt haplography in the paleo script (note the similarity of *waw* and *kaph* in some scripts). Note the parallelism with **אמונתך** later in the verse.

Ps 91:2

The reading **יאמר** would make sense, but it is hard to be sure that it existed and that the LXX is not merely trying to escape a difficulty. The LXX is Psalms is, however, willing elsewhere to be odd in its use of tense-forms (surely so even on the Porter model, and all the more on the standard model), and, where it deviates from the usual Hebrew-to-Greek tense-form equivalents, it almost never puts a future for a perfect (usually where it deviates it has an aorist for an imperfect). Thus, the LXX is hard to explain apart from a G **יאמר**. The loss of the

initial *yodh* is not easy to explain, but not impossible. The MT is difficult in context (see the next verse, for instance), and a participle seems impossible. A repointing of the M אָמַר to אָמַר does seem possible, however, and would balance the imperfect with which the previous v ends. The G text would then be a tense-form assimilation, though such does not seem (data would be nice here) common. Note that in v6 G seems to have misread יְשׁוּד as וְשׁוּד, possibly evidence of a fatigued G scribe in this passage.

{Post-script: The reading יְאָמַר in fact *does* seem to be viable, for (1) the Greek ἐπεῖ could hardly be based on anything else, and (2) M can be explained as corrupt haplography after *nun* in the paleo script. Since יְאָמַר is viable on both external and transcriptional grounds, the reading, being superior on intrinsic grounds, should be adopted.}

Ps 97:11

So (among others) HALOT (1:282b).

Ps 98:3

While the plus לִיעֶקֶב could be a G-stlye plus, it would seem to improve the meter (WBC), and could have dropped because of the close connection often seen elsewhere between אָמַת and חֶסֶד.

Ps 104:1

Ought לִדּוּד be read? True, this could be an (O)G addition, esp. in light of 103:1, but the similarities of 103 to 104 are so strong that perhaps they have the same author, and the line could have been lost in a stichometric exemplar. Additionally, this could be a somewhat extreme instance of the phenomenon of material being lost in between repeated letter sequences (בִּרְכֵי נַפְשִׁי אֶת יְהוָה). Also note the agreement of 11Q5, which does not seem to be particularly close to G.

Ps 104:4

See the *TC* 2018 article (9-10)

Ps 104:6

See especially Hong (*TC* 2018 article, pp. 11-12).

Ps 105:28

L's דְּבָרוֹ seems to be an error unique to that MS (cf. JC, Ginsburg).

Ps 105:45

Deciding between the singular and plural for תּוֹרָה here is not altogether easy. The plural occurs nowhere else in Psalms, so the singular might be an assimilation. Yet the same evidence would suggest that the singular is supported by intrinsic evidence. The plural might be an assimilation to the immediately preceding plural. Partial assimilation to Dt 4:40 is possible. Watson in *Classical Hebrew Poetry* might suggest the singular as a poetic counterpoint to the plural. Cf. also the comments on Lev 26:46.

{Post-script: It seems to retain the MT pointing, but on the basis of OG, a defective spelling seems quite possible, especially with assimilation to the fuller spelling of the previous word a clear trigger.}

Ps 106:1

A look at Ps 104-106 in Kennicott shows that a small minority tends to make the two words one; MT^L has one word only here, with weak MS support. Given that both the LXX (in always putting this phrase at the head of the Psalm) and the Peshitta (in deleting it) recognize this phrase as liturgical, it is likely that Massoretic copyists did as well. Indeed, the Union Prayer Book prints it as one word. Thus the one-word form can be explained as a historical development in response to a recognition of and increasing inclination toward liturgical elements, while the two-word form has strong external support and might, though functionally liturgical, be formally a relic of a day when the phrase was taken at face value.

{Addendum: UXLC 1.9 changed יהללוי in Ps 149:1 and 150:1 to one word each. M-M (at least) has *two* words in both verses, however. Also note that sometimes at Qumran the string is written as one word, though cf. HALOT for evidence that semi-grammaticalization had already begun late in the biblical period.}

Ps 106:2

While M could be retained and repointed, the external support (G S Jerome according to Kraus 2: 315) is so impressive, the pl. to rare, and haplography under these conditions to likely, that textual rather than paratextual error seems probable.

Ps 106:4a, b

While switching between grammatical persons is a feature of Hebrew poetry, here it seems too out of place (so, tentatively, Kraus 2: 315). The external evidence (see ib.) is quite impressive, and the error, easy to make, once made could easily be made a second time (or, less likely, spread from one prior error to another word by emendation).

Ps 106:12

While MT could stand (as a *yaqtul* of history), the other form makes good sense, easily explains the rival reading (haplography), and has strong external support (G V P).

Ps 107:36

On the external evidence see Flint 235 (strong external evidence within the Greek tradition overturns Rahlfs' Gottingen Ps, which was edited on dubious principles, Flint 230, plus 4QPs^d). The MT is either transposition, a common error in MT-Ps, or assimilation to the singular form which occurs twice earlier (see BDB sub MOSHAV) in the psalm (the plural here fits the context; see esp. the following verse).

Ps 108:11

See BHS a. It is certainly possible that מִצֹר and מִבְצָר are synonyms exchanged without consequence in the two versions of the song (viz. here and 60:11). But it is also possible that מִבְצָר here is corrupt dittography of the *mem* in the herodian script. According to Muraoka (94^b sub περικοχη) the OG word in question translates מִבְצָר only here (do the brackets in Muraoka cast doubt on the soundness of MT here?), while it translates מִצֹר ten times. With a plausible text-critical scenario before us, it seems best to see these two passages as having (at this point) originally the same verbiage.

Ps 109:28

See WBC (75). BHS (as noted in *ibid*) is in error.

Ps 113:8

Cf. WBC (99). Assimilation to the repeated terminal-*yodh* forms in this psalm, facilitated by the visual similarity of *waw* and *yodh*. (So also J-M 93p, and cf. Ges 90n, Kraus; BH, BHS are most cautious.)

Ps 118:13

See WBC (121).

Ps 119:49

Following G; M is taken as corrupt haplography in the square script, רך becoming ר. (For other external options, see Flint 235).

Ps 119:79

See WBC.

Ps 119:82

As BHS notes, this is probably partial dittography: Note the oddity of the expression and the meter.

Ps 119:91

MT is difficult, (1) lacking a subject for the verb, and (2) why is היום used here?

One solution (from DCH?) is to point the first letter of the verse as an asseverative lamedh (“Your judgments stand today”). If “stand” is in the sense of “endure, remain,” then this makes good sense, but then the parallel line (“for all are your servants”) seems to be a non sequitur. Unless perhaps כי there is not to be understood as the cause of the action but of the statement. That is, the psalmist asserts that God’s judgments remain in force today as always, giving as the basis for this assertion the fact that everything that happens is a function of God’s sovereignty. And of course the asseverative lamedh is used at least twice elsewhere in the psalm. But probably כהיום or something similar would have been used if the meaning was “as it is today.”

Another option is to follow G and to read עמד. The meaning would then be either “the day stands [in attendance upon] your judgments” or “the wind, etc.” But does either make good sense—for why would the day (as opposed to the night) or the wind (as opposed to any other force of nature) be singled out as emblematic of all of creation / time? If the first word of v92 was לילה instead of לולי, we would have across four verses the series heavens, earth, day, night; but I cannot find external evidence for this (an appealing conjectural emendation, no?). Might לולי be a play on words, sounding similar to but different from the expected לילה? Beyond all dispute, the author of Ps 119 makes constant use of words plays, often (especially?) across the line break within each verse. Note also the Aramaic /ele/ “night” (cf. HALOT 2: 1909a). This seems to make the most sense. The waw could be a corrupt dittograph either of the preceding daleth or of the first part of the following he.

119:118

=“their thought(s).” See HALOT 2: 1793bf.

Ps 119:119

He/chet confusion in MT, anticipated of the grammatical person in which the next poetic line is cast in 11QPs^a and G (i.e., the reading adopted explains the others). WBC considers our reading a strong one, though it ultimately opts for MT.

Ps 119:128

Wrong word division. This solution is close to, but not precisely that of BHS, which needlessly puts a *lamedh* prefix before the כל which stands *before* M’s פקודי, or that of BDB sub ישר, which needlessly deletes the *lamedh* which terminates the כל which stands *after* M’s פקודי.

Ps 119:175

The defective reading of MT is hard to rule out altogether, but the external evidence is so strong, and *yodh* might have been lost to corrupt haplography in the paleo script, that the *plene* seems the stronger contender.

Ps 120:6

MT is auditory error? WBC is ambivalent.

Ps 133:3

Though this line is not found in G, it has the ring of truth: found in not only 11Q5 but also in 11Q6, it echoes a phrase found repeatedly in the psalms of ascent, and it could have been lost either through homeoteleuton or through loss of a line in a stoichiometric exemplar (which indeed elsewhere seems to have happened mainly at the beginning or end of a psalm). True, 11Q5 may have absorbed expanded forms of certain psalms at points (e.g., 135 and 145), but what are the chance that such an expansion would be so fitting as this one, without an immediate contextual trigger (contrast the situation with בַּחֲצֹת אֱלֹהֵינוּ)?

Ps 135:3

Following G (note that the OG rendering would have been different if its text matched that of M, as the super/subscriptions show) and 11Q5, and thus removing the only non-liturgical use of הללו יה in M-Ps. M here is a(n unconscious) adaption to the more common expression. The minority expression is found elsewhere in 117:1, 148:7, Jer 20:13 and cf. Ps 150:1.

Ps 137:1

PPS proposes (with Q [Ulrich 3:718]) בבבל. A preposition within a construct chain seems a bit surprising for a late poem (but check grammars on this), but the fact that it is found within a Q scroll, which would be the source most likely to eliminate such a linguistic phenomenon, might point in its favor. It might, however, be dittography. On the other hand, in the face of three identical letters in a row, haplography seems more likely than dittography, but it's hard to be sure. *PPP* also argues that metrical considerations favor the long reading. Further, the archaic/poetic form in v6 suggests an archaic/poetic form here.

Ps 138:2

MT is all but impossible to make sense of, but שם makes good sense (if “every name” here = “every potential rival's name”), and שמך can be explained either as corrupt dittography in the paleo script or as anticipation of the suffix of the following word. Some witnesses to OG add σου here, but these same witnesses have the inner-greek corruption αγιον for λογιον (V-*luxta LXX* [=the Gallican Psalter] confirms the majority text of OG w/o any variants listed in BSV; curiously, one witness to V-*iuxta hebraicum* [Θ] adds *sanctum* after *nomen*, but this is seemingly independent, and perhaps prompted by *sancto* earlier in the verse). BSV represents V as agreeing with MT, though seemingly the majority of MSS omit *tuum*. S agrees with G, and Leiden lists no variants. T on the other hand agrees with MT.

Ps 139:6

(Perhaps incidentally, I became persuaded that MT is all but impossible while reading THBS 2 re this verse.) Corrupt haplography in the square script. Explanatory paraphrase: “The extent of Your knowledge of my being and character exceeds my capacity for comprehension.” Pointed on the analogy of Job 10:7, allowing for the lack of a *daghesh* in (at least) L of our verse.

Ps 139:20

See WBC, adding that L is an O-class error for proto-M שׂוֹנֵא; that reading is then easily a case of transcription for Old Hebrew נִשְׂאוּ (preserved in G; and also preserved in, or successfully emended to, in Q).

Ps 139:21

So G. Following HALOT (2:1008b, second suggestion) except for an immaterial aspect of the pointing. Fatigue, or a damaged exemplar, could have led to this *lapis calami* (*tet/mem* confusion + near haplography), facilitated the rarity of the Old Hebrew lexeme (which, in its favor, has a hitpolel form attested, which adds much intrinsic evidence in favor of this change).

Ps 140:9

Following OG. Note the visual similar to the previous two letters (i.e., the literal length of the word in question).

Ps 140:10

Following OG. Note the proximity of this variant to that in v9 where we followed G. M might have arisen due to anticipation of the soon-to-come *waw* (which perhaps stood out in the scribe's mind due to its unusual nature), or as a corrupt dittography of the right half of the following *mem*.

Ps 144:2

MT is difficult, and the sevir עמים is an easy reading to explain (assimilation to 18:48) and a somewhat difficult reading from which to trace עמי.

Tentatively, we reconstruct (see Gottingen) the OG as representing עמו, which, if construed broadly (the entire people of God, Jew and Gentile), could be parallel to 18:48's עמים. But the matter is difficult.

{Post-script: See WBC, adding that the loss of final *mem* could be polygenetic in that the following letter is *taw*, leading to haplography of a final *mem* without difficulty.}

Ps 144:5

Cf. Ps 18:10. *Kaph/mem* confusion in the paleo script.

Ps 144:7

Perhaps mechanical assimilation to חציך in the previous verse, or the type of singular → plural variation often seen in the Psalter.

Ps 145:5a

See WBC.

Ps 145:5b

On the orthography see JC and Ginsburg. On the prefix see WBC.

Ps 145:13

Note that Freedman, *PPP*, 69 is supportive of the long reading. The LXX does not seem elsewhere to concern itself with acrostics, nor was such even universally recognized even in M^A (see the small, thick, green FS).

(The pointing of בכל *bis* is a nod to the Hebrew MS that contains this verse (cf., e.g., BH 1100). {Note, however, that there are (I think all in vol. 1 of SRO 1st ed., and I think mainly or completely in Sam) inconsistencies in my handling of such degashim and kamatzim.}

Ps 147:8

WBC's arguments against the plus are not convincing, for G-Psalms does not add whole lines like this, the psalms does not hide God's interaction with mankind until the end as he supposes, the external support Rahlfs adduces for the short reading in OG is dubious (the same witnesses clearly err elsewhere, in my view), and a line could have been lost in a stichometric exemplar.

Ps 147:20

Following G and 11Q5.

Job 2:8

See IOSCS vol. 36 for an argument that the G *Vorlage* was אשפת rather than אפר. If so, G could be preferable in that אשפת is less common and that אפר would more easily be a transcriptional error for אשפת than the reverse.

Job 3:11

G is preferable for at least five reasons: (1) M is explainable as transcriptional error; (2) it could also be an assimilation anticipating the next line; (3) the M idiom is far more common, but (4) Job elsewhere (31:15) uses the rarer idiom, and (5) there are intrinsic difficulties with M (on this point see WBC).

Job 6:2

G appears to support the Qr, which is easier in context even as the Kt could easily be a Herodian-era waw/yodh confusion.

Job 6:7

The second line is difficult. The proposal **זהמה** for **המה** on the basis of LXX faces the difficulty that the verb it elsewhere attested only as a piel, which is harder to restore than a qal here.

We tentatively follow the lead of NEB: “my intestinal tract grows as with illness” (my rendering of their Hebrew text).

Job 6:12-13 [originally labeled Job 6:13]

As Talmon notes, **האם** occurs only here and by error in Num 17:28 in the OT. Important linguistic matters hang in the balance; given that fact and the difficulty in retroverting LXX-Job, a marginal reading is called for in any case.

The phrase **η ουκ** (pointed thus) occurs in Job only in 10:20, where it renders **הלא**. Such is in itself plausible here in terms of meaning, and while the transcriptional process from G to M would be unusual (transposition plus exchange of a letter not visually or aurally especially similar), it is not impossible. The following **אין** presents a difficulty, in that the collocation **הלא אין** occurs nowhere else. Perhaps it is a doublet for **הלא**, but this seems quite unlikely in M-Job, and we would have to posit a rather complicated textual history for M (first a doublet, then a transformation of **הלא** into **האם**). Yet the collocation is perhaps not impossible.

The LXX **επιισθεν** is perplexing, both as to semantics (perhaps reflecting the “strength” meaning suggested {verify this} in CDCH?) and form (where the pronominal ending gone?) as a translation of **עזרתי**. Lacking a clear explanation, M should be retained.

Probably G had **בו** for **בי** (graphic confusion easily explains the rise of one from the other). It is probably not wise to posit a different position with the sentence for it on the basis of the LXX.

{Post-script: NICOT's proposal makes more sense.}

Job 7:5

It is difficult to be sure, but we (cf. HALOT) follow Qr, which seems to be reflected in T (**וגרישתא**) and G (**OG: βωλακας**) and possibly P (there are some inner-syriac textual variants and syriac lexical questions that muddy the waters here); V seems to pass over the word, either because Jerome did not understand it or because he was smoothing out the style (note the following **עפר**).

Job 7:20

NICOT (150-51n³) favors G. Many (including NET) see an orthodox corruption in M, but I lean rather towards a more pedestrian explanation: Corrupt haplography in the paleo script (*yodh* + *kaph* → *yodh*).

{Post-script: Re intrinsic grounds, cf. UBCS, agreeably to the G reading.}

Job 8:15

Following Q (see THB 1C)

Job 8:18

Visual error: *Zayin* → *waw* (+ redivision), > *aleph* (aural), and final *kaph* → *taw* (unless the final *kaph* is a corrupt dittography of the *he* with which the next verse begins, *taw* being lost due to haplography).

Job 11:4

Admittedly not a common error, yet Job was all but certain to have been written in a paleo script, and in such scripts *waw* and *kaph* can look quite a bit alike.

Job 12:10

Corrupt dittography, facilitated by the commonness of the phrase **כל בשר** and the visual similarity of **איש** to **בשר** (that is, *yodh* somewhat resembles *resh* and metathesis of one position is not hard to envisage).

Job 13:24

Following the orthography of the ancient MS 4QPaleoJob^c; on the MS as a whole, see THB 1B, esp. Althann's

overview of Job, and Ulrich (here specifically 3: 727).

I have, however, declined to depart from L where the specific point of orthography in question is reconstructed, at least pending further study of the MS, since different reconstructions might differ in these details.

Job 13:27

Originally I adopted this defective orthography on another basis {JC? Ginsburg?}, but see it reflected in 4QPaleoJob^c as well: See on v25 above.

Job 14:14

On the orthography see Ulrich 3: 728 and the comments on v25 above.

Job 14:16a

On the orthography see Ulrich 3: 728 and the comments on v25 above.

Job 14:16b

The MS alluded to immediately above is not extant here, but other evidence points toward an original defective spelling.

Job 15:35-16:1

Reconstructing a sectional breakout for the book of Job requires a certain eclecticism, but data from the first edition of SRO shows that sections of fragile things (around two thirds as many P-class variants as there are O-class variants!), confirming what Ginsburg long ago observed. The chart of MSS in BHQ shows no inner-consistency, and seemingly a tendency for every MS to slip up at some point.

Job 17:15

I got this reading from the BDB appendix. Haplography (see the last word of previous v) + aural loss (*ayin* after *he*) + *beth/mem* confusion.

Job 18:2

The sense that this verse requires is tolerably clear from parallels throughout the book, but MT is difficult or, as I tend to think, impossible. The chain of events is admittedly complex, but might not have occurred all at once, might have compounded, and are far from impossible in so difficult a book:

First (not necessarily in order of generation but as one reads the verse from right to left): The negative **לֹא** was lost, b/c small, due to homoeotetuton, or as part of an attempt to wrest sense from the verse after another error. Second, **תָּשִׁים** became **תְּשִׁימוֹן**, like *before* the introduction of final letters, possibly by anticipation of the last two letters of **תְּבִינוּ** after that corrupt form had come into being, or as corrupt dittography of *mem* → *mem* + *nun* with subsequent defective → *plene* imprecision of transmission (well-documented in MT-Job), or through some kind of emendation.

Third, **חָדָל** (this retroversion of OG is secure, having multiple parallels) became **תְּבִינוּ** though *chet/taw* visual error, *beth/dalet* visual error, and *lamed/nun+waw* visual error (followed by an insertion of a *plene yodh*), or some similar process; alternatively or (partly) in addition, this might be related to the second item just mentioned. At rate, the M(T) reading was surely facilitated in some measure by the prominence of the **בִּין** root in Job.

(Concerning **קִנְצִי**, see HALOT.)

Job 19:18

Following the spelling but not pointing of OG (cf. THB 1C).

Job 19:29

Neither the Kt, שדי, nor the Qr, שדון, is clear as to its meaning; the commentators and lexicographers are much puzzled by the forms. Given the high number of *hapax legomena* in Job, it is possible that we simply have a form (whether the Kt or the Qr) which we understand dimly at best. (Is one form an infinitive of די in the š-stem? Is the Kt שדי with an energetic *nun*, as someone cited in NICOT suggests, or a non-Hebraic majestic plural ending? These suggestions seem far-fetched, but, especially with respect to the first and third, difficult to rule out entirely.)

The Vulgate reading is unlikely to represent שדישדין, for (a) it is difficult to account for the MT on transcriptional grounds, (b) the Vulgate is on historical grounds unlikely uniquely to have preserved an original reading, especially where polygenesis is not likely in play, and (c) the difficult MT and the goal of Jerome to be sensible likely means that Jerome was grasping for meaning about as much as we are.

Difficult to assess but in the end important is the evidence of the LXX. The translation σου εστιν αυτων η υλη might take the ש as the relative pronoun (σου εστιν) and די or די as “matter” (υλις); the αυτων is probably interpretive, but just might reflect a *Vorlage* or a misreading שדיהון (in this case די is understood similarly as in 21:5, 31:2, 40:2; cf. Joosten in *Helmet on a Hill* on the Aramaic ending).

An alternative approach to the LXX is to take υλις in the sense of “thicket” and to retrovert שמיר, which could then be understood in the sense “flint,” referring presumably to a weapon of judicial sentence or of warfare. The advantage here is that, relative to שדי, the putative G reading could be identical with respect to two letters (and their positions), similar with respect to another (in the square script), and have the same number of letters. This reading would, however, be about as obscure as the MT. The words σου εστιν αυτων would be the interpretive/clarifying work of the translator on this view (as noted, the αυτων is likely from the translator, not the *Vorlage*; little can be made of εστιν in any case, and σου is quite plausibly part of the translator's contribution as well).

Probably the best way to understand the LXX is to take υλις in the sense of “thicket” but to retrovert שדי, understood by the translator as שדי (the same mistaken vocalization seems to be reflected in the Ps 104:16). As BDB (sub די) points out, the LXX uses υλωδης in 29:5 to render the consonant string שדי, so this scenario has a degree of precedent to it. The Kt would then predate the Qr (the latter being either an attempt to wrest sense from the Kt or a transcriptional error) and most likely have arisen from a mechanical repetition of the *nun* with which the previous word, תדען, unexpectedly terminates. The words σου εστιν αυτων would be the interpretive/clarifying work of the translator on this view as well.

The last solution is only tentative, but it seems plausible and makes sense of the line.

Job 20:17

Difficult; see WBC. It is possible that we should reading sg. נהר and understand “oil,” but given (1) the understanding of the OG and (2) the strong Jewish-Aramaic evidence (see CAL sub דהין) for the word given here, buttressed by other possible Aramaisms in Job, this solution tentatively seems best.

Job 20:23a

Corrupt dittography of the preceding *waw* + *yodh/nun* confusion.

Job 20:23b

So also Muraoka 83^a.

Job 21:8

Difficult. Tentatively, we take עמם to be a doublet in M, and לנפשם to be visual confusion for לפניהם in G.

Job 21:12

The possibility of *beth/kaph* error is so plausible that it is no stretch to assume it to underlie OG, which translates not with εν but with the accusative because of Greek grammar (it not being a hyper-literal translation) (notice that the translation does not have any circumlocution suggesting כ or otherwise that the syntax of the first noun is different from that of the second [in Hebrew, of course, the preposition is elided on the second not, to no

semantic effect]). The suggestion כִּתְּרִי is dubious and does not fit the context; see further on this point WBC.

Job 23:13

See WBC, adding that it is reasonable to retrovert OG as thus reading (though admittedly this exact equivalence does not occur elsewhere); aural dittography + *dalth/resh* confusion. (Another option is to read כָּאֶחָד, comparable to קָאֵם in MinP. This spelling would not surprise me in Job, which has a number of similar spellings. However, would OG have translated at it did with that reading in its *Vorlage*?)

{Post-script: Indeed it seemingly would, for the literal translator of Hosea renders said form (10:14) as a *weqatal*, not as a participle (if it were interpreted as an Aramaic-style participle). Note also the conclusion reached at 25:5 (Research Notes); consistency all but demands following a similar course here.}

Job 24:21

Difficult. Tentatively, we take G (which, as elsewhere, translates loosely) and T to represent הִרַע. P = MT but points רָעָה.

Job 26:13

A difficult colon (WBC has extensive discussion; and see also 3:1066-1067). Ultimately, I think graphical error (facilitated by a difficult passage) is at fault. The reading בְּרִיחִי is appealing not only as helping to impart (as I think) a suitable sense to the colon in which it sits, but it also prepares the way or a very Job-like play on words in the second colon, wherein the root בָּרַח reappears, but with a different meaning. As for שְׁפִירָה, here is perhaps the greatest difficulty. Tentatively, I see this an alternate spelling of a root סָפַר meaning something like “tear down”: Cf. Syriac ܣܦܪ meaning “shave” or “gnaw” (on the latter see <https://archive.org/details/ishodadofmervbis03daaduoft/page/n185/mode/2up>) and the OG use here of the verb δειδω, which in general seems to translate Hebrew verbs which hover between fear and being brought low / destruction. DCH apparently argues along similar lines, and the root in this sense probably appears in Job 38:37.

Job 28:11-12

In preparing a follow-up edition for SRO (in the Fall of 2024), I encountered an anomaly: here many (all?) important witnesses, including UXLC, have an open paragraph, but SRO-1 had none. I have added it for future editions.

Job 30:22

Tentatively, we follow BDB in taking the Kt to be from a by-form of שָׁאַה, “to crash [trans.].”

Job 31:7-8

UXLC has a paragraph break here, but BHQ disputes that L has one here. In any case, other external evidence and intrinsic evidence tells against the presence of a break here.

Job 33:14

Since Elihu is indignant at Job's alleged non-reponsiveness, and goes on to list ways in which God *does* (not *does not*) reveal himself, an asseverative rather than a negative seems to fit better here.

Job 33:17b

The verb כָּסַח is rare, which fact, together with the visual similarity of *cheth* to *he*, explains M well. That LXX's εἰρησαστο represents this is suggested by the Aramaic senses of פָּרַק combined with the LXX tendency to read Hebrew through an Aramaic filter.

Job 33:21

Seeing OG (which has a verb [singular, but this, in a stylistically-sensitive OG book like Job, is not surprising with the neuter plural subject], not a noun) as supporting Qr, on the meaning of which see HALOT sub שָׁפַח.

Job 34:14

A doublet of רוּחוֹ, facilitated by visual similarity and by the expectation of the noun לֵב after the root שִׁים.

Job 34:26

Hiph'il 3ms from root חתה (cf. Ges paradigms for roots עִיע).

Job 34:36a

Seemingly אֲבִי is a ghost word (cf. HALOT 1:4a), here inserted via a faded *lamedh* and the frequency of the word אֵב. The use of אֲבִל is fitting in that this is a late book (cf. HALOT *l.c.*); on the retroversion, cf. the Daniel references (in Theodotian) and 2 Esdras.

Job 35:16-36:1

Following MA, given the reliability of this MS, the intrinsic evidence, and the fact that closed sections are somewhat more fragile than other section types.

Job 37:24

As NICOT and WBC point out, חֲכָמֵי לֵב is not used in a pejorative sense (“those who think themselves wise”) elsewhere in the OT; this being the case, there is some problem with the MT, at least as pointed. NICOT, WBC and Anderson suggest something meaning “the wise of heart (surely) fear him.” It is difficult to derive the MT לֹא יִרְאֶה from יִרְאוּהוּ or יִרְאוּהוּ, and the pointing לֹא יִרְאֶה, while difficult to rule out altogether, seems unlikely to me. Taking the root as רָאָה, in the sense of “regard with approval,” assuming God as the implied subject, and pointing לֹא as (as at least some of the commentators do) an asseverative, seems to yield good sense: “He gives his approval to the wise.”

{Post-script: That understanding of רָאָה seems forced, though, and does not fit well with v21 or Elihu's view of God in general. Given that (a) poetry in Job often uses the same verb in both lines (as NICOT somewhere points out), and (b) a defective plural verb is sometimes found *where there is a 3ms suffix* (e.g. יִאֲכֻלוּ, Ex 12:8), a better approach seems to be יִרְאֶהוּ, assuming near haplography.}

Job 38:10

Beth/mem confusion + *mem/resh* confusion (or, in place of that second element: *yodh/resh* confusion + overlooking the *mem*). Alternatively or as a facilitating factor, the scribe's eye dropped down to, or his mind anticipated, the pre-M(T) reading יִשְׁבֵּר in v11 (*q.v.*), which resembles יִשְׁבֵּר all the more in light of the fact that יִשְׁבֵּר is preceded by וּפָא, the *aleph* of which might have squeezed out the *yodh* (and possibly, but not necessarily, the *pe* was overlooked owing to near haplography).

Job 38:11

Metathesis + *yodh/resh* confusion + wrong word division + addition of a helping letter (unless, in place of that fourth element, we hypothesize corrupt dittography at some stage).

Job 38:15

Corrupt dittography of the following *waw* + *zayin*.

Job 41:12

The path is a bit unclear, but this makes more sense. On the retroversion of OG, see 1 Sam 14:7. M might be influenced by Job 40:26.

Job 42:9

Near haplography after the preceding *waw*, or else a slightly different error involving *tsadde* in the paleo script.

Job 42:11-12

UXLC has a paragraph break here, but BHQ disputes that L has one here. In any case, other external evidence and intrinsic evidence tells against the presence of a break here.

Introduction to Proverbs

G adds much material, most of which has no clear transcriptional or theological trigger for its omission and so is suspect. Yet a few long readings might be due to homoeoteleuton or the like. Moreover, a number of long readings in M similarly have no clear motivation for their loss in G and, particularly where they span more than one verse, are thus suspect as well. Here are two important lists along these lines (culled from HBCE and Ginsburg):

G minuses

13:6

(15:28 4QPrb; note that this MS is stichometric: THB 1C:248^b)

15:31

16:1

16:3

16:6 ("cf. G 15:27a": HBCE 240)

18:23-19:2

20:14-19

22:6

23:23

13:6 might be an inner-greek loss; see HBCE.

HBCE notes that the M readings from 15:31-16:6 fit well in their context, so adding intrinsic evidence to the possibility of a stichometric arrangement in an early MS and the consideration that M was less prone to add than G in this book, it seems preferable to keep the long readings in that section. In addition, that section contains much resequencing in G, and it is easy to imagine material being lost in the shuffle.

The long sections seem necessary to dispense with given their length and the non-motivation of G to remove them.

Pr 22:6 is suspicious, in that חָנַךְ in this sense and (secondarily) ל + direct object seem more characteristic of later Hebrew than earlier. On the other hand, see Segal on עַל פִּי in the prepositions section and note the possibility of near homoeoteleuton.

Pr 23:23 is suspicious as being similar to 4:5 and, perhaps more importantly, it interrupts the immediate context (see HBCE).

In sum, the minuses before chapter 17 are either possibly invalid (13:6) or have transcriptional causes (the rest); those after chapter 17 are, with the possible exception of 22:6 (this suspicious on other grounds) hard to explain on transcriptional grounds. Note in this connection M's rearrangement of 31:25-26. Might M have been copied (somewhat poorly, given the many transcriptional errors) from a mixed exemplar, the second half of which descends from an expansionistic type of text?

G pluses to consider

3:15 (near homoeoteleuton?)

3:22 (homoeoteleuton?)

22:8 (homoeoteleuton?)

27:20 (near homoeoteleuton?)

HBCE has helpful comments on the G pluses.

Note with reference to 3:15 that Ben Sirach might have gotten the thought from here (in Hebrew). However, it interrupts a proverb also found in 8:11, which suggests that it is secondary to the biblical book of Proverbs, whatever its source.

In favor of 3:22 note the preponderance of paired couplets in the immediate context. There is no clear trigger for addition, the book does repeat itself at times, and homoeoteleuton readily explains the short reading (as it does a number of G minuses elsewhere). {Post-script: But OG so often imports lines from elsewhere that this is more likely a secondary plus.}

22:8 is likely, as HBCE notes in so many words, a corrupt dittography.

Re 27:20, HBCE argues that the plus is inspired by עֵינַי earlier in the verse and by 16:30. The latter verse is much more a conceptual than a verbal parallel, however. The immediately surrounding verses seem often to repeat a word twice, which is not true of the G couplet here. Note also the close proximity to another large G plus (next v): While this could be coincidental, it could also be evidence of intervenionism in this part of the book in G. A decision is difficult, and so pending further research M is retained as being from the more reliable witness.

Pr 1:21

On the form (חַמִּיּוֹת) see HBCE, though Fox prefers M on the basis that Wisdom is seeking crowds, not heights. But note 8:2 (the reference came to my attention from a somewhat related context in BDB sub ראשׁ), the various passages about standing on a wall (→ DCH sub חומה with <PREP> על), note the suitability of שַׁעַר as a parallel term (though admittedly the same arguably goes for חַמִּיּוֹת), the rarity of the spelling חַמִּיּוֹת, and בְּרֹאשׁ, which, it seems to me, is suitable with the G reading than with the M reading.

Pr 2:9

Near haplography of *taw*, corrupt dittography of the *kaph* of the following word, the influence of the morphological shape of the preceding וּמִשְׁפָּט, mechanical assimilation to the two previous words (viz., nouns), or some combination of these factors, facilitated by a MS lacking line breaks, led to the error. As for instinct evidence, see BDB sub יָשַׁר *pi'el*; the meaning fits well and accords with usage elsewhere in this book. It is true that a string of nouns can tranverse a line break in Proverbs (see, at least, 3:2), but the syntax here remains awkward, the sense of G strong, and the transcriptional situation not implausible, so that G seems preferable.

Pr 3:24

Corrupt dittography. (See HBCE on the intrinsic evidence.) Potentially helpful in confirming the reading is the testimony of P (unless HBCE is right that P-Pr frequently consults OG-Pr).

Pr 3:34

Just possibly אֵם is asseverative, but if that usage exists, all or nearly all cases are restricted to Job, a much later book than this (solomonic portion of) Proverbs. Are we rather to follow OG (in the form in which the NT quotes it, although even as it stands OG might represent a form other than the Tetragrammaton) in reading אֱלֹהִים, positing an accidental drop of the middle letters (somehow facilitated perhaps by its resemblance to the following לִלְצִיִּם)? Note the lack of an antecedent in M, and the existence in M of a very similar error in the following verse.

Pr 3:28

Kt is corrupt dittography in the paleo script, assimilation to the grammatical number of מְבַעֲלִי in v27, or perhaps

one facilitated by the other.

Pr 4:16

The confluence of PVT here suggests that the Qr might be based on a really-existing reading in the MT tradition (check Ginsburg and Kennicott whether in fact it is); even if it was not, these groups of witnesses together, along side the ease with which *waw/yodh* could have occurred in the early days of the MT text, suggests that the reading adopted here is in fact the original M reading.

Pr 4:27-5:1

For some reason MM (with M^L) does not have a sectional break here, but BHQ lists M^A (and M^Y) as having one, and JC has one (and agrees with M^A and M^Y that it is an open break).

Pr 5:6

That is, “The way of life she does not tread” (on the verb פלס, cf. Ps 78:50, etc.). Given the strong external evidence, פן might be an inner-M error. Some argue that פן can mean something other than “lest,” but the linguistic evidence is dubious indeed (CDCH does not acknowledge any alternatives!). Setting aside for the sake of argument that only here, as some note, does פן follow rather than precede the key matter, the meaning with the MT reading could be “The way of life lest she tread, her feet have tottered, etc.” (affirming a doctrine of reprobation). But the syntax is complex and tortured. Much simpler is reading בל, which again has strong external evidence, and visual error similarity coupled with the rarity of בל explains the variation on transcriptional grounds. (And on intrinsic grounds, Solomon does use בל elsewhere in this book, e.g. 9:13.)

{Post-script: J-M p568 n1 claims that פן sometimes is synonymous with אל, but even if so, that does not apply in this context.}

Pr 6:23

HALOT (2: 1699a) mentions but dismisses a proposal to read with G P תוכחת ומוסר for L's תוכחות מוסר. Now, MM (=SR1,2) has תוכחת מוסר, i.e., the first word is plene, so metathesis of L's second waw is not likely. But what if the original text was תוכחת ומסר, i.e. with metathesis of the conjunction to the spot that the more common spelling מוסר would lead a scribe to expect? M does read oddly.

Pr 7:10

The plural of לב occurs 4x in Pr (15:11, 17:3, 21:2, 24:12), making it somewhat distinctive of the book (it occurs elsewhere only 3x, viz. Ps 7:10, 125:4, Isa 44:18), so G V could be an assimilation to (locally) common usage. Yet when V is added to G, the external evidence for a rare form is not insignificant. Tentatively, we suppose M to have assimilated to the more common term in Scripture (594x). (Note as well that LXX-Pr uses the plural of καρδια 10x but the singular 67x, so its use of the plural here is likely significant, especially when put alongside V.)

Pr 7:22e

See HBCE (G's rendering appears in v23, albeit not immediately, either due to free rendering as HBCE thinks, or some error of transposition).

Pr 8:5

HBCE doubts the retroversion, but he does so against some weighty textual critics. See further NICOT.

Pr 8:16a

M disrupts the definite pattern in vv15-16 in a way that appears to me to be more likely due to transcriptional error than to a lack of stylistic consistency on Solomon's part: The *kaph* of כל is a corrupt dittography of the preceding *mem* (in either a paleo or a square script), the *yodh* became *lamedh* by error (perhaps because *yodh* can, in some scripts, resemble a *lamedh* if it runs up too closely to the immediately above line of text or the ink

ran at the top of the letter), and the final *waw* became *yodh* (more likely in a square script, but still quite possible in a paleo script). (Another possibility is that כל comes from בי, but this would disrupt the pattern, and δὲ εἰς is quite plausibly explained at the translator's addition; alternatively, a separate error from that found in M led to בי being inserted as a corrupt dittography of the end of וְנִיבִים and the beginning of יִשְׁפֹּטוּ, facilitated by the two-fold occurrence of this word in the near context.)

Pr 8:16b

A complex case. Very many MT MSS read אֶרֶץ, while others, including L and A (according to MM) have צִדֵּק. P has a difficult textual variant here; I leave towards the “righteousness” reading, but HBCE prefers the “land” reading. V reflects צִדֵּק (and BSV records no variants). On balance, the weight M^{AL} and the ancient of testimony of V and, possibly, P leans me toward saying that the M reading was צִדֵּק. The G reading, on the other hand, appears clearly to have been אֶרֶץ. Given the phraseology שְׁפִטֵי אֶרֶץ elsewhere, the possibility of assimilation to צִדֵּק in the previous verse, and the visual similarity of צִדֵּק to אֶרֶץ, the word אֶרֶץ seems preferable. {Anchor (67) agrees with G.}

Pr 8:24

See HBCE. On the pointing, cf. Job 28:11 (pointed there as per Huehnergard). The same pointing as here has been adopted in Job 38:16.

Pr 8:28

Metathesis, perhaps triggered by the fact that the following word will have *waw* as their penultimate letter. Among others cf. HALOT 1: 809a.

Pr 9:13

Following Anchor (75) in seeing M as an inadvertent omission. *Pace* HBCE, such is not too hard to see: only two letters, not dissimilar to the nearby וְכָל; and to my mind it is not, given the difficulties of word spacing in many MSS, hard to imagine that at some stage the first two letters were misread as the common word כָּל and separated from what follows, then lost. On this reading כִּלְמָה is parallel (in sound and meaning) to פְּתִיּוֹת אֶסְמִיָּה as כְּסִלּוֹת. Note also the conceptual parallel in Jer 3:3 etc.

Incidentally, is it possible that the daghesh in MT points to the existence of a *sevir* here?

Pr 12:14

The Qr seems preferable: Elsewhere where forms of גְּמֹול co-occur with a form of the root שׁוּב, the verb is in the *hiph'il* (except for Ob 1:15, but there the text seems incorrect, given the factors mentioned here and the non-negligible rate of error in M-MinP); the Kt could easily have emerged by accident, given the ease of *waw/yodh* confusion and the frequency of the *qal* of שׁוּב.

Pr 13:4

Vertical dittography, perhaps facilitated by the later occurrence of נִפְשׁ. (Alternatively, but less likely, a misplaced dittography of נִפְשׁ corrupted via transposition.)

Pr 14:3

M(T)'s תִּשְׁמֹרוּם is probably a *lapsus calami* (metathesis) for תִּשְׁמְרוּם (so HBCE; as this source observes, it is impossible to know what G has, but good Greek style does, given the neuter plural χεῖλη, readily explain the singular φυλασσει). (J-M 44c offers, with doubt, a possible explanation for M(T), unless one points with an /u/ vowel under the *resh* – that is, a defective plural with an objective suffix, not a common orthographic phenomenon – this, together with the odd phonology, makes M(T) unlikely indeed. I contemplated positing a noun “guard” or some such with the 3mp possessive suffix תִּשְׁמְרוֹם on the model of J-M 88Lu, but this too runs into the problem of grammatical number.)

Pr 14:33

Note especially Aq. Accidental omission of a small word, probably facilitated by visual similarity (especially in a paleo script) to the last to letter of the preceding כסילים ידע. It is doubtful to me whether ידע niph'al can bear the sense required in M, but “be known” (in the heightened Hebraic sense) makes good sense here, considering both the parallel line and the sense כסילים in Proverbs.

Pr 19:27

As HBCE notes, “Some commentators construe this verse as ironic, but this reading does not really work” (279); at the least, such an ironic sense to these words here would be quite unexpected. While HBCE sees the problem as insoluble, I tentatively take a cue from HALOT re חזל and read רעה for דעת with G.

Pr 22:20

See especially WBC on the intrinsic evidence and HCE on the external evidence. It probable that G and S indeed read שלישים in that שלשים would likely have been rendered by at least one of them “thirty” (rather than “three”), but not certain. In that case we would make use the (rarely used) principle that readings can be reconstructed from elements of different witnesses – that is to say, we can read שלשים, borrowing the *lack* of a medial *yodh* from M(T) and the *presence* of a penultimate *yodh* (in place of the MT *waw*) from G (+S?; Fox here says S in independent, but does he not in the intro posit a dependence of S on G?). But it is also possible that G indeed had שלשים, or שלשם, in which case we are simply adopting a G reading *in toto* as often. The last-mentioned reading is appealing one two counts: First, the unusual spelling might have occasioned the unusual mental vocalization of the OG translator (and so also the Syriac translator?), and second, the highly defective spelling might be due to an allusion to a work (a Hebrew-language translation of *Instruction of Amenemope*) done roughly at or before Solomon's time and for reason of that early date likely to have exhibited much defective spelling (true, the Pentateuch typically has relatively full spellings – see Tov, 3rd edition for the data here, to much there is nuance to be sure – but the spellings there might be due to a post-mosaic, canonical “touching-up” (the word might be Steinmann's, from his *From Abraham to Paul*, q.v. re the Pentateuch). The chief downside of שלשם is that it leaves M^{Kt} שלשום a bit hard to explain, whereas שלשים or שלישים provides a mechanism (*waw/yodh* confusion). Perhaps the /o/ vowels in the nearby הלא and במועצת influenced the scribe in question. It is also to be remarked that for as much as “the day before yesterday” does not make much sense here, neither does “three times,” which might have led to an oral tradition of vocalizing as if the word was שלשום. Still another possibility is corrupt dittography of the right half of the final *mem*.

Pr 22:21

Cf. HALOT 1:67a.

Pr 23:18

See HBCE (near homoeoteleuton).

Pr 23:24

(NB for L's Kt יגול JC has יגיל w/o Qr)

Pr 24:5b

In general, see HBCE; adding that M(T)'s *waw* might be due to corrupt dittography of the following *zayin* (suggested by a skewed interpretation of the verse or by aural influence from preceding הון and/or following כח).
{Post-script: All in all, a plene spelling seems more likely; then, it is just a single-letter error in M.}

Ps 24:12

Yodh/nun error: the root נצ"ר does not bear the sense required here, and יצ"ר is elsewhere linked with רוח, a synonym of נפש.

G seems to read נפשים or נפשמ (kaph/mem confusion, possibly with near haplography as well). Note the

grammatical parallelism with לבות. (O)G added כל as often, but this can be set aside.

Pr 24:22-23

So JC. This would be the only closed section in the book. Ginsburg's testimony is unclear; there might have been a typesetting error toward the end of this book involving the indentation, or the MS(S) on which the Rabbinic Bible was based saw systematic alteration near the end (presumably this MS evidence is late, and conflicts, on most points at least, with both M^L and M^A, a circumstance that is not especially suggestive of originality).

Pr 25:20

See HBCE (corrupt dittography).

Pr 25:27

Reading והקר (infinitive from hiph'il יקר, “to make precious” or, here and elsewhere, “rare”) makes for good parallelism, and the rival reading is explainable as transcriptional error. HBCE and HALOT 1:432^a are in agreement on this point. BHQ agrees that the LXX is thus to be retroverted but prefers M without comment. NICOT (307 n⁵³) dissents from the G reading because of the “track record of the LXX in this book,” yet goes on to advance a conjectural emendation (308 n⁵³).

The rest of the verse is trickier. Tentatively, we propose that G had a defective דברם rather than a *plene* דברים (as HBCE, BHQ have it); such explains the M reading more easily.

Also tentatively, we suppose that G also read כבוד, though HBCE's suggestion of מְכַבֵּד also seems possible.

Pr 27:13

Cf. 20:16.

27:16

צפן רוה I take to be a corrupt dittograph of the following צפן רוה (or possibly of צפן alone): It is insensible, HBCE's appeal to V is unlikely on external grounds, dittography is a plausible transcriptional explanation, and OG leaves is unrepresented (σκληρος is added for clarity, as in 29:19). This leaves the question of the pointing: צָפֵן (see NICOT) or צָפֵן (more or all of the ancient versions); we will return to this question below except to note that צָפֵן רוה as a term meaning “north win” seems very plausible (cf. 25:23).

For the retroversion of OG's second line HBCE and BHQ agree with a certain scholar in retroverting וְשָׁמוּ יְמִינִי יִקְרָא. If this is the original reading, I would appeal to the evidence (see HALOT s.v.) that יְמִינִי can mean “lucky,” and then speculate that this is an auto-antonym (enantiosemy), which is, it seems to me, fairly common with terms having to do with religion, luck, honor/shame, and the like; so the meaning should be “And his [viz., the husband's] name will be called [viz. by his friends] 'Unlikely.’” The difficulty here, beyond the speculative semantic analysis, is the sudden introduction of a 3rd singular reference. Yet so would it be if the M pointing of צָפֵן is followed. More substantively, it shifts the focus from description of the wife (the certain focus of v15, and the focus, if צָפֵן is read there, in v16a) to the position of the husband, while if יִקְרָא can be an alternate spelling of קָרָא and mean “unexpectedly encounter” (both quite valid suppositions in my view), the M reading in v16b, while like every other reading featuring a rather oblique reference to the husband, nevertheless maintains a focus on the wife, describing her character as (not only like the north wind – so the previous line as I vocalize it) slippery (=unable to be contained or controlled). So leaving v16b as it is, but dropping צָפֵן רוה and reading צָפֵן in v16a, seems best, though certainly this is a difficult case.

Pr 29:4

תרומות is unparalleled in this sense (see., e.g., WBC), and visual error (facilitated by the rarity of תרומית) explains the difference. DCH lists one of the antonyms of משפט as being מרמה, to opposing justice to deception has precedent. (Another possible retroversion, not cited in the secondary literature to my knowledge {but I have not checked every source at this point} is מזומות or מזוימות.)

Pr 30:1

M is taken as a faulty word division, G as haplography or abbreviation. The reading as given (or the shorter G reading) prepares the way for v2 (notice the starting כִּי); M does not make sense

Pr 30:17

See OG and DCH 4:521a.

Pr 30:31

Cf. HBCE and the error in Dt 33:21.

Ruth 2:1

On the sense of Kt and Qr, see BDB (clearly Qr is preferable). We follow G (on the equivalence, see OG-3:2).

Ruth 2:7a-b

Here is what we propose (cf. BHQ):

-It seems somewhat more likely that the LXX is interpreting עָתָה than that it saw עָרַב

-A damaged exemplar led M to mistake an original לָהּ for זֶה (unusual orthography occurs elsewhere in the book; in the paleo script as well as the modern this error seems just possible; the same spelling occurs in Dt 3:11 [kt], where G might have read הִנֵּה, but even if so, the presence of a *he* in the third slot is still attested even by it; here it could be argued that G had לָא, but even if so, the presence of a *lamedh* in the first slot is still attested). (It could be argued from v14 that she *is* in the house, but see WBC [125])

-LXX correctly vocalizes שָׁבִתָּה

-The LXX (a) either interprets/emends הַבֵּית or (b) is an inner-greek corruption has occurred (OIKΩ → ΑΓΡΩ); the latter scenario is in some degree supported by the fact that forms of οἶκος occur 6x in Ruth, while forms of ἀγρός occur 17x.

{The spelling לָהּ as occurs (with a prefix) in Dt 4:32, where Codex Cairensis has לָא, but JC, etc. have לָהּ.}

Ruth 2:22

Following a Q MS (cf. the “Textual History of Ruth” article in THB 1C, though not necessarily accepting all the details of the argument there). (Such orthographic expansions would become rare in the medieval period when the Kt-Qr system tended to call attention to, and by calling to oral corrections to, preserve the defective -aw endings.)

Ruth 3:14a

Re מְרַגְלוֹתוּ: L (as transcribed by WLC 4.20, *not* BHS), and Ginsburg (main text) have מְרַגְלוֹתוּ; MM {have not checked JC or the M^A PDF} and some MSS cited by Ginsburg have מְרַגְלוֹתוּ. Four of the five total occurrences of this word occur in Ruth, and the three cases in Ruth besides this case all occur *before* 3:14 and *all* have a *defective* spelling; therefore, and in light of the (apparent) strong testimony behind the *plene*, the defective is taken to be assimilation (a counter-argument on intrinsic grounds might be that the author of Ruth preferred the defective spelling, but given the wide variations in spelling elsewhere within an author, this seems unlikely).

Ruth 4:4

BHQ makes M impossible to explain, yet there are a number of other interchanges of the second and third person imperfect prefix forms in the OT, including in Ruth (see the apparatuses on 3:15). Given the testimony of G, the second person form is viable, and attempts to explain the third person seem highly strained.

Ruth 4:5

See the Tyndale Bulletin 1990 article (available free online) for extensive discussion. His conclusion seem basically sound, with the possible modification that G seems to have read קְנוֹתָהּ (influenced no doubt by קְנוֹתָהּ)

earlier in the verse); but the point remains that reading קנייתה makes the best sense of probably any reading, attested or even conjectural.

Introduction to Song of Songs

BHQ (10*) states: “Both 4QCant^a and 4qCant^b have a text which, as Tov has demonstrated, has been intentionally shortened: 4QCant^a lacks 4:8-6:10, 4QCant^b 3:6-8, 4:4-7; 4QCant^b ends with 5:1. The text of 4QCant^a is closer to M than that of 4QCant^b.” There is very strong reason to question whether 4QCant^b really ends at 5:1: Apparently the only reason for this supposition is the large final *mem* in דודים (see THB 1C: 321^b and 327^b; cf. Tov, “Excerpted,” 592 and, on the uncertain origin/function of small and large letters, see David Marcus, “Does the *Yod* of נִפְשִׁי in Ps 24:4 Represent a Miniscule *Waw*?” 132-134 in *Textus* 2018), but “4QJosh^a attest[s] to the same scribal practice in Josh 8:18 but the manuscript does not end there” (327^b). As the other two omissions in 4QCant^b are explainable as transcriptional error (see below), it best to view this MS as supporting, contrary to general opinion, the macro-structure of MT (there are eccentricities of a minor character).

Interestingly, both 4:8-6:10 and 3:6-8 are both (in M^L; M^A is not extant past ציון בנות in 3:11 according to BHS *8) bracketed by closed sections, making the situation reminiscent of Jdg 6:7-10 where accidental omission due to the space is possible, though ואמר in that passage is suspicious, and perhaps the interpolator included the sections (there are parallels in M-Jer). 4:4 does not begin a section, but as just implied, 4:7 does end a section (the break is closed in M^L, open in M^Y). 5:1 has a closed sectional break following (open in M^Y), though it is far from obvious why this circumstance would lead to the accidental close of the book so very early.

A notable feature of 4QCant^a is its text in 4:1-2, where the word order (a) would seem to be assimilated to vv3ff, but (b) is *not* reflective of 6:5-6, which vv, of course, 4QCant^a does not have. Possible scenarios: (a) 4QCant^a is abbreviated, and assimilates in chap. 4 without regard for chap. 6; (b) 4QCant^a is original, and the additional material mirrored 4:1-2 imperfectly at this point; (c) 4QCant^a is original with regard to 4:8-6:10, but, after the E text split off, itself broke off from the purest of C texts in assimilating 4:1-2 to vv3ff. The last option seems the most likely in the light of the probable assimilation in 3:11 (ציון for ירושלם).

Reasons for Including 4:8-6:10

- 1) No obvious reason for the material to be added (but same could be said for many interpolations in other cases; see also the third point below)
- 2) Very many verbal connections (but this is the norm for many G-type marco-interpolations)
- 3) Many thematic connections (but see above; indeed, this might be the reason for the insertion, as macro-expansions, where they do not pad out the text with additional historical details, and surely sometime where they do, tend to dwell on the real or perceived themes of the biblical text)
- 4) The transition from 4:7 to 6:11 seems a bit abrupt (but not impossibly so, to judge from the portions of the book not subject on documentary grounds to doubt)
- 5) Diachronics: (a) The apparently old form כמו occurs in 6:10 (also in 7:2); (b) את in the sense “with” occurs in 4:8 (only there in the book; it is possible that אתי is intended); (c) mention of תרצה, a northern city, in 6:4 (but the fame of the city could easily have reached the Southern Kingdom, and the kingdoms were not always; Amos 6:1 provides an example, surely one among many, of periods when the two kingdoms, while not altogether harmonious – note the rhetorical strategy in 2:5 – could be discussed together and share imagery and ideas).

Reasons for Excluding 4:8-6:10

- 1) No clear transcriptional grounds for accidental loss (as noted above, it is surrounded by sectional breaks, yet the amount of text is so large that this seems likely; furthermore, 4:8-6:10 has sectional breaks within it); the length of the passage (34 verses), while significant, is not unprecedented (the Song of the Three in Dan chapter 3 is 69 verses in the LXX!)
- 2) A number of stylistic dissonances seem to be evident: (a) as the ESV Study Bible points out, כלה occurs repeatedly but only in this passage (but note usage of this word ends at 5:1, so it could be argued that it used specifically of the wedding night); (b) the toponym לבנון is used *with* the article outside this passage (and, according to MT at least, in Ps 72:16), but *without* the article (as in DSS; so HALOT) in this passage (largely,

writers are consistent in their usage – 2 Ki 19:23 is an exception that proves the rule, being dependent upon Isa 37:24 – though David in Ps 29:5-6 and Isaiah and Ezekiel are not), though there are notable parallels in usage with גלעד (see below) such that this might be explainable; (c) only in 5:5 and 5:6 does a pronoun immediately follow a pronoun; (d) only in 6:5 does a verb immediately follow a pronoun with the same referent (in 8:9 the pronouns and the verbs have different referents); (e) repeatedly and only in this section is אהות used in a non-literal sense (it is used in a literal sense in 8:8); (f) the numeral אחד or אהת occurs only in this section; (g) the word יד, potentially charged in such a context as SS, occurs in the singular only in this section (5:4! and 5:5); elsewhere it occurs only in the plural in what is probably a set phrase (7:2; the plural does occur in 5:14, just possibly with connotations); (h) 4:1 uses גלעד *without* the article, 6:5 *with* it (but this is probably not a problem – see BDB s.v.); (i) in 4:2, the *hapax* הקצובות is used, while in 6:6 the (slightly) more common רחלים is used (cf. 4:3 in 4QCant^a with 6:6); (j) the word השבעתי is used 3x (and only 3x) in the undisputed section of action *not* to occur, but 2x (and only 2x) in the disputed section of action *to* occur; (l) גן is used several times in the singular (usually with reference to the bride) in the disputed section, but in the undisputed only גנים (*not* used in reference to the bride) and (in reference to the bride) the relatively rare גנה; (l) גנה with and without suffixes occurs 9x outside this section, but never within it; (m) neither שלמה nor המלך occur, though they occur 7x and 5x respectively elsewhere (there is, however, a royal reference in 6:8); (n) לילה occurs in the majestic plural in 3:1 and 3:8, but in the singular in 5:2; (o) constructions like קומי לך in 2:10 occur 7x outside but never within this section; (p) the imperative is used 35x in the whole book, but only in 4:8 does an imperfect for a positive command occur (of course negative imperatives of command are beside the point); (q) כי occurs 5x in the book, but never in this section (cf. especially 2:5 and 5:8); (r) צמה occurs in 6:7 in a clause possibly borrowed verbatim from 4:3, and use of צמה after 5:1 might be problematic (cf. Isa 47:1-2; but בתולה there need not mean “virgin” or necessarily be programmatic in the respect required by this argument); (s) או occurs 5x but never in this section; (t) the construction עד ש occurs 8x (e.g. 1:12) but never in this section; (u) עם is used only 1x outside this section, but 8x within it; (v) מי זאת is in 6:10 followed by an article, but not so 3:6 and 8:5. Of course as is evident from Mk 16 and Jn 8, such evidence is fraught with difficulty. The phrase בנות ציון, for instance, occurs only in 3:11. The *waw* consecutive imperfect occurs only in 6:9, but the *waw* consecutive perfect occurs twice outside the passage (2:17 and 4:6, both the same expression); note that in Ecc the former expression is rare (and uses the cohortative endings) but does occur, while the latter occurs somewhat more often. Moreover, OT authors often incorporated various sources into their compositions (e.g. the Chronicler). If Solomon incorporated another love poem into his, then that might account for the stylistic differences. However, (a) the similarities between 4:8-6:10 and the rest of SS are so striking that it is hard not to see literary dependency, though admittedly the direction of dependence might be such that Solomon was modelling his work after 4:8-6:10, and (b) especially given what was just noted under (a), what are the chances that a later scribe would omit precisely 4:8-6:10, if that section was original to the book?

3) 5:2-8 is very difficult, but in the end is probably not best understood as highly, specifically sexual in nature; cf., e.g., Concordia there.

4) 5:9-16 would be the only extended praise of the man's physical features. It thus could have been added to balance the book, but its exclusion, if original, is hard to account for.

The matter in 4:8-6:10 can be summarized thus: (1) an actual invitation, missing otherwise; (2) confirmation of consummation; (3) a new dream sequence; (4) extolling handsomeness; (5) a new “who is this” line. On the one hand, it is (a) hard to explain why this material would be added – though not impossible, especially in the cases of (1), (2), and (4) – and (b) notable how much the alleged interpolation matches in style, content, and tone the surrounding material. Might the long reading be an abbreviation after all? On the other hand, many undoubted interpolations in other books match, to an extent, the style and tone of the surrounding material, and, as mentioned above, the added material might be a sort of “extended meditation,” and, as shown at length above, there are stylistic dissonances.

Two factors lean me, as of 5/9/18, toward the MG version: (a) 4QCant^a contains several apparent lexical updates (אינה, not a biblical form; probably מזקנתך), transpositions in the interest of harmony (שערך etc.), and

assimilations (בנות ירושלם), making it seem like the sort of text that might rework, rather than faithfully preserve; (b) it remains a distinct possibility that 4QCant^b ends at 5:1, in which case it would be certain that abbreviation was a phenomenon even without major resequencing and was at work specifically in SS.

6/27/18 update: Note that while the 1QCanta word order in 4:1-2 brings those verses into conformity (viz. in the frontedness of the *kaph* of comparison) to vv3-4, v5 is left along even though it does not follow the initial-*kaph* pattern. That said, perhaps v5 was left untouched owing to the influence of 7:3.

11/3/18 update: Cf. the comments on “Tabernacle Account” in Research Notes.

See further:

-Brian P. Gault, "The Fragments of 'Canticles' from Qumran: Implications and Limitations for Interpretation," *Revue de Qumrân* 24.3, 2010, pp. 351–371

-Emanuel Tov, "Excerpted and Abbreviated Biblical Texts from Qumran," *Revue de Qumrân* 16.4, 1995, pp. 581–600. (“With some hesitation they [4QCant^{a,b}] are described here [viz. in Tov's essay] as abbreviated texts, although there are no exact parallels for this assumption among other Qumran texts” 591.) Yet cf. 4QPsⁿ (p 592) and (just possibly) 4QEze^a (p 506); in the case of the former, note first that it is a psalm and therefore liturgical forces might be at work and second that the jump is from one verse to (and including) another very similar to it, whereas 4QCant^{a,b} do not jump from one similar verse to another, though they could easily have done so. For another possible abbreviated text not mentioned by Tov, see “4Q47 (4QJosh): An Abbreviated Text?” by Ariel Feldman, an essay in *Is there a Text in This Cave? Studies in the Textuality of the Dead Sea Scrolls in Honor of George J. Brooke* Studies on the Text of the Desert of Judah vol. 119 Brill 2017, pp152-63; but as THB notes, this may be a re-worked text and so not at all exhibiting the same phenomenon as 4QCant^{a,b} or it may be a better text than either G or M and therefore would (1) not support the abbreviation theory for SS and (2) tend to support the idea that M-SS has one (or, just possibly, more) interpolations.

-Emanuel Tov, "Three Manuscripts (Abbreviated Texts?) of Canticles from Cave 4," *Journal of Jewish Studies* 46, 1995, 88–111.

Places in SS where G has a notable lack of a conjunction (possibly preferable on a G priority theory):

-2:4 דגלו (but corrupt haplography after הדין?)

-2:12 קול (but assimilation to frequent asyndeton in context??)

-2:13 הגפנים (but assimilation to frequent asyndeton in context??)

-5:5 ידי (but near haplography before *yodh*?)

-5:5 אצבעתי (assimilation to asyndeton, or near haplography after *resh*??)

-5:6 דודי (assimilation to this form many times elsewhere in book, or near haplography after *yodh*?)

-6:2 ללקט (assimilation to asyndeton??) [is this last entry in error?]

Of these, the asyndetic readings are *most* preferable where there are (immediately above) *two* question marks (since there the proposed reason why the asyndeton could be considered secondary is most dubious)

SS 1:1

See SRO general introduction. Further comments:

On Tirzah, see Kitto 3: 1009^b-1010^a [PDF 1046-47]; {archaeological works?}

SS 2:13

While certainty is hardly possible, the Qr seems preferable. It is doubtful whether the 2nd person fem. -i ending appears in late texts, and appears nowhere else in SS (on 4:9 see the comment below) despite ample opportunity for it to appear. The Kt might be mechanical assimilation to the previous word. Note that there is Q evidence for Qr. Cf. v10.

SS 4:9a

The spelling לבבתיני is to be looked upon with much suspicion, as, according to Ginsburg's apparatus, it is a

Western reading. Perhaps it originated when the <ti> sound was misinterpreted (in a sort of aural / mental *lapsus calumni*) as the 1st person singular ending. A similar error occurs in some MSS at 2:14.

SS 4:12 [If 4QCanta does *not* have priority in 4:8-6:10]

The M reading is likely due to anticipation of the final letter of the word נעול shortly to be repeated. This verse employs a form of the pattern A + X / A + B.

SS 8:4-5

Given that elsewhere L may wrongly have a closed for an open section (1:4-5, 5:1-2, and 6:3-4) and the fact that a clear majority of the MSS collated in Pericope vol. 4 pp. 108-109 n¹⁵ (referring to p. 106) have an open section here, a correction to L seems advisable here. (M^A is sadly unavailable here.)

Lam 1:11

The Kt is unaccountable, for (1) the *patach* could hardly have an *o* reflex in such a case, and (2) Blau under “noun patterns” lists no structure similar to this. Important too are the two Qumran fragments which lack the *waw* in question (see Ulrich). The error admittedly not completely clear as to its origin; perhaps corrupt dittography of the *daleth* (in either the square or the paleo script this seems possible).

{Post-script: But Kt could be the preposition “from” + the (pseudo-)noun *chamud* (qal passive from *chamad*) or could be the noun *machmod*—which latter noun occurs in v7; so Kt is plausible. That said, (corrupt) dittographs are a large share of the (admittedly small, in absolute terms) errors in M-Lam; and OG translates both the same way, and that as a true noun, not a passive form. M could be a *plene* assimilation to v7. So the case is uncertain, but the form without a medial *waw* still seems preferable.}

{Post-post-script: In defense of Qr, see now ICC (69).}

Lam 1:16

Dittography: WBC's scansion of this poem does not show a 4 in the second element (that is, to the right of the “+” sign) elsewhere in this poem.

Lam 2:2a-b

See Freedman, *Pottery, Poetry, and Prophecy*, 27-28 for a convincing argument.

Note that the enclitic *mem* is pointed מֶמֶץ on the analogy of חֶלֶקֶם in 4:16, קֶבֶצֶם in Mic 4:12, and other similar cases.

{Post-script: Note that appeal to an enclitic *mem* is not necessary. Dittography is at least as good an option.}

Lam 3:30

So (to judge by his translation) Allen; so also (at least) HALOT 2: 1458a and (apparently) NIV⁸⁴. *Waw/yodh* confusion, facilitated by a collection of somewhat interrelated and somewhat obscure roots שוה, שיח, שחה, שזה.

Lam 3:32a

L has a Kt-Qr, but JC (and many other MSS: Davidson) have L-Qr as the text w/o any Qr.

Lam 3:22b

See Allen, 174-175.

Lam 4:21

Corrupt dittography, or just possibly an emendation. See ICC.

Lam 5:22

See ICC and Allen for discussion. While I have wondered whether מֶם can be asseverative, even if so, the word

here is probably in error, being a dittograph (with metathesis) of the following word, facilitated by the commonness of the collocation **כי אם**.

Intro to Ecc

The following notes have not been thoroughly rewritten after switching from G to M priority. (Note that M is still held to exhibit many unintentional errors.)

Ecc 1:5

See BHQ 65*, adding that G has an assimilation also in 2:3.

Ecc 1:13

See BHQ 67* and note further that elsewhere in the OT **אלהים** after **ירא** lacks the article, so M might be simply an assimilation.

Ecc 3:18

M may be due to dittography from **בהמה** plus skipping over a word.

Ecc 4:17

Re Kt-Qr, cf. the external evidence (pretty strong for sg.; MT = inner M error?), Pr 3:26, and the (confusingly worded, to be sure) opinion of BHQ.

Ecc 5:5

G could be a forward assimilation, but it seems somewhat more likely that M is a theological adjustment. {But I have revised this}

Ecc 5:16a

Reading **ואבל** has the advantage of readily explaining M as a transcriptional error (two similar letters in the Herodian script, though which M obviously passed). A second **av** is, as BHQ notes, probable in LXX {have not checked Gottingen}; though this is hard to explain, perhaps it is unconscious backwards assimilation on the part of the translator (or possibly a Hebrew-language scribe).

Ecc 5:16b

As BHQ notes, the final letter in M is due to dittography.

Ecc 7:10

MT (and probably T) is an inner-M error (Heordian script?). Thus usage is problematic and readily explainable as visual error (perhaps facilitated by the recent **מאלה**).

Ecc 8:8a

As to deciding between **המות** and **מות** here (the pointing of **במלחמה** hanging on the decision): The G reading could be an assimilation to the syntax of 7:14, yet that passage could just as easily be taken as intrinsic evidence for G here. Indeed, an article follows **ביום** in the MT 69% of the time (and a significant number of the remaining 31% involves forms with pronominal suffixes), so M could be an assimilation to usual usage. Moreover, much of the 31% involves wisdom literature. On the whole, then, intrinsic evidence, as well as the preference given to G elsewhere in this book, leans one strongly toward **מות**.

Ecc 8:10a-b

See the essay in *Florilegium Lovaniense* (=Martinez FS) for extensive and helpful discussion on this difficult verse. Provisionally my reconstruction is assumes (1) a change from **מובאים** to **ובאו**, which first change assumes (a) haplography after the final *mem* of the preceding word (as the essay just cited notes as a possibility); and (b)

waw/yodh confusion + haplography of *mem*, this time due to the nearby *mem* in the next word, i.e., using non-final letters to make things clearer, קברִיִּם מוֹבָאִים וּמִמָּקוֹם became, whether in two discreet steps or, as we think more likely, in one step, קברִיִּם וּבָאוּ וּמִמָּקוֹם. My reconstruction further assumes (2) an original וַיִּשְׁתַּבְּחוּ became by *beth/kaph* confusion (on this point I agree with the essay).

Note that, given the translation technique for this book, and *pace* the essay, what is to be reconstructed for the *Vorlage* for the OG of יהלכו rather than the essay's והלכו for MT יהלכו. My suggestion is that we have corrupt haplography triggered by the following *he* in the paleo script in G. The M versional evidence which seems to support the G reading is harder to explain. There loss of *yodh*, which by then had become a small letter, seems possible; alternatively, we could have assimilation to the earlier perfect verb ובאו, as it by then was found in M MSS, or paraphrase, or some combination of these options. The G reading is possible but leaves the MT reading difficult to explain, while the MT reading seems slightly better on intrinsic grounds (as a habitual imperfect), though admittedly the path from it to the other readings is a bit complex.

The translation would my understanding of the text be something like (adapting Rotherham): “And, thereupon, I considered the lawless as to their graves they were brought, that [*waw* of specification] from the place of the Holy One they used to go and be lauded in the city wherein they had so done,--even this, was vanity.” The next verse goes on to say “Because sentence against a wicked work is not executed speedily (Ecc 8:11 ROT).” That is, as the essay suggests, it puzzles the preacher that the death of the wicked, whose wicked lives were lauded even though their hypocrisy was plain through their visits to the Temple, is widely separated from their evil and/or hypocrisy. Note that a frequentive sense of יהלכו would help my line of argument here, but if it be objected that this usage no longer held in this linguistic period (a point to look into), or that the reasoning of this passage is unlikely to have hung on a particular nuance of a tense-form, the thrust of Qohelet's argument is made clear by the clause in which the city's praise is heaped upon the wicked, for such implies that divine retribution for their sins was not immediate, which non-immediacy brings Qohelet to his point in v11.

Certainly all this argumentation on my part is intrinsic, but the difficulty this verse has visited upon commentators perhaps justifies a somewhat involved approach. Textual criticism and exegesis are each not always simple undertakings!

Ecc 8:17

BHQ is noncommittal, but M is probably an assimilation to usual usage (הָאָדָם is common in Ecc; אָדָם is uncommon and with the possible exception of 8:1 occurs only where the syntax requires it).

Ecc 9:2a

M is clearly a transcriptional error (see BHQ).

Ecc 9:2b

Technically this reading – the rival of which is easily explained on transcriptional grounds – is found only in Jerome, yet see BHQ on the strong probability that the LXX originally so read. The sense is “in that,” explicating the thought at the end of v1 (as divided in SROtxt).

Ecc 9:2c

This word could easily have been omitted in this lengthy series, and external evidence favors it. There is, moreover, no obvious parallel to which the long reading could be an assimilation.

Ecc 9:4

Metathesis. Given the error in 1 Sam 20:30, Holladay's בָּחַר II is thus a ghost form.

Ecc 10:1

The external evidence is overwhelming (see BHQ). This is thus a rare instance where MT departs from M in a non-trivial way.

Introduction to Esther

{Arguments for short text}

According to BibleWorks, forms of כֹּל occur 73x in MT, but even as this word is very frequently missing in the MT relative to the LXX, πᾶς occurs 76x in the LXX. Such might show that the Greek tradition behind, or the Hebrew tradition translated into, the additional material in the LXX is unafraid of כֹּל/πᾶς. If so, this increased the likelihood that the *Vorlage* of LXX often lacked כֹּל where MT has it. Put along the frequent pluses of MT relative to LXX with respect to names and explicit grammatical subjects, this suggests that the MT is a padded out text. The multitude of forms of Esther (see especially IOSCS 30 on the OG, AT, OL, and Aramaic) suggests that this was a very popular book (but then why the absence from Qumran?), or one popular to rework. The more popular a text, or at least the more popular a text to rework, the less likely that an altogether pure strain of text would happen to be the one copy from which either the MT or the OG (whatever that is in this case) worked. There is, in other words, a case to be made that G/LXX expands with respect to the large pluses and sundry other matters, but the MT expands with many minor matters.

The LXX in 3:3 might support a translator-created abbreviation model, but see the comments on that below.

Concerning the intrinsic evidence against the AT text, see Jobes, especially in her discussion of the central importance of chapter 2 to the plot of the book as whole. The AT is free rendering of a reworked (=abbreviated and resequenced) version of Est with the Greek additions added in.

{Arguments for long text}

The LXX is highly paraphrastic, and such could easily include condensation (cf. van der Vorm-Crouchs re Is, noting there that omission of a subject can hardly be so common a phenomenon in Is as in Est, inasmuch as the former is not narrative; the parallel with LXX-Is is especially strong with regards to synonymous language). Such a scenario certainly has parallels in, for example, P elsewhere. Note also a degree of interweaving in LXX-Est (e.g. the content of a minus is often expressed in a plus fairly nearby, a plus often arguably Greek in style; note also examples like 3:13 ספרים discussed in the research notes file). (Such interweaving is *not*, so far as I am aware, attested in LXX-Jer.)

The chief difficulty would be if AT is an independent translation of a Hebrew MS, for in this case it is difficult not to see as existing a Hebrew-language short text, inasmuch as (see Jobes) most of the short readings relative to MT are shared by LXX-AT. One option is that AT is earlier than LXX (as Jobes would argue), and that the LXX was an attempt to bring it more in alignment with the MT (a potential parallel would be the manner in which Th-Dan is thought to have displaced OG-Dan as a closer rendering of the MT; the LXX's attitude toward the Additions might have been the same as Jerome's regarding the Daniel Additions). A difficulty with this view is that LXX-Est is not especially literal (but Th-Dan is not highly literal, either). Another option is that AT is later and further condenses and rearranges, though if so, it must have consulted a Hebrew-language MS on some points (see Jobes on the Hebrew script-specific variants and note the handful of places where an LXX minus relative to MT is *not* present in AT).

11/3/18 update: Cf. the comments on “Tabernacle Account” in Research Notes.

Est 1:16

A proper name (see BDB) transposed in MT (see BHQ).

Esther 3:7

Very difficult; see BHQ *141-42. BHS proposes reading לחדש לחדש for MT לחדש on the basis of P, but P would actually seem to reflect בחדש בחדש. To this latter reading Pr 1:14 might be taken as a parallel, but the meaning there is probably “divide lots over spoil in our company” (for the idea there see NICOT). Yet given the flex of Hebrew prepositions, especially ל and ב, might בחדש have been for the author a legitimate option? This does seem a reach, and in any case P alone seems unlikely as the only surviving repository of the original text (though homoeoteleuton is of course polygenetic).

Another option would seem to be to insert ויפל הגורל על from OG, notwithstanding the objection recorded

in BHQ that OG certainly contains significant secondary elements elsewhere in the verse. The difficulty here is two-fold: (1) It is not perfectly clear how this phrase dropped out; and (2) it is not clear whether a number can be used without the word חַדָּשׁ in a context like this. Ginsburg and others on the basis of OG add לַחֲדָשׁ after the number, but this makes for a very strained transcriptional situation to arrive at MT from there.

{Post-script: For a solution that seems plausible, see WBC 380-381.}

לְהַשְׁמִיד עִם מְרַדְּכִי בַיּוֹם אֶחָד וַיִּפֹּל הַגּוֹרֵל עַל שְׁלֹשָׁה עָשָׂר יוֹם לַחֲדָשׁ

Est 4:12

Cf. EEC. Perhaps M is corrupt dittography, facilitated by a misreading of the third vowel as /i/ instead of /e/, a misreading in turn facilitated by the rare, full spelling וַיִּגִּיד.

Est 6:13

Following the suggestion of HALOT (1:314b); M(T) is visual error, facilitated by the *hapax legomenon*. BHQ notes that OG uses οἱ φιλοῖ a number of times, positing in that version a kind of “terminological standardization” (iirc); the scope of the translator's use of this Greek term, however, by no means precludes his having reading רַחֲמֵי here, especially as—as BHQ also notes—P so reads as well. The commentaries make clear that the same group of people is in view, and in such a context חַכְמָיו does not make sense.

Est 8:13

There is significance MT MS evidence for the Qr (see BHQ), *waw/yodh* confusion is quite possible, the more Aramaic-like form might be intrinsically more likely, and a tendency toward עָתִיד might be in evidence in Isa 10:13^{Qr}; some weight, too, must be attached to the reading tradition in Est 3:14, where a vocalization עֲתִידִים would have been possible but has not materialized.

Est 10:1

Kt is very hard to account for except as an error (haplography triggered by the visual similarity of the following *resh*; possibly triggered also by the fact that we are near the end of a short book, so perhaps the scribe was pushing through to the end despite fatigue). We thus agree with WBC, q.v.

Dan 2:23

This was brought to my attention by Oort (135). Assimilation to the number of בִּיעֲנָא. The context makes it clear that Daniel was the one to whom it was revealed (v19, 24, etc.).

Dan 2:29

See BHS, adding that Th appears to support the plural. The *yodh* in question could easily have been lost in the visually similar series *yodh-nun-yodh-(final)kaph*.

Dan 3:15a

In this particular instance, note that the SRO-1 base text had קִיתָרִס, as indicated in the spreadsheet, with קִיתָרוֹס as the (orthographic) correction. However, UXLC 2.2 updated the Kt to be קִיתָרִס, and JC and MM both lack a *waw* as well. Therefore, Column D has been changed from קִיתָרוֹס to קִיתָרִס and the tag has been changed from O to Kt.

Dan 3:19

See Olariu (372). Most of his examples are not too convincing, involving longer sections and probable abbreviation; but here the plus is very brief, might be a dittography (if not simply a mechanical repetition of one of the stock phrases of the book), is corroborated by the OG, the locution וְאָמַר can stylistically stand on its own in this book (cf. esp. 2:12); and, as Olariu points out, “this is the only instance when the [fuller] phrase does not introduce direct speech.”

Dan 4:6

See Concordia (230-231). Forms of חזה occurs 31x in L, while forms of חזו occur 12x. However, the former is a common word across all literature, while the latter has a more “biblical” ring to it and therefore would stick in the mind more. Also, the form חזוי, with and without prefixes, occurs 9x in Dan, so it in particular would be prominent in a scribe's mind. Finally, corrupt dittography could be at work.

Dan 5:7b (+16, 29)

Retroverting the OG (cf. 1 Esdras 3:6, Plutarch *Cim.* 9.3 [Noonan 96 n²¹¹]); on the form and etymology, see Noonan, 95-96. M(T) is *waw/yodh* confusion to which the other two occurrences of this rare term were assimilated. The Qr reflects developments in later Hebrew reflecting complicated etymologies.

Dan 5:27

L has חקילתה, JC and MM have חקילת, and Ginsburg (w/ no note) and VDH both have חקילתא (even as both, there in agreement w/ JC against L, have חלתה in 6:3); external support seems to support the *aleph* reading.

Dan 7:20a

Cf. the note on 5:5a.

Dan 7:20c

MT is corrupt dittography.

Dan 8:14

M (T) is corrupt haplography. In reading אליי BHS and Concordia (398) concur.

Dan 9:17

Corrupt haplography. See BHS and cf v19.

Dan 11:1

I think Oort brought this to my attention; BDB (at least) agrees. Assimilation to the preceding המדי most likely (less likely, loss of a *t* after a *d*).

Dan 11:10b

Re *second* Kt-Qr: Most likely, a faded left half of the *he* (as elsewhere) (less likely, assimilation to some earlier plurals, but some singulars intervene).

Dan 11:12

Re Kt-Qr: A bit difficult. Perhaps Kt = transposition + dittography of the *resh*, or *waw/yodh* confusion + addition of a helping letter.

Introduction to Ezra-Nehemiah

If one assumes 1 Esdras priority, one supposes the MT to be basically this text (with some transposition in the case of Zerubbabel) interwoven with the Nehemiah Memiors (NM) (which seem to be attested externally by Josephus; on the late date note the THB remark regarding Josh that there is no clear evidence for a firm MT until surprisingly late). If one assumes that the Three Youths narrative is an addition, then this must have been added to 1 Esdras only after the compilation of MT-Ezra-Nehemiah. (Just possibly the same is true for the larger overlap with 2 Chr found in 1 Esdras.) Such could have been the work of the Greek translator, or of a Hebrew *Vorlage*. The basic motivation for expanding this text into MT would presumably be to supplement the narrative with additional information about the return from exile, the Nehemiah memiors being a handy way to do this. The evidence from Josephus is striking indeed – a Nehemiah narrative in circulation is plausible, and it is plausible that someone would interweave it with the Ezra narrative, explaining the MT; while for someone to have split the MT in two and for the LXX to have access to and credulous of the Ezra portion but not the Neh portion,

even as Josephus had access specifically to 1 Esdras as well as to the NM seems less likely.

If one assumes MT priority, one assumes that a scribe trimmed the Nehemiah material, trimmed the references to the rebuilding of Jerusalem, transposed (for chronological reasons?) the Zerubbabel material, expanded the intro, and added the Three Youths. The primary motivation presumably would be to maximize the role of Ezra (a celebrated figure in Jewish history, to be sure) by minimizing the role of Nehemiah; secondarily, the revisor added interesting material (the Three Youths) and expanded the introduction (from 2 Chr), unless, as mentioned with respect to the other scenario, one or both of these elements is a later intrusion into the 1 Esdras text (as I recall, some argue that the Three seems stylistically different from the rest of 1 Esdras and so may be an inner-LXX corruption, albeit a major one). The minimization/maximization would be paralleled in the AT of Esther; the Three Youths is potentially paralleled in the Esther/Daniel additions (Td-Dan is especially significant in this connection, in that the translation of clearly Semitic text is literal, yet the large interpolation, not certainly Semitic in origin and certainly not original to Dan, are retained, whether at the design of the translator of Th-Dan or by scribal convention). (11/3/18 update: Cf. the comments on “Tabernacle Account” in Research Notes.)

Excursus 1: 1 Esdras could be said to occupy the place that the AT would have occupied had it gained wider circulation alongside LXX-Est. The case of Greek-Dan is interesting in this connection. There one version apparently supplanted the other. It is interesting that the same did not happen with 1 and 2 Esdras. Perhaps the content was different enough to warrant different treatment, though the AT is arguably almost as different from LXX-Est as 1 Esdras is from 2 Esdras. Perhaps the AT simply did not circulate in influential circles, though its survival in the medieval period (and partial attestation in OL and Josephus suggest that it was widespread at one point). Or perhaps it did not gain firm standing in the Greek OT tradition because of a lack of *Vorlage* (yet several books in the Greek OT are thought to have been written in Greek).

Another option is that 1 Esdras (to some extent at least) and the NM (attested at least in some form by Josephus) are the source materials which the author/editor of canonical Ezra-Nehemiah used in his composition. (A parallel situation would be if the records of Gad or the book of Jashar were extant.) Yet the chronological and other discrepancies between 1 Esdras and MT (see below) would seem to speak against this, for the author/editor of the canonical book would in this case evidently be considerably reworking the content (not just the form/style) of two records (viz. the *Vorlage* of 1 Esdras and the NM) both earlier than himself and, evidently, deemed trustworthy enough to form the verbal basis for his own work.

A key question is whether the historical difficulties in MT are insuperable (and any parallel difficulties in 1 Esdras are not similarly insuperable, in which we will have simply exchanged one uncertain case for another) – viz. the identity of Sheshbazzar and the extent of the rebuilding. As to the first: Kitto (3:1157^b) says, “The name Sheshbazzar was the Chaldee or Persic name which he had after the analogy of Belteshazzar, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego.” (Check HALOT on the etymology.) This is hard to prove or disprove. (How plausible is the time frame? Cyrus' decree is 539 BC [Archeological Study Bible]; Haggai and Zechariah minister 18 years later, perhaps having been mere children at the time of the return, as suggested by the wording in Zech 2:4 [ibid]). {}

As to the second question (viz. the extent of the rebuilding), {}

Excursus 2: We should not say that the Masoretes got their canon wrong if we posit the priority of the text of 1 Esdras. {Indeed, did not some of the early sources name the book simply “Ezra”? Look into this.} The number of books in the Jewish canon was apparently never in serious doubt by the orthodox. If 1 Esdras has priority, the situation in the MT is this: The archetype of the MT happened to use a badly interpolated text of Ezra, just as it happened to use a badly interpolated text of Jeremiah. The LXX, meanwhile, is not in truth “the Greek OT” (despite the convenience of this label) but rather a collection of translations of various notable items of Jewish literature into Greek. Alongside such things as 1 Enoch, this tradition produced a rendering of the *Vorlage* of Ezra-Nehemiah, which rendering we refer to as 2 Esdras. The only difference from other cases (or most other cases, if we take the AT and Th-Dan into account) is that the tradition produced a translation, not of altogether a new book, but of a different *Vorlage* of a book that had already been translated (viz. 1 Esdras). (Alternatively, 2 Esdras is a translation of another book, Ezra-Nehemiah being a Rewritten work based on Ezra. In this case, appealing to Ezra-Nehemiah for support for a different reading in Ezra would be akin to using a

Rewritten Pentateuch for textual criticism of a Pentateuchal book.) To summarize: This is not a question of canon, but of textual criticism. 1 Esdras *is* a translation of Ezra-Nehemiah, just of a very different *Vorlage*, just as a translation of 4QCant^b would be a translation of Song of Songs.

{Post-script: Neh 11:33 is apparently lacking in G, and the long reading may be suspect on intrinsic grounds: Cf. BDB sub רמה. {But this is not a strong argument, for diachronics could very plausibly explain this, if not indeed synchronic variation as with לבנון.}}

Ezra 2:25

If I recall right BHQ suggests יערים but the loss of the initial *yodh* is harder to account for than transposition.

Ezra 2:50a

The Qr is supported by G V and the parallel Neh 7:52 (where, interestingly, the opposite error occurred in G).

Ezra 2:67

See WBC, adding the strong possibility of transcriptional error. Now, BHQ points to Neh 7:68 as having חמרים, but while such is strictly true, that latter verse *also* has גמלים, not גמליהם as in our verse; moreover, G-Neh 7:68 adds αὐτῶν to *neither* animal noun.

Ezra 3:5

See also 1 Chr 20:4, 2 Chr 20:1, 2 Chr 20:35, 2 Chr 24:4.

Ezra 3:10

See BHQ – MT is probably an inner-M accidental supplying of a *plene* spelling based on a careless reading of the text.

Ezra 4:2

While MT could be an aural error, it is hard not (with BHQ) to see this as theological meddling. If so, it is striking that apparently it is an inner-M error, not a proto-M error, unless (V) P independently corrected ולו to ולא.

Ezra 4:9a

A difficult case, as, on the one hand, אדין is all but impossible to construe sensibly, while on the other hand, the external evidence (1 Es 2:17) is slim. It is to be noted that OG (ταδε εαρινεν) has either a conflation or a dittography, whether based on אדין or based on a verb based on the root דין. Tentatively, I appeal to transcriptional error: The last letter of v8 is *aleph*, and the first word (of v9) after אדין is רחום which (particularly as regards its beginning) a real resemblance to the part of אדין which follows *aleph* – that is, אדין appears to be a corrupt dittograph.

Ezra 5:4

See the commentaries, and see v3 both for intrinsic evidence and for the OG rendering. Mechanical assimilation to the preceding כנמא, visual error (*yodh* + *final nun* could be, it seems to me, mistaken for *aleph* in a cramped hand), or one facilitated by the other. (Other possible readings deserve mention, viz. אמר defective or אמרו verbal.)

Ezra 6:15

See HALOT 2: 1993a.

Ezra 8:5

See the commentaries, adding this: OG (and 1 Esdras) did not have זתא, else they would have rendered ζαθουα as in Ezra 2:8 etc. (I have double-checked some of the relevant passages in 2 Esdras and in 1 Esdras from Gottingen); they, I theorize, saw זתא, and mentally pointed it not as זתא but as זתא.

Ezra 8:10

See the commentaries. The presence of the *daghesh* is modeled after 10:29 (contrast כְּנִי in 10:34, where מְבִנִּי, rather than וּמְבִנִּי as here).

Ezra 8:17b-c

“...what to say to Iddo and [to] his brothers who were appointed over...” – Combining elements of WBC and BHQ (43*).

Ezra 10:16

MT is probably a corrupt dittography in a Herodian script.

Ezra 10:41

See THB sample from vol. 5, the thrust of which is that the יהו suffix does not occur elsewhere in Ezra. See LXX.

Ezra 10:44

Re Kt-Qr: The Kt is represented as in WLC 4.20 (not 4.14. = WTT). We follow Qr = OG.

Neh 3:15

See BHQ, with the modification that the form could very well be וַיַּעֲמֵד, in which case MT = transposition + *waw/yodh* confusion. Another possibility is that the erroneous final *waw* in MT is due to a fatigued scribe assimilating to the previous three words which ending in *waw* or an *u* sound, although the sense is different in those cases. Yet see on 5:9 below.

Neh 3:30, 31

MT אַחֲרֵי is probably corrupt haplography for אַחֲרָיו, given (1) the flow of the context and (2) the fact that אַחֲרֵי with a finite verb is apparently attested elsewhere with a temporal, not a spacial sense (see HALOT 1: 36a). Admittedly, it seems strange for the same error to occur twice, but note the apparent fatigue in MT specifically in v13.

Neh 5:9

MT is an inner-M error involving transposition + *waw/yodh* confusion.

Neh 5:15

Following OG as reconstructed from VL (cf. esp. BHQ and WBC; also THB 3C re VL-Ezra-Nehemiah).

Neh 8:6

L appears to be an inner-MT error; see, e.g. MM.

Neh 9:17a

See BHQ.

Neh 9:17b

MT is hard to explain, though a definite possibility is mechanical repetition of the *waw* prefix after the preceding וַיִּרְבֵּ; cf. the obvious lapse earlier in the verse. Yet a non-conjunctive use of the *waw* prefix seems unlikely at this stage of Hebrew, and there is a set phrase in play. G is much preferable.

Neh 12:9

Re Kt-Qr: (O)G not habet, but the revision has the Qr, as does (at least) V, which name is known elsewhere (see

BDB).

Neh 12:46a, b

Tentatively, we resolve this difficult verse by assuming (w/ OG) that the conjunction on אסף is corrupt haplography after דויד (it is just possible that it is original, and a resumptive *waw*; but such seems unlikely in so late a book). Then singular ראש can refer to him. (NEB proposes repointing מְקַדֵּם, but the sense that this context would require seems not to be attested in the OT; cf. BDB).

1 Chr 1:7

See Allen 2: 96.

1 Chr 2:18

Following WBC (37 n^{18.b-b}) and possibly NAC (a bit unclear); partially KEL. S (*I have* verified w/ Leiden) T Aq; admittedly a bit strange of external evidence, but the verse is difficult in any case, and the late date of Chr makes the G less chronologically distinct from the MT text as in most other books, so a shared error is less surprising (cf. 5:41). M = *he/taw* confusion + wrong word division.

1 Chr 3:6

See Allen 2: 96, adding that אלישמע is much more common in the OT than אלישוע is.

1 Chr 3:19

The words בני and בן (with and without the conjunction) both occur so frequently in the first chapters of 1 Chr that confusion would be easy, and by this point, mid-way through chapter three, fatigue can be expected to be afflicted many a scribe. Note also that in 1:41 and 2:7 it is a plural, not a singular, that is anomalous. Cf. further v21b below.

1 Chr 3:21b

Scribal fatigue (cf. on v19 above) combined with the graphic similarity of *waw* and *yodh* led to both erroneous suffixes and to a jumbled sequence here. On the intrinsic evidence, see *Hamlet on a Hill* (580-85). It is to be noted that in (at least) 1:41 (cf. WBC's textual note there) the OG preserves the unexpected plural, so we do not have a thorough-going facilitating *Tendenz* in this respect, which bolsters the testimony of G here. Yet again, it seems probable (cf. on ידייתון) that M-Chr often errs with respect to *waw/yodh* confusion. Admittedly, in v22 G has ובני for וכן, but if that v is not in fact an error in M, an isolated assimilation in G is not hard to imagine.

1 Chr 3:24

See Allen 2: 107. OG can plausibly be conjectured so to have read, and V so reads. {Haven't checked Leiden.} Qr is a *plene* spelling. {See also Gogel (101).}

1 Chr 4:15

It is not clear (see Allen 2: 106 for discussion) what G reads, but V {have not check Leiden-P} supports what on intrinsic grounds seems to be the better reading, which reading also explains MT by faulty word division.

1 Chr 4:20

(KEL 110 has a typo, but from the external evidence cited and from the translation on p. 109 it is evident that the Qr is preferred.)

1 Chr 4:28

See BHS to Josh 19:2 and Talmon (303).

1 Chr 5:18

“MT would require the article” (Allen 2: 96). Ibid posits assimilation to ולגדי in v26, but another possibility is corrupt dittography (note the following *waw*). That this error requires the square script is a point in its favor, as possibly the book was thus composed; probably at any rate the OG was translated from a square MS (Tov).

1 Chr 5:25

L, which has little or no (to go off JC, Ginsburg) is probably an assimilation to the spelling of this form and similar forms which most often obtain in this book (so, at least, also 6:4).

1 Chr 5:26

Probably corrupt dittography (cf. commentaries). It seems unlikely that the OG translator would coincidentally omit a place name unknown to modern archaeologists, while retaining many elements doubtless obscure to him in this v and elsewhere.

1 Chr 5:41

See WBC and note that the external evidence is the same as in 2:18.

1 Chr 6:6

See Allen 2: 96. He posits assimilation to the *-waw* terminus of the surrounding words, which is possible; also possible is assimilation from a personal name not found elsewhere to one which *is*.

The pointing is based on the hypothesis that the form here is short for עדיאל.

1 Chr 6:8a-b

See Allen 2: 103. Note that most OG MSS have a plus here at agrees with M. We tentatively agree with Allen's implicit judgment (does his volume 1 explicate?) that the shorter OG text is original. Intrinsic evidence certainly favors the minus: “Exod 6.24 : Elkanah and Abiasaph were brothers” (ibid.).

1 Chr 6:25

See Allen 2: 111 and BDB sub מעשיהו.

1 Chr 6:43

Following OG^L, which iirc correctly THB says sometimes revises towards a Hebrew text similar but not identical to MT – OG for its part may have a separate, perhaps inner-greek corruption – and mirroring Josh 21:15.

1 Chr 6:44

This fills out the list and accords with Josh 21:16. The OG may be corrupt, but note the addition elsewhere of a final *nu* (e.g. Ωσαν for חושה in 4:4).

1 Chr 6:46

A gloss (so WBC 97) or (more likely imo) a corrupt dittograph.

1 Chr 7:6

Note (1) the ease with which this error could occur before בנימן and (2) that the external evidence is like that of 2:18 and 5:41 (I *have* verified P; I have *not* looked into Aq, who, if he is not extant, can be hypothesized so also to have read) with the coincidental addition (via emendation?) of MSS G^L V.

1 Chr 9:38 Note the parallel passage 8:32. Allen (2: 95) supposes this to be an inner-G assimilation, but *he/mem* confusion is the square script is more than possible.

1 Chr 9:41

The spelling of L (a minority reading within the tradition as a whole, to go off Ginsburg) is probably an

assimilation to 8:35.

1 Chr 9:42

See Allen 2: 94 and cf. BDB sub יהועדה. Comparison with 8:36 makes intrinsic evidence for G here very strong, especially as assimilation in G is not likely at work since the forms of the names are slightly different (cf. Allen); moreover, *daleth/resh* confusion is endemic in the MS tradition.

1 Chr 10:11

See Allen 2: 108.

1 Chr 11:11a

See 2 Sam-Concordia (449-450). (Note, however, that here the error might not be orthodox corruption, esp. given forms elsewhere in M-Chr, but rather visual error, a faint upper shaft of the *lamedh* leading a (final?) *mem* to be seen.)

1 Chr 11:11b

The meaning and text of the terms ראש השלשים and ראש השלש are problematic. The key passages are:

(1) 2 Sam 23:8 (quoted in (3) = 1 Chr 11:11, our verse) השלשי

(2) 2 Sam 23:18 (quoted in (4) = 1 Chr 11:20) השלשה

(3) 1 Chr 11:11 השלושים

(4) 1 Chr 11:20 השלושה

(5) 1 Chr 12:9 השלושים

The first item: One could read השלשים with most witnesses to 1 Chr 11:11, but it seems better to read with the OG (=G^L) there השלשה, assuming *waw/yodh* confusion in the paleo script, since the same error occurs in 2 Sam 23:18 (see below).

The second item: One could read השלשי if one assumes inner-greek corruption in G^L's text of (4) and some sort of early error here. However, this is rather a complicated scenario, especially given the weakness of G^L in Chr (see on (3)). It seems better to retain the MG reading in 1 Chr 11:20 and assume *waw/he* confusion (in the paleo script) in M in 2 Sam 23:18.

The third item: One could read השלושה with G^L (=be₂; see Allen vol. 1 on MS groupings in Para.). That recension does not object to item (5). On the other hand (a), they have τριων for τριακοντα in 1 Chr 11:15, a senseless reading and, more to the point, possibly indicating confusion on the part of the revisor with all the multiples of three in this passage, (b) this is quite weak external evidence, and (c) there is a possibility of inner-greek assimilation to Lucianic Samuel. Therefore it seems best to retain M (=OG) השלושים.

The fourth item: Cf. on (2).

The fifth item: The text here seems secure.

This analysis leaves us with the following:

(1') 2 Sam 23:8 (quoted in (3) = 1 Chr 11:11, our verse) השלשה

(2') 2 Sam 23:18 (quoted in (4) = 1 Chr 11:20) השלשה

(3') 1 Chr 11:11 השלושים

(4') 1 Chr 11:20 השלושה

(5') 1 Chr 12:9 השלושים

This leaves us with a consistent form in Sam, but (a) inconsistent terminology in Chr and (2) a verbal discrepancy between (1) (=2 Sam 23:8) and (3) (=1 Chr 11:11). However, when we look at items (1), (2), and (4), we have *three different individuals* identified (literally) as “the chief of the three” (whether “three” = “officers” as some suppose makes no difference on this point), so in any event these military personnel notices (a) refer to different time periods, (b) refer to various corps, (c) or some combination of these things: Different men from different backgrounds came to David at different times. (Might this help explain the other discrepancies in number between the Sam and Chr accounts of David's warriors?) Thus, while it is tempting to try to get items (1) and (3) to match exactly, the term “chief of the three/thirty” in either variation is not “literal”

(I believe this is WBC-1 Chr's word) or not *exclusive* (that is, there were not *only* three or thirty [perhaps “the thirty” were similar to the Persian Immortals], but the rank of the man in question); the terms are synonymous in such a context.

1 Chr 11:12

Re ודוד, following OG (note 2 Sam 23:9, on which see the research notes there).

1 Chr 11:14a-b

See Allen 2: 96. Though a bit unusual, the situation is not implausible (viz. mechanical repetition of the plural ending by an inattentive scribe); note that even if Chr was composed in the square script, final forms would not likely have been in vogue yet, as we have documentation of their as-yet spodic use in Massoretic MSS from centuries later. Intrinsic evidence makes MT all but impossible.

1 Chr 11:20

Re Kt-Qr, see the parallel 2 Sam 23:18, where the text is secure ($G^L = G^B = M$); here M(T) is aural error.

1 Chr 12:21

Following HALOT 1: 793a. Admittedly, OG and V are hard to assess in these cases (*Transformation*, 98-99), but might lend support; and there is solid inner-M evidence for this name, which is attested in inscriptions and bears a much more Semitic character.

1 Chr 12:34

Homoeoteteluton. (I think I was influenced by Allen here, but would have to double-check before citing.)

1 Chr 14:11

Allen 2: 97 suggests assimilation to ויעלו in v8 and notes the ויבא in the parallel passage. Sense can be made of M (“They [viz] David and his men went up, and David struck them there”), but looking at the broader context, David is consistently referred to in the plural, so intrinsic evidence favors G.

1 Chr 14:16

Possibly a mechanical repetition of the final *waw* on the earlier verb.

1 Chr 15:18a

See Allen 2: 103, adding for clarity that Allen has elsewhere demonstrated to be plausible the supposition of a particular line-length for an early exemplar, and ובניהו, similar to בן which is of course a very common word in this book, could have caused confusion. Cancellation marks, if supplied, were overlooked by a later copyist.

1 Chr 15:18b

Cf. WBC (1: 184 n^{18.e}), noting that there is no reason to retrovert a different name than in v21, although such would strength the case for the plus. The names in v18 are all otherwise repeated in the following verses, and haplography would be easy after the visually similar preceding name.

1 Chr 15:27

We follow G: Cf. WBC and note how OG renders in v22.

1 Chr 16:15

Corrupt dittography (or, just possibly, read זוכר, with זכרו being metathesis); cf. Ps 105:8.

1 Chr 16:19

Assimilated to preceding 2nd person. See further Allen 2: 97.

1 Chr 16:35

See WBC to Ps 106:47.

1 Chr 17:11

Haplography. See 2 Sam 7:12 and Allen 2: 129.

1 Chr 17:18

HALOT (1:458a). The possibility occurs to me that לכבד is a corruption of לדבר (cf. 2 Sam 7:20), but I am aware of no external evidence for this, and further emendation in the verse would be necessary.

1 Chr 17:24

Allen 2: 144 has this as a gloss, but an unintentional doublet seems more likely to me.

1 Chr 21:12

Plene spelling for נסך; cf. 2 Sam 24:13. See Allen 2: 97, though the opinion quoted there of *pe/kaph* confusion seems more likely than that offered by Allen.

1 Chr 22:7

As Allen 2: 97 points out, v11 provides strong intrinsic evidence, and external support is significant as well. His theory of assimilation to the previous verse is highly probable, though *waw/yodh* confusion is possible as well.

1 Chr 24:6

Cf. HALOT 1:32a. (G, granted, errs with regard to אחז *bis*; but this error is certainly polygenetic.)

1 Chr 26:1

See HALOT 1:5b and WBC.

1 Chr 28:18

Allen 2: 102 thinks assimilation to 2 Chr 5:8, but we judge haplography to be more likely.

1 Chr 29:3

See Allen 2: 100. His theory that the G plus is emended dittography is plausible if emended to corrupt dittography. On the other hand, as he notes the plus is the easier reading, and accidental loss of והנה before נתתי is not too hard to envision, as both words are four letters, the first two are visually similar, and the plus is not absolutely essential for the sense.

2 Chr 1:13

The path from G is admittedly a bit difficult to explain, but the hypothesis in Allen 2: 131 is plausible and M is impossible to make sense of unless the *lamedh* preposition can mean “from” in Chr which seems unlikely. Note that the translator of OG-Chron seems to avoid the article with βαμα (1 Chr 16:39, 21:29), explaining the lack of one here.

2 Chr 2:10

Cf. 1 Ki 10:9 and 2 Chr 9:8, and note that *mem* both precedes and follows the proposed *lamedh*-plus. I do not have statistics on this, but I have noticed that often transmissional errors seem to occur in places bracketed by the same letter.

2 Chr 3:2

בשני is corrupt(ed) dittography (so Allen 2: 131).

2 Chr 3:4

See WBC. I *have* verified P w/ Leiden.

2 Chr 4:10

So Allen 2: 138.

2 Chr 5:13b

M's בית יהוה ענן מלא seems improbable indeed (cf. WBC, which, without external evidence, deletes בית יהוה as a gloss). We follow G's כבוד for בית, explaining M as haplography + *waw/yodh* confusion + *daleth/taw* confusion.

2 Chr 6:27

While G could be assimilation, the pattern in this prayer is so consistent that the accidental loss of a small word seems more likely.

2 Chr 6:28

So Ginsburg (cf. 1 Ki 8:37). Corrupt dittography or mechanical anticipation of שַׁרְיָו (plus, in the case of L, shift from defective to *plene* spelling).

2 Chr 6:42

See BHS. L (which is an inner-MT error: Cf. JC, Ginsburg) is probably either a mechanical assimilation to the preceding grammatical plural or an auditory error.

2 Chr 8:9a

Allen 2: 131 cites sources “regard[ing] it [viz. אֲשֶׁר] as a corrupted dittograph of יִשְׂרָאֵל.” This is possible, or M may be a mechanical repetition (cf. the beginning of v8).

2 Chr 8:9b

See Allen 2: 129.

2 Chr 8:15

For retroversion cf. Dt 26:13 w/ LXX.

2 Chr 10:3

See the parallel passage (1 Ki 12:3). The word קהל was lost after וכל by homoeotetuton, facilitated by the fact that in Chr the phrase כל ישראל is much more common than קהל ישראל. The correspondence between Ki and Chr on these points is tight as well, so a *Tendenz* for the Chronicler is not in evidence.

2 Chr 15:11

See J-M p504 n3, noting the OG probable confirmation, the ease with which dittography would strike here, and the fact (noted by J-M) that use of the article as a relative pronoun is characteristic of the Chronicler. Holmstedt retains MT, but can only do so by positing a distinction between booty brought and booty retained at home, but this distinction seems dubious in context. (I have checked J-M re the pointing the article before he with a tsere; indeed a patach as here.)

2 Chr 17:3

Allen 2: 145 calls this a gloss, but more likely is accidental assimilation, for the phrase “David his/your father” occurs about 25x elsewhere in Chr, and בדרכי דויד occurs 2x elsewhere. Moreover, as Allen points out, the same error occurs in 15:18 in G-Chr. The same passage provides intrinsic support for G here, as do the further points

mentioned in Allen. (In terms of exegesis, it is interesting that so reading means that one need not necessarily view David's latter years as predominately negative.)

2 Chr 20:1

See Allen 2: 98 with the modification that the OG seems to support מעוניים not מעינים as the name of the people, and apart from a Qr (probably an assimilation to M-26:7) external support appears forthcoming only for the *yodh* form in 1 Chr 4:41. (The issue in Ezra 2:50 is probably a separate matter.)

2 Chr 22:9

External support much favors the *plene*. As for the vocalization, Ginsburg and some ancient versions favor a singular subject. {Commentaries?}

2 Chr 25:23

So (at least) HALOT (2:938a); see 2 Ki 14:13.

2 Chr 30:21

beith could have fallen out after a final mem due to visual simlairty (cf. Allen 2: 157). As ibid notes, v21 supports G here.

2 Chr 31:17

Allen 2: 122 argues that this is a “simplification.” This is possible, but the visual error is quite plausible, and זאח may be favored by Chr and may be favored by diachronic shifts in usage (e.g., the G text of Ex).

2 Chr 32:17

To judge by JC and Ginsburg, L lacks external support here and may be simply haplography.

2 Chr 32:24

Cf. Jenni (3: 140) and HALOT (s.v. אָמַר); visual error, facilitated by the frequency of the form ויאמר; alternatively or in addition, a species of polar error.

2 Chr 32:38

Cf. Allen 2: 108 whose view is slightly different. We take M to be an accidental mix-up due to inattention + the great visual similarity of the two words.

2 Chr 33:20

Allen 2: 138 posits homoeoarchon, which is possible but the position makes it a bit unusual in my view. The explanation might simply be the overlooking of a small word which is not absolutely necessary for a sensible clause.

2 Chr 34:5

The Qr (and T, G^L) seems to be an emendation based on the Kt. G, however, points to this reading, which, allowing for linguistic updating with respect to the article, matches the parallel passage (2 Kg 23:20). The Kt seems to be a scribal error involving the addition of two forms of the plural suffix (cf. WBC).

2 Chr 34:6

Re Kt-Qr: Obscure. Note that L is anomalous in having בָּהָר; Kennicott lists no support for this, apparently all other MSS having בְּהָר. As to the retroversion of the OG, the matter is admittedly a bit uncertain, but if MT was read is seems likely that “mountain” would have been worked in in some way; and cf. the similar renderings of חֶרֶב in Ps 102:7 and 109:10. For the pointing see BDB.

2 Chr 34:9

Allen 2: 102 thinks that the plus is “a gloss from 24.10,” but the parallel is much more conceptual than verbal. In addition, through the book Chronicles takes a real interest in the שררים. Thus there is some intrinsic support for its inclusion, a lack of a clear reason why G would add, and a transcriptional explanation for its absence (haplography).

2 Chr 35:12

Allen 2: 152 calls G the easier reading and rejects it on the principle of the harder reading, but transcriptional error (*samekh/kaph* and *resh/nun*) is quite possible so the easier reading is in my view preferable.

2 Chr 36:9

Following G and noting || 2 Ki 24:8. So (at least) Steinmann (*From Abraham to Paul*, 145-146). Haplography and/or loss due to visual similarity to the word before and the word after.

Works Cited

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- Whitley, C. F., “Some Remarks on *lu* and *lo*,” *Zeitschrift für die alttestamentliche Wissenschaft* 87 [1975]:212-14.